

CIVIL SERVICES EXAMINATION

UPSC • SOCIOLOGY (OPTIONAL) — PAPER 2



Sociology — Paper 2

Indian Society



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Introduction to the Sociology of India

1.1 The Structure of Paper 2

Paper 2 (Indian Society) is divided into three sections: Section A, Section B and Section C. Paper 1, in contrast, has no sections — Sociology is the only optional subject in which Paper 1 carries no sectioning, while Paper 2 is sectioned.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Section A — how to study India:** through Western theories or through the Indian (Brahmanical/Indological) perspective.
- **Section B — what to study in India:** caste, village, tribe and kinship (the specifically Indian phenomena).
- **Section C — social change in India:** the most important section in terms of contemporary events.

Every unit of Section C has one thing in common: all of them are about social change in India — urbanisation, industrialisation, globalisation, secularism and their impact on family, caste, village and tribe. Section A's theme is the method (how to study India); Section B's theme is the subject matter (caste, village, tribe, kinship).

DATA & FACTS

Contemporary questions in Paper 2 range between 40 and 70 marks (about 50 marks on average); the theoretical part is roughly 180–200 marks.

CRITICAL POINT

Paper 2 is **not** dynamic while Paper 1 is static — both are equally static and equally dynamic. The myth arises because people do not actually know the thinkers (they have read Ghurye but do not know Ghurye).

QUICK REVISION

- Paper 2 has three sections (A, B, C); Paper 1 has none.
- Section A = how to study India; Section B = caste/village/tribe/kinship; Section C = social change.
- Both papers are equally static and dynamic (myth to be avoided).

1.2 Studying India: Western Theories vs Indian Perspective

There are two broad approaches to studying India: through **Western theories**, or through the **Indian perspective**. The teacher deliberately writes “Indian perspective” and not “Indian theories” — India, in sociology specifically, has no theories of its own.

CRITICAL POINT

Most Indian sociologists are “Western by mind and Indian by thinking”; their minds are colonised by Western theory. Talk to any Indian sociologist and they will speak of structural functionalism, feminism or functionalism — but never of an Indian theory. India could only develop a **perspective**, not a theory.

The Western theories through which India has been studied are: **Structural Functionalism**, **Marxism**, **Subaltern**, and **Feminism**. The Indian perspective is **Indology (Orientalism)**.

KEY CONCEPT

“Indian perspective” does not mean “study by Indians alone.” A Britisher or a German scholar can also study India through the Indian perspective. You do not have to be Indian to study India.

EXAMPLE

Cultural relativism — the teacher’s example: in London (2010), a girl of about ten came up and asked him for a lighter; he was shocked and embarrassed, for a ten-year-old smoking would be unimaginable in India, yet in London it is entirely normal. This cultural shock is **cultural relativism**: every culture is unique, and one is in no position to judge another through one’s own culture. Hence studying India through Marxism (a Western product) is studying it through a Western lens.

QUICK REVISION

- Two approaches: Western theories vs Indian perspective.
- India has no theory, only a perspective (minds colonised by the West).
- Western theories: Structural Functionalism, Marxism, Subaltern, Feminism; Indian: Indology.
- Cultural relativism: don’t judge another culture through your own.

1.3 Structural Functionalism

The two most important scholars for structural functionalism are **M. N. Srinivas** (given in the syllabus) and **S. C. Dube** (not in the syllabus, but important — UPSC has already asked a question on him).

CRITICAL POINT

Paper 1 lists six thinkers explicitly, yet questions are routinely asked on thinkers whose names are not listed. There is nothing “out of syllabus” in UPSC — we only know previous-year questions and a few bullet points that we call a syllabus.

QUICK REVISION

- Structural functionalism: M. N. Srinivas (in syllabus) and S. C. Dube (not in syllabus, but asked).
- There is nothing “out of syllabus” in UPSC.

1.4 Marxism

The important Marxist scholars who studied India are:

- **Dange** — founder of the Communist Party of India; an academician regarded as one of the first Indian social scientists to study India through the Marxist perspective.
- **D. D. Kosambi** — an important Marxist scholar.
- **D. P. Mukerji** — spelled M-U-K-E-R-J-I (pronounced and written as Mukerji).
- **Ramakrishna Mukherjee**.
- **A. R. Desai** — given in the syllabus (named alongside the Marxist perspective).

QUICK REVISION

- Marxist scholars: Dange, D. D. Kosambi, D. P. Mukerji, Ramakrishna Mukherjee, A. R. Desai.
- A. R. Desai is the one named in the syllabus.

1.5 The Subaltern Perspective

The subaltern approach is missing from the syllabus, yet UPSC has asked questions on Ambedkar and Ranajit Guha. The important subaltern scholars are:

- **B. R. Ambedkar** — dealt with the untouchables.
- **David Hardiman** — dealt with tribals.
- **Ranajit Guha** — dealt with tribals.
- **Gail Omvedt** — an American sociologist who came to India, married an Indian, stayed, and (the teacher notes) died about a week before this lecture; studied India through the subaltern lens, analysed Dalits and Dalit women, and took three–four factors into account.

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTION

Subaltern is not in the syllabus, but Ambedkar and Ranajit Guha have been asked; expect a question on Gail Omvedt. Many students do not even realise Omvedt is a theorist (and a woman) from the subaltern tradition.

1.5.1 What does “subaltern” mean?

The literal meaning comes from “sub” (below), as in “subway” — a way that passes beneath the road. Subaltern, therefore, means looking at India from below — from the perspective of the most oppressed.

COMPARISON

- **Marxism** talks about the exploitation of the **poor** — the working class (industrial “have-nots”) and the peasant/serf (feudal “have-nots”) — and this exploitation is purely **economic**.
- **Subaltern** also deals with the poor, but recognises that “poor” is not a homogeneous group. Different social locations produce different problems, so it also talks about women and, within them, Dalit women.

A Muslim woman and a poor man may both be poor, but the Muslim woman faces a specific patriarchy operating within Muslim households that the poor man does not. Through the intersectionality approach, no class is homogeneous. Because Marxism speaks only of the poor, it cannot address women who are not merely poor but also women — exploited not only by rich men but by upper castes.

KEY CONCEPT

Who are the subaltern? Not women, but **Dalit women**; not all castes, but the most oppressed castes — the **Shudras or the untouchables**.

- **Shudras and untouchables are different** — they are not the same; they are grouped here only for convenience.
- The **untouchables** are victims of poverty *and* of pollution — two different things with different causes. Marxism can explain economic exploitation, but not social exploitation or historical injustice.
- **Tribals** cannot be called a working class: their issues are forest conservation and displacement-induced development (metro, corridors, railways, airports, highways — all resting on deforestation and mining). A tribal is not even regarded as Hindu — seen as outside the Hindu fold.

EXAMPLE

When we celebrate “20% growth,” what does that growth mean for the Dalit woman who cannot go to work, who faces abuse, or for the poor young men with no job? To understand India from the subaltern view is to ask what GDP means to the highly oppressed.

QUICK REVISION

- Subaltern = looking at India from below (sub = below, as in subway).
- Unlike Marxism (which is economic only), subaltern recognises multiple social locations (intersectionality).
- Names: Ambedkar (untouchables), Hardiman & Ranajit Guha (tribals), Gail Omvedt (Dalits/Dalit women).
- Subaltern groups: Dalit women, Shudras, untouchables, tribals.

1.6 The Feminist Perspective

The important feminist scholars who studied India are:

- **Uma Chakravarti** — academically recognised as a feminist (people also call Raja Ram Mohan Roy or Savitribai Phule feminist, but academically Chakravarti is the feminist). She described the evolution of **Brahminical Patriarchy** — a very different kind of patriarchy.
- **Leela Dube** — wife of S. C. Dube (a structural functionalist), but she herself falls under the feminist perspective.
- **Jyotiba Phule and Savitribai Phule** — largely studied Dalits and Dalit women.
- **Sharmila Rege** — studied Dalit women specifically.

KEY CONCEPT

Brahminical Patriarchy (Uma Chakravarti): a specific Indian form of patriarchy. After every crime against a Dalit woman, newspapers carry the slogan “Smash Brahminical Patriarchy” — but few know what it means.

1.6.1 *Women as Gateway to Caste (Leela Dube)*

Leela Dube (a follower of Chakravarti) holds that the exploitation of women in India is largely the result of **caste as a structure**. She also calls women the **gateway to caste** — because it is only through women that the caste system reproduces itself.

COMPARISON

- **Anuloma (hypergamy):** an upper-caste man marrying a lower-caste woman — permissible.
- **Pratiloma (hypogamy):** a lower-caste man marrying an upper-caste woman — not permissible (traditionally unacceptable).

EXAMPLE

Love marriage was “discovered” in the West (marriage implicitly meant love marriage); arranged marriage was “made in India” — the British discovered it as an Indian institution and had to name it. Arranged marriage means marriage **within the same caste**: the two people may differ, but the caste is already fixed, because the family has socialised the girl into that caste.

Girls are preserved by the family as pure, and their wishes are sidelined, so that through this girl the family’s caste is reproduced in the next generation. The girl is exchanged between two similar castes — hence she is the gateway to caste.

1.6.2 *Structuralism (a new theoretical perspective)*

KEY CONCEPT

Structuralism is all about language: communication is possible only through the exchange of words. Applied to marriage, a marriage is nothing but a communication facilitated not by the exchange of words but by the **exchange of girls** — girls are exchanged so that two families can communicate and form a new alliance. The girl becomes an object circulated from one generation to the next.

QUICK REVISION

- Feminist scholars: Uma Chakravarti (Brahminical Patriarchy), Leela Dube (women as gateway to caste), Phules, Sharmila Rege.
- Anuloma = hypergamy (upper man + lower woman, permissible); Pratiloma = hypogamy (prohibited).
- Structuralism: marriage = exchange of girls (like exchange of words).

1.7 The Indian Perspective: Indology & Orientalism

Whatever we know of India today is largely **colonial knowledge**. The guiding question: do we know India through ourselves, or through the British? The answer the teacher gives: we know India through a **Brahminical lens**.

KEY CONCEPT

Indology simply means the study of India by anyone — but with a specific method. Studying India through the ancient Brahmanical texts is the **Indological approach**.

Imagine being a British professor teaching British students: you introduce Indology (India), Egyptology (Egypt), Tibetology (Tibet/China) — all “Asian cultures.” This is Orientalism. The West “invented man,” and this invented man “discovered” India as the “other” culture.

EXAMPLE

A traveller hires a guide; after daily conversation a bond forms, and the traveller comes to accept whatever the guide says as reality. The British did the same: whatever the **Brahmins** told them became “reality.” Hence we know India through the British, but the British knew India through the Brahmins — a **Brahminical lens**.

The Brahmins introduced the British to the traditional texts — the **Dharma Shastras, Dharma Sutras, Smritis and Manu Smriti** — which were written in Sanskrit. Learning Sanskrit became the British’s first task, because once they could read Sanskrit they no longer needed the guide.

The result: studying India through the ancient Brahmanical texts is the Indological approach — a **book view** of India.

1.7.1 The founders of Indology

- **William Jones** — the first to study India through ancient Brahmanical texts in a systematic form; established the **Asiatic Society** (c. 1774/1775–80s) and its journal **Asiatic Researches**; translated the **Rig Veda**; published **Sacred Books of the East**; a contemporary of Warren Hastings (who invited him — Jones was a Supreme Court judge) and of Wellesley.
- **Wilkins** — translated the **Bhagavad Gita** and the **Upanishads**; first learned Sanskrit.
- **Max Müller** — a German; gave the theory of **naturism** (nature worship as the oldest religion); the first to see similarity between Sanskrit and German; professor of **comparative philology** at Oxford; coined **Aryan Brotherhood**.

DATA & FACTS

A. L. Basham (author of “The Wonder That Was India”) called William Jones and Wilkins the **true founders of Indology in India**.

The first similarity the British found between India and Europe was in **language** — Sanskrit resembles European languages, especially German. William Jones went so far as to claim that all European languages have their origin in Sanskrit. This gave the world the word **Indo-European** (from comparative philology).

KEY CONCEPT

Four beliefs common to Jones, Wilkins and Max Müller: (1) Indian culture is Brahminical culture; (2) to understand India one must learn Sanskrit; (3) Indians and Europeans are similar; (4) Sanskrit is the origin of the other (European) languages.

William Jones established a **Department of Sanskrit and Indic Studies** within the Asiatic institution, thereby making Indology a discipline in itself — like physics or chemistry (just as we now have South Asian studies at JNU and a South Asian University in Delhi).

QUICK REVISION

- Indian perspective = Indology (book view via ancient Brahmanical texts).
- Founders: William Jones (Asiatic Society, Rig Veda, Sacred Books of the East), Wilkins (Gita, Upanishads), Max Müller (Aryan Brotherhood).
- We know India through a Brahminical lens.

1.8 How We Know India: Travellers, Missionaries, Orientalists

Bernard Cohn (a Chicago anthropologist) describes three routes through which we know India: travellers’ accounts, missionaries’ accounts, and the accounts of the Orientalists.

1.8.1 Travellers

- **Megasthenes** — wrote **Indica**; visited India during Chandragupta Maurya’s time, sent by the Seleucid Greek Empire; noted seven groups in the Mauryan administration. He observed the **caste system but not slavery** (though Kautilya’s Arthashastra does record slavery — a reminder of how ambiguous the early accounts, and the very word “caste,” are); he had a **field view** of India.
- **Ibn Battuta** — wrote the **Rihla**; knew Arabic, Sanskrit and Greek; learned Sanskrit quickly and befriended Brahmins; witnessed and wrote on the caste system.
- **Abdul Razak Samarkandi** — well versed in Sanskrit, also wrote on India.
- **François Bernier** — visited during the time of Dara Shikoh; **Tavernier** (a Frenchman) also came.

1.8.2 Missionaries

Missionaries came to convert (proselytise) people into Christianity. Because their motive was conversion, their account of other religions is **value-loaded** — they treat other religions as inferior.

1.8.3 Orientalists

KEY CONCEPT

Orientalism is the study of the “Orient” (the Eastern/other cultures) by Westerners. A Westerner explaining India is an Orientalist — and an Orientalist is always an outsider; an Indian cannot be an Orientalist. For convenience, treat **Indologist and Orientalist as synonymous** (the difference only arises with Ghurye’s Indian Indology).

QUICK REVISION

- Bernard Cohn’s three routes: travellers, missionaries, orientalists.
- Travellers: Megasthenes (Indica), Ibn Battuta (Rihla), Samarkandi, Bernier, Tavernier.
- Orientalist = always an outsider; Indologist treated as synonymous with Orientalist (for now).

1.9 Book View vs Field View

COMPARISON

- **Book view:** understanding India through ancient texts (Vedas, Upanishads, epics) — the method of William Jones and Wilkins.
- **Field view:** understanding India by going into the field, living in villages, observing directly — the method of the travellers and later of field-based sociology.

Sociology emerged in the West in response to urbanisation and industrialisation — not to rural settings. Studying villages is therefore a uniquely Indian exercise. **Andre Beteille** notes that Indian sociologists are regarded abroad as **social anthropologists**, even while they practise sociology at home.

CRITICAL POINT

A hierarchy was created between the two disciplines: sociology was for the modern, civilised, Western, educated people; anthropology was for the “other,” uncivilised, tribal cultures. Today these distinctions have lost relevance — anthropologists study the West as much as sociologists study the East.

In its early days, Indian sociology was called **social anthropology**. Ghurye was an anthropologist and Indologist; his students (Iravati Karve, M. N. Srinivas) were likewise regarded as social anthropologists.

QUICK REVISION

- Book view (texts) vs Field view (living in villages).

- Early Indian sociology = social anthropology (hierarchy: sociology > anthropology).
- Ghurye and his students (Iravati Karve, M. N. Srinivas) were social anthropologists.

1.10 Section B: Village, Tribe, Caste, Kinship

Four phenomena are seen as particularly Indian: village, tribe, caste and kinship.

1.10.1 Tribe

G. S. Ghurye was the first to open the debate on tribe in Indian sociology, in debate with the British anthropologist **Verrier Elwin**.

COMPARISON

- **Ghurye (nationalist)**: tribals are Hindus — merely **backward Hindus** who, if assimilated, will gradually become forward Hindus. Isolating them traps them in a permanent cycle of isolation.
- **Elwin (isolationist)**: tribal cultures must be preserved in isolation. This view won — including in the Constituent Assembly.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

The isolationist view survives today in the Fifth and Sixth Schedules and the **Inner Line Permit** (North-East) that protect tribal pockets. The critique: tribals have become “artifacts in a museum,” looked at like animals.

1.10.2 Caste

KEY CONCEPT

Indian sociology is nothing less than the **sociology of caste** — the two have become synonymous. Indian sociologists remain focused on caste (seen as traditional), not on class (individualism and meritocracy).

CRITICAL POINT

The caste paradox: to end caste you must first know what caste is; but the moment you explain caste to someone (a father to his child), caste gets a new lease of life and reproduces itself. The dream of caste being dead dies with every explanation.

1.10.3 Kinship

Families are formed around the notion of caste. If 93% of India practises endogamy, then 93% of families are formed around caste — so kinship networks are caste-based. In rural India there are even caste-based moneylender associations.

DATA & FACTS

93% of India practises endogamy, so roughly 93% of Indian families are formed around caste.

KEY CONCEPT

Caste is not just identity — it is **capital** and a **resource**: it forms family, kinship, alliances and vote banks, and is used for mobility (reservation) and political power. “To say caste should end is to say life should end in India.”

David Mandelbaum identified **village, caste, kinship and tribe** as the four basic units of Indian society.

QUICK REVISION

- Section B's four Indian phenomena: village, tribe, caste, kinship.
- Ghurye (assimilate) vs Elwin (isolate) — isolation won.
- Caste = resource/capital; 93% endogamy; Mandelbaum's four basic units.

1.11 Section C: Social Change in India

Section C is the most important in terms of contemporary events. Its unifying theme is social change in India.

1.11.1 Village

- Villages are being urbanised; urban development schemes reach rural areas every year — this is urbanisation.
- **Bharat Nirman** means the reconstruction of villages. Gandhi believed India lies in the village (“Bharat lies in village”), so village and India are synonymous.

1.11.2 Tribe

- Since independence many tribals have been assimilated into a non-tribal culture (Hindu or Western). The **7.5% reservation for STs** is a “gateway to become a member of another culture” they never belonged to.
- Tribals who resisted the British (e.g. the **Tana Bhagat movement**) are today becoming doctors, engineers and IES officers — accommodated into the meritocratic, Western fold.
- The **Criminal Tribes** policy was done away with; many such tribes are now classified as Scheduled Tribes and given reservation — the moment they are given reservation, they are modernised.

1.11.3 Kinship / family

- The Western theory holds that the family life-cycle moves from jointness to nuclearity (the joint family breaking into nuclear households).
- The idea of the Indian joint family is known to us largely through the British — via the epics (the Pandavas, the Kauravas, five or more brothers under one roof).

- Today, jobs in Bangalore, Delhi or America create **migrant households, not families**; the joint family (with joint residence) is dissolving.

1.11.4 *Secularism & globalisation*

Secularism is a Western idea that altered Indian power structures; globalisation and its impact are read on family, elderly, caste and politics — always social change.

QUICK REVISION

- Section C = social change: urbanisation, Bharat Nirman, 7.5% ST reservation, criminal tribes reclassified as ST.
- Joint family turning nuclear; migrant households; secularism; globalisation.

1.12 Misconceptions About Paper 2

CRITICAL POINT

The claim “Paper 1 is static, Paper 2 is dynamic” is a wrong classification. Both are equally static and equally dynamic. People say this because they confuse the 50 marks of contemporary questions with the full 250 marks.

The teacher closes by flagging that **caste** and **Varna** are often used interchangeably — M. N. Srinivas wrote an article titled “**Varna and Caste**” precisely to separate the two. This is taken up the next day.

QUICK REVISION

- Paper 2 is not dynamic-only — the static/dynamic split is a myth.
- Caste vs Varna: M. N. Srinivas, “Varna and Caste.”

1.13 Preview: Louis Dumont

Louis Dumont is an Indologist — but unlike Ghurye he did not rely only on Brahmanical texts. He also did field work: in Tamil Nadu (the **Pramalai Kallar** caste of Madurai district, at **Tengal Patti** — once a criminal tribe) and in **Gorakhpur**. From that field work he derived his theory of **purity and impurity**.

COMPARISON

- **G. S. Ghurye** is mainly **book view**.
- **Louis Dumont** is **book view + field view**.

QUICK REVISION

- Louis Dumont = Indologist with book + field view; purity/impurity theory (Tamil Nadu, Gorakhpur).

- Ghurye = book view only.

The Origin of Caste

2.1 Caste, Varna & the Theories of Origin

The basic unit of Paper 2 is caste. To understand the meaning of caste we must understand its origin; to understand the origin we must study the theories of origin.

CRITICAL POINT

None of the theories of the origin of caste is empirically valid — they are all based on speculation (“hava bazi”). There is no “good” theory here; every theorist is, in the teacher’s words, “a bad person.”

Six theories are dealt with: (1) the Traditional/Divine theory; (2) Karma and transmigration of soul; (3) the Racial theory; (4) the Occupational theory; (5) the Political theory; (6) the Broken Man theory (Ambedkar).

After origin, the next challenge is **Varna**. Caste, Varna and Jati must be separated (Senart; M. N. Srinivas). Notably, every thinker except M. N. Srinivas began with the idea of the origin of caste.

QUICK REVISION

- Six theories of origin; none is empirically valid (all speculation).
- Chain: caste, its origin, and the theories of origin.
- Every thinker except M. N. Srinivas begins with the origin of caste.

2.2 The Traditional (Divine) Theory

A creature called **Brahma** (the creator of the universe; the equivalent of the “Big Bang” in natural science) collapsed and fragmented into pieces. The four Varnas emerged from his body:

- From the **mouth** came the **Brahmins** — the head/mouth symbolises knowledge, wisdom and good speech.
- From the **arms** came the **Kshatriyas** — arms symbolise strength and the warrior class.
- From the **thighs** came the **Vaishyas** — no scientific reason is given; merchants move about a great deal.
- From the **feet** came the **Shudras** — as the feet bear the body’s burden, so the Shudras bear society’s burden as labourers.

KEY CONCEPT

Conclusion of the divine theory: **caste has its origin in divinity** — the deity made it, and we can do nothing about it.

QUICK REVISION

- Brahma's body: mouth: Brahmins; arms: Kshatriyas; thighs: Vaishyas; feet: Shudras.
- Conclusion: caste has a divine origin.

2.3 Karma & Transmigration of Soul

Why is one born a Kshatriya? In this theory it is not Brahma but **karma** — the good deeds of a past life are rewarded in the present. The transmigration of the soul means the fruit of past deeds is received in this life.

KEY CONCEPT

The **upper status** of a Varna is justified by **good karma** in a past life; the **lower status** is justified by **bad karma** (sin) in a past life.

QUICK REVISION

- Varna status is explained by karma in a past life (not by Brahma).
- Good karma gives the upper Varna; bad karma gives the lower Varna.

2.4 Broken Man Theory (Ambedkar)

This theory is given by **Ambedkar** (associated with his book “The Broken Men”). The **Dalit** literally means the “broken man” (toota hua admi) — broken out of the Varna vyavastha.

The argument runs:

1. The **original kings were Shudras** (the real kings), not Kshatriyas.
2. These Shudra kings **exploited the Brahmanical priests**.
3. The Brahmins held one power — to **invest someone with the sacred thread**.
4. Enraged, the Brahmins refused the Shudras the sacred thread, so the Shudras became the only group without it and thereby got the **lowest status** among the four.

EXAMPLE

Jyotiba Phule held the same opinion — kings like **Bali** and **Sugriva** were Shudras.

2.4.1 The sacred thread and the Dvija–Ekaja divide

The sacred thread ceremony (in Sanskrit, the **Upanayana** ceremony) is performed at about 7–8 years of age and marks a **spiritual rebirth** (divya janma). The thread itself is the “dhaga.”

KEY CONCEPT

- **Dvija (twice-born):** Brahmins, Kshatriyas and Vaishyas receive the sacred thread — they are born once physically and once spiritually.
- **Ekaja (once-born):** the Shudra does not receive the thread — born only once.
- Under the Varna model, the three Dvija are the **Savarna** (noble Varna); the Shudra, and beyond the four a fifth, form the rest.
- The **Pancham Varna (fifth Varna)** is the untouchable — a Varna with no Varna.

QUICK REVISION

- Ambedkar: the original kings were Shudras; denied the sacred thread, they became the lowest.
- Sacred thread = Upanayana (spiritual rebirth).
- Dvija (twice-born: B, K, V) vs Ekaja (once-born: Shudra).

2.5 Racial Theory of Caste

The racial theory was given by the **British**, because the idea of race came from Europe. When the British decided to understand the population, they began classifying it (Mongoloid, Caucasoid, Negroid) — race being the first category “scientifically” classified. They argued that **caste is nothing but race**.

DATA & FACTS

Proponents of the racial theory: **Herbert Hope Risley** (director of the first ethnographic department of India; one of the first census commissioners), **D. N. Majumdar**, and **G. S. Ghurye**.

CRITICAL POINT

You cannot understand Ghurye without the racial theory — it is the basis of his first book on caste.

The story: the **Aryans** (fair-skinned, pointed nose) came from outside and clashed with the **indigenous people** (dark-skinned, snub nose) of the Indus Valley (Harappan) civilisation. From the clash of these two races came **Vedic Hinduism**, and from Vedic Hinduism came caste.

- Vedic Hinduism did not exist before the Aryans; the written record of Sanskrit came with them. The Aryans are thus regarded as the makers of Hinduism.
- The Aryans brought a **threefold division** already practised in Persia — priestly class, warrior class and merchants — and reproduced it in India as Brahmin, Kshatriya and Vaishya. The indigenous people became the Shudras.
- The Indus Valley civilisation is generally regarded as an **egalitarian society** with a single system — no caste structure.

KEY CONCEPT

To preserve racial purity, the Aryans practised **endogamy** (marriage within the same group) and **restricted hypergamy** (Anuloma). **Hypergamy** = an upper-caste man marrying a lower-caste woman; **hypogamy** (Pratiloma) = an upper-caste woman marrying a lower-caste man (prohibited).

Endogamy and restricted hypergamy became instruments to preserve, conserve and maintain Aryan culture (language + culture = race). They made both groups (Aryan and non-Aryan) **closed groups**, and this closed group later became what we call **caste**.

DATA & FACTS

- **Varna is a Sanskrit word meaning “colour”** — the four Varnas are literally a colour spectrum, with the darkest-skinned placed lowest. This is the original racial theory of caste.
- Aryan invasion timeline: the Harappan civilisation ended around **1700 BC**; around **1500 BC** the Aryan nomads took control of the Indus Valley; **500 BC** marks the end of Aryan rule (and the start of Magadha rule).
- The Aryans are seen as **cattle herders** — nomadic warrior groups; **cattle were a sign of status and wealth** (today’s equivalent of a big car). Later cattle became so important that it was made illegal to kill or eat them. The caste system officially ended in **1950 AD**.

CRITICAL POINT

The Aryan-invasion explanation for the Harappan decline (as found in R. S. Sharma’s NCERT account) is regarded as **one of the weakest reasons** for the decline of the Harappan civilisation.

QUICK REVISION

- Racial theory (Risley, Majumdar, Ghurye): Aryans (fair, pointed nose) vs indigenous (dark, snub nose).
- Clash of races gives Vedic Hinduism, which gives caste.
- Endogamy + restricted hypergamy make closed groups, which become caste.
- Varna = “colour”; Aryan timeline: 1700 BC (Harappan end), then 1500 BC (Aryan rule), then 500 BC (Magadha).

2.6 Occupational Theory of Caste

This theory was given by **Nesfield** and **Denzil Ibbetson**. Nesfield accepts the racial theory but argues it is too broad to explain how caste actually formed; he therefore asks what lay beyond race.

KEY CONCEPT

Nesfield: **caste developed as a natural outcome of the division of labour**.

- The people defeated by the Aryans were regarded as **Dasas (slaves)**; the Aryans, with their

skills and discipline, became the masters.

- With different occupations came different caste groups, and these built **guilds** around their occupation — the guild system (given by Ibbetson; the guild is the **Shreni**).
- Initially, caste was **not fixed or hereditary**; no occupation was superior or inferior — every occupation was functional and necessary for the economy.
- Gradually, the **Brahmins** (priests, teachers, advisors) gained respect: they were always seen with kings, and kings depended on them — giving the impression that being Brahmin was being superior.

EXAMPLE

The dependency factor is key: the doctor is the most important person in a hospital because the whole staff depends on the doctor. Occupations with many dependents became high-status; those easily available became low-status.

QUICK REVISION

- Occupational theory (Nesfield, Ibbetson): caste = natural outcome of the division of labour.
- Dasas (slaves); guilds (Shreni); hereditary occupation.

2.7 Political (Brahmanical) Theory

The political theory is also called the **Brahmanical theory**. It holds that the caste system is **the making of the Brahmins** — Brahmins manufactured the system to manipulate people and gain power.

QUICK REVISION

- Political/Brahmanical theory: caste = the making of the Brahmins (to gain power).

2.8 The Two Most Important Theories

CRITICAL POINT

The two most important theories are the **Racial** and the **Occupational** theories, because their features turn out to be the features of caste itself:

- **Racial**: endogamy and restricted hypergamy.
- **Occupational**: hereditary (occupation passed down).

QUICK REVISION

- The two important theories: Racial (endogamy + hypergamy) and Occupational (hereditary).

2.9 Senart's Caution: Caste vs Varna

Senart argues that all theories of origin confuse **caste with Varna** — they look at caste through the Varna lens. The word **caste is alien** (Portuguese); India's indigenous word is **Jati**. Jati and Varna are indigenous; "caste" is foreign — hence the persistent confusion.

M. N. Srinivas wrote the article "**Varna and Caste**" to make the distinction clear.

QUICK REVISION

- Senart: don't confuse caste (alien, Portuguese) with Varna (indigenous); jati is indigenous.

2.10 Varna Model vs Jati Model (M. N. Srinivas)

Srinivas argues that the fourfold classification (Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra) comes from the Sanskrit texts (Vedas, Manu Smriti) — it is purely **book view**. The moment one steps outside the book into the field, one does not find these four; one finds actual **communities (jatis)**.

Attribute	Varna Model	Jati Model
Basis	Book view — ancient Sanskrit texts (Vedas, Manu Smriti)	Field view — actual communities observed in villages
Number of categories	4 (Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra)	About 4000 castes all over India
Mobility	None — fixed, immutable, hierarchically arranged	Mobility exists — caste is mutable and nebulous
Hierarchy	Fixed and definite	"Muddled" — regionally variable (Dipankar Gupta)
Scale	Macro-cosmic view; an ideal type / model	Local, empirical, region-specific

Srinivas is regarded as the **first Indian sociologist** to understand India not through books but through the field — using field work and **participant observation**. This was a paradigm shift in the sociology of India.

2.10.1 The Rampura village study

- Srinivas found not four but **many** categories, e.g. the **smith** caste.
- Even among Brahmins there was hierarchy — Hoysala Brahmin, Madhav Brahmin, Krishna Vaishnav Brahmin.
- The distinction between **kachcha (raw) food** and **pakka (cooked) food**: refusing a person's cooked food marks them as lower; accepting it marks them as equal or higher.
- The smith would accept cooked food only from the **Hoysala Brahmin** (so the smith saw himself as their equal), but the Hoysala Brahmin never reciprocated — and other castes saw the smith as even more untouchable than the untouchables.

KEY CONCEPT

Hierarchy is not fixed. Even if Brahmin is superior and the untouchable inferior, the **middle region of the hierarchy is highly vague** — Dipankar Gupta calls it a “**muddled hierarchy**.”

2.10.2 Mobility in caste

Srinivas found mobility in caste. Caste is therefore **mutable and nebulous**, not immutable. The key is the **scale** on which we measure:

COMPARISON

- **Ritual scale** (purity–impurity): mobility does not occur — a Shudra remains ritually impure even after becoming an IAS officer.
- **Secular/merit scale** (individual achievement): mobility does occur — the Shudra who becomes an officer has risen, even if not ritually.

Mobility in caste comes from political and material conditions. For example, in U.P. the **Ahir** are considered dominant because they have political and material power.

CRITICAL POINT

On “is caste a myth and class a reality?” — the answer given is that **class is also a myth**: class means an open system, but nothing is absolutely open. Models (Varna, class) are what we read; reality is far more complex and can never be academically presented in neat, chapter-wise form.

EXAMPLE

In the field one caste may hold **multiple occupations** and **multiple castes** may share one occupation (as F. G. Bailey found at Bisipara, Odisha) — so the occupational link is not fixed.

QUICK REVISION

- Varna model (book, 4 castes, no mobility) vs Jati model (field, 4000 castes, mobile, “muddled”).
- Srinivas = first field-view / participant-observation sociologist.
- Rampura study; kachcha vs pakka food; ritual vs secular scale of mobility.

2.11 Varna Vyavastha & Related Concepts

Varna Vyavastha is the term scholars use for the Varna system. Beyond the four Varnas there is the **Pancham Varna** (fifth) — the untouchables.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Savarna**: the four “noble” Varnas (B, K, V, S).
- **Avarna**: those outside — the untouchables (no Varna; the “impure” Varna).
- **Dvija**: twice-born (the three that receive the sacred thread).

- **Ekaja:** once-born (Shudra and Avarna). Shudra and Avarna are both Ekaja, which brings them very close to each other.

Even within Brahmins there is hierarchy — **Trivedi** (read three Vedas), **Chaturvedi** (four Vedas), **Dvivedi** (two Vedas). There are even **untouchable Brahmins**: the priests who perform **death rituals** are seen as polluted by the “pure” priests.

EXAMPLE

Occasions of purity (birth/Naamkaran, havan, new house, wedding) bring a Brahmin priest in; but the priest who handles death is treated as polluted. There is even specialisation among Pandits — some exorcise spirits, some handle death, some handle weddings.

2.11.1 Who are the Dalits?

KEY CONCEPT

The **Pancham Varna (untouchables)** includes three book-view categories: **Dalits**, **Chandal**, and **Malechha**.

- **Chandal** — the child born of a prohibited union (an upper-caste woman and a lower-caste man); such a child has **no caste** — a punishment designed to prevent intermixing and preserve caste purity.
- **Malechha** — outsiders/foreigners, seen as impure.
- Jati is a community term — we speak of Muslim jaat, Hindu jaat, Sikh jaat, Bengali jaat, Maratha jaat, Yadav jaat, Kunbi jaat, Oraon jaat, Munda jaat (tribals too are communities/jatis).

QUICK REVISION

- Varna vyavastha; Pancham Varna (untouchables).
- Savarna vs Avarna; Dvija vs Ekaja; untouchable Brahmins (death-ritual priests).
- Pancham Varna = Dalits, Chandal, Malechha.

2.12 Dalits, Scheduled Castes & OBCs

2.12.1 Scheduled Castes

Scheduled Caste (SC) is a **government-notified** category (listed in the Gazette of India). **Not all Dalits are SCs** — only those on the list are.

EXAMPLE

Like the Below Poverty Line list, the SC list has **inclusion and exclusion errors** — governments, being human, put the wrong people in and leave the right people out (the analogy of the friend who ruins the party).

DATA & FACTS

Dalits are **not exclusive to Hindus** — there are Dalit Christians, Buddhists, Jains, Sikhs and Muslims. But the SC category is given only to **Hindu, Sikh and Buddhist Dalits** — **not to Muslim or Christian Dalits** (Presidential Order, 1950). Sikhism and Buddhism are treated as Hindu religions, so their Dalits qualify.

A court case is ongoing over SC status for Muslim/Christian Dalits.

2.12.2 Dalit elites

Among Dalits there are **Dalit elites**. Because SC status brings reservation, an SC holder (say, a Hindu Dalit) rises while his Muslim-Dalit friend does not. The benefit makes him an officer, builds **social capital**, and can carry him to an MLA candidacy.

KEY CONCEPT

It is the **intersectionality of religion and caste** that produces mobility among individuals. Sociological analysis focuses on **structures**, not individuals — like a **geologist** who explains earthquakes through tectonic plates, not individual whim.

2.12.3 OBCs and the “backward-forward”

Shudra is also not homogeneous: there is the **forward Shudra (upper caste)** and the **backward Shudra (lower caste)**. The OBC (**Other Backward Class**) category is for the backward Shudras.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

The Constitution speaks of “other socially and educationally backward classes”; the **Mandal Commission (1979)** was set up to identify them and drew up criteria and a list. “Other” means other than the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes. Within the OBC category, the better-off form the **creamy layer**, who are meant to be excluded from the benefits.

EXAMPLE

The same Jat is OBC in one state and forward in another — **regional variation** makes the book view (“Jat”) useless; it is a field-view category.

CRITICAL POINT

- A new **Varna Vyavastha** has been created by the government: **General, EWS, OBC, SC, ST** — and none of these is homogeneous.
- **Satish Deshpande** coined “**backward-forward**” — backward as Shudra, forward within the Shudra. He says the **Jat quota demand is more an expression of caste entitlement than a claim to class disadvantage**.

QUICK REVISION

- SC = government-notified list; not all Dalits are SCs.

- SC only for Hindu/Sikh/Buddhist Dalits (Presidential Order 1950); not Muslim/Christian.
- Dalit elites; OBC (Mandal 1979) with creamy layer; backward-forward (Deshpande).

2.13 Caste Census

India never had “caste” — it had **Jati and Varna**. The British did not know these; they only asked “who are we?” and, to answer, conducted a **census** (a survey).

DATA & FACTS

The first census was conducted in **1871** (initially the North-Western Province, becoming an all-India census around 1891–1901).

A census is one form of survey. The British wanted a “**neat and clean**” picture — tables, rows and columns — so they **quantified a qualitative reality**, dividing people into caste, religion and language.

- They referred both to **ancient Brahmanical texts** and to **vernacular texts** (local/folk/tribal literature, jati puranas) — because tribal life is not in the Vedas.
- The result was a bewildering list of categories — Kunbi, Yadav, Baidya, Bhargava, Jat, Suthar, Gujjar, Muslim, Buddhist, Jain, and so on.
- The problem became “**who amongst them is caste?**” — people did not know their own caste; in Punjab the census commissioners found people could not say. Caste was **imposed on India by the British** and thereby manufactured.

CRITICAL POINT

The caste census did not classify the population — it **divided** us into castes.

2.13.1 *Nicholas Dirks and Foucault*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Nicholas Dirks** (“Castes of Mind”): caste is the **product of the colonial project of classifying people**; the census was a “**cultural technology of power**.”
- “Colonial conquest not only creates knowledge, but is produced by it as well.”
- **Michel Foucault**: knowledge is power — knowledge cannot be separated from power.

DATA & FACTS

The last SC/ST caste census was in **1931**. The recent debate was over an **OBC census** — the enumeration of Other Backward Classes, not of Dalits or tribals.

QUICK REVISION

- First census 1871; caste imposed by the British (manufactured).
- Nicholas Dirks: census = “cultural technology of power”; Foucault: knowledge is power.

- Last SC/ST caste census: 1931; recent debate = OBC census.

2.14 Orientalism, Indology & Occidentalism

2.14.1 *Orientalism*

KEY CONCEPT

Orientalism = the representation of non-Western people by Western people.

To the Orientalist, India is caste, snake charmers and priests — an image the film **Slumdog Millionaire** reinforced even among people who had never known India.

CRITICAL POINT

But not all Europeans represented India badly. **Voltaire** loved the Ganga; **William Jones** found similarities between Sanskrit and English; **Max Müller** coined “Aryan brotherhood.” **Trotman** calls these lovers of India **Indomaniacs**, and the denigrators **Indophobics**.

With the consolidation of British rule, the mood turned from **Indomania to Indophobia** — the **European U-turn**.

COMPARISON

- **William Jones** is an **Indologist** because he established the first department dedicated to understanding Indian culture through the ancient Brahmanical texts — the founder of Indology.
- **Travellers** (Albiruni — “Kitab-ul-Hind”; Abdul Razak Samarkandi — Vijayanagar; François Bernier and Tavernier — the Mughal empire) studied **empires**, not Indian culture.

2.14.2 *Occidentalism*

KEY CONCEPT

Occidentalism is the exact opposite of Orientalism — the non-West representing the West (e.g. Nehru’s depiction of the West; the “Great Indian wedding”; Monsoon Wedding; Bride and Prejudice; the Bollywoodisation of South Indian cinema and the Hollywoodisation of Bollywood — a pattern of homogenisation).

QUICK REVISION

- Orientalism = West representing non-West; Occidentalism = non-West representing West.
- Indomania to Indophobia = the European U-turn.

The Indological Perspective

3.1 Indology as Method: The Orientalist Background

The first topic in the syllabus is the **Indological Perspective**, with **G. S. Ghurye** named in brackets. Indology is a **method** to study India. (A recommended recent book is **Abhijit Kundu's "Sociology of India"**, Sage, 2021.)

It all starts with **Orientalism** — the representation of the non-West by the Western. The British wanted to understand “Indian culture,” a problematic phrase since India is diverse and has no single culture.

CRITICAL POINT

“Indian culture” is a misnomer: India is not a homogeneous country with one culture; every community has its own culture.

William Jones and **Wilkins** are regarded as the founders of Indology. They tried to understand Indian culture through the ancient Brahmanical texts — the Vedas, Upanishads, Bhagavad Gita, Hitopadesha, Manu Smriti.

KEY CONCEPT

Hermeneutics = the interpretation of culture through text, including the attempt to study the **intention of the author**.

Jones found similarities between Sanskrit and European languages and concluded that European and Indian cultures are the same. **Max Müller** wrote **Sacred Books of the East**, was a professor of **philology** (comparison of languages), gave the **Aryan Invasion Theory** in a systematic form, and coined “**Aryan brotherhood**.”

KEY CONCEPT

Phase of Indomania — the three key figures are **William Jones, Wilkins and Max Müller**: all in love with Indian culture, all finding similarities between Indian and European culture, and finally calling the link a “brotherhood.”

QUICK REVISION

- Indology = a method; first syllabus topic (G. S. Ghurye).
- Founders: Jones & Wilkins; hermeneutics; Max Müller's Aryan Invasion Theory & Aryan brotherhood.

- Indomania = love of Indian culture (Jones, Wilkins, Max Müller).

3.2 From Indomania to Indophobia

Indophobia is the phase of criticising Indian culture to justify colonial rule. Its notable figures are **Max Weber** and **Karl Marx** — and, later, Max Müller himself.

- **Max Weber** is an Orientalist: he represented Hinduism in a specific manner, and his account fed the colonial justification for rule.
- **Karl Marx** criticised Indian culture: the Indian village was a **static unit** that does not change, hence no progress. (India has no class structure, only caste; religion prevents antagonism — Dalits respect Brahmins — so society remains static; whatever change came to India came from the British: modern education, middle class, English education, the telegram and the postal network.)
- **Max Müller** later turned to a **theory of racial division** — the indigenous race is inferior and must be civilised by the Aryan race.

KEY CONCEPT

Rule through knowledge: colonial rule was justified through knowledge, not just military force. (Weber's power and authority always require people's acceptance for legitimacy.)

CRITICAL POINT

The shift from Indomania to Indophobia is called the **European U-turn**, developing gradually with the consolidation of British rule.

QUICK REVISION

- Indophobia = criticising Indian culture to justify rule (Weber, Marx, later Max Müller).
- Rule through knowledge; the European U-turn.

3.3 Nationalist / Indigenous Indology (Bombay School)

In reaction to Indophobia, **nationalist historiography** developed, to restore the glory of India — and with it **cultural nationalism**.

Two institutions: the **Asiatic Society** (William Jones — to study Hindu/Sanskritic culture) and the **Bhandarkar Research Institution** (Bombay — to criticise the Orientalist approach and restore India's past glory).

EXAMPLE

The quarrel is about "**who is original**": the British claimed the Hindus are like them (a duplicate); nationalist Indology claims the **Vedic Aryans are original** and the Europeans the duplicate. **Dayanand Saraswati** put it bluntly: the **Vedas are the true source of knowledge**, not the Bible.

Nationalist-Indology figures include **Ranade**, **Bal Gangadhar Tilak**, **Savarkar**, **G. S. Ghurye** and

Iravati Karve — many of them extreme Hindus whose symbols (the Ganga, etc.) later became **Hindutva**, which discouraged Muslims from joining the nationalist movement (nationalism was equated with Hinduism).

KEY CONCEPT

Karel Upadhyay (an Indian-American sociologist) says Ghurye's **sociological imagination** can be traced to **three factors: British Orientalism, Diffusionism, and Nationalism.**

KEY CONCEPT

Brahminization is Ghurye's term (later popularised by M. N. Srinivas as **Sanskritization**): the process of Aryanising/Hinduising the South and the tribals.

3.3.1 *The Bombay school*

- The indigenous/nationalist Indology is also called the **Bombay school** (like the Frankfurt school or the Chicago school). It developed in reaction to British Orientalism, Nationalism and Indophobia.
- Led by **G. S. Ghurye** (founder), with **Iravati Karve, Bankim Chattopadhyay** and **B. D. Shankar.**
- It tried to **restore and assert India's true place in human history**, and to **neutralise the Western Indologists (Indophobics)** who were portraying a wrong picture of Indian society.
- It claims the **superiority of Vedic Aryans over European Aryans** — everything in Europe had already been invented in the Indian past, and the Vedas are the true source of knowledge.

This social thought led to **cultural nationalism** — seen in the **Dharma Sabha, Brahmo Samaj and Arya Samaj**, all of which trace Indian roots back to Vedic Hindu Aryan culture (to the Gita and the Vedas).

CRITICAL POINT

In this discourse Ghurye saw **India as the product of the Vedic period** and **ignored the contributions of Islamic and British rulers.** Equivalences follow: Indian culture = Vedic culture; Indian philosophy = Vedanta; Indian religion = Hinduism; Aryans = the higher castes (Brahmins). The result — **"India is Hindu and Hindu is India."**

QUICK REVISION

- Nationalist Indology = Bombay school (reaction to Indophobia); Bhandarkar Research Institution.
- Ghurye (founder) with Iravati Karve, Bankim Chattopadhyay, B. D. Shankar.
- Upadhyay's three factors: Orientalism, Diffusionism, Nationalism; Brahminization, later Sanskritization.

3.4 G. S. Ghurye: Cultural Unity & Composite Culture

Ghurye is one of the most important pillars: M. N. Srinivas, Andre Beteille and A. R. Desai were all, in one way or another, influenced by him.

D. P. Mukerji held that “you cannot be an Indian sociologist unless you know Sanskrit,” and regarded Ghurye as the Indian sociologist who knows Sanskrit. Ghurye established the **Department of Indology at Bombay University (1919)**.

KEY CONCEPT

Ghurye’s core dilemma: should Indian sociology follow Western frameworks, or be indigenous? His answer — you cannot have your own sociology without understanding **Hindu culture** (the culture of the texts).

Like the Europeans, Ghurye compared civilisations (Indian, Egyptian, European): joint family in India/Egypt vs nuclear family in Europe; jointness vs individualism. “You cannot have sociology without comparison — comparative method is sociology itself.”

KEY CONCEPT

Ghurye believed **Indian culture is one (homogeneous)**, and that this **cultural unity** can be traced to the **ancient texts**. Indian culture = **Hindu Vedic Aryan culture**, formed in the Indo-Gangetic plains and diffused to the South.

CRITICAL POINT

To privilege Sanskrit (and the Vedas) is to privilege one culture over another: India had the **Sangam literature** too, and Veda is not Sangam, Sangam is not Veda. Equating the Sanskrit/Vedic culture with Indian culture as such is the core Indological problem.

Institutions that created cultural unity are part of Indian culture. The transmission from north to south happened through:

- **Brahmi script + Sanskrit language** — Sanskrit was a medium of conversation and inter-regional contact; many languages are Brahmi-scripted and Sanskrit-derived (e.g. Marathi).
- **Marital alliances** — a political instrument through which royal families (North-West/Sindh, Kamarupa/Assam, Vidarbha, Dravid desh) came into contact, spreading culture.
- **Ashwamedha sacrifice** — the horse, a symbol of monarchic power, wandered all over India and provided **ritual unity**.
- **Indian sadhus and saints** — travelling sages transmitting Vedic culture (Ghurye’s books **Gods and Men** and **Indian Sadhus**). Ghurye names **Sage Agastya, Shankaracharya and God Skanda/Kandha** as carriers of Vedic Aryanism to the South.

QUICK REVISION

- Ghurye: cultural unity traceable to ancient texts; composite culture.
- D. P. Mukerji on Sanskrit; Bombay University 1919.

- Diffusion mechanisms: Brahmi + Sanskrit, marital alliances, Ashwamedha, sadhus/saints.
- Sangam is not Veda — privileging Sanskrit privileges one culture over another.

3.5 The Triad

KEY CONCEPT

The **Triad** is the idea of “three” in everything in Hinduism — a **set of values** that forms the composite culture of the Aryan Vedic Hindus.

Its components:

- **Three gods** — Brahma, Vishnu, Mahesh.
- **Purusharth** (purposes of life) — **Dharma** (duty), **Artha** (economic condition), **Kama** (passion), **Moksha** (salvation).
- **Ashrams** (stages of life) — **Brahmacharya** (student), **Grihastha** (householder), **Vanaprastha** (anchorite), **Sanyasa** (renunciate); Ghurye clubs the last two to make a triad.
- **Trai Vidya** (threefold knowledge) — **Rig Veda** (rituals/code of conduct), **Yajur Veda** (war and the warrior class), **Sam Veda** (art, music, dance); the Atharva Veda is excluded.
- **Three qualities** — Sattva, Rajas, Tamas.
- **Threefold ethics** — **Dam** (self-control), **Daan** (charity), **Daya** (compassion).
- **Three religious duties** — **Yajna** (sacrifice), **Adhyayan** (study), **Dana** (charity).
- **Three Varnas** — Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya (written “Vis” in the original Rig Veda; the Shudra is not mentioned in the original Veda).

EXAMPLE

The roots of corporate social responsibility (CSR) can be traced to the **Daan** philosophy, and Gandhi’s idea of **trusteeship** comes from Daan — unique to Indian culture.

DATA & FACTS

The ages of the ashrams vary by Varna: Brahmacharya begins at 5–6 for Brahmins, 7–8 for Kshatriyas, 9–10 for Vaishyas, and is **absent for the Shudra**.

QUICK REVISION

- Triad = the “three” in everything (set of values that forms composite culture).
- Components: 3 gods, Purusharth, ashrams, Trai Vidya, 3 qualities, 3 ethics, 3 duties, 3 Varnas.
- CSR/Gandhi’s trusteeship come from the Daan philosophy.

3.6 Diffusionism & the Aryanization of the South

To explain how one culture spread, Ghurye used **Diffusionism** — a theory associated with his PhD supervisor **W. H. R. Rivers**.

Attribute	Diffusionism	Evolutionism
Origin	One — culture begins at a single point (Egypt/Persia) and diffuses outward, taking different forms	Many — each culture has its own starting point
Direction	Culture travels out from one origin	Cultures converge on one end-point (the scientific age)
Core claim	The origin is one	The development/end is one

The Aryan culture travelled from Egypt/Persia to the Indo-Gangetic plains (and separately to Europe), where it became **Vedic Hinduism**. **Caste is described as the original creation of the Indo-Gangetic plains**, from where it diffused to the South.

KEY CONCEPT

Aryanization of the South — Ghurye says **Agastya, Shankaracharya and Skanda (Kandha)** carried Vedic Aryanism to the South. The South is thus not “different,” only an Aryanised copy.

- **Skanda = Kartik = Subramaniam (Murugan)** in the South — the same god in a diffused, Dravidian form.
- **Krishna** in the North is fair/blue, full-bodied, playing the flute; in the South he is black, handless, without flute. **Jagannath** is another form (avatar) of Vishnu.
- **Buddha and Mahavir are claimed as avatars of Vishnu** — the Hinduization of non-Hindus.

CRITICAL POINT

The Aryan timeline is itself open to the **sociology of knowledge (Karl Mannheim)**: the carbon dating is “traced” to about 1500 BC, but one already influenced by the Aryan Invasion theory may look only that far — prior theory shapes research.

3.6.1 Syncretism

Syncretism = continuous interaction between North and South, and between folk and elites — e.g. **Kabir** seeking similarities between Hinduism and Islam to show we are culturally one.

EXAMPLE

The assimilation of tribal gods into Hinduism: **Hanuman** (monkey form) and **Ganesh** (elephant form) show that animal worship (animism/animatism) was absorbed into Hindu culture.

Ghurye extends this: Jainism (Mahavir), Buddhism (Buddha) and Sikhism (Guru Nanak — who travelled as far as Multan) are all, in his reading, **part of Hindu culture in a diffused form**. J. P. S. Oberoi calls Buddhism, Jainism and Sikhism the “**Hindu protestant religions**.”

Louis Dumont is also an Indologist (using structuralism as a method): all over India he found one common thing — the **Brahmin–untouchable binary of purity and impurity** — another expression of cultural unity.

QUICK REVISION

- Diffusionism (origin one) vs Evolutionism (end one); theory of W. H. R. Rivers.
- Caste = original creation of the Indo-Gangetic plains; diffused to the South.
- Aryanization of the South (Agastya, Shankaracharya, Skanda); syncretism; Louis Dumont's purity–impurity.
- Karl Mannheim's sociology of knowledge: prior theory shapes research (carbon dating).

3.7 Ghurye on Caste**KEY CONCEPT**

Ghurye: **“Caste is a Brahmanical child of Indo-Aryan culture, cradled in the land of Ganga and Jamuna, and then transferred to other parts of the country through diffusion.”** (A line to reproduce in the exam.)

CRITICAL POINT

Because Ghurye accepted the Aryan Invasion (a racial) theory, he subscribes to the **racial theory of caste** — caste is the child of race. Hence his first book on caste was **“Caste and Race.”**

KEY CONCEPT

“Race produced caste, but occupation stabilised it.” So Ghurye combines the **racial** and **occupational** theories of origin.

DATA & FACTS

Ghurye's book on caste went through **5 editions** (with changing titles): Caste and Race, then Caste and Class, then Caste, Class and Occupation, and the last edition (1969) on what is happening to caste today. The first edition was **1932**.

QUICK REVISION

- Caste = Brahmanical child of Indo-Aryan culture, cradled in the Ganga–Jamuna land, transferred by diffusion.
- Race produced caste, occupation stabilised it (racial + occupational).
- First book “Caste and Race” (1932; 5 editions).

3.8 Joint Family, Gotra & Charana

3.8.1 Joint family

KEY CONCEPT

Joint family: four or more people living under one roof, sharing food and property — the **Hindu Undivided Family (HUF)**.

Ghurye traces the joint family to the epics (the family-centric Ramayana/Mahabharata, five brothers together), contrasting it with today's hero-centric, individualistic serials. The British codified Hindu family law on the basis of these ancient Sanskrit texts — laws that persist in the HUF.

CRITICAL POINT

The fear among minorities is that the **Uniform Civil Code** is the modern, secular avatar of the **Aryanisation/Hinduisation of the non-Hindu**.

3.8.2 Gotra & Charana

Ghurye wrote "**Brahminical Institutions: Gotra and Charana.**"

KEY CONCEPT

- **Gotra** derives from caste; there are **seven gotras** (from the seven/sapta rishis), whose **36 children** form the **pravara**. In caste we practise **endogamy**; in gotra we practise **exogamy** (sapind exogamy) — one cannot marry within the same gotra.
- **Charana** is the **guru–shishya relationship**, taught in the **gurukul** (the school revolving around the guru), a **dyadic** bond — unlike today, where a teacher is honoured only once a year (Teacher's Day) and coaching batches run into the hundreds.

KEY CONCEPT

Integration is the common idea running through Ghurye's work: **caste divides, gotra unites**; the joint family integrates through jointness. Even the caste system, in his reading, is an **integrative system** — a Brahmin and a Dalit both have caste and are thus integrated.

QUICK REVISION

- Joint family = HUF (4+ under one roof).
- Gotra: endogamy in caste, exogamy in gotra; Charana = guru–shishya (gurukul).
- Integration is the running theme: caste divides, gotra unites.

3.9 The Indian Knowledge System (Vidyas)

KEY CONCEPT

The **Vidyas** are the Indian system of knowledge — a compendium of **32 texts/topics** (ritual, martial, practical sciences and philosophy: Mimamsa, Samkhya, Vaishesika; and the **18 Puranas**).

CRITICAL POINT

The Vidyas were **limited to elites** — the Kauravas and Pandavas were elites; the masses were excluded. Inequality is visible even in the Mahabharata.

QUICK REVISION

- Vidyas = compendium of 32 texts/topics + 18 Puranas.
- Limited to elites — inequality even in the Mahabharata.

3.10 Subject Matter: Social History

Ghurye was one of the first to establish **social anthropology** in India. Asked what Indian sociology should study, he answered: **social history** — history on social lines, where facts are integrated into a theoretical framework.

DATA & FACTS

In **1931** Ghurye gave a lecture on the role of history and sociology, arguing that **distinguishing history from sociology would be fruitless** in India — sociology cannot be visualised without historical (ancient Sanskrit) roots.

KEY CONCEPT

Ghurye's three subject matters of sociology: (1) **social history**, (2) **comparison of cultures** (comparative method = sociology), (3) **history of civilisations**.

CRITICAL POINT

Ghurye is sometimes called the “**Indian Durkheim**,” but this is imprecise: Durkheim studied **economic** integration (mechanical/organic solidarity), while Ghurye studied integration arising from **culture**.

His students carried the project forward: **M. N. Srinivas** studied the **Coorg (Kurg)** people — on Ghurye's advice, because Ghurye believed the Coorgs were descendants of the Egyptians; **Iravati Karve** compared kinship/marriage patterns across North, Central and South India to find the underlying cultural unity.

KEY CONCEPT

Social change in India, for Ghurye, has been a constant process of **interaction between Aryans and non-Aryans**, and the gradual **assimilation** of non-Aryans into the Vedic Hindu Aryan fold.

QUICK REVISION

- Subject matter = social history; 1931 lecture (history–sociology split is fruitless).
- Three subject matters: social history, comparison of cultures, history of civilisations.
- “Indian Durkheim” (imprecise); students: Srinivas (Coorg), Iravati Karve (kinship).

3.11 Assumptions & Features of Indology

3.11.1 Assumptions

- India is a **culturally united civilisation** with a **homogeneous** population.
- Indian culture can be understood **only** by referring to the ancient Sanskrit texts.
- These texts reveal the **underlying ideas and values beneath diversity** — what unites the seemingly different cultures (e.g. Dravidian and Brahmanical).

3.11.2 Features

- It is a **book view** of Indian society — knowledge of culture comes only through text.
- Reference to ancient texts establishes **continuities between present and past** (hermeneutics).
- The texts help formulate an **ideal type** against which divergences in the present are understood.

QUICK REVISION

- Assumptions: India homogeneous; texts-only; texts reveal unity beneath diversity.
- Features: book view; continuity present–past; ideal type.

3.12 Indological Explanations of Contemporary Issues

The Indologist explains the present by tracing it to the ancient texts. The teacher gives four examples (for answers), each showing either convergence or divergence between text and context:

3.12.1 Untouchability

EXAMPLE

In the Ramayana, Ram ate the berries (jhootha) of **Shabri** and **Hanuman** sat beside Ram — so untouchability did not exist then; it was **introduced later by the foreign Aryans**.

3.12.2 Tribals & environmentalism

EXAMPLE

Nishad and the **Vanar Sena** helped Ram cross the river — an integrated relationship with tribals. Ram bows before the river, showing an **indigenous environmentalism** that needed no Western education.

EXAMPLE

The **Earth Goddess** is the earliest form of nature worship — worshipping nature is worshipping woman, since both are producers and both reproduce themselves. Sita is shown close to nature, and Indian environmentalism was **initiated by women** (women are more environmentalist than men in India), unlike the West where it was initiated by men. Likewise, gender disparity in **property ownership** (land held by the king, never the queen) can be traced to the ancient texts.

3.12.3 Women's position**EXAMPLE**

Iravati Karve's "Yugant" (1968) — the first female recipient of the Sahitya Akademi Award — is a feminist interpretation of the Mahabharata: **Bhishma Pitamah** objectified women (Amba, Ambika, Ambalika); **Kunti** (who blindfolded herself), **Gandhari** and **Sita** (whose **agni pariksha** is a virginity test) show that women were never safe, and that the sacrificial woman is the ideal.

3.12.4 Communalism**EXAMPLE**

T. N. Madan, reading **Kalhana's Rajatarangini** (Kalhana is called the first official historian of India), traces the coexistence and tension between Hindu and Muslim empires in Kashmir to explain the roots of communalism.

CRITICAL POINT

- Indology can be combined with Western theories: Iravati Karve uses **feminism**; D. P. Mukerji fused **Marxism** with Indology. Western theories are not opposite to Indology.
- Ghurye's Indology is distinct in three ways: he reads the **original Sanskrit** (not translations); he uses the **diffusionist method**; and he uses Indology as a **nationalist** project to neutralise Western Indologists.

QUICK REVISION

- Examples: untouchability (Shabari), tribals (Nishad/Vanar Sena), women (Yugant; Sita's agni pariksha), communalism (Rajatarangini).
- Indology can be used with Western theories (Iravati Karve = feminism; D. P. Mukerji = Marxism).

3.13 A Note on the Critique of Indology

The teacher flagged that the **critique of Indology** is important but deferred it to the following class ("Tomorrow we will begin with Structural Functionalism"). The critique is therefore referenced but **not delivered** in these transcripts.

QUICK REVISION

- Critique of Indology was referenced but deferred — not delivered in these transcripts.

The Critique of Indology

4.1 Ghurye Ignored Material Conditions

Ghurye's Indology is all about culture — how Hindu culture formed and diffused, and how this produced cultural unity. The first critique is that it ignored **material conditions**: livelihood, control over resources, class struggle, adaptation. Ghurye gave primacy to **ideas over matter**.

COMPARISON

- Ghurye looked at the same historical facts (or mythology) as resulting in **cultural formation**.
- D. D. Kosambi (a Marxist) looked at the Aryan invasion as **class struggle** — why did the indigenous people become slaves? This focuses on the economic base, on the formation of slavery, not culture.

QUICK REVISION

- Ghurye ignored material conditions; gave primacy to ideas over matter.
- D. D. Kosambi read the Aryan invasion as class struggle (economic base).

4.2 Book View vs Field View

Indology provides a **book view** of Indian society, divorced from the **field view**. Ghurye looked at caste through the Varna model because that is how the Vedas describe it. But in the field:

- You do not find Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra as four clear groups.
- You do not find the same fixed hierarchy.
- Brahmin is not homogeneous — there is hierarchy within Brahmins.
- Pollution is not limited to untouchables — it is found within Brahmins too.

CRITICAL POINT

What India is, and what India is projected to be, are two different Indias. The book-view critique is associated with **M. N. Srinivas**.

QUICK REVISION

- Indology = book view, divorced from field view.
- Field reality: no four clear Varnas, no fixed hierarchy, Brahmins heterogeneous, pollution

within Brahmins.

4.3 Undue Importance to Brahmins

Ghurye gave **undue importance to Brahmins** in the cultural history of India. No one group can be treated as the reason for the formation of Indian culture; and this great status cannot be attributed to Brahmins purely on the basis of **mythology** (the Aryan invasion theory has no written records).

DATA & FACTS

In ancient texts you do not find Brahmin dynasties — dynasties have always been **Kshatriya (kings)**. There were even times when Brahmins were not considered in dynastic formation (e.g. the Mughal empire).

CRITICAL POINT

Ghurye treated the Aryans as Hindu upper-caste Brahmins, and Vedic Aryan Hinduism as the product of Brahmins — a claim not based on any fact.

QUICK REVISION

- Ghurye gave undue importance to Brahmins, on the basis of mythology.
- No Brahmin dynasties; dynasties were Kshatriya (e.g. Mughal empire).

4.4 Vedic Hinduism Equated with Indian Culture

Ghurye **equated Vedic Hinduism with Indian culture**. In reality Indian culture is **diverse and composite**, consisting of people professing multiple faiths and ideologies. Islam and Buddhism claim distinct identity — Buddhism came as a challenge to Brahmanism, so equating Buddhism with Hinduism is wrong.

QUICK REVISION

- Ghurye equated Vedic Hinduism with Indian culture; but Indian culture is diverse and composite.
- Islam and Buddhism have distinct identities (Buddhism challenged Brahmanism).

4.5 P. V. Kane: “Ought” vs “Is”

P. V. Kane (author of *History of Dharmashastra*) says Indology is more about **what India ought to be** than **what India is**.

EXAMPLE

The **Grihya Sutra** (householder duties) describes what an **ideal woman** ought to be — looking after the household, caring for the elderly and the husband. But what India is today: women are in the job market, equally achievement-oriented after feminism. So there is a large gap between

the textual “ought” and the actual “is”.

QUICK REVISION

- P. V. Kane: Indology describes “ought to be” more than “is” (Grihya Sutra’s ideal woman vs feminism).

4.6 Acceptance of the Aryan Invasion Theory

Indology starts with the acceptance of the Aryan invasion theory. In doing so it subscribes to **British Orientalism** — to how the British wanted India to be seen, as part of a power equation designed to justify colonial supremacy.

QUICK REVISION

- Indology starts by accepting the Aryan invasion theory = subscribing to British Orientalism.

4.7 Edward Said & Inden: Propaganda, Not a Discipline

Edward Said (a post-colonial scholar) and **Inden** argue that Indology was **less a discipline and more a propaganda**. Post-colonial studies deal with what happened to colonies after liberation.

KEY CONCEPT

Indology gives a **fixed, timeless and spaceless view** of Indian society — with no regional variation, let alone historical change. India is presented as static (Vedic, Hindu, Aryan, with no social change), which helped the British convince the indigenous people that they had come to bring change.

CRITICAL POINT

The nationalist Indologists’ subscription to the Aryan theory is itself a subscription to the power equation designed by the British — a discourse that gave elevated status to outsiders and a demeaning status to the indigenous population. **Ashis Nandy** (*Colonization of Mind*) says even the way we criticise the British is designed by them.

QUICK REVISION

- Edward Said & Inden: Indology = propaganda, giving a fixed, timeless, spaceless view of India.
- Ashis Nandy, *Colonization of Mind*; the discourse is one of power (Foucault: knowledge is power).

4.8 Carol Upadhyay: Brahmanical & Savarna Outlook

CRITICAL POINT

Carol Upadhyay (the same scholar who traced Ghurye's sociological imagination to three factors): the Indological approach described Hindu customs and rituals as Indian society, making the discipline not only **politically conservative** but also **Brahmanical and Savarna** in its outlook.

QUICK REVISION

- Carol Upadhyay: Indology made the discipline politically conservative, Brahmanical and Savarna.

4.9 Lack of Objectivity & Empiricism

Indology **lacks objectivity and empiricism**. It is based on text and interpretation, and that interpretation is simply assumed to be Indian culture — there is no objectivity in the whole research.

QUICK REVISION

- Indology lacks objectivity and empiricism (text + interpretation assumed as Indian culture).

4.10 T. K. Oommen: A West European Notion of Nation

CRITICAL POINT

T. K. Oommen (Professor Emeritus, JNU) says Ghurye held a **notion of nation that is utterly West European**. When Ghurye speaks of the “assimilation of non-Aryans into Vedic Aryans”, he is using colonial language — diffusionism and evolutionism are themselves Western theories. The very idea of nation Ghurye held is a colonial construction.

QUICK REVISION

- T. K. Oommen: Ghurye's notion of nation is West European; “assimilation” is colonial language.

4.11 The Brahmin Reflexivity Problem

D. P. Mukherjee believed a true Indian sociologist must be well-versed in Sanskrit; for him only Ghurye was the “Indian sociologist”, the rest mere “sociologists of India”.

CRITICAL POINT

But whether Ghurye, D. P. Mukherjee, M. N. Srinivas or Andre Beteille — **all four syllabus scholars are Brahmin men**. As Brahmins they subscribe to theories in which Brahmins are superior; there is **no reflexivity** in their sociology. Mukherjee's position neglects the perspective of those who did not belong to the Vedic Aryan culture.

QUICK REVISION

- All four syllabus scholars are Brahmin men — no reflexivity about their social location.
- D. P. Mukherjee: only Ghurye is the “Indian sociologist” (Sanskrit-based).

4.12 Conclusion: Dumont & Pocock

In conclusion, Indology established the discourse of **cultural studies** in India, out of which Indian sociology emerged. **Dumont and Pocock** believe that Indian sociology lies at the **intersection of Indology and sociology**.

QUICK REVISION

- Indology established cultural studies; Indian sociology emerged from it.
- Dumont & Pocock: Indian sociology lies at the intersection of Indology and sociology.

4.13 The Contribution of Indology to Indian Sociology (PYQ)**PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTION**

“How did Ghurye’s Indological Perspective help in the contribution to Indian Sociology?” — the question asks for the **contribution**, not merely an explanation of Indology. First explain the perspective, then Ghurye as Indologist, and finally the contribution in 3–4 lines.

The positive contributions of the Indological perspective to Indian sociology:

- **It started the discourse of cultural studies** in India — people began writing on Indian/Hindu culture, Hinduization and Aryanization.
- **It started the comparative study of culture** — between Vedic Aryans and European Aryans, between caste and race (Varna = colour), through philology/Indo-European. Comparative study is the essence of sociology — we compare and generalise.
- **It established the subject matter of Indian sociology = the study of social history** — Ghurye laid the foundation stone (the evolution of caste, comparison with its past).
- **It studied Hindu culture and how it established solidarity/integration all over India** — the same collective consciousness from Vedic Hindu Aryan culture; all became Sanskritized/Hinduized/integrated. This is why some call Ghurye the “Indian Durkheim”.
- **It linked Western and Indian sociology** — Dumont and Pocock: Indian sociology lies at the confluence of Indology and Western sociology.

CRITICAL POINT

Later concepts — Sanskritization, little/great tradition, purity/pollution — all trace back to Ghurye’s debate on Hinduization. (Note: Ghurye on caste is different — there he says caste developed from race and occupation stabilised it, but only in Hindustan proper (North/Central India); in South India caste and race were not synonymous.)

DATA & FACTS

Study reference: NCERT Class 11, Chapter 5 “Indian Sociologists”, pages 85–90 (for Ghurye).

QUICK REVISION

- Indology’s contributions: cultural studies, comparative study of culture, social history as subject matter, Hindu culture/solidarity, link to Western sociology.
- Dumont & Pocock: Indian sociology = confluence of Indology and Western sociology.

Structural Functionalism: M. N. Srinivas

5.1 M. N. Srinivas: Background & Mentors

M. N. Srinivas (full name **Mysore Narasimhachar Srinivas**) is the first person to introduce structural functionalism to study India (under Radcliffe-Brown). He is called the **Doyen of Indian sociology** (Satish Deshpande's term), having contributed to family, politics, caste, village and religion. Other structural functionalists: **S. C. Dube** (critiqued Srinivas from within the framework, but Marxist-inclined), **I. P. Desai** (family/marriage/kinship), and **McKim Marriott** (some place him in the civilizational perspective).

KEY CONCEPT

Srinivas wrote an article titled “**Professor G. S. Ghurye and I**” — a relationship of rivalry. Ghurye was his PhD supervisor, yet Srinivas never wanted to be a field worker; he wanted to be a theoretician like Max Weber. Ghurye made him a field worker.

DATA & FACTS

Srinivas did **two PhDs**: first under G. S. Ghurye (Bombay University); second, a **D.Phil at Oxford** under **A. R. Radcliffe-Brown** (and, after Radcliffe-Brown died, **Evans-Pritchard**). His three gurus are Ghurye, Radcliffe-Brown and Evans-Pritchard.

COMPARISON

- **British tradition** of structural functionalism (Radcliffe-Brown, Evans-Pritchard) is **field-based**.
- **French** (Durkheim) and **American** (Talcott Parsons) traditions are **theory-based** — Durkheim and Parsons only theorised; they never did field study.

QUICK REVISION

- Srinivas = first to introduce structural functionalism to India; “Doyen of Indian sociology”.
- Other SF scholars: S. C. Dube, I. P. Desai, McKim Marriott.
- Two PhDs: Ghurye, then Radcliffe-Brown / Evans-Pritchard (Oxford D.Phil).
- British SF = field-based; French/American = theory-based.

5.2 Why Coorg (Kurg)?

Coorg (Kurg) is called the “**Scotland of India**” — an isolated hilly region in the south-western part of Karnataka. Srinivas studied the **Coorgs** (the inhabitants) for two reasons:

- Ghurye wanted to check his diffusion theory: if even this isolated pocket shows Hindu character, then Vedic Hindu Aryan culture has diffused all over India.
- Ghurye believed the Coorgs and Egyptian culture share features — both preserve dead bodies (tombs).

EXAMPLE

Srinivas being from Mysore (Karnataka) also explains the location — the geographical location of one’s field is influenced by one’s social location.

QUICK REVISION

- Coorg = “Scotland of India”, isolated Karnataka region.
- Two reasons: check Ghurye’s diffusion theory; check Egyptian (tomb) connection.

5.3 The Coorg Study (1952)

This study was the **beginning of the field-work tradition in India** — a paradigm shift from **book view to field view**. Srinivas first relied on British records (Coorg was invaded by Lingayat Rajas in the 9th century AD; the British attacked the Lingayats in 1834 and conducted a census in 1881).

DATA & FACTS

The census found the Coorgs **claimed Kshatriya status**, but the British gave them **Shudra status** (influenced by the racial theory of caste — dark isolated tribals could not be Kshatriya). The Coorgs demanded Kshatriya status; in **1926** the Bombay High Court ruled they were **not Shudras**.

The Coorgs had been the military/aristocracy under the Lingayat (Shiva-worshipping) dynasty, hence they claimed Kshatriya status. In the 1941 census the Coorgs had subdivisions — **Amma Coorg** (Brahmin Coorg, about 600) and **Sanna Coorg** (Kshatriya Coorg). The **Kaveri Purana** (a local Purana) was written to justify their Kshatriya status — tracing descent from the marriage of a disciple of sage Agastya with a Brahmin girl, after which the Kaveri river began flowing.

KEY CONCEPT

Srinivas fused structural functionalism with **historical sociology** — unlike Western structural functionalism, which is **ahistorical**.

QUICK REVISION

- Coorg study = beginning of field-work tradition (paradigm shift from book to field view).
- Coorgs claimed Kshatriya, British gave Shudra; Bombay HC (1926) ruled not Shudras.
- Kaveri Purana justified Kshatriya status; Srinivas fused SF with historical sociology.

5.4 The Four Levels of Hinduism

Hinduism has **no founder** (unlike Buddhism, Sikhism, Islam, Christianity). Srinivas believed Hinduism is **amorphous and complex**, a set of very diverse beliefs that varies from region to region. He spoke of **four levels of Hinduism**:

- **All-India Sanskritic Hinduism** — Brahmins, Vedas, rituals, Upanayana (what we normally think of as Hinduism).
- **Local Hinduism** — local deities not found in all-India Hinduism (e.g. Murugan, Karni Mata).

KEY CONCEPT

“Edge effect” (a concept Srinivas used, attributed to Radcliffe-Brown) and “spread”: a smaller area has more homogeneous customs; as the area grows, heterogeneous elements appear.

When a region gets “Hinduised”, it means all-India Sanskritic Hinduism is absorbing local Hinduism, or local Hinduism is borrowing from it (a two-way process).

QUICK REVISION

- Hinduism has no founder; it is amorphous and complex, regionally varied.
- Four levels: all-India Sanskritic vs local (Murugan, Karni Mata); edge effect / spread.

5.5 The Village Structure of Coorg

Srinivas found five important things in the Coorg village structure:

- **Oka** — the joint patrilineal family system (property passed from father to son).
- **Ritual purity and pollution** — “madi” (pure) and “pole” (impure); birth, death, bodily emissions are impure; the cobra is a sacred shrine for ancestor worship.
- **Caste structure** — Brahmin Coorg, Kshatriya Coorg, and local castes (Banna, Meda, etc.).
- **Interdependence between castes** — dependence on upper castes (Brahmins) in ritual contexts (weddings), and on low castes in non-ritual contexts (e.g. a plumber to fix a toilet).
- **Festivals** — a time of social solidarity, bringing all castes together (collective effervescence).

QUICK REVISION

- Coorg village structure: Oka (patrilineal joint family), purity/pollution (madi/pole), caste structure, interdependence, festivals.

5.6 Structural Functionalism Applied

KEY CONCEPT

Structural functionalism looks at the units of social structure and how each contributes to the **maintenance of the system**. Radcliffe-Brown: “a social structure is any structure that performs certain functions” (system maintenance). Man is a biological being until initiated into rituals,

becoming a **social personality**.

Seen through this lens, the Coorg features maintain the system: **Oka** (jointness) maintains the units; **purity/pollution** produces value consensus (Parsons); **caste structure** creates interdependence; **festivals** bind people into an integrated whole.

EXAMPLE

Robert Merton's **rain dance** (among an African community): rain dance does not bring rain, but it brings solidarity and integrates the people — its **latent function** (unanticipated consequence).

QUICK REVISION

- SF: each unit performs a function for system maintenance (Radcliffe-Brown).
- Coorg units: Oka, purity/pollution, caste, festivals all maintain the system.
- Merton's rain dance = latent function (solidarity, not rain).

5.7 Sanskritization

KEY CONCEPT

Sanskritization (coined in *Religion and Society Among the Coorgs of South India*): a process characterised by the **cultural imitation of the dvija (twice-born — B, K, V)** by a low caste, tribe, or other group. E.g. adopting vegetarianism, the sacred thread, learning Sanskrit, teetotalism.

It is essentially the application of **Merton's reference group theory**: the reference group of the low caste/tribal was the upper caste (dvija). Till the late 1940s people looked up to Brahmins; today the reference groups are secular (scientists, IAS officers).

EXAMPLE

The Coorgs Sanskritized themselves (worshipping Shiva, claiming Kshatriya status), producing Brahmin Coorg and Kshatriya Coorg within. Ancient examples: kings claimed Kshatriya status after invading; Maharishi Valmiki (Shudra became Maharishi); Buddha (Kshatriya claimed Brahminical status). Kanishka ("devaputra") and Ashoka ("Devanampiya Piyadassi") claimed status.

CRITICAL POINT

Sanskritization brings **social cohesion** (low castes become like high castes), but the high caste will not acknowledge them as equal. It changes **positions** but not the **system** — the caste system is maintained despite mobility (moving equilibrium).

When tribes get Hinduised, egalitarian people absorb inequality — but even this inequality is seen as functional (different groups dependent on each other).

QUICK REVISION

- Sanskritization = cultural imitation of the dvija by low caste/tribe/group (Merton's reference

group theory).

- Brings social cohesion but not equality; changes positions, not the system.
- Tribes getting Hinduised = egalitarians absorbing inequality.

5.8 The Remembered Village

Srinivas's second field study was in **Rampura** (a pseudonym for **Kodagahalli**, Karnataka), conducted in 1948, days after Gandhi's assassination, on the advice of Evans-Pritchard. He used a pseudonym (like Shakespeare writing "Hamlet" for Helsingør) to protect villagers' privacy.

DATA & FACTS

The social composition of Rampura (1948): **19 caste groups + 1 Muslim family**. The dominant caste was the **Vokkaliga (Okaliga)** — a peasant, land-owning group with maximum numbers. Srinivas stayed 11 months and kept field notes.

EXAMPLE

In the 1970s his field notes **were burnt** (during Vietnam-war protests in America, students set fire to STD booths). **Sol Tax** (an American anthropologist) advised him to recollect and rewrite from memory — hence the book's name, *The Remembered Village*.

Concepts coined in this book: **dominant caste**, **vote bank**, and (reused) **Sanskritization**.

- Observations: Brahmins and Lingayats were proponents of law and justice; Vokkaligas resolved disputes; a Muslim group performed "magic"/healing (hakeem); the **Jajmani system** established interdependence (low castes gave goods/services to upper castes for financial support).

QUICK REVISION

- Rampura = pseudonym for Kodagahalli; 19 castes + 1 Muslim family; Vokkaliga dominant.
- Field notes burnt (1970s, Vietnam protests); Sol Tax advised rewriting from memory.
- Coined: dominant caste, vote bank; observations incl. Jajmani system.

5.9 Dominant Caste & the Two Hierarchies

KEY CONCEPT

Dominant caste = a caste with preponderance of **numerical strength**, **economic wealth** and **political power** (three capitals: social, economic, cultural/symbolic — easily transmissible and interchangeable).

COMPARISON

- **Ritual hierarchy** (book view, all-India): Brahmin supreme, Shudra inferior, on the basis of

purity and pollution.

- **Secular hierarchy** (field view, local): based on **land, wealth, power and numbers**.

In Rampura the Vokkaligas were dominant in the **secular** hierarchy; Brahmins were superior in the **ritual** hierarchy — status is **contextual**. Even a dominant caste wants Kshatriya status, so it claims ritual superiority too.

EXAMPLE

The **Yadavs** of U.P. became a dominant caste (numbers, land, ministers, vote bank) — but they first had to Sanskritize themselves, creating myths (descent from Yadu) to claim Kshatriya status.

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTION

The teacher cites the PYQ “Salient features of A. R. Desai’s Marxist sociology” and notes Section A questions are static.

QUICK REVISION

- Dominant caste = numbers + wealth + political power (three capitals).
- Ritual hierarchy (purity) vs secular hierarchy (land/wealth/power); status is contextual.
- Yadavs Sanskritized themselves to claim Kshatriya status.

5.10 Sanskritization Revisited (Conceptual Issues)

The **original definition** of Sanskritization (later revised by Srinivas himself) was: “a process in which low-caste Hindus orient themselves to the **Brahminical** lifestyle” (initially called **Brahmanization**). Later he realised people follow different reference groups — Kshatriya, Vaishya, even Shudra lifestyles — so he revised it to “imitation of the **dvija** lifestyle”.

EXAMPLE

In Gujarat the reference group is the **Patel** (merchant); in Haryana, the **Jat**; in Andhra, the **Reddy**; in U.P., the **Yadav**. All are **local jatis** — none appears in the Varna hierarchy. Slogans: “baniya saf, brahmin maaf”, “brahmin baniya thakur chor, baaki sab DS4” (DS4 = Dalit Shoshit Samaj, Kanshi Ram, 1981, U.P.).

KEY CONCEPT

Sanskritization can be seen as **anticipatory socialization** (Merton). It has existed since ancient times — e.g. the **Satavahana dynasty** (also called Andhra) stood out by claiming **Brahminical status** (a warrior class claiming Brahmin status).

CRITICAL POINT

Desanskritization (a term coined by D. N. Majumdar) is not academically well-accepted. **Rajputization** was coined by Surjit Sinha (among the Bhumij tribe of West Bengal).

QUICK REVISION

- Original definition = Brahminical lifestyle (Brahmanization); revised to dvija lifestyle.
- Reference groups vary (Patel, Jat, Reddy, Yadav — all local jatis).
- Sanskritization = anticipatory socialization; Satavahana claimed Brahminical status.

5.11 The Critique of Structural Functionalism

- **Harmonious, rosy image:** SF only sees integration, not conflict, exploitation or untouchability. It negates material conditions (poverty, gender inequality). Srinivas saw the Oka (patrilineal) but not that a woman has no share in it.
- **Brahminical perspective:** Srinivas (a Brahmin) reads through a Brahminical lens; ideology is justified in the name of sociology; his concepts assume everyone wants to claim upper-caste status.
- **Sweeping generalizations:** from two field studies (Coorg, Rampura) he generalised to “all India” (inductive reasoning, not falsifiable). In the field, wealth/numbers/power are not neatly concentrated in one caste.
- **Field studies reflect book-view biases:** despite knowing everyone claims superiority, he still believed all over India Brahmins are at the top and untouchables at the bottom (his Brahmin social location).

QUICK REVISION

- SF critique: ignores conflict/material conditions; Brahminical bias; sweeping generalizations; book-view biases.
- Provides a harmonious, not objective, picture.

The Marxist Perspective: A. R. Desai

6.1 A. R. Desai: Life & Influences

A. R. Desai is the most important Marxist sociologist of India; his work brought a **radical turn** to Indian sociology. The Bombay school had two legacies — started by Ghurye, finished by Desai (D. N. Majumdar's point). **Sujata Patel** is to Desai what Carol Upadhyay is to Ghurye: she says Desai is “first and foremost a Marxist, then a sociologist, then a human being”.

- Influences: (1) the **nationalist movement**; (2) **Marxism**; (3) his father **Ramlal Desai** (a civil servant, storyteller, novelist and Gandhian).
- In **1934** he joined the Communist Party of India and was **rusticated** from Baroda University for radical activism; he then studied under Ghurye in Bombay.

KEY CONCEPT

Marx: “Philosophers have only interpreted the world; the point is to change it.” Desai subscribed to this — he wanted to change society, not just understand it.

His famous book *Social Background of Indian Nationalism* (1948); an earlier book was *Gandhi X-Ray* (critical of Gandhi — his father loved Gandhi, he did not).

QUICK REVISION

- A. R. Desai = most important Marxist sociologist; radical turn in Indian sociology.
- Influences: nationalist movement, Marxism, father Ramlal Desai.
- 1934 joined CPI, rusticated from Baroda; studied under Ghurye.
- Book: *Social Background of Indian Nationalism* (1948); *Gandhi X-Ray*.

6.2 Feudalism, Colonialism & Capitalism

Desai reads India through the **mode of production**: pre-British India was **feudal**; colonialism introduced **capitalism**; after independence India was supposed to follow socialism but never did — the Indian state became the **guardian of capitalism**.

KEY CONCEPT

Features of Indian feudalism: (1) **self-sufficient village economy**; (2) **caste structure** — “caste is the steel frame of Hinduism” (like bureaucracy is the steel frame of India, per Sardar Patel), with guilds (shrenis) based on caste/occupation; (3) **communal ownership of land** (no private

property); (4) **revenue collector as representative of the monarch.**

Desai read the economist **R. P. Dutt** (who wrote *India Today*) and **Dadabhai Naoroji** (drain of wealth).

QUICK REVISION

- Feudal (pre-British) to capitalist (colonialism) to state as guardian of capitalism (post-independence).
- Feudalism: self-sufficient village, caste = steel frame of Hinduism, communal land, revenue collector.

6.3 The Critique of the Indian State

- *State and Society* (1976) contains the essay “**The Myth of Welfare State**” — the Indian state claims to be a welfare state but serves the capitalist class, not the proletariat.
- *India’s Path of Development* (1978/1980) reviewed 30 years (1948–77) and found increasing class inequality and poverty.
- Indian National Congress was an ally of the capitalist class, a “Brahmin-baniya party” (Periyar’s view; the self-respect movement; anti-Brahminical Dravidian movement leading to DMK/AIADMK).

QUICK REVISION

- Myth of Welfare State (1976): state serves capitalist class.
- India’s Path of Development (1978): increasing inequality.
- Congress = ally of capitalists, “Brahmin-baniya party” (Periyar).

6.4 State, Welfarism & Planning

Marxism helps understand **state formation, its ideology and the assessment of welfarism**. The first tool of the Indian state was **planning** — but plans were financed by **taxing the common people**, not the capitalist class. This reduced purchasing power and consumerism, so development happened for the capitalist, never the nation.

- Industries were controlled by old caste-privileged families (Birla, Tata — from British times); old banias became new financial/commercial capitalists.
- **Land reforms** (intended for the landless) actually created a class more dependent on the state, helping only landholders.

CRITICAL POINT

Instruments that seemed socialist (planning, cooperatives, land reform, regional rural banks, mixed economy) were, for Desai, lip service — serving the capitalist class and the nexus of rural-urban bourgeoisie. The Green Revolution’s unanticipated consequence was the creation of

rich peasants.

QUICK REVISION

- Planning taxed the masses, reducing purchasing power; served the capitalist class.
- Land reform helped landholders; Green Revolution created rich peasants.

6.5 Society as Emerging, Developing & Declining

Marxism explains society as **emerging, developing, subsequently declining, and ultimately either emerging into a qualitatively new society or disintegrating** — through the inherent contradictions of each mode of production (dialectics is the motor of history).

QUICK REVISION

- Marxism: society emerges, develops, declines, transforms through inherent contradictions (dialectics = motor of history).

6.6 Nationalism as an Inherent Contradiction of Colonialism

Nationalism was the **inherent contradiction of colonialism**: colonialism created the conditions (modern education, modern means of communication) that produced nationalist consciousness, which then turned against colonialism. Desai: “colonialism gave way to nationalism, and this nationalism, although made by colonialism, turned against colonialism itself”.

- The **moderates** lived under **false consciousness** (they believed the British were modernising India); the **extremists** exposed the truth (development of underdevelopment).

CRITICAL POINT

Desai on Gandhi: Gandhi borrowed mass-line politics from **Lenin** (mass-based movement, Bolshevik revolution). But Gandhi’s approach was actually **class collaborationist**, not mass-based — he was a “friend of industrialists”. In the Ahmedabad mill strike (1918) Gandhi only fought for a wage increase and preached **trusteeship**, never touching structural exploitation. Trusteeship (donating the surplus) merely **opiated the masses**.

QUICK REVISION

- Nationalism = inherent contradiction of colonialism.
- Moderates = false consciousness; extremists exposed the truth.
- Gandhi: class collaborationist, trusteeship opiated the masses (Ahmedabad mill strike 1918).

6.7 The Significance of the Marxist Perspective

- Marxist perspective was a **challenge to the status quoist** structural-functional and Indological approaches.

- It is the only approach that can explain **social change** (structural functionalism can only explain maintenance).
- It draws on **history, political economy and anthropology** — Desai opposed rigid disciplinary boundaries.
- It understands India through the **economic base**, whereas Indology and structural functionalism understand India through culture, religion, family, caste.

KEY CONCEPT

Micro (field study, Srinivas) vs **macro** (book view, Ghurye) vs **mezzo** (middle path, Desai).

CRITICAL POINT

Critique of Desai: (1) not substantiated empirically — clubbing 2000 years as “feudal”, claiming land was communally owned (Gupta land grants contradict this); (2) not objective — projecting the Indian state purely as a capitalist instrument, ignoring welfare.

QUICK REVISION

- Marxist perspective = challenge to status quo; explains social change; draws on history/political economy/anthropology.
- Macro (Ghurye), micro (Srinivas), mezzo (Desai).
- Critique: not empirical, not objective.

The Subaltern Perspective

7.1 What is the Subaltern Perspective?

The subaltern perspective means to **read history from below** — from the perspective of the led, not the leaders. Nationalist historiography projects Gandhi, Nehru, Tilak etc. as leaders of peasant and tribal movements (though they were neither peasant nor tribal), making history **hero-centric**. The ignored movements and people are the subaltern.

EXAMPLE

“I fought with them” vs “they fought with him” — the difference is only the **camera angle**. Nationalist history keeps the camera on the hero; subaltern history turns it to the movement and the masses (e.g. what did the Champaran people think of Gandhi?).

KEY CONCEPT

Subaltern literally means **inferior ranks** (not class — “class” is Marxist terminology). It includes **peasants, tribals, Dalits**, and Dalit/tribal/peasant **women** (intersectional). The term was coined by **Antonio Gramsci** (a neo-Marxist): cultural hegemony vs **counter-hegemony** (the subaltern represents counter-hegemony).

DATA & FACTS

Subaltern is the **only perspective coming from a colonized country** (others come from colonizers); it is also called **post-colonial historiography**.

QUICK REVISION

- Subaltern = read history from below (camera angle on the movement, not the leader).
- Inferior ranks: peasants, tribals, Dalits, their women (Gramsci coined the term; counter-hegemony).
- Only perspective from a colonized country; = post-colonial historiography.

7.2 David Hardiman & The Coming of Devi

David Hardiman (a socialist historian) wrote *The Coming of Devi* (Devi = Goddess), about an indigenous, autonomous tribal movement in the coastal belt of **Gujarat (1922–23)**, the **Devi movement**.

Parsi businessmen (liquor shops) + landlords + moneylenders formed a nexus that addicted tribals to alcohol, pushing them into debt and marginalisation. When **smallpox** struck in 1922, a rumour spread; **shamans** (believed possessed by the Goddess) organised rituals, and the Goddess “said”: stop drinking alcohol. The Adivasis became teetotalers.

CRITICAL POINT

This was an **autonomous** social movement with elements of **social reform**, not spearheaded by any elite nationalist bourgeois leader. Gandhi later incorporated Adivasis into the mass movement only because these local movements showed tribals were assertive.

QUICK REVISION

- Hardiman, *The Coming of Devi*: autonomous Adivasi movement in coastal Gujarat (1922–23).
- Nexus (Parsi liquor shops + landlords + moneylenders) leading to addiction, then smallpox, then Devi says stop alcohol, then teetotalism.

7.3 Ranajit Guha: Critique of Nationalist Historiography

Ranajit Guha is the founder of Subaltern Studies. His critique of mainstream nationalist historiography:

- Nationalist historiography does not represent history — it **produces heroes**.
- The subalterns are not objects of history, but the **true makers of history**.
- It focuses on peasants and tribals in the colonial movement, overlooked by elitist historiography.
- Elitist historiography gives the impression that nationalist consciousness was the achievement of only the elites.
- It constructs a **binary of elite and subaltern** (like Marx’s bourgeoisie–proletariat).
- Subaltern politics is an **autonomous domain**, independent of elite politics.

KEY CONCEPT

Guha’s conclusion: the history of Indian nationalism is a “**spiritual biography of Indian elites**” — we read biographies of leaders, not movements.

EXAMPLE

The NCERT *Themes in Indian History (Part 3)* reflects the subaltern turn: the **Pahadiyas** (hunters, shifting cultivators, charcoal producers) — the backbone of the Santhal rebellion — get attention; **Siddhu Manji** (Santhal leader); moneylenders projected as “Dekus” (dacoits). **Shahid Amin** shows the “Mahatma” title was first used by Gorakhpur people, later attributed to Tagore.

QUICK REVISION

- Ranajit Guha = founder of Subaltern Studies; nationalist history produces heroes, not history.
- History of Indian nationalism = spiritual biography of elites.

- Pahadiyas (backbone of Santhal rebellion), Siddhu Manji, Shahid Amin (Mahatma title).

7.4 B. R. Ambedkar & the Subaltern

Ambedkar is not a Marxist (though influenced by Marxism — his book *Marx and Buddha*; Buddha was against caste). The Communist Party fought for workers' rights, never for the **human rights of Dalits**.

KEY CONCEPT

Ambedkar: **Hinduism and democracy cannot coexist** — democracy is equality, Hinduism is **graded inequality**. Caste is not just a division of labour but a **division of labourers**.

- The Indian nationalist movement was a **Hindu-Brahminical upper-caste men's movement**, not an Indian one. Congress was a **Brahminical party**; its demands (Indianization of civil services, modern education, representation in assemblies) served upper-caste Brahmin men.
- The word **Dalit** was coined by **Jyotiba Phule** (in *Gulamgiri*). Ambedkar was influenced by Phule (British Raj better than Peshwa Raj — meritocracy vs casteism).
- Vedas, Smritis and Shastras justify Dalit oppression (like Marx's religion opiating the masses).
- Ambedkar's programmes: **Mahad Satyagraha** (temple/water entry), the **Republican Party of India** (1936, aiming at a **caste-less**, not just classless, India), journals (Mook Nayak, Equality Janta, Bahishkrit Bharat), and the cause of peasant castes (**Mahar** and **Kunbi**).

CRITICAL POINT

Ambedkar's conclusion: **India has not gained independence** — upper-caste Brahmin men gained independence from the British; Dalits are still waiting for independence from the upper-caste Brahmin men.

QUICK REVISION

- Ambedkar is not a Marxist; CPI ignored Dalit human rights.
- Hinduism + democracy cannot coexist; caste = division of labourers.
- Congress = Brahminical party; Dalit word coined by Phule; Republican Party (1936) aimed at caste-less India.

7.5 Great Tradition vs Little Tradition

A binary again: **great tradition** (national, elite, urban scale) vs **little tradition** (local, folk, common masses).

EXAMPLE

The Ramayana has **400+ versions**. The television Ramayana is the elitist/great-tradition version; in the North East Ramlila is dance-based, Ram is shown as an avatar of Vishnu; some versions show Ram promoting untouchability (the Shambuka episode); one Indian village worships Ravan

and does not celebrate Diwali. **Karwa Chauth** was a Rajasthan/Gujarat folk tradition that became a great tradition through Bollywood.

QUICK REVISION

- Great tradition (national/elite) vs little tradition (local/folk).
- Ramayana has 400+ versions; Karwa Chauth went from folk to great tradition.

7.6 The Critique of the Subaltern Perspective

- **Sumit Sarkar** (a subaltern historian) feuded with Ranajit Guha: the voices now represented in subaltern literature are not really subaltern but elites (e.g. upper-caste women).
- **Gayatri Spivak** — “Can the Subaltern Speak?” — when upper-caste Brahmins speak on behalf of the subaltern, reality is distorted; the social location of the researcher matters.
- **Kumkum Roy** (JNU) — where are the **Vedic dasis** (female slaves)?
- Who is subaltern? Dalits include elites (e.g. Mayawati — a Dalit elite).

QUICK REVISION

- Critique: Sumit Sarkar (elites represented as subaltern), Gayatri Spivak (Can the Subaltern Speak?), Kumkum Roy (Vedic dasis).
- Problem of representation and of who is truly subaltern (Dalit elites).

Social Background of Indian Nationalism

8.1 The Book & the Mode-of-Production Method

Social Background of Indian Nationalism (A. R. Desai, 1948) analyses the Indian national movement from 1830 to 1947 through the Marxist lens — i.e. through the **mode of production**, not culture or rituals. Its sequel is *Recent Trends in Indian Nationalism* (1960), and later *State and Society in India* (1975).

QUICK REVISION

- Book (1948) analyses nationalism 1830–1947 through mode of production.
- Sequel: *Recent Trends in Indian Nationalism* (1960); *State and Society in India* (1975).

8.2 Pre-British Feudal Mode of Production

Desai's five features of the pre-British feudal mode of production:

- **Village as community owner of land** — no private property.
- **Self-sufficiency** — subsistence economy, barter, no classes.
- **Monarch receives produce through revenue collectors** (representative of the monarch; monarch = symbolic owner).
- **Static economy.**
- **Caste as the steel frame of Hinduism** — occupation decided by caste (Baniyas were traders, Brahmins were educators).

QUICK REVISION

- Feudal features: communal land, self-sufficiency, revenue collector, static economy, caste as steel frame.

8.3 The Colonial Mode of Production

With the British, **means of production changed** (in Europe the industrial revolution came from below; in India it was super-imposed from above — East India Company, ports, railways, mining). The five features changed:

- Village commune **eroded** by peasant proprietors (zamindari, Permanent Settlement, private ownership, sunset laws).

- Self-sufficiency ended — villages interconnected (postal, telegraph, railways, factories in Chhota Nagpur, mining, deforestation leading to tribal uprisings for material needs).
- Monarchy became a **centralized state** (British India, Supreme Court at Kolkata = all-India, Governor-General).
- Static became a **mobile/evolving economy**.
- Caste as steel frame **rusting** — the class of artisans disappeared (modern industry); new **rural classes** (zamindar, absentee landlords/gentlemen farmers, moneylenders, agricultural labourers, tenants, petty-bourgeois merchants) and **urban classes** (capitalist industrialists, working class, petty traders, professional/white-collar classes) emerged.

KEY CONCEPT

This is a **qualitative structural transformation** — a change from one mode of production to another, not a quantitative change.

QUICK REVISION

- Means of production changed (imposed from above).
- Village commune gave way to peasant proprietors; self-sufficiency to interconnection; monarchy to centralized state; static to mobile economy; caste rusting with new rural/urban classes.
- Qualitative structural transformation.

8.4 Factors Leading to Nationalist Consciousness

Nationalism is a **form of consciousness** (ideology in the superstructure, shaped by material conditions — unlike Hegel, who placed ideology at the base). The trigger factors:

- **Introduction of the press** — Benedict Anderson's *Imagined Communities*; gazettes, pamphlets, journals, exchange of letters.
- **Railways** — enabled Gandhi to travel and lead movements.
- **Postal services** — (they later acquired new functions, e.g. postal banking).
- **Modern industry**.
- **Centralized uniform laws** — replacing caste panchayats and local laws with all-India laws.
- **English education** — one universal language for communication (about 5% English literacy).

CRITICAL POINT

Nationalism was the **unanticipated consequence** of modernisation — never planned by the British.

QUICK REVISION

- Nationalism = form of consciousness (superstructure, shaped by material conditions).
- Factors: press (Anderson), railways, postal, industry, uniform laws, English education.
- Nationalism = unanticipated consequence of modernisation.

8.5 The Five Phases of Indian Nationalism

Each phase is characterised by a specific class and its interest:

- **Phase 1 (1820s–1885)** — the **intelligentsia** class; social-religious reforms (Raja Ram Mohan Roy, I. C. Vidyasagar); narrow social base; the **Indian renaissance** (reawakening); primary westernized people. Reforms: abolition of sati (William Bentinck), child marriage, widow remarriage. Feminism in India was introduced by men (British men + westernized Hindu men), unlike the West (Mary Wollstonecraft).
- **Phase 2 (1885–1905)** — INC established (all-India), Swadeshi movement (1905); social base widened; three classes — **educated middle class** (modern schools), **merchant class** (Indian international trade), **industrialist class** (modern industry), each a specific caste group (Brahmins, banias, Parsis). Congress under moderates served these classes. Fissure leading to the **Surat Split (1907)** = polarization (moderates = upper classes, extremists = lower classes).
- **Phase 3 (1905–1918)** — home rule; Gandhi entered politics with mass-line politics; **militan-tization/Hinduization** of the movement (Shivaji, Ganga, Ganpati — Hindu symbols alienated Muslims; nationalism equated with Hinduism).
- **Phase 4 (till 1934)** — civil disobedience (1930–34); social base enormously enlarged (Ahmed-abad mill strike 1918, Champaran, Kheda); class to mass movement. WWI, the Russian revolution, the Khilafat movement (unified Hindus-Muslims) stirred the masses. Congress remained under the influence of the capitalist class (swadeshi/boycott served industrialists who financed Congress); Gandhi = class collaborationist.
- **Phase 5 (1934–1939)** — disenchantment with Gandhian ideology; **Congress Socialist Party** (workers and peasants on class lines); **All India Kisan Sabha** (pressure group of the CPI; objectives: abolition of landlordism, repudiation of debts, socialist state); growth of the Communist Party; Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (Bhagat Singh).

QUICK REVISION

- Five phases, each = a class and its interest: intelligentsia (reforms), three classes (INC/swadeshi), Hinduization, mass movement, socialist turn.
- Surat Split 1907 = polarization; CSP and Kisan Sabha in phase 5.

8.6 Conclusion: External vs Internal Colonialism

By 1946 (after Quit India 1942) the social base had enormously enlarged, but Congress remained dominated by the dominant class. Desai concludes: **external colonialism was replaced by internal colonialism** — the British left, and the Congress (representing the Indian capitalist class) took over. The nationalist movement was an **all-class movement**, yet it remained dominated by the Gandhian Congress, which then formed the Indian state and chose **bourgeois (not socialist) industrialization**.

CRITICAL POINT

Desai's contention with Marx: Marx thought capitalism would revolutionise the mode of production; Desai held that capitalism in India **destroyed the indigenous industry** that could have developed capitalism on its own. Desai was a nationalist as well as a Marxist — more **Trotskyite** than Marxist (against the two-stage revolution idea).

QUICK REVISION

- External colonialism replaced by internal colonialism; Indian state chose bourgeois industrialization.
- Desai: capitalism destroyed indigenous industry; more Trotskyite than Marxist.

Westernization & Sanskritization

9.1 Westernization: Three Levels of Change

Westernization (M. N. Srinivas's idea) is a process of change at **three levels** over 150 years of British rule — remember **IIT: Institutional, Ideological, Technological**.

- **Institutional** (four types): modern education (Western philosophy); modern laws (from **particular to universal** standards — punishment by crime, not criminal); economic change (jajmani system to modern capitalism: banks, share markets, cooperatives — sources of mobility increased); political change (democracy, legislature, parliament, Westminster model — political democracy was a British gift).
- **Technological**: printing press, railways, telegraph/telegram, machine-led work (mass production/industry).
- **Ideological**: humanitarianism (egalitarianism, meritocracy), rationality, liberty, equality, fraternity, secularism — leading to social-religious reforms (abolition of sati, gender equality, widow remarriage, girl-child education).

Also: a higher standard of life (lifestyle) and **nationalist consciousness** are effects of westernization.

QUICK REVISION

- Westernization = change at 3 levels (IIT): Institutional, Ideological, Technological.
- Institutional: education, laws (particular to universal), economy, politics.
- Technological: press, railways, telegraph, industry. Ideological: humanitarianism, rationality, etc.

9.2 Negative Effects of Westernization

Srinivas is **ambivalent** about westernization (like Weber on bureaucracy) — he notes both positive and negative effects. Negative effects:

- **Rise of individualism** — weakening of respect for elders, sacrifice, arranged marriage (marriage age now 26 for men, 23 for women in urban India); job-switching, live-in relationships.
- **Disintegration of the family** — joint to nuclear (urbanization, migration to new pockets).
- **Junk-food culture** — dietary change, obesity.
- **Rise of protest and backward-class movement** — egalitarianism leading to positive discrimination leading to reservation leading to new communities demanding reservation (Mandal

Commission), disintegrating rather than integrating India.

CRITICAL POINT

Why does a sociologist call these “negative”? Because Srinivas is a **structural functionalist**, concerned with social order and the maintenance of institutions.

QUICK REVISION

- Negative effects: individualism, family disintegration, junk food, backward-class movement.
- Srinivas is ambivalent (like Weber on bureaucracy); a structural functionalist concerned with order.

9.3 Primary, Secondary & Tertiary Westernization

The impact of westernization was **not homogeneous** — it was limited to a few elites (the **new Indian elites**). Srinivas gives prefixes to westernization:

- **Primary westernization** — those in **direct contact** with the British: (1) traders/industrialists (Bombay = Parsis, Kolkata = Baniyas, Madras = Brahmins) — externally westernized (coat, tie, cigar), internally Sanskritized; (2) intellectuals (Raja Ram Mohan Roy, I. C. Vidyasagar) — externally Sanskritized, internally westernized (rationality, equality, liberty).
- **Secondary westernization** — those dependent on the primary elites (employees in shipping, patients in hospitals, litigants in courts, readers of newspapers/books) — consumers, not producers, of knowledge/jobs.
- **Tertiary westernization** — the least westernized: rural folk culture, especially lower castes with remote and limited exposure.

KEY CONCEPT

Brahmins and Baniyas were the “**neck points of the funnel**” of westernization — Brahmins facilitated knowledge, Baniyas facilitated economic growth. They were already privileged (apex of the knowledge pyramid; already in trade) — no merit, just traditional capital exchanged.

QUICK REVISION

- Impact not homogeneous; limited to new Indian elites.
- Primary (direct contact), secondary (dependent on primary), tertiary (rural folk/lower castes).
- Brahmins & Baniyas = neck points of the funnel.

9.4 Westernization vs Modernization

COMPARISON

- **Daniel Lerner** prefers “modernization”: “westernization” is too local and limited (Japan and Israel are not West; importing from them is modernization, not westernization). Moderniza-

tion is **global**.

- **M. N. Srinivas** prefers “westernization”: “modernization” is **ethically loaded** (modern = good), while “westernization” is ethically neutral (just drawing from Britain/Europe, no good/bad judgement).

QUICK REVISION

- Lerner: westernization too local/limited; modernization is global.
- Srinivas: modernization ethically loaded; westernization ethically neutral.

9.5 Westernization & Sanskritization: A Dynamic Relation

Sanskritization = lower castes imitating the upper castes; westernization = upper castes imitating the Western/British. Srinivas analysed the dynamic relation between these two. There are **three relations**:

- **Sanskritization as a prerequisite for westernization** — the primary beneficiaries of westernization were the upper castes (Brahmins, Baniyas), so Sanskritization helps westernize individuals; the two pattern variables are **imbricated** (conjoined) — in India there is no binary.
- **Westernization promotes/accelerates Sanskritization** — TV and cinema popularised Sanskritic gods (Krishna, Ramayana, Mahabharat); Harikatha spread via radio/TV; railways and the PRASAD scheme made pilgrimage accessible; the press made epics cheap and accessible; Brahma Samaj, Arya Samaj and Prarthana Samaj popularised the Vedas.
- **Conflict between the two** — primary westernization of the upper castes broadened the hierarchy and triggered backward-class assertion (the **self-respect movement** of Periyar/E. V. Ramasamy Naicker in South India, leading to anti-Brahminical Dravidian politics, linguistic and cultural consciousness). To be westernized is to no longer respect Brahmins as authority.

CRITICAL POINT

Srinivas’s conclusion: the relation between Sanskritization and Westernization is **highly dynamic** and should be **empirically studied** (not generalised) — because India is diverse, and each pocket has a different experience of the same seemingly homogeneous concept.

EXAMPLE

During lockdown, the first thing on television was the Ramayana and Mahabharata — western technology (TV, the internet) carrying Sanskritic content to the masses.

QUICK REVISION

- Three relations: Sanskritization as prerequisite; westernization promotes Sanskritization; conflict between the two.
- Conclusion: dynamic relation, empirically studied, not generalised.

A. R. Desai's Review of the Indian State

10.1 The Three Books & the Six Instruments

A. R. Desai wrote **three books** to explain the post-independence Indian state: *Recent Trends in Indian Nationalism* (1960, for 1947–1960), *State and Society* (1976, for 1960–1974), and *India's Path of Development* (1978/1980, for 1974–1980). Together with *Social Background of Indian Nationalism* (1830–1947), these cover the whole arc.

KEY CONCEPT

The **six instruments** of post-independence India: (1) **Constitution** (made India an autonomous state), (2) **Planning** (to run the economy and distribute resources), (3) **Land reforms** (to abolish class inequalities), (4) **Cooperatives**, (5) **Regional Rural Banks** (to integrate Bharat with India), (6) **Public Sector Enterprises** (to industrialise).

The larger vision of the Indian state was the **socialist pattern** (not socialism) — equal opportunity and equal distribution. Desai's question: which path did India actually traverse? The state had two choices — **bourgeois industrialization** or **socialist industrialization**. The state claimed the socialist pattern; Desai disputes this, arguing India went with **bourgeois industrialization**.

QUICK REVISION

- Three books: *Recent Trends* (1960), *State and Society* (1976), *India's Path of Development* (1978/80).
- Six instruments: Constitution, Planning, Land reforms, Cooperatives, Regional Rural Banks, PSE.
- State claimed socialist pattern; Desai says it was bourgeois industrialization.

10.2 Planning

Desai says planning did **three things**:

- **Masses were taxed to finance the plans** (their purchasing power declined); in reality plans should have been financed by the capitalist class.
- It **established a nexus** between local goons (dada), bureaucrats (babu) and politicians (lala) — the Bora Commission's dada-lala-babu nexus.
- It **centralised trade and industry in a few families** (of certain castes), e.g. Adani/Ambani today.

CRITICAL POINT

Social-welfare schemes came very late; planning was about heavy (urban) industrialization, not agrarian. Import substitution (from 1956) promoted production but never purchasing power. “Ease of doing business” is a bourgeois instrument — there is no index for “ease of working conditions”.

QUICK REVISION

- Planning: taxed masses, created dada-lala-babu nexus, centralised trade/industry in few families.
- Welfare schemes came late; import substitution from 1956; ease-of-doing-business = bourgeois.

10.3 Land Reforms

Land reform means the government takes the excess land (e.g. from 10 acres, takes 8) and distributes it to the landless. Private property in land began with **zamindari** under the British (before that, land was communal); revenue collectors became zamindars through British incentives and sunset laws, under the Permanent Settlement — but they never reinvested (no Protestant ethics).

DATA & FACTS

Land reform was **partially successful** only in West Bengal, Kerala and some Andhra pockets — the common factor being **Communist regimes**.

Why land reform largely failed: landowners found **loopholes** (investing in schools/cooperative banks to avoid seizure; benami transfers); cooperatives were **hijacked by upper-caste leaders**; the state and the agrarian-capitalist class were in nexus. The **Green Revolution** favoured the already-rich peasants, exacerbating class inequality (heavy machinery and inputs stayed with the upper castes).

QUICK REVISION

- Land reform = take excess land, distribute to the landless; private property began with zamindari.
- Partially successful only under Communist regimes (West Bengal, Kerala, parts of Andhra).
- Failed due to loopholes, benami transfers, cooperatives hijacked, Green Revolution favouring rich peasants.

10.4 Public Sector Enterprises

CRITICAL POINT

There is **gross inefficiency of production** in many PSEs (widespread in power, transport, steel, fertilizers). The reason: PSEs were **headed by ex-landlords** (allies of the capitalist class), while national-level bureaucrats framed policies for private industrialists, neglecting public-sector production.

QUICK REVISION

- PSEs grossly inefficient (power, transport, steel, fertilizers); headed by ex-landlords; bureaucrats prioritised private industry.

10.5 The Constitution

KEY CONCEPT

Desai: “**The Indian Constitution is a bourgeois constitution**” — concerned more with the rights of the capitalist class than of the working class.

- It is largely **borrowed from the Government of India Act 1935**, which was built on the Simon Commission, Round Table Conferences 1/2/3 and the white report — while the **Nehru Report** (which spoke of working-class rights) was rejected/burnt.
- Gandhi never supported reservation for Dalits — reservation is a “window” for the lower castes (Kancha Ilaiah’s point), and keeping it shut kept only the upper castes enlightened.
- Civil liberties have been crushed since the Indian state was formed; movements have been suppressed; the state has unleashed the police and army on those exercising democratic rights.

CRITICAL POINT

Conclusion: **democracy was sacrificed to support capitalism.**

QUICK REVISION

- Constitution = bourgeois text (borrowed from GOI Act 1935; Nehru Report rejected).
- Gandhi never supported Dalit reservation; civil liberties crushed; democracy sacrificed for capitalism.

10.6 India’s Path of Development

India’s Path of Development reviews 30 years of the Indian state. Its findings:

- **Class inequality widened** (like the Oxfam report: 2% hold 90% of wealth, 98% hold 2%).
- **Small-scale industries with capital expanded at the cost of handicraft industries and rural artisans** — handicrafts collapsed again (as under the British); trade fairs are run like museums.

- **Social inequality in educational attainment is ever-increasing** — education is accessible only to those with resources (right-to-education issues: midday meals, faculty-student ratio, dropouts).
- **Concentration of landholding** in the hands of a tiny minority of landlords, with **pauperization and proletarianization** at the bottom.

CRITICAL POINT

Conclusion: the Indian state **paid lip service to socialism** while following capitalism.

QUICK REVISION

- Path of Development: class inequality widened, handicrafts collapsed, educational inequality grew, land concentrated.
- Indian state paid lip service to socialism.

Introduction to Modernization of Indian Tradition

11.1 Modernization as a Theory

The next topic — “**Modernization of Indian Tradition**” (Yogendra Singh) — is the topic around which the sociology of India revolves. To understand it, one must first understand modernization. Modernization is a **process of social change** — ongoing, and cannot be captured in a fixed frame. Its roots lie in **Weber, Parsons and Marx**; its key proponents are **Rostow** (traditional society to mass consumption) and **Daniel Lerner**.

CRITICAL POINT

Our common-sense idea of modernization (highways, metro, English medium, IAS/IPS, fast food, live-in relationships) is actually the **Western idea** of modernization — a form of **cultural hegemony**. Marx’s modernization means simply **progress**, which can even mean a classless society with equal access and no private property.

QUICK REVISION

- Modernization of Indian Tradition = the core topic (Yogendra Singh).
- Roots: Weber, Parsons, Marx; proponents Rostow and Lerner.
- Common-sense modernization = Western idea (cultural hegemony).

11.2 Yogendra Singh & the Integrated Approach

In the first chapter of *Modernization of Indian Tradition*, Yogendra Singh reviews the European theories of modernization (Rostow, Lerner) and the theories of social change — including those originating in India (M. N. Srinivas’s Sanskritization and Westernization).

Modernization of Indian Tradition is described as a **confluence (sangam)** where rivers meet — Yogendra Singh reviewed the Western modernization theories (Lerner, Rostow, Parsons) on one side and the Indian theories of social change (Srinivas’s Sanskritization and Westernization) on the other, and brought them together.

KEY CONCEPT

Yogendra Singh’s most important contribution: an **Indian approach** to studying Indian society that is **not anti-Western** — an **integrated approach** combining Western and Indian theories. India is the making of the West, so it cannot be understood by Indian theory alone.

EXAMPLE

To say “India is modernizing” is absurd — India is not one; it consists of diverse little traditions, and each pocket experiences modernization differently. E.g. the **Panchayati Raj Institution** kept the traditional panchayat but imposed modern constitutional/democratic principles (free and fair elections) on top — a “sandwich” of tradition and modernity. In the West traditions were lost; in India traditions were never lost — they adjusted to modern ideas (structural adjustment).

DATA & FACTS

Yogendra Singh died the previous year; Dipankar Gupta called his death the “**death of an era in Indian sociology**”.

QUICK REVISION

- Yogendra Singh: integrated approach (West + India), not anti-Western.
- India is diverse; traditions adjust to modernity (PRI = sandwich; structural adjustment).
- Yogendra Singh’s death = death of an era (Dipankar Gupta).

11.3 Folk-Urban Continuum & Little/Great Tradition

Yogendra Singh also reviewed the American anthropologists of the civilizational approach:

- **Robert Redfield** — the **folk-urban continuum**.
- **Milton Singer** — the **little tradition** / **great tradition** idea (roots traceable to Redfield).
- **McKim Marriott** — the **interaction** between little and great tradition, for which he coined **universalization** and **parochialization**.

KEY CONCEPT

Great tradition = the national/bigger tradition (great only **quantitatively**, not qualitatively); **little tradition** = the local/folk tradition. India has many little traditions — there is no single Indian tradition.

QUICK REVISION

- Redfield: folk-urban continuum; Singer: little/great tradition; Marriott: universalization & parochialization.
- Great tradition = national (quantitative); little = local/folk; India = many little traditions.

Little and Great Tradition

12.1 Tradition: Meaning and Forms

Before studying the modernisation of Indian tradition, one must understand what **tradition** itself is.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Tradition** — any custom, practice or ritual that is forwarded from one generation to the next, either **orally** or in **written form**.
- If it continues for generations together, it becomes established as a tradition.
- The key requirement of a tradition is **longevity** — it must have been sustained over a long time: through upheavals, earthquakes and other disturbances, the practice still survives. That is what makes it a tradition.

12.1.1 Oral vs written tradition

- **Written tradition** is generally regarded as mainstream, elitist, superior, authentic and original.
- **Oral tradition** is regarded as not mainstream, not classical, not elitist — local, limited to a few people and not popular.
 - Written things become popular easily because they are printed and copies are distributed cheaply; written things have reach, which oral ones lack (e.g. a statement written on social media spreads, while a spoken remark reaches only one friend).

12.2 Robert Redfield and the Study of Tradition

The systematic study of tradition was initiated by an American anthropologist, **Robert Redfield**.

DATA & FACTS

- Robert Redfield — American anthropologist.
- Conducted a field study in **Tepoztlán**, a village in Mexico.
- There he identified **two types of tradition: Little Tradition and Great Tradition**.

In every society — village or city — every civilisation has its own traditions and customs, practised locally (orally or in writing) but absent in other pockets. Some traditions are practised locally, others universally.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Great Tradition** is always the **written** one.
- **Little Tradition** is always the **oral** one.
- The little tradition is practised at the local/village level; the great tradition is known universally, all over India.

12.3 Kishan Garhi Village and Milton Singer's Study

Redfield's students visited Indian villages to observe these traditions, just as Redfield had studied Tepoztlán. One such village was **Kishan Garhi** in Uttar Pradesh, studied by **Milton Singer** (a student of Redfield).

EXAMPLE

- **Govardhan** — the local practice at Kishan Garhi. It is believed that some 40 km from the village, Lord Krishna descended to help villagers protect their cattle from a heavy rain by lifting the entire **Govardhan** mountain on his little finger (while playing the flute on the other hand).
- Today a local practice called **Govardhan** is celebrated around this: cattle dung is treated as wealth (a source of methane), and rituals are conducted around Govardhan because it sustains the local economy.
- This is a local practice — the whole of India cannot be expected to celebrate Govardhan or have a Govardhan holiday — so it remains a **little tradition**.
- The same story is used by the Yadav people to trace their descent/lineage to Lord Krishna (Yadu Maharaj). The story is passed **orally**, so it is a little tradition.

The terms 'little tradition' and 'great tradition' were coined by Robert Redfield; the examples studied in India come from Redfield's students.

12.4 Universalization of Little Tradition

It is not true that little traditions always remain little. Over a period of time they may become great, and once great, the oral little tradition may even acquire a written form to justify its greatness.

EXAMPLE

- **Sannauli** → **Raksha Bandhan**. In Kishan Garhi there is a local custom called **Sannauli**: a brother must visit his married sister once a year, carrying gifts for the priest who arranged the marriage and for the sister's in-laws; the sister applies a tilak (with barley grains) on his forehead and ties a thread (dhaga) on his wrist as a mark of the visit.
- This local practice is celebrated today in the name of **Raksha Bandhan** — it has become a great tradition. Raksha Bandhan was never originally a great tradition; its 'little' form was Sannauli.
- Today Raksha Bandhan has a national holiday and written texts to justify it (its history is

found even on Wikipedia); nothing is written about Sannauli, which remains oral.

- When a little tradition becomes great or universalised — celebrated all over India in different forms — the process is called **universalization of little tradition**.
- The terms **universalization** and **parochialization** were coined by **McKim Marriott**, another student of Redfield.

EXAMPLE

- **Karwa Chauth** — today celebrated all over India, but it began as a local custom of western Rajasthan and Gujarat and then took universalised form. It was never originally an all-India (great) tradition; it was oral, and even today nothing is written about it, yet it is universally practised and has become part of the great tradition.
- **Jaya** → **Bharata** → **Mahabharata**. The great epic Mahabharata is a great tradition, but its original form was **Jaya** — a local text of about 3,000 verses — which grew through Bharata into the Mahabharata (the Sanskrit epic attributed to Vyasa, who in reality wrote only a few parts).

12.5 Parochialization of Great Tradition

- When a great tradition becomes little — takes a localised form in different villages — the process is called **parochialization**.

EXAMPLE

- **Govardhan** is a parochialised form of the Govardhan event (Krishna saving the cattle). The full Krishna narrative — his childhood story and life — is known all over India (great tradition); in different villages it has taken a parochialised, local form.
- **Diwali** was initially a local festival celebrating the welcome of Rama (on his return after killing Ravana), but has become part of the great tradition — popularised through the **Ramayana** and **Ramlila**. Ramlila was itself practised locally, and every village began projecting it to spread awareness of the great heroes among the masses.
- **Harikatha** (the stories of Krishna) was practised locally but gradually took a great avatar and became part of the great tradition.
- **G. S. Ghurye** also discussed this: local customs limited to the Hindu Vedic belt diffused all over India with the help of priests and customs like **Ashwamedha** — little traditions that became great once practised everywhere.

KEY CONCEPT

- **McKim Marriott** believes **social change in India can be explained with the help of the interaction between little tradition and great tradition**.
- Just as **westernization** and **Sanskritization** are processes of social change, **universalization** (a local practice becoming universal) and **parochialization** (a universal practice taking a local avatar) are also processes of social change.

12.6 Examples from Kishan Garhi: Saurati and Naurata

Milton Singer studied Kishan Garhi and its little traditions; McKim Marriott re-studied the same village and developed the concepts of universalization and parochialization. Kishan Garhi was treated as representative of all Indian villages because it was imbued with folk customs and local traditions (just as Gandhi saw the village as representing India).

EXAMPLE

- **Festival of Lights** — celebrated around a local goddess **Saurati** (also written Saurata; S-A-U-R-T-I / S-A-U-R-T-H-A), a symbol of wealth and prosperity.
- Marriott believed **Saurati is a parochialised form of Lakshmi** (Lakshmi is the all-India Sanskritic Hindu goddess of wealth and prosperity, who at the local level becomes Saurati).
- **Naurata** — a local goddess in Kishan Garhi worshipped for **nine days/nights** (made of mud). Marriott believed **Naurata became Navratri all over India** — the origin of Navratri lies in Naurata, and the nine-night Navratri customs (fasting, food restrictions) practised all over India originated in that village.
- **Naurata has also influenced Durga Puja and Kali Puja** (per Marriott).

CRITICAL POINT

- The teacher flagged that the exact direction of the deity examples is easy to confuse, and instructed students to follow the written notes. The written version is:
- **Parochialization** — a process of **localization** of the great tradition: in Kishan Garhi, the mud female deity **Naurata** is worshipped for nine consecutive nights; Marriott believes **Durga has been parochialised into Naurata** (the name itself deriving from 'Navratri').
- **Universalization** — in the Festival of Lights, the local goddess **Saurati** would have been **universalised into the goddess Lakshmi** of the great tradition.

In conclusion, seen through festivals and deities, the religion of the village of Kishan Garhi may be said to have originated from a continuing process of communication between the little and the great tradition.

12.7 Sanskritization as Parochialization

COMPARISON

- **All-India Sanskritic Hinduism** = the **great tradition** — found everywhere across India; there is no state without a temple of the Hindu gods.
- **Local Hinduism** (local gods like **Karni Mata, Mansa Devi, Murugan**) = the **little tradition** — practised locally, limited to a specific region, by few people, not found elsewhere.
- Great tradition is largely among literate, Sanskrit-knowing elites; little tradition is oral, among the illiterate, at mass level but local.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Sanskritization** is the process by which local Hinduism borrows from all-India Sanskritic Hinduism — i.e. low-caste, tribal or other groups emulate the **twice-born (dvija)** upper castes, their lifestyle, customs and even their gods.
- Therefore **Sanskritization is nothing but the parochialization of all-India Sanskritic Hinduism.**
- Sanskritization can also be called **traditionalization** — the emulation of dvija traditions by the non-dvija low castes.

EXAMPLE

- **Coorg (Kodagu)** example (from M. N. Srinivas): the Coorgs were invaded by the **Lingayats** (Shaivites, worshippers of Shiva). The Coorgs then claim **Kshatriya status**; Shiva (a great-tradition deity) got parochialised among the Coorg.
- The Coorgs began to consider the **Kaveri** as a sacred river (Kaveri is a sacred goddess among Hindus), and even wrote a **Kaveri Purana** — a local Purana that does not exist among the great Puranas.
- This shows great tradition getting localised/parochialised among a local group.

12.8 Great & Little Tradition and Social Change: Yogendra Singh's Framework

The great and little traditions form part of our culture, and they must be understood to grasp **Yogendra Singh's** book **Modernization of Indian Tradition**. There is no single 'Indian tradition' — traditions vary from village to village and from the local to the great level.

KEY CONCEPT

- Tradition does not die; it **adapts**. When exposed to modern/colonial forces, a tradition like Holi adapts rather than disappears — today Holi is played with modern water jets and AK-47-shaped pichkaris; Diwali uses environment-friendly, carbon-free, sustainable firecrackers.
- This is the unique feature of tradition — it is continuous and passed from generation to generation.

Yogendra Singh studies **modernization** as the change introduced by colonization (modern education, modern laws, parliamentary structure, democracy, fundamental rights — all came from outside) and its interaction with existing traditions. He looks at changes in **every realm**, at both the **cultural level** and the **structural level**.

COMPARISON

- Yogendra Singh's framework (the table to remember):
- **Sources of change** — cultural structure vs social structure.
- **Cultural structure** — **little tradition** and **great tradition**.

- **Social structure** — **micro-structure** and **macro-structure**.
- **Direction of change** — **orthogenetic** (change from within) and **heterogenetic** (change from outside).
- Examples: Naurata → Durga (Durga is a universalised form of Naurata) is change **from within** = orthogenetic; **Sanskritization** is orthogenetic (from within India); **westernization** is heterogenetic (from outside).

- **Orthogenetic change** (from within): **Sanskritization** / **traditionalization**.
- **Heterogenetic change** (from outside): **primary westernization**, **Islamization** (and Sufi culture — Sufi songs/'Sufization' of Bollywood coming from outside). Secondary westernization is largely heterogenetic but can also be orthogenetic.
 - Primary westernization is heterogenetic; secondary (and tertiary) westernization are orthogenetic in form.
 - The primary people (upper-caste Brahmins and Banias, especially Brahmins) got western education first, and were the first to be emulated by the lower castes — who in emulating them also emulated western culture; hence secondary westernization faced some cultural resistance.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Islamization** began with the advent of the Sultanate: it introduced things alien to Indian civilisation — new land systems, and a warrior class with its own army (the first such class in India).
- With the Sultanate and then the Mughals, a harmony and peaceful mutual coexistence was gradually established between the local indigenous (Vedic) people and the Muslim outsiders — though there were also periods of war (which Yogendra Singh does not dwell on; he avoids the conflict dimension and is not influenced by Marxism here).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Yogendra Singh's definition of modernization**: an **ongoing process** from a traditional, agrarian Indian society to a modern, industrial (Western) society.
- He insists modernization in India should **not be seen as a binary opposition** — in the West modernization came at the cost of tradition, but in India traditions get modernised; tradition and modernity **coexist**.
- Example: **caste** is a traditional system, yet it has taken a modern avatar through **caste associations** (e.g. an all-India Thakur association) — modern democratic associations formed around traditional identities, possible only because of the Constitution.
- Example: **Panchayati Raj Institution** is the democratic (constitutionalised) avatar of the old local **caste panchayat** — the panchayat did not end, it got modernised/institutionalised.
- Example: worship of **Lord Jagannath** now happens digitally — pilgrimage, digital aarti, online donation — the tradition persists in a modernised avatar.

Yogendra Singh's theory is considered the **most comprehensive** because it covers every level:

changes in little tradition and great tradition, and changes at micro-structure and macro-structure.

- **Macro-structure:** modern bureaucracy, parliament, meritocracy — systems India did not have before (recruitment was patronised/nepotistic, not a rational written process). This is a macro-level change (rational bureaucracy, open competitive exam with universalised treatment).
- **Micro-structure:** individuals — e.g. the traditional role of women (housewife) and of Dalits has changed; women now work at par with men (gender equality / women empowerment). This micro-level change also affects the macro-structure of the family (families weakened/separated, 'living apart together' arrangements).

DATA & FACTS

- The **modernization theory** was originally given by classical theorists — **Comte, Marx, Weber, Parsons** — but it explained the modernising process of the **West**.
- In contemporary times, especially the **post-Cold War** period, modernization theories explain the modernization of the **non-West** — every country can be placed within **Rostow's five stages**: traditional; pre-take-off; take-off; drive to maturity; and the age of mass consumption.
- Yogendra Singh explains modernization through the process of **colonization**, but he does not limit himself to colonization — he also studies the impact of **westernization, Islamization** and **Sanskritization**.

The detailed explanation of the framework is continued in the next lecture (Modernization of Indian Tradition).

QUICK REVISION

- Tradition = custom/practice/ritual passed down generations (orally or written), sustained by longevity.
- Written tradition = mainstream/elitist/superior; oral tradition = local/limited/not popular.
- Robert Redfield (American anthropologist) studied Tepoztlán, Mexico and coined **Little Tradition** (oral, local) and **Great Tradition** (written, universal).
- Milton Singer studied Kishan Garhi (UP); McKim Marriott re-studied it and coined **universalization** (little → great) and **parochialization** (great → little).
- Examples: Sannauli → Raksha Bandhan; Karwa Chauth (local Rajasthan/Gujarat → all-India); Jaya → Bharata → Mahabharata; Diwali + Ramlila; Govardhan (parochialised).
- Kishan Garhi deities: Saurati (Festival of Lights) ↔ Lakshmi; Naurata (9 nights) → Navratri, also influencing Durga Puja/Kali Puja.
- Sanskritization = parochialization of all-India Sanskritic Hinduism; Coorg/Lingayat/Kaveri Purana example.
- Yogendra Singh's framework: cultural (little/great) + structural (micro/macro) + orthogenetic (within) vs heterogenetic (outside); modernization = agrarian → industrial, tradition & modernity coexist (not binary).

Tribal Communities in India

13.1 The Definitional Problem

13.1.1 *Four Themes of the Tribal Unit*

Tribes constitute a vast area of interest — almost a full discipline in themselves — but in the syllabus they form one small unit from which one or two questions are asked.

KEY CONCEPT

- The **four major themes** under Tribes:
- 1. The **definitional problem** (what is a tribe, and by what criteria are people labelled tribes?).
- 2. **Geographical spread** of tribes.
- 3. **Colonial policies and the tribes** (and their impact).
- 4. The issue of **integration and autonomy**.
- These themes are not isolated — they are all integrated, and the root of everything lies in the **colonial history of India**.

13.1.2 *Tribe as an Externally Imposed Category*

Do tribes see themselves as 'tribes' the way we identify them? No — they do not identify themselves as such.

EXAMPLE

- **S. C. Roy** (India's first ethnographer) studied the **Mundas** and found that they call themselves **Horoko** — a term in the Mundari language meaning '**the original creation of the creator**' — not a subdivision of the population, a different race, or something lesser, but the original human beings.
- When Roy interacted with the **Khonds** (a tribe), one of them asked, 'Are there Khonds in your country as well?' — showing that the groups we treat as distinct view themselves completely differently from how outsiders see them.

KEY CONCEPT

- The **tribal identity** by which these groups are now known is **not something they imposed on themselves or created** — it is an **external category imposed upon them**.
- The image that comes to mind — semi-naked, forest-dwelling, illiterate, primitive people —

was **constructed by the European colonizers**.

- In the 16th–18th centuries (the peak of colonization), categories such as **tribe, indigenous people, first nation, aborigine and native** were created to label the people of the non-Western world. The first label used was **native** (the original inhabitants of a place).

COMPARISON

- In **Australia/America** there were indigenous inhabitants and external colonizers, so 'indigenous', 'first nation', 'native' all overlapped.
- In **India**, everyone was native — Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, Shudras and tribes alike — so a fresh internal distinction had to be created: **caste vs tribe**.
- The British divided Indian society into two categories: (1) those **absorbed in the mainstream feudal system** (the caste groups), and (2) those **relatively isolated, living in the forest** (the tribes).

KEY CONCEPT

- The term 'tribe' was introduced by the British colonial government as an administrative strategy — to distinguish between those already incorporated within the hierarchical feudal system and those outside it.
- This was a practice of **administrative convenience**: hierarchical (caste) society vs relatively egalitarian (tribal) society.
- To create a distinct category, the colonizers used various **criteria**. The first was **religion**: those who practise **animism** (belief in soul / panpsychism — a soul in every object) were considered tribes.
- The criterion was later refined: those **outside the universal religions** (Hinduism, Islam, Sikhism, Christianity, Buddhism, Jainism) — having their own indigenous/native religion — would be considered tribes.

13.1.3 The Classical Evolutionary Theory

The definitions of tribe were intertwined with the political and social conditions of the time; two theories dominated the colonial era — the classical evolutionary theory and functionalism.

KEY CONCEPT

- In the 16th century, the **Enlightenment** emerged in Europe, promoting **rational thought** over theological interpretation: society was no longer seen as divinely ordained, and every social relation came to be seen as a **human creation**.
- With industrialisation, technology, inventions and navigation, Europeans travelled and met diverse cultures, and had to explain **human diversity**.
- **Positivism** was established: society is external and objective, so data can be collected about it and **laws** of society (applying to every society) can be formulated.
- This produced a **division of the social sciences**: **sociology** (to critically interpret one's

own, industrial society) and **anthropology** (to study 'other cultures' — the non-European, non-developed cultures).

KEY CONCEPT

- Contact with non-Western peoples produced a **racial superiority complex**: Australian and African tribals exchanged gold for glass beads, so Europeans concluded these were 'child-like' people whose brains were not developed.
- This formed the **evolutionary theory**: society develops in **stages**, and certain societies are **arrested** at a particular (early) stage of growth — these were labelled **tribe** (least developed, uncivilised, illiterate, without good technology, chaotically arranged).
- Europeans speculated that these people represented the childhood or early stages of human development, and that Europeans had evolved into a superior stage they self-designated as 'civilisation'. The word 'tribe' emerged in this context, applied to people seen as far away from civilisation.

CRITICAL POINT

- The animal-like equation of tribals allowed Europeans to **acquire their land and justify genocide** — driving them away or killing them.
- Tribal land was called **Terra Nullius** (terra = territory; nullius = void/zero) — 'vacant land', ready to be captured, ignoring their habitation.
- Most were killed in mass massacres; survivors were sent to **reserves** (like wildlife reserves/national parks) in America, Australia and New Zealand.
- Example: the **Maori** of New Zealand — the indigenous settlers subjugated to minority and vulnerability after colonisation (e.g. the wrestlers Dwayne 'The Rock' Johnson and Roman Reigns are Maori); recently a Maori candidate was in line to be the next Prime Minister of New Zealand.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- **G. S. Ghurye** was inspired by evolutionism (and by **E. B. Tylor**, the founder of the school of evolutionism — Ghurye even gave a racial origin of the caste system).
- Ghurye defines tribes as communities which **live away from the civilised, speak the same tribal dialect, profess a primitive religion (animism), practise a primitive occupation (hunter-gatherers), are largely carnivorous, live naked or semi-naked, and have nomadic habits**.
- The emphasis is on **primitiveness/backwardness** as a stage of evolution — from which they will gradually develop towards civilisation.
- This gave colonial powers the authority to rule: the '**White Man's Burden**' — the colonisers claimed the obligation to civilise these 'uncivilised' people and share the fruits of civilisation. 'Civilisation' to them meant their own culture, the most evolved form.

13.1.4 The Functionalist Approach

The classical evolutionary theory was not based on fieldwork — it relied on **second-hand data** (travellers, traders, missionaries, e.g. Marco Polo, Vasco da Gama), who sensationalised what they saw ('they eat raw meat, perform magic, roam naked, have incestuous sex'). This produced a distorted image, and the evolutionary theories were later rejected.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Functionalism** begins with **fieldwork** — collecting **first-hand, empirical data** rather than speculation. The people among whom fieldwork was done were designated as **tribe**.
- Functionalism put forth the paradigm of tribe as an **isolated, bounded and homogeneous entity**.
- **Each tribe was a single homogeneous entity** — a single pattern of institutions and ideas — and those who shared this pattern participated in no other pattern. They were viewed as having a **definite identity**, endorsed by the practice of **endogamy** and a body of belief unique to themselves.
- Rooted in **structural-functionalism**, this stressed **equilibrium**: the boundedness of social relations maintains equilibrium, so the tribe is presented as **unchanging, static, and ahistorical** — living the same way for generations, with change coming only when they contact colonial powers.
- **Boundedness** means one's whole life is defined by social relations — especially **kinship and descent**. By birth into a family/descent group one gets fixed economic, political and social roles (no choices: e.g. the eldest son rules, the youngest cannot).

KEY CONCEPT

- **D. N. Majumdar** (an Indian structural-functionalist, inspired by Radcliffe-Brown) defines **tribe** as a **collection of families wearing a common name, occupying a common territory, observing certain taboos regarding marriage, profession/occupation, and having a well-assigned system of reciprocity**.
- **Reciprocity** — mutual obligation: giving something and expecting something in return. As **Marcel Mauss** (a relative of Durkheim, author of *The Gift*) put it, '**if friends make gifts, gifts make friends**' — exchanging objects creates and maintains a social relationship, so strangers cannot simply transact as in a market.

CRITICAL POINT

- Functionalism was criticised on two grounds:
- 1. **The neat classification was impossible** — tribes cannot be neatly boxed as isolated/bounded. The **Ramayana** (from the Gupta age) shows **Shabri** (a tribal woman) and a **king of the forest** who helps Rama cross the river — evidence of ancient contact between tribe and caste, thousands of years before colonisation.
- 2. **Over-emphasis on equilibrium** — the claim of a static, unchanging, ahistorical society was challenged (no society is without change/conflict).

13.1.5 Elman Service's Socio-Political Typology

KEY CONCEPT

- **Elman Service** used a **socio-political typology** to understand the tribe, dividing all the societies of the world, on the basis of organisational complexity, into **four categories: band, tribe, chiefdom, state**.
- The **tribe is simply a stage in organisational complexity** — more complex than a band, less complex than a chiefdom and state — with **no developmental stigma or progressive ideology attached**.
- **Tribe refers to all those societies based on relations of kinship, especially descent groups:** a person becomes a member by being **born into a descent group**, and carries that identity for purposes of **marriage, ownership of resources, and political relations**.
- This is the more comprehensive definition accepted by scholars — it places tribe on a scale of evolving organisational complexity without attaching any developmental or progressive significance to the stages.

13.1.6 Post-Colonial Paradigm Shift

Colonial ethnography was sponsored by the colonial rulers and could not criticise colonial rule — it painted a happy-go-lucky picture of tribes as isolated societies in equilibrium, ignoring the violence, genocide and epidemics that colonial rule brought.

KEY CONCEPT

- In the **post-colonial period**, when natives got the chance to write about themselves, scholars began to project tribes as a **distinct ethnic group** — not racial, not backward, not static.
- An **ethnic group** has: (1) a **sense of unity / identity consciousness** (I belong to that group), and (2) a **shared experience** of culture, history, or another unifying factor.
- **Post-colonial ethnography rejected the idea of equilibrium / static tribal society, and the term 'tribe' was replaced by 'ethnic groups'** — applied mostly to communities that may be **less dominant in the social hierarchy** but have a **distinct culture**.
- Tribes are now seen as **interacting** with the mainstream and **gradually transforming** — e.g. Scheduled Tribe members entering the IAS/IPS and white-collar jobs, and tribal tourism (museums, restaurants, souvenirs, the 'tribal circuit') showcasing their culture. They can no longer be labelled backward, primitive, or static.

The debate on whether **tribes should be seen as the 'indigenous people of India'** (an EPW article by the sociologist **Virginius Xaxa**) is taken up in the next class.

QUICK REVISION

- Four themes: definitional problem, geographical spread, colonial policies, integration & autonomy — all rooted in colonial history.
- 'Tribe' is an external, colonially imposed category — tribals do not call themselves tribes (Mundas = 'Horoko', original creation of creator; S. C. Roy).

- British administrative strategy: caste = absorbed in feudal hierarchy; tribe = isolated forest-dwellers; criteria — animism, outside universal religions.
- Classical evolutionary theory: Enlightenment → rationality → positivism → racial superiority complex → tribe = 'arrested childhood stage'; terra nullius; genocide/reserves; Ghurye's definition; White Man's Burden.
- Functionalism: fieldwork & first-hand data; tribe = isolated, bounded, homogeneous, static (equilibrium); D. N. Majumdar's definition; reciprocity (Mauss, 'The Gift'); criticised (Ramayana's Shabri; no pure equilibrium).
- Elman Service: band → tribe → chiefdom → state; tribe = kinship/descent-based, no stigma.
- Post-colonial shift: 'tribe' → 'ethnic groups' (identity consciousness + shared culture), interacting and transforming.

13.2 Indigenous Status and the Tribe–Caste Relationship

13.2.1 Who Are 'Indigenous' People?

In lay terms, **indigenous** means the original inhabitant of a place — but today the relevant idea is that they are the **descendants** of original inhabitants, not the originals themselves.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- The term gained currency through the **International Labour Organization (ILO)**.
- **ILO Convention 107 (1957)** defined who is indigenous.
- **ILO Convention 169 (1989)** gave the idea of how to *identify* indigenous people.
- ILO's position: it is more important to **identify** indigenous people than to **define** them.

KEY CONCEPT

- ILO's identification criteria:
 1. **Self-identification / self-determination** — they proclaim themselves the original inhabitants (and we accept it).
 2. **Historical continuity** — a historical connection with the ancestors whose descendants they claim to be.
 3. **Distinct political, social and economic system** — distinct from the mainstream, having maintained their distinct identity and not fully assimilated.
 4. **Distinct language, culture and belief** — distinct way of life, thought process, religion, family and other institutions.
 5. **Non-dominant part of society** — i.e. marginalised.
- In short: original inhabitants before colonisation, with historical continuity, distinct systems and culture, and marginalised status.

13.2.2 The Indigenous-Status Debate: Virginius Xaxa

The debate over whether Indian tribes are indigenous is summarised from an EPW article by the sociologist **Virginius Xaxa** ('Tribes as Indigenous People of India'). Until 1989 tribes were accepted as indigenous; after 1989 the Indian government had difficulty accepting the label.

KEY CONCEPT

- The definition of tribe has always been difficult, but one thing associated with tribes is accepted: they are the **dispossessed and deprived people of a region** — vulnerable, marginalised, needing support.
- Indian tribes have **never claimed to be the original inhabitants**; what they have asked for is **access to the resources of their region** and a **say in how those resources are used**.
- Tribes occupy regions rich in forest and natural resources (minerals, coal), but these resources have been extracted **without sharing the fruits of development** — their land is snatched by corporates or government companies and they are displaced.
- The tribal identity gives self-esteem and has been used to mobilise people for their rights and due share of development — in the process they have begun to assert themselves as the indigenous population/natives of India.

13.2.3 ILO Conventions 107 and 169

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- **Convention 107 (1957)** — about the integration of indigenous people: to 'protect and promote the progressive integration' of indigenous people into mainstream society. India **accepted** this convention.
- **Integration ≠ assimilation**: assimilation means losing one's identity and becoming part of the other; integration means keeping one's identity while becoming part of the whole — like a **rainbow** (each colour keeps its identity yet is part of the continuum) or a **salad bowl**.
- Example: the **Sikh** community has not become Hindu to integrate into India — it keeps its own identity, religion, and separate laws, yet is part of the nation.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- **1985** — on the basis of several activists, ILO concluded the convention needed revision: integration vs assimilation should be **decided by the tribes themselves** (a 'next level of democracy' — they should plan and execute their own development schemes).
- **Convention 169 (1989)** — shifts from **integration to empowerment**: it speaks of **need rights** and **power rights**, especially **rights over land** (what is to be done with their land should be their decision, not the government's or a mining company's).
- Convention 169 gave a specific definition of indigenous highlighting **three aspects**: (1) **lived before colonisation**; (2) **marginalised after colonisation**; (3) **govern their life based on their own socio-economic and cultural institutions** (rather than the broad constitutional/state structure).

- This created a problem for the Indian government, which therefore **did not accept Convention 169**.

13.2.4 Arguments Against Indigenous Status

CRITICAL POINT

- The government's core objection: **no population in India is less indigenous than the tribes** — Sikhs, Hindus, Muslims, Buddhists and Jains were all present before colonisation, so none is 'more indigenous' than another.
- The detailed arguments against granting tribes indigenous status:
 - **Waves, not one wave, of colonisation.** Unlike the US, New Zealand and Australia (where a single wave of colonisation in the 16th–17th century pushed the original population to marginal areas), India has seen waves of movement over centuries and millennia — so there is no fixed point to decide who is native. **How far back should one go to determine who is native and who is not?**
 - **Close proximity and acculturation.** Tribes have lived in close proximity with non-tribes for centuries, leading to much acculturation and even assimilation (e.g. the **Ramayana's** Bhil woman **Shabri**, who offers berries/fruits to Rama — evidence of smooth cultural contact). Indian experience is different from the US pattern of pushing natives to reserves.
 - **The Aryan-migration problem.** If the Aryan migration (which pushed the original inhabitants southward) is taken as the reference, then non-tribes become the 'migrants'. But many tribes settled *after* the Aryans: the **Mongoloid tribes of the North-East** migrated from Tibet, Myanmar and Mongolia (via China) and settled only around the 1st millennium AD — the **Meiteis** around the 16th century, the **Kukis** even later. So **not all tribes can claim settlement prior to the Aryans**.
 - **The reference-point problem.** Should indigenous status be given at the national or the local (territory-occupied) level? If **original settlement** is the criterion, several **non-tribal** communities would be included as indigenous — the **Dravidian** speakers (Tamil, Kannada, Telugu, Malayalam) settled before the Aryans — while several tribes (Nagas, Kukis, Mizos) would be excluded. These non-tribes are also often the *dominant* communities of their states, so they cannot be given indigenous status.
 - **Fused, mixed communities.** Indian society is made up of caste groups formed out of the **fusion** of various groups — Bengalis, Odiyas and others have both indigenous and non-indigenous components, so only **one segment** of a community would be 'indigenous' while the rest would not.

13.2.5 Arguments For Indigenous Status

KEY CONCEPT

- Activists, tribal scholars and sociologists (including **Virginus Xaxa**) argue for declaring tribes indigenous because it leads to their **self-empowerment** — improved welfare and participatory democracy (they plan and execute their own welfare plans).

- The claim should not be read literally (original settlement) but for the **larger good** it brings.
- **Time of settlement, not original settlement.** It is defended not on the basis of *original* settlement but *time* of settlement — their fathers, grandfathers and forefathers have lived in that area for a very long time, so they have original-settler status of that place.
- **Worst victims of colonisation.** Forests were exploited for raw material, tribals were treated like animals and their land treated as **terra nullius** — so they faced the maximum brunt of colonisation and share all the **attributes of colonised people** (an ethnic identity as a non-dominant, vulnerable section).
- **Do not mix the two levels.** Do not confuse the national level with the local level — simply give them original-settler/priority rights over the particular area they have long inhabited.
- **Understand why the claim is arising.** Dominant communities make the same 'this is our land' claim through **sons-of-the-soil movements** — Marathi speakers in Maharashtra (against 'Biharis', during Balasaheb Thackeray and Raj Thackeray's agitations), Tamils in Tamil Nadu, Kannadigas, Punjabis, Gujaratis — and governments respond with reservations (e.g. Maharashtra/Haryana reserving private jobs for locals). But this privilege is denied to tribals: coal and minerals are extracted on their land (by Vedanta, Tata, etc.) without them getting the benefits or the right to protest. The **minimum** that should be done is to **recognise their prior rights over their land and resources**.

QUICK REVISION

- Indigenous = descendants of original inhabitants; ILO 107 (1957) defined it, ILO 169 (1989) identified it (self-identification, historical continuity, distinct systems/culture, non-dominant).
- Xaxa's debate: tribes are dispossessed/deprived; they never claimed to be 'original' — they demand rights over regional resources.
- 107 = progressive integration (rainbow/salad bowl, not assimilation); India accepted it. 169 = empowerment + land rights; India rejected it.
- Against indigenous status: waves of migration (no fixed point); proximity/acculturation (Shabri); Aryan migration (NE tribes settled later); reference point (Dravidians would count, Nagas/Kukis/Mizos would not); fused communities (one segment only).
- For indigenous status: time (not original) of settlement; worst victims of colonisation (terra nullius); don't mix levels; sons-of-the-soil hypocrisy — minimum is recognising land/resource rights.

13.2.6 Tribe and Caste: Two Foreign Categories

KEY CONCEPT

- Both 'tribe' and 'caste' are **foreign words, not Indian** — neither is how Indian society organises itself.
- **Tribe** is a colonial construct (introduced by the British).
- **Caste** comes from the Portuguese word '**casta**' — the Portuguese saw Indian society divided into distinct, endogamous groups and used 'caste' to identify them.

- The Indian terms: tribe = **janjati**; caste = **jati** (the 'ground reality'). Janjati is simply the **jati that lives in the forest**.
- Colonial ethnographers wanted to create a **watertight boundary** between caste and tribe — projecting tribe as a distinct, isolated group unaffected by caste.

Post-colonisation, scholars showed that tribe and caste were never separate — they interacted, and their identities are **fluid, not fixed**. The evolutionists defined tribe as backward; the functionalists as isolated/bounded with a unique fixed identity. This categorisation became official through the **Census** (1901: those following animism; 1931: those following a religion other than the mainstream).

13.2.7 *From Watertight Boundary to Continuum: Mandelbaum and Wiser*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Mandelbaum** (David Mandelbaum) — there are many groups at the **intersection of tribe and caste** whose identities are difficult to pinpoint (they appear like both a tribe and a caste).
- His distinguishing criterion: **in a tribe, the principal links for the whole of society are based on kinship** — but for a **jati**, it is not just kinship but the **presence of other jatis of unequal rank** that enables it to continue as a particular jati group.
- Therefore **hierarchy is the central feature of caste** (absent in the egalitarian tribe): jatis insist on hierarchical ordering, while tribesmen organise society by kinship without insisting on hierarchy.

EXAMPLE

William Wiser — in the village, several jatis performing different tasks live together in **organic solidarity** (interdependence due to heterogeneity: a barber cuts hair, a carpenter offers services). This heterogeneity is **not** the case with tribes, where homogeneity prevails.

13.2.8 *The Tribe–Caste Continuum*

KEY CONCEPT

- A **continuum** means there is no discrete categorisation — change from one end to the other is so gradual that you cannot draw a clean line (like a rainbow: you cannot tell exactly where violet ends and indigo begins).
- The **tribe–caste continuum** holds that **tribe and caste are polar ideal categories** — ideal types (in Weber's sense) that do not exist in reality. They are reference points; most communities lie **somewhere in between** — closer to tribe but with some caste influence, or closer to caste but with some tribal influence.
- This idea was given by **F. G. Bailey** (who studied the village **Bishipara in Odisha**), **Surjit Sinha** (who studied the **Lodha** community in West Bengal), and **D. N. Majumdar**.
- The continuum reflects continuous interaction: tribes and castes have influenced each other and adopted elements from each other — no tribe is completely isolated from caste influence.

EXAMPLE

- **D. N. Majumdar** — the movement of tribal people adopting caste elements is **one form of Sanskritization** (using M. N. Srinivas's idea): tribes absorb caste-based ideology/elements to be recognised in Hindu society and proclaim a caste identity.
- Example from the **Garo Hills**: the **Songsarek Garos** show little or no sign of Sanskritization, while the **Dalus** have completely adopted a Hindu identity (proclaiming themselves Vaishnavas). These are the two extremes of the continuum; in between lie **Rabha, Koch and Hajong** — absorbing caste elements but not fully identifying as caste.
- Christian missionaries established schools and converted tribals (especially in Jharkhand, Chhattisgarh, Odisha and the North-East); later organisations like the **RSS** began similar activity (e.g. coaching institutes in Arunachal) inculcating Hindu values — both processes erode tribal identity.

13.2.9 Hindu Mode of Tribal Absorption (N. K. Bose)**KEY CONCEPT**

- **Nirmal Kumar Bose (N. K. Bose)** gave the idea of the '**Hindu mode of tribal absorption**' — the process by which Hindus gradually absorb a tribal community as a distinct caste group.
- Reasons why a tribe adopts the caste system:
 1. **Monopoly over an occupation** — economic security (their basic economy runs; they are no longer dependent).
 2. The **level of technology and lifestyle** the tribe saw among Hindu farmers/peasants.
- A tribe absorbs caste identity **irrespective of the position it gets in the hierarchy**.

EXAMPLE

- Example: the **Juangs of Odisha** (studied by Bose) — the dominant castes depended on the Juangs for local liquor, became addicted, and fell into debt; through these economic ties with mainstream castes, the Juangs gradually assumed a caste-like identity.
- **Poverty of Brahmins** was another reason (also cited by **Herbert Risley**): poor priests acted as guides for aspiring tribes — for a fee they created stories proving a tribe's claim to a dominant (e.g. Rajput) caste identity.
- Example: the **Kanjar** community — said to be Rajputs and descendants of **Maharana Pratap** who left their kingdom after the Mughal/Delhi Sultanate invasion and took to the forest, thus acquiring a tribal identity. Such stories legitimised the tribe's upward claim.

CRITICAL POINT

N. K. Bose is criticised for talking about movement in **one direction only** (tribe → caste). In fact movement also happens the other way — **caste moving towards tribe** — which is called **tribalization**.

13.2.10 Tribalization: The Reverse Movement (C. W. Brown)

EXAMPLE

- **C. W. Brown** studied the **Bhotias** (now in Uttarakhand, at the Indo-Tibetan border): they were actually **Rajputs** who preferred a **non-Hindu lifestyle** (e.g. eating beef) in order to form long-term trading relations with Tibetans (which involved living in each other's houses).
- They **sacrificed their upper-caste status for economic benefit** — becoming nomadic traders with a tribal-like identity.
- **Post-independence**, cross-border trade was discontinued, and the Bhotias — whose economic and political relations were now within mainland India — **attempted to move back towards Hindu upper-caste identity**.
- This shows movement from **caste to tribe** (tribalization), not just tribe to caste.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Conclusion:** colonial scholars and the functionalist definition tried to project a **fixed** identity, but the identity of tribe and caste is in reality **fluid** — it changes with context and circumstances (a group may move towards tribal identity or towards caste identity depending on the situation).
- The identity of being a tribe or a caste is **a matter of historical and political process**, and **may change over time depending on the context**.

CRITICAL POINT

Note on terminology: Sanskritization and 'casteization' are **not interchangeable**. Majumdar uses Srinivas's idea of Sanskritization to explain tribe→caste mobility; it is **one type of Sanskritization**, not the same as casteization.

QUICK REVISION

- 'Tribe' and 'caste' are foreign constructs — tribe (colonial), caste (Portuguese 'casta'); Indian terms are **janjati** (forest jati) and **jati**.
- Colonial ethnographers drew a watertight caste-tribe boundary; post-colonial scholars show it was fluid and interactive.
- Mandelbaum: tribe = kinship-based, egalitarian; jati = hierarchy of unequal-ranked jatis. Wiser: village = heterogeneous organic solidarity.
- Tribe-caste continuum (Bailey-Bishipara, Sinha-Lodha, Majumdar): polar ideal types, most groups in between; Majumdar = tribe→caste as a form of Sanskritization (Garo Hills: Songsarek ↔ Dalus, with Rabha/Koch/Hajong in between).
- N. K. Bose — Hindu mode of tribal absorption (occupation monopoly, technology/lifestyle, Juangs, poverty of Brahmins/Risley, Kanjar-Maharana Pratap story); criticised for one-direction movement.
- Tribalization (reverse): C. W. Brown's Bhotias (Rajputs who ate beef for Tibetan trade).

- Tribe/caste identity = historical-political process, changes with context.

13.3 Scheduled Tribes, PVTGs and Geographical Spread

13.3.1 *From Tribe to Scheduled Tribe*

The journey is from a socio-cultural entity to a politico-administrative category. The term **tribe** originated with British rule (from 1885), which identified a feudal society as **caste** and a more backward one as **tribe**; later functionalism pictured the tribe as a close, bonded, homogeneous society tied to a territory — so the colonial idea of the tribe was **backward** and **separated**.

KEY CONCEPT

- Tribes were identified largely in terms of what they were not — not practising Vedic Hinduism, not Muslim, no stratification, no money economy. These were **negative traits** (negation/absence of a characteristic), not positive ones.
- The **Census of India** (started by the British) consolidated this identity:
- **1901** — tribes = those who follow **animism**.
- **1921** — the additional idea of **territory** (localised people with a specific identity).
- **1931** — the term '**primitive tribe**' was introduced.
- **Government of India Act 1935** — 'primitive tribe' was replaced by '**backward tribe**'.
- **1941** — tribes identified by **tribal origin** (subjective, giving the government flexibility to classify anyone as tribe or caste).

Post-independence scholars challenged this: the colonial ethnography had rendered a **fixed image** to an identity that was actually **fluid and contextual** (with instances of both tribalization and casteization).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Tribe** = a **cultural category** (culturally fluid, no single criterion separates it from caste).
- **Scheduled Tribe (ST)** = a **politico-administrative category** — objective (you are or you are not), with no cultural elements. It does **not capture the enormous socio-cultural complexity** of the various tribes.
- The categorisation of the population was done **to make special welfare provision available** to them.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- Two key articles: **Article 366** (defines Scheduled Tribes as those deemed to be so under Article 342) and **Article 342** (provides for the listing of Scheduled Tribes).
- The same groups listed under the Government of India Act 1935 were reclassified as **Scheduled Tribes in 1950**, with constitutional/legal provisions (reservations and other rights) attached.

13.3.2 Ghurye vs Elwin: Assimilation vs Isolation

COMPARISON

- **G. S. Ghurye — assimilation.** An Indologist (famous for the racial origin of caste), he held that tribes are '**backward Hindus**' — not different from caste — and the best way to manage them is to **assimilate** them into the mainstream Hindu value system, breaking down all barriers.
- **Verrier Elwin — isolation.** Based on his fieldwork, he held that whenever tribes come into contact with the mainstream they are **exploited** and their resources snatched — so they should be **protected and isolated**, like a **national reserve / wildlife sanctuary** (minimal contact with outsiders).
- Elwin was criticised as a '**colonial hangover**' (the US pattern of pushing indigenous people to reserves, making them tenants in their own land).
- The Indian government therefore chose a middle path: **Nehru's integration approach** (the **tribal panchsheel** framework) — integrate, neither isolate nor assimilate.

13.3.3 Identifying the Scheduled Tribe: Commissions and the Lokur Criteria

The initial criterion was borrowed from the Government of India Act 1935. Later, the **First Backward Classes Commission (Kaka Kalelkar)** made some suggestions (not accepted for classifying tribes), and in 1965 the **Lokur Committee** gave specific criteria.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- **Lokur Committee (1965)** — five criteria to identify tribes:
 1. **Primitive traits.**
 2. **Geographical isolation.**
 3. **Shyness of contact with the community at large.**
 4. **Distinct culture.**
 5. **Backwardness.**

CRITICAL POINT

- These criteria have **not been revised since 1965** and are now largely **obsolete**:
- **Primitive traits** — no objective definition of 'primitive'; many tribes have modernised and integrated with the mainstream.
- **Geographical isolation** — in a globalised world (trains, ships, tribal circuits, tourism in Andaman/Lakshadweep) no part of India is isolated any more.
- **Shyness of contact** — largely obsolete; ST students study and interact with everyone. The **Sentinelese** (who killed an American missionary trying to enter their island) are a rare exception.
- **Distinct culture** — the idea rested on a flawed assumption of a single Brahminical-Hindu 'national culture'; India is diverse from Kashmir to Kanyakumari, yet with common threads

that are increasing with globalisation, internet and media.

- **Backwardness** — again subjective (economic? educational?), with no clear criterion.
- The process of inclusion/exclusion is therefore **vague and based on flawed assumptions**.

13.3.4 Area Restriction and Its Removal (1976)

KEY CONCEPT

- Under the British-era criteria, tribes were assumed to be **localised groups**, so tribal status applied only within a **specific territory**: a person could be a Scheduled Tribe in one district but not in the neighbouring district.
- This **area restriction** discouraged mobility — a tribe moving to another state for work would lose the welfare benefits.
- The **Lokur Committee** argued the territorial restriction was a **barrier to spatial and social mobility** and **contrary to the goal of tribal integration**, and said it should be removed.
- **1976 — Removal of Area Restrictions Act**: restriction lifted, but now at the **state level** (a tribe is recognised in a particular state, not nationally) — e.g. the **Naga** are STs in Nagaland, not in UP; the **Banjara** are STs in several states but included in the SC list in Delhi (which has no ST list).

13.3.5 Anomalies in Scheduling and the Political Gimmick

CRITICAL POINT

- With no objective criteria for inclusion/exclusion, scheduling becomes a **political gimmick/tool** to mobilise people and gather votes — e.g. **Gurjars** and other communities demanding ST status.
- **Anomalies**: some communities that have improved and integrated do not want to give up their ST identity (ST is politico-administrative, not cultural); and casteist people wrongly treat STs as a lower caste, though ST communities lie **outside the caste system**.
- These anomalies need a commission to be corrected.

EXAMPLE

- Related reference (from **Christophe Jaffrelot**, the caste specialist, in Indian Express): why dominant castes like **Patidar, Patel and Maratha** now demand **OBC** status.
- The **Green Revolution** produced a rising middle caste whose dominance rested on **land and economic superiority** (agriculture). But agriculture has lost its remunerative value, and land is no longer a source of dominance — wealth now comes from **private jobs, IT and startups** (captured by educated Brahmins/Kshatriyas) and government jobs (where SCs benefit from reservation).
- Left only with **numerical preponderance**, these middle castes demand OBC status (and even sub-quotas within OBC) to regain status and compete for government jobs.

QUICK REVISION

- Tribe (cultural) → Scheduled Tribe (politico-administrative) via colonial census: 1901 animism, 1921 territory, 1931 'primitive', 1935 'backward', 1941 origin.
- Tribes identified by negative traits ('what they were not').
- Ghurye = assimilation (backward Hindus); Elwin = isolation (national-reserve model, 'colonial hangover'); Nehru = integration (tribal panchsheel).
- Articles 366 & 342; Kaka Kalelkar commission; Lokur Committee 1965 (five criteria).
- Area restriction removed 1976 → state-level recognition.
- Criteria obsolete; scheduling a political gimmick; anomalies persist.

13.3.6 PVTGs: Origin and Criteria**GOVERNMENT & POLICY**

- The **Dhebar Commission** created **PTG (Primitive Tribal Group)** as a separate category in **1973**, out of all the Scheduled Tribes.
- In **2006**, PTG was renamed **PVTG (Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Group)** — dropping the derogatory term 'primitive'.
- PVTGs are tribes that are **more marginalised and vulnerable even among the STs** — on the verge of extinction if not specially protected.

DATA & FACTS

- Currently **75 groups** are listed as PVTGs; the maximum (**13**) are in **Odisha**.
- They are found mainly in **seven states**: Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, Andhra Pradesh and Odisha.
- Total PVTG population ≈ **27.5 lakh**.
- Famous PVTGs: **Jarawas** and **Sentinelese** (Andaman), and the **Bonda** (Odisha).

KEY CONCEPT

- The **criteria** for a PVTG:
 1. **Forest-dependent livelihood** (living in the forest).
 2. **Pre-agricultural level of existence** — a way of life similar to the Stone Age (Paleolithic/Mesolithic), before the Neolithic agricultural stage.
 3. **Stagnant or declining population**.
 4. **Low literacy rate**.
 5. **Subsistence-based economy** — no concept of surplus (they produce only for consumption, unlike a modern surplus/profit economy).

EXAMPLE

- **Mankidia** — a community living in the **Simlipal Tiger Reserve** (Odisha) who used to kill monkeys for food; they were excluded/removed when the reserve was created.
- **Jarawas** — the **Andaman Trunk Road** passes through their habitation, and 'human safari' tourism treats them as a showpiece (people photograph them); police officers were once suspended for giving Jarawa girls biscuits to make them dance naked.
- **Bonda (Odisha)** — Bonda women wear only a two-inch cloth called **ringa** to cover the lower abdomen (with beads over the chest).
- The **folklore** (narrated by **N. K. Bose** and **Verrier Elwin**): when Sita was bathing in a lake in Odisha, Bonda women stole her saree; on discovering this she cursed them to remain naked; when they begged forgiveness she tore a piece of her saree and gave it to them — hence the divine instruction to wear the ringa. Two educated Bonda girls who rejected the custom were labelled witches and physically punished.
- This shows how stories are created to absorb communities into the Hindu fold — e.g. **Ganesha** (an elephant totem of a tribal community turned into a god) and **Kali** (a tribal goddess depicted as an incarnation of Durga).

13.3.7 Problems Faced by PVTGs**CRITICAL POINT**

- 1. **Loss of traditional livelihood and customary rights on resources** — industrial projects, conservation and tourism have removed them from forest land (the Mankidia from Simlipal; they are the '**refugees of development**'). Removed from the forest they lose their only skill (exploiting forest resources — fuel, food, timber, medicine) and face a deep trauma (like being shifted from a palatial village home to a 2BHK flat).
- 2. **Perceived primitivism/backwardness in discourse** — the term 'primitive tribal group' is still used in official communication (even in 2021), devaluing their culture and tradition.
- 3. **Irrational criteria of inclusion** — inclusion/exclusion is **ad hoc** with no logic (some Odisha STs satisfy all criteria but are not listed), so many communities miss special assistance.
- 4. **Treated as 'endangered'** — socio-economic vulnerability led them to be treated as on the verge of extinction, leading to **disastrous intervention**: disallowing PVTG members from availing **sterilisation schemes** (their reproductive rights are not recognised). This **sidesteps the real factors for mortality** (poor nutrition, ineffective vaccination, lack of healthcare). A recent Chhattisgarh High Court judgment and an MP case relaxed this, but they still need SDM permission for reproductive rights.
- 5. **Bonded labour** — when their land is alienated and they are forced out, they end up as manual/bonded labourers (e.g. **Sahariyas** of Rajasthan, **Juangs** of Odisha) through systems like the **Haliya** system of debt-bondage, where they cannot even pay the interest from their wages.
- 6. **Low literacy** — in single digits, due to poor education policy, infrastructure shortage and teacher absenteeism in PVTG areas.

- **7. Loss of land ownership** — e.g. 245 Baiga families removed for the **Achanakmar Tiger Reserve**.
- **8. Lack of baseline surveys** — an Anthropological Survey of India report notes there is no vital data (infant/maternal mortality, education, per-capita income) for most PVTGs, so no targets can be set for schemes — reflecting government ignorance.

13.3.8 Scheme and Recommendations (NAC 2013)

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- **Scheme for Development of PVTGs** — the state government plans the scheme (education, health, economic livelihood) with full flexibility and submits it to the Tribal Ministry; the **central government provides 100% funding**.
- Problem: different PVTGs have different problems, so a '**one size fits all**' approach cannot work — the scheme remains largely **top-down**.
- The **National Advisory Committee (NAC, 2013)** — headed by Sonia Gandhi — recommended:
 1. **Status of Scheduled Tribe to all PVTGs** (some PVTGs, e.g. the **Paudi Bhuinya**, are not even recognised as STs).
 2. A **rights-based approach** to empowerment — ensuring **habitat rights**, land rights, customary habitation, and educational/economic rights (restoring their habitation on forest land).
 3. A **single-window approach** — one portal for all benefits (education, health, infrastructure, economy), instead of multiple windows.
 4. **Regular census and baseline surveys** so schemes can be customised.

QUICK REVISION

- PTG (1973, Dhebar Commission) → PVTG (2006); 75 groups, max in Odisha (13); 7 states; ~27.5 lakh.
- PVTG criteria: forest-dependent livelihood; pre-agricultural (Stone Age) existence; stagnant/declining population; low literacy; subsistence economy (no surplus).
- Examples: Mankidia (Simlipal), Jarawa/Sentinelese (Andaman), Bonda (ringa + Sita folklore).
- Problems: loss of livelihood/rights ('refugees of development'); perceived primitivism; ad-hoc inclusion; reproductive-rights denial; bonded labour (Sahariya/Juang, Haliya); low literacy; land alienation (Baiga); no baseline surveys.
- Scheme for Development of PVTGs (state plans, 100% central funding); NAC 2013 (Sonia Gandhi) — ST status to all PVTGs, rights-based approach, single-window, regular census/baseline surveys.

13.3.9 Geographical Distribution of Tribes

DATA & FACTS

- **2011 Census:** tribal population $\approx$ **10.42 crore**, i.e. a little over **8.5–8.6%** of India's population.
- Per the draft **National Tribal Policy**, there are $\approx$ **698** Scheduled Tribes ($\approx$ **705** per the Census).
- **Odisha** has the largest number of distinct tribes — **68**.
- **Nine tribes** constitute about **60%** of the total tribal population: **Bhil, Gond, Santhal, Oraon, Mina, Munda, Khond, Ho and Naga**. Eight of these are in central India (Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Jharkhand, Andhra); only the **Naga** are from the North-East.
- Some tribes are found across five-six states; others are confined to a specific district of a single state.

KEY CONCEPT

- **L. P. Vidyarthi** (the famous Indian anthropologist) divided India into **five zones** on the basis of tribal distribution:
- 1. **Himalayan region** — (a) **North-east Himalayan** (the seven sisters + Sikkim: Assam, Meghalaya, Arunachal, Manipur, Tripura, etc.) with tribes like **Naga, Garo, Khasi, Lepcha**; (b) **Central Himalayan** (the Tarai/Uttarakhand) with the **Khasa** and **Bhotiya**; (c) **North Himalayan** (Jammu & Kashmir, Himachal) with the **Gaddi, Bakarwal, Gujjar**.
- 2. **Middle India** — Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Odisha, Jharkhand and Bihar, where most of the tribal population (over 5–5.5 crore) lives.
- 3. **Western India** — Rajasthan, Gujarat, Maharashtra, with tribes like **Bhil, Mina, Maldhari**.
- 4. **Southern India** — Karnataka, Andhra, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, with tribes like **Chenchu, Toda, Kurumba**.
- 5. **Island region** — Andaman & Nicobar and Lakshadweep: **Jarawa, Onge, Andamanese, Sentinelese** (Andaman) and the **Moplah**/Muslim tribes of Lakshadweep.

EXAMPLE

- **Khasa** (Central Himalayan) — a famous group practising **polyandry** (one woman, multiple husbands). They justify it by claiming descent from the **Pandavas** (who practised polyandry), but the real reason is the **scarcity of fertile land** in the hills: if three sons each marry separately and divide land, the holding shrinks each generation ($1/3$, then $1/9$...), so polyandry keeps the land undivided and viable. **Polyandry is an adaptation to ecology, not merely a cultural practice.**
- **Onge** (Andaman) — studied by **Radcliffe-Brown** (of structural-functionalism).
- **Muslim tribes** — Lakshadweep's tribes are mainly Muslim (Moplah); in J&K the **Bakarwal** and **Gujjar** are Muslim tribes. (The **Asifa** case victim belonged to the Bakarwal pastoral community.) Muslim STs get reservation — unlike the separate question of Muslim/Christian

SCs.

13.4 Tribes and the Colonial State

13.4.1 *Three Phases of Tribe–State Interaction*

KEY CONCEPT

- The interaction of tribes with the state can be seen in **three phases: pre-colonial, colonial, and post-colonial** (post-independence).
- **Pre-colonial period** — interaction was very limited: tribes were given complete freedom and left **ungoverned**; early feudal lords paid little attention, recruiting them only for the military when needed. No taxation or laws were imposed on them.
- Reason: tribal (forest) areas lay **between two kingdoms** and served as a **buffer zone** — the kingdoms got free protection (any army passing through the forest first faced the tribals) and safe passage, so they maintained harmonious relations and never taxed them.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Colonial period** — the idea of the state changed radically: the British **unified India** under a single administration, which was **antithetical to tribal society** (lineages, clans, descent groups, kinship-based politics controlled by relatives).
- It was a **despotic state** (the idea of **Karl Wittfogel**): a strong, centrally governed administrative machinery for **tax collection**, backed by a large military and police force.
- For the **first time**, tribals tasted the **imposition of direct rule**.

13.4.2 *The Colonial State: Three Aspects*

KEY CONCEPT

- British rule with respect to tribes can be summarised under **three aspects**:
- 1. **Classification**.
- 2. **Policy of segregation**.
- 3. **Subjugation** — which ultimately led to several **tribal revolts** (a cyclical relationship: these aspects triggered revolts, which led to more of the same).

Policy-making is always dictated by the perceived interests of those in power. As long as tribes occupied remote regions and did not interfere with the rulers' autonomy, they were **left alone**. But when those inhospitable regions were noticed as **reservoirs of valued goods** (forest, minerals, mines — the raw materials of British industry), the tribes began to be seen as **impediments to revenue generation**, and suppression, killing and genocide followed.

13.4.3 *Classification and the Criminal Tribes Act*

British administrators (governor-generals, commissioners) were highly educated (Oxford, Cambridge) and combined **subjugation** with **academic curiosity** — colonial ethnographers like

Herbert Risley and **J. H. Hutton** were themselves East India Company employees. This curiosity produced **classification** and several categories of tribe, most infamously the '**criminal tribes**' (now called **denotified tribes**).

EXAMPLE

Hutton entered the villages of the **Angami Naga** (infamous for **head-hunting** — cutting and keeping an enemy's head as a trophy) to suppress the practice; even as he attacked them he collected their trophies and documented them — suppression fused with academic study.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- **Criminal Tribes Act, 1871** — its background lies in the **gypsies of Europe** and the **Industrial Revolution**: with the rise of a settled (sedentary) lifestyle as the norm, nomads were treated with **suspicion** (part of **Victorian ethics** that travelled to India — though India never saw nomadism as a threat, e.g. Shankaracharya's travels).
- First came the **Habitual Offenders Act, 1869**, giving authorities enormous power to regulate 'habitual offenders' (arrest, house arrest, punishment, questioning).
- Combining this with the **caste system** and the idea of **race** (biological inheritance of traits — just as some 'races' were deemed feeble-minded, criminality was treated as an inherited trait), the Criminal Tribes Act **branded whole communities criminal by birth**.
- It **branded 150 communities criminal by birth**, made it compulsory for suspected tribes to be **registered**, put them under **strict surveillance**, curtailed their movements, and turned them into **scapegoats** — a novel idea: a person labelled criminal from the day of birth irrespective of any act.

KEY CONCEPT

Race is a 'folk taxonomy' — how a society categorises the outer world. In simple tribal society it is just '**us versus them**'; as society grows more complex, categories grow more complex (aided by evolutionism, which placed societies on a ladder of development — some even called '**homo monstrosus**', i.e. not fully human, monster-like). Racial classification was then arranged into a hierarchy and tasks allotted accordingly.

CRITICAL POINT

- Another reason for the Criminal Tribes Act was political: the **1857 First War of Independence** (which rural/tribal communities supported) and the **thagi (thuggee)** movement — convoys passing through forests were robbed and British personnel killed. Communities that opposed British rule were therefore **labelled criminal** — a tool to suppress revolt.
- Almost **all** the communities branded criminal lived **near the main settlements/centres of British rule** (implemented first in Bengal, then extended to the North-West like Punjab — where the revolts were).

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- **Post-independence:** on the recommendation of the **Iyengar Committee**, the Criminal Tribes Act was **repealed** by the **Criminal Tribes Laws Repeal Act, 1952**, replaced by the **Habitual Offenders Act, 1952** (blame shifted from the whole community to the individual, and only after repeat offences).
- The **Dhebar Committee** suggested dropping the derogatory 'ex-criminal tribe' label in favour of **denotified tribes** (Hindi: **vimukta jatis**).
- Yet the **stigma of criminality persists** — these communities are still treated as criminal by local police/administration and remain marginalised.

13.4.4 Policy of Segregation

KEY CONCEPT

- The **policy of segregation and separation** was followed in parts of India with **no trading/commercial interest** — mainly the **North-East and South India** — where the British did not want to spend energy or money.
- Although the British kept their hold on these far-off regions (appointing subordinate kings who treated them as paramount power), they did **not interfere** in tribal affairs.
- Example: the **Naga Hills** had little intrusion until opened up during **World War II** (when Japan entered **Imphal and Kohima**, the North-East people supported the British and opened their village pathways to the army).
- The British helped set up the **Naga Hill District Council** to deal with outsiders — later renamed the **Naga National Council** under the leadership of **Angami Zapu Phizo** — the seed of Nagaland's ethno-nationalism.
- This produced the **Inner Line Permit (ILP)** — a special permit (a 'visa') still required today to enter the North-East; **outsiders are not allowed to possess land/property** in the North-East (and in some other areas like East Godavari district).

COMPARISON

- Under this segregation, the British divided tribal areas into **Excluded Areas** and **Partially Excluded Areas** (Government of India Act 1935) — these later became the **Fifth Schedule** and **Sixth Schedule** areas.
- This is a clear colonial carry-over: just as the 1935 Act's list of tribes became the basis of the Scheduled Tribes list, the Excluded/Partially Excluded areas became the Fifth/Sixth Schedule areas.

CRITICAL POINT

- The segregation was largely **lip service** (especially in mainland India): land-transfer acts that should have protected tribal land failed because of three combined exploiters — the **simplicity of tribes**, the **entry of money-lenders**, and **corrupt officers** — which pushed

tribes into marginalisation and poverty.

- This is why tribal struggles are for **Jal, Jungle and Zameen** (water, forest and land) — the three things snatched away from them.

13.4.5 Subjugation and Tribal Revolts

KEY CONCEPT

- **Subjugation** = active use of force, leading to bloody wars and brutal suppression of anyone challenging the British Raj — through **Saam, Daam, Dand, Bhed** (all means) — intensified by the British prejudice that tribals were **animal-like creatures** (violence in remote tribal areas went unnoticed).
- Later, **Gandhi** mobilised people nationally, and the **Congress**, in a late session, passed a resolution that post-independence **tribal rights and culture would be preserved** and tribes given freedom to live as they liked.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Major factors that led to tribal unrest:**
- 1. **Infiltration of outsiders** (merchants, money-lenders, police).
- 2. **Imposition of external rules** — civil and criminal laws, and **monetization** of a non-monetized economy (money-lenders gave loans without security, then trapped the tribals into plantation labour to repay; taxes/lagaan were alien to tribal society).
- 3. **Disproportionate impoverishment and marginalization** — the colonial brunt was faced by all, but tribals faced the most severe attack (treated like animals); between **1891 and 1901** the tribal population **declined substantially**.

EXAMPLE

- **Santhal uprising (1855)** — against merchants, money-lenders and police imposing their rule; approximately **30,000 Santhals** were killed.
- **Mina uprising (Rajasthan)** under the leadership of **Govind Guru** — against the **begari/begar** system (bonded labour: a loan of Rs. 500 binding one to a lifetime of work).

13.4.6 Impact of Colonial Rule on Tribal Life

KEY CONCEPT

- 1. **Introduction of private property** — broke down the **communal mode of production** and communal ownership of resources (forest owned collectively, not by an individual/family), eroding the collective solidarity.
- 2. **Land alienation and 'tenantisation'** — tribes became **tenants in their own land**, leading to **peasantization** (hunter-gatherers forced into cultivation) and **depeasantization** (cultivators reduced to daily-wage/contract labour) — through large-scale **land transfer from adivasis to non-adivasis**.

- 3. **Commercialization of forest** — further marginalisation. Verrier Elwin's **Nature–Man–Spirit (NMS) complex**: for the tribe the forest is home and the dwelling of their god, and their economy, social life and culture are forest-centric — so removing them is **ethnocide** (killing the culture), not just economic loss.
- Example: **Niyamgiri** — the **Dongria Kondh** tribe opposed the allocation of the Niyamgiri forest to **Vedanta** (and won the case); they believe the trees are the home of their god **Niyam Raja** and cutting them would bring a divine curse.
- 4. **Monetization** — money replaced **barter** and introduced an **impersonal medium of exchange** (in barter, exchange is embedded in social obligation — you cannot exchange with anyone; in money exchange, identity does not matter). This meant the **general disappearance of non-market mechanisms of social control of resources and allocation of goods**.
- 5. **Entry of class** — monetization created poverty, confusion and **class differentiation** within tribes (some with more harmonious contact with the mainstream became elites).

13.4.7 *Soft Power and the Overall Impact*

KEY CONCEPT

- Alongside classification, segregation and subjugation, the colonial power also used **soft power**: it **funded and sent Christian missionaries** to the tribal areas — to 'civilise' criminal tribes and to spread Christianity (most successfully in the North-East and Eastern India) — while simultaneously using brutal violence.
- **Overall impact**: the transformation of **Adivasi dignity** and a **threat to tribal identity**. Tribes became '**the other**' — whose economic non-conformity came in the way of the exploitation of natural resources.

CRITICAL POINT

- This threat to tribal identity did **not end at independence** — poverty, marginalisation and impoverishment consolidated the ethnic identity and produced **two responses**:
- 1. **Ethno-nationalism** — tribal parties and movements asserting identity (e.g. **Jharkhand Mukti Morcha**).
- 2. **Naxalism (left-wing extremism)** — when the state/rulers themselves become exploiters, such ideologies find fertile ground. Today Naxalism is concentrated in the **tribal belts** — the '**red corridor**' of Odisha, Andhra and West Bengal.

QUICK REVISION

- Three phases: pre-colonial (buffer zones, no taxation, military recruitment) → colonial (unified despotic state, direct rule) → post-colonial.
- Three aspects of British rule: classification, segregation, subjugation → tribal revolts.
- Criminal Tribes Act 1871 (from Habitual Offenders Act 1869 + caste + race) — 150 communities branded criminal by birth; repealed 1952 (Iyengar Committee) → Habitual Offenders

Act 1952; renamed 'denotified tribes' (vimukta jatis) by Dhebar Committee; stigma persists.

- Segregation: NE/South India lip service; Excluded/Partially Excluded areas → 5th/6th Schedule; Inner Line Permit; Naga National Council (Zapu Phizo).
- Subjugation: Saam-Daam-Dand-Bhed; factors — outsiders, external rules/monetization, disproportionate impoverishment; Santhal uprising 1855 (~30,000 killed), Mina uprising (Govind Guru, begari).
- Impacts: private property → breakdown of communal mode; land alienation → peasantization/depeasantization; forest commercialization → ethnocide (Niyamgiri/Dongria Kondh); monetization → impersonal exchange; class penetration; Christian missionaries as soft power.
- Post-colonial: threat persists → ethno-nationalism (Jharkhand Mukti Morcha) or Naxalism (red corridor).

13.5 Post-Colonial Administration — Isolation, Assimilation and Integration

13.5.1 *The Post-Independence Dilemma*

KEY CONCEPT

- Post-independence, the Indian government faced a dilemma over how to manage the tribes. Two major approaches contended:
- 1. The **isolationist approach** — advocated by **Verrier Elwin**.
- 2. The **assimilationist approach** — advocated by **G. S. Ghurye (Govind Sadashiv Rao Ghurye)**.
- Both, in their own way, were really aiming at the same end — ultimately making the tribe part of Hindu society — but by different routes.

13.5.2 *Verrier Elwin and the Theory of Isolation*

Verrier Elwin was a missionary who came to India, worked in tribal areas, came in contact with Mahatma Gandhi, and assisted the freedom struggle; post-independence he was appointed **tribal advisor to Jawaharlal Nehru**. His core finding: whenever tribes come into contact with the outside world they are **exploited and left marginalised** — hence his theory of isolation.

KEY CONCEPT

- Elwin advocated establishing **national-park-like structures**, isolated from the outside world, where entry is not possible without permission.
- He wrote the book '**The Baiga**' (on the Baiga tribe), arguing the government should adopt this national-park approach.
- Reason: on contact with the mainstream, tribes are exploited by **money-lenders, zamindars and corrupt police** — so isolation lets them live happily.
- Within this 'national park': allow the **traditional tribal councils (panchayats)** and recognise the authority of the **village headman/chief**; any non-tribal settlement (hospital, school, bank) requires a **government license and the tribal head's permission**; and **no missionary of**

any religion should be allowed in, so tribal life is not broken up.

- In short: minimise the tribe's contact with outsiders.

13.5.3 Elwin's Four Classes of Tribes ('The Aboriginals')

In 'The Aboriginals' (1943), Elwin divided tribes into **four classes** on the basis of their cultural development / amount of cultural contact with outsiders.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Class 1** — the purest of pure tribal groups: completely isolated from the mainstream, about **2–3 million** persons, with their **religion alive**, **tribal organisation unimpaired** and a healthy organisation of tribal life.
- **Class 2** — tribes that have come into contact with the mainstream Hindu society but retain much of their tribal characteristics. Their life has become more **individualistic** and less honest and less simple (communal sharing/exchange is less prevalent).
- **Class 3** — the **largest section** (about **four-fifths** of the tribal population): **tribal in name but Hindu in practice**, absorbed into the **lower rung** of the Hindu hierarchy (informally treated as lower castes). Causes: British exploitation (uprooted, migrated to cities, unskilled manual labour, poverty, illiteracy, the vicious cycle of poverty and indebtedness) and conversion/absorption by **Christian and Hindu missionaries**.
- **Class 4** — those who have '**won the battle of culture**': the old **tribal aristocracy** — **Raj Gonds (Gond Rajas)**, **great Bhils**, **Naga chieftains**, **wealthy Santhals**, **highly intellectual Mundas** — economically well-off and properly recognised by the mainstream; they retain their old tribal names and tribal religion despite adopting the Hindu faith and modern lifestyle.

KEY CONCEPT

- Elwin's stated aim: **the whole 'aboriginal problem' is to enable tribesmen of the first and second classes to advance directly to the fourth class, without suffering the despair and degradation of the third.**
- Hence he advocates **isolation, especially during the transition period** — first make them economically powerful, and expose them to competition only when they are ready.
- This is really a gentler path to the same assimilation — but avoiding the painful third stage.

13.5.4 Ghurye and the Theory of Assimilation

G. S. Ghurye argued for assimilation in his book '**The Scheduled Tribes**'. He was backed by right-wing/Indological scholars, notably **A. V. Thakkar Bappa** (head of a Hindu mission — like the Christian missionaries — running schools such as Saraswati Shishu Mandir), who **criticised Elwin's isolation as a 'colonial hangover'** / anti-national (adopting the British policy of segregation).

KEY CONCEPT

- Like Elwin, Ghurye divides the tribes into **three sections**:

- **Section 1** — the **Raj Gonds** and similar tribes who have **successfully fought the battle of cultural contact** and are recognised as members of fairly high status (even proclaiming **Kshatriya** status) in Hindu society.
- **Section 2** — the **large mass of tribes** that has been **partially Hinduized** through closer contact with Hindus (plain peasants/villagers/rural society).
- **Section 3** — the **hill sections** that exhibit great resistance to the alien culture — completely isolated, treating Hindu culture as alien, shy of contact and maintaining distance.
- Most tribes are in this third category.

KEY CONCEPT

- Ghurye's conclusion: '**tribal people in India are backward Hindus, differing only in degree.**'
- Their **backwardness is due to imperfect/partial assimilation** into Hindu society — had they been fully Hinduized they would not be backward, marginalised or poor.
- Partial Hinduization creates a conflict: they are **bilingual** (dominant language outside, own language at home) — needing the mass language for survival while protecting identity through their own language.
- Therefore the remedy is **complete assimilation** — create paths so their assimilation becomes more organised and sorted.

13.5.5 Nehru's Policy of Integration

KEY CONCEPT

- The government chose **neither assimilation nor isolation**, but the **policy of integration** — the stand of **Jawaharlal Nehru** and his government.
- In fact, after fierce criticism, **Elwin himself changed his stance** and proposed the integration policy (though it is normally attributed to Nehru).
- Nehru's reasoning: we should **not isolate** them (treating tribes like **museum artifacts** — static specimens that anthropologists visit and write about), and we should **not assimilate** them (destroying their prestigious, virtuous culture).
- Nehru's famous line: '**We should not try to make them a second copy of ourselves**' — instead, provide the conditions for them to live their life to the fullest, retain their culture, and enjoy it, while giving them basic necessities (health, education, electricity) without hampering their culture, and **empower** them to become self-dependent.
- Criticism: this was **lip service** — in letter but not in spirit — because most colonial policies were carried forward as they were, and tribes continued to be exploited.

13.5.6 The Tribal Panchsheel (Five Principles)

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- Nehru's policy of integration is expressed in the **Tribal Panchsheel — five fundamental principles for tribal development**, aimed at protecting indigenous/tribal culture:
- 1. **People should develop along the line of their own genius** — not imposing anything on them; encouraging their own traditional art and architecture and providing a market for their products (e.g. if they are good at weaving, let them develop that).
- 2. **Tribal rights on lands and forests should be protected.**
- 3. **Train and build up a team of their own people** to do the work of administration and development — avoiding too many outsiders in their territory; the ultimate aim is an army of workers from among them (few outsiders want to serve in tribal areas, e.g. the film *Newton*).
- 4. **Do not over-administer those areas or overwhelm them with a multiplicity of schemes** — rather, work through their own social and cultural institutions (their traditional ways of managing resources and resolving disputes).
- 5. **Judge results not by the statistics of money spent, but by the quality of human character evolved** — measure impact, not expenditure.

CRITICAL POINT

The third principle was never realised because of **tribal/dalit elitism**: those who obtain reservation benefits often associate themselves with the higher group and refrain from working for the empowerment of their own community — the same problem that weakens reservation benefits for Dalits as a whole.

13.5.7 Schemes of Integration (TSP, Fifth/Sixth Schedule, PESA)

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- Under the policy of integration, the government designed several schemes/structures:
- **Tribal Sub-Plan (TSP)** — a directly asked exam question (2017–18, 10-mark). It was designed in the **Fifth Five-Year Plan** on the recommendation of the anthropologist **S. C. Dube** (with help from **L. P. Vidyarthi**).
- **Fifth Schedule areas** and **Sixth Schedule areas**.
- **PESA — Panchayats (Extension to Scheduled Areas) Act**, which falls under the Fifth Schedule areas.
- (These are covered in polity/Laxmikanth.)

QUICK REVISION

- Post-independence dilemma: isolation (Elwin) vs assimilation (Ghurye).
- Elwin: national-park model (The Baiga); no outside entry; tribal councils + headman authority; no missionaries. The *Aboriginals* (1943) — 4 classes (Class 1 purest; Class 2 contact but tribal; Class 3 tribal-by-name absorbed in lower rung, ~4/5; Class 4 aristocracy).

Aim: Class 1–2 → Class 4 directly, skipping Class 3.

- Ghurye (The Scheduled Tribes): 3 sections (Raj Gonds high-status; partially Hinduized mass; resistant hill sections). 'Tribes are backward Hindus'; backwardness = imperfect assimilation → complete assimilation.
- Nehru: integration — not museum, not second copy of ourselves; but lip service in practice.
- Tribal Panchsheel (5 principles): own genius; protect land/forest rights; build own personnel; don't over-administer (work through their institutions); judge by human character, not money spent.
- Schemes: Tribal Sub-Plan (5th FYP, S. C. Dube), Fifth/Sixth Schedule, PESA.

13.6 Ethnicity, Ethnic Groups and Ethno-Nationalism

13.6.1 *Nation, State and Ethnicity: The Basic Concepts*

The term **ethnicity** is derived from **ethnos**, meaning **nation**. Understanding ethnicity therefore begins with the difference between a nation and a state.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Nation** — a group of people with **shared culture and belief**, who use this shared culture for **political mobilisation** (i.e. there is political awareness/consciousness). Shared culture alone does not make a nation; the political identity/consciousness is essential.
- **State** — a **political/geopolitical entity** with a **territory** of its own.
- A **nation may or may not have a territory**; when a politically aware group with shared culture gets its own territory it becomes a **nation-state** (e.g. **Japan**).
- Examples of nations without states: the **Kurds** (fighting for a territory), and **Khalistan** (a nation with cultural belief and political consciousness used to mobilise, demanding a state).
- A state can be multicultural, pluralistic or monocultural; when the majority of a state's people share one culture it becomes a nation-state.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ethnicity** (definition by **Thomas Hylland Eriksen**): the **relationship between groups of people whose members consider themselves distinct, and who are often related or ranked hierarchically within a society**.
- Two essential elements: (1) an **awareness of distinctiveness**, and (2) the groups are **ranked hierarchically** (this ranking is what drives ethnic interaction, as groups try to protect or improve their rank).

13.6.2 Defining Ethnicity and the Ethnic Group

KEY CONCEPT

- **Collective identity** is based on some common characteristics — which can be **objective** (region, language, religion, caste — clear, discrete categories based on shared experience/history) or **subjective** (by self-ascription — a sense of belonging even without actually belonging).
- **Ethnic group** = a **historical entity** whose members, in large part, **consider themselves alike** by virtue of certain **stable features** (language, race, culture, territory, etc.).
- An **ethnic group can never exist in isolation** — ethnic identity surfaces only when there is **contact** with another group and a **ranking/deprivation** against that group.
- Example: Tamil speakers live happily until the state tries to impose Hindi as a national language — the ranking/threat makes their linguistic ethnic identity surface with solidarity.

EXAMPLE

- **Subjective/self-ascribed identity** — **Jharkhand Mukti Morcha**: it aimed to liberate Jharkhand from Bihar, arguing tribal rights were not recognised; but not only tribals supported it — several caste groups supported it for their **vested interest** (in a new state they would become more powerful). This is called '**pseudo-tribalism**' or '**tribalism without tribes**' — a **contextual/situational identity** assumed, not objective.
- Likewise, leaders of **Dalit assertion** and **feminist** movements are often not themselves from the marginalised group (e.g. **Gandhi** fighting untouchability though not a Dalit) — they **self-ascribe** to the movement's identity.
- A **situational** example: abroad, a Bihari and a person from Madhya Pradesh may bond over a shared language even though their identities differ at home.

KEY CONCEPT

- According to **Eriksen**: ethnic groups can never exist in isolation; very often there is a **hierarchy within society**, with some groups enjoying **more status and greater material rewards** than others.
- For ethnic groups to develop there **must be some contact between groups** that entertains the idea of each other as being culturally distinct.
- When contact is **not beneficial** (deprivation, exploitation), it produces ethnic identity; when this identity is used for **political mobilisation**, it becomes **ethno-nationalism** (a sense of national identity). The politically aware group may then take democratic routes (protest, discussion) or turn to violence (civil war, secessionist movements, Naxalism).

13.6.3 Criteria of an Ethnic Group (M. E. Brown and Weber)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Michael E. Brown** gave **six criteria** for a group to be an ethnic group:
 1. **Name** — a group must have a name to identify it.
 2. **Common ancestry** — real, assumed or putative (e.g. the **Yadavs** believe they descend from Krishna / 'Yaduvanshi'); the belief itself creates solidarity.
 3. **Shared belief system** — at least on contextual issues (e.g. in the **farmers' protest**, people from very different backgrounds — Bollywood/Punjabi stars, capitalists, money-lenders, intermediaries, genuine farmers — share a belief in that context despite their other conflicts).
 4. **Some degree of shared culture** — shared belief without shared culture is not enough (I may believe Blacks in the US are wrongly exploited and sympathise, but I will never be part of that ethnic group because I do not share the culture and would not be accepted as a member).
 5. **Sense of attachment to a particular territory** — common but not fully accepted, because some ethnic groups have no territorial attachment (e.g. **Dalit emancipation**).
 6. **Self-awareness** — most members must believe they constitute an ethnic group (awareness 'in mind, heart and soul' that I am a member of this group in a particular role).

KEY CONCEPT

Max Weber's similar criteria for an ethnic group: (1) **shared ancestry** (real or assumed), and (2) **shared experience** — a shared history (language, historical past, colonisation, deprivation, shared territory). This common belief creates strong bonds between members.

13.6.4 Types of Ethnicity (Eriksen)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Eriksen's classification** of types of ethnic interaction (US-based but valid for India):
 1. **Modern migrants** — recent immigrants and their descendants (e.g. in the US); they suffer racism, are aware of being weaker than the dominant white/Caucasoid group, but are **unlikely to demand their own state** (little political mobilisation).
 2. **Indigenous population** — original inhabitants living there before colonisation; **politically powerless** (relative isolation, lack of education/financial empowerment, under-represented in national government), and **partly integrated into the dominant society at the lower hierarchy** (like Elwin's 'Class 3'). E.g. the weaker tribes — **Maldhari** (Gujarat), **Bonda**, **Toda**, the **PVTGs** — exploited but too few/powerless to resist or demand a state.
 3. **Proto-nations / ethno-nationalists** — ethnic groups **actively seeking an independent state** — e.g. the **Nagas** (Naga National Council / NSCN), **Meiteis** (before merger), several North-East secessionist groups (supported by China/Myanmar), the **Kurds**, **Tamils in Sri Lanka** (LTTE), and the **Balochis**.
 4. **Post-slavery minorities** — descendants of slaves (e.g. **Blacks/Afro-Americans** in the US, the **Siddhi** community in Gujarat, people of African origin in Malaysia); now citizens but still

suffering racism/degradation → **identity politics**.

13.6.5 Multiculturalism vs Pluralism

COMPARISON

- **Multiculturalism** — many cultures living in the same society, held together by **tolerance** (stereotypes persist and prevent interaction; there is merely law and order).
- **Pluralism** — different cultural groups living together with **constructive dialogue**: they sit together, discuss each religion's problems, modify and appreciate each other's traditions.
- The aim is **pluralism** (the utopian end); in reality India is **multicultural** — tolerance rather than constructive dialogue.
- Example: in a pluralist society, Hindus and Muslims would sit and discuss their religions; in a multicultural society there is only tolerance backed by law and order.

13.6.6 Hot and Cold Ethnicity (Fenton)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Steve Fenton** described two types of ethnicity based on **degree of intensity**:
- **Hot ethnicity** — appeals to **blood and passion**, with **strong group loyalty**; mobilised in support of nationalist movements or where there is intense inter-group conflict (e.g. communal riots — people take up swords, petrol bombs).
- **Cold ethnicity** — much **less impassioned**, involving **calculation and instrumentality** (utilitarian): the appeal is less emotional and hopes to derive **benefits** from the group. Examples: election-time caste mobilisation (building a statue/temple for a caste's saint, declaring a festival), and companies using emotional ethnic appeals to sell products (Amazon's Rakhi ad, MakeMyTrip's Diwali ad).
- In cold ethnicity one supports a group **in hope of deriving benefits** (OBC/SBC promises in manifestos), not out of blood-and-passion loyalty.

KEY CONCEPT

Fenton's key point: ethnicity is never the only identity people have — no one is full-time ethnic (at least not in the same way in all settings). A person has **multiple ethnic identities** (Hindu, Bihari, Rajput) that surface in **different circumstances** — which identity is expressed depends on context.

13.6.7 Approaches to Ethnicity: Primordial, Instrumentalist, Materialist

KEY CONCEPT

- **Primordial approach** (oldest, dominant before the 1970s; **Clifford Geertz**): ethnic identity is **innate, fixed and permanent** — each individual is **born into** an ethnic group (a culturally defined unit), and ethnicity serves a **fundamental human need for belonging and meaning**.

One is aware of one's cultural distinctiveness from birth.

- It invokes '**ancient hatred**': fundamental cultural differences and divergent values between ethnic groups inevitably result in a **clash of cultures**, caused by **past animosity**.
- **Flaw**: it cannot explain violence where there was no past animosity — e.g. the **sons-of-the-soil movement** in Maharashtra (initially Marathis vs 'Madrasis'/South Indians, later against **Biharis** — with whom there was no historical conflict).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Instrumentalist approach** (Fredrik Barth — 'ethnic boundaries'): ethnic identity is **instrumental/utilitarian** — it expresses only when there is some utility.
- **Ethnic boundaries are social rather than territorial**: individuals **selectively emphasise** those forms of cultural difference that are important to them, and the cultural features drawn upon are **not fixed but situationally defined**.
- Which identity surfaces depends on context: in a Hindu–Muslim conflict the **Hindu** identity comes up (forgetting caste); in an intercaste conflict the **Rajput/Yadav** identity comes up; when a Bihari goes to Maharashtra, the **Bihari** identity unites all Bihari Hindus against Marathis.
- This is an **oscillating equilibrium** — a person is a member of multiple ethnic groups and expresses different identities in different situations. **Ethnic identities are the product of ascription and self-ascription**.

KEY CONCEPT

Materialist (Marxist) approach: ethnicity emerges from **class relations**. Either (1) ethnic violence is due to **economic inequality** between groups (the deprived group revolts against the oppressor), or (2) ethnicity is a **tool used by the bourgeoisie/capitalists to divide the proletariat** into ethnic groups so they never unite and never make a revolution.

13.6.8 Ethnic Conflict and Collective Violence

KEY CONCEPT

- **Conflict ≠ violence**. Conflict can be expressed democratically through the avenues provided by democracy (discussion, dissent). Violence erupts when conflict is **suppressed by force** by an authoritarian/coercive state.
- In an **ethnically plural society with freedom of expression**, some conflict on identity basis is **typically to be expected** (it is part of democracy — active discussion). Issues discussed: which language should be used for education/employment; whether some groups should get rights; whether religious dress is allowed; affirmative action/reservation.
- In an **authoritarian society** that keeps ethnic discontent under the surface, there is **sudden eruption of violence** (e.g. **Shaheen Bagh** — violence erupted when right-wing groups entered and demanded clearance).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Collective violence** (not individual) can take several forms:
 1. **Riots** — between two ethnic groups on an **almost equal pedestal** (neither weak enough to be massacred), with state neutrality in doubt.
 2. **Pogrom / genocide** — a **state-approved attack on helpless minorities** (e.g. the **Jews/Holocaust**, the **1984 anti-Sikh riots**).
 3. **Civil war** — the **state itself becomes a combatant** (e.g. **Kurds vs Turkey**, **Tamils/LTTE vs the Sri Lankan state**, **Naga secessionism**).
 4. **Lynching** — many kill one/few (mob justice; e.g. **Nido Tania**, an Arunachal Pradesh boy beaten to death by shopkeepers in Lajpat Nagar, 2015).
 5. **Terrorism** — a few kill many (e.g. 'mujahideen' who know they will not return but kill many).

13.6.9 Causes of Ethno-Nationalism among Tribes**KEY CONCEPT**

- The reasons for the **rise of ethno-nationalism among tribes** (a directly asked exam question):
 1. **We-feeling and ethnocentrism** — ethnic identity produces an 'in-group' feeling, leading to **ethnocentrism** and a **demand for more power**, mainly due to a **feeling of marginalisation** (they demand autonomy, forest rights, control over industry).
 2. **Historic factors** — division of society on the basis of race, religion, language, region; **past animosity** (e.g. the **Bru/Reang** and **Meitei** cases, and the recent **Assam–Mizoram** border clash).
 3. **Political factors** — lack of representation, no reservation/government jobs, feeling powerless; and **exclusionary nationalist ideologies** (e.g. the **Bodos** in Assam over citizenship; the **Darjeeling/Gorkhaland** agitation after Bengali was imposed as official language over Nepali speakers; also **Kodoland** and **Nagalim**).
 4. **Economic reasons** — feeling of deficit/deprivation/backwardness, developmental deficit, resources snatched away and livelihood lost: **Jharkhand** (tribal resources feeding Bihar → Jharkhand Mukti Morcha), **Telangana** (Andhra spending concentrated in Rayalaseema).
 5. **Cultural factors** — threat to identity and autonomy, plus **stereotypes/discrimination** and **language-related conflicts**.

QUICK REVISION

- Ethnicity (from 'ethnos' = nation) = relationship between groups that consider themselves distinct and are ranked hierarchically (Eriksen).
- Ethnic identity surfaces only with contact + ranking/deprivation (not in isolation); objective vs subjective (self-ascribed) identity — Jharkhand Mukti Morcha = 'pseudo-tribalism'.
- Ethnic group criteria (M. E. Brown): name, common ancestry, shared belief, shared culture, territorial attachment, self-awareness; Weber: shared ancestry + shared experience.

- Types (Eriksen): modern migrants, indigenous population, proto-nations/ethno-nationalists (Nagas, Kurds, LTTE, Balochis), post-slavery minorities (Blacks, Siddhi).
- Multiculturalism (tolerance) vs pluralism (constructive dialogue); India aims for pluralism, is multicultural.
- Hot vs cold ethnicity (Fenton); 'no one is full-time ethnic' — multiple identities surface by context.
- Approaches: primordial (Geertz — innate/fixed, 'ancient hatred'), instrumentalist (Barth — ethnic boundaries, situational), materialist (Marx — class/divide-and-rule).
- Collective violence: riots, pogrom/genocide, civil war, lynching, terrorism.
- Causes of tribal ethno-nationalism: we-feeling/ethnocentrism; historic factors; political (representation, exclusionary ideology); economic (Jharkhand, Telangana); cultural (identity threat, language).

Modernization of Indian Tradition (Yogendra Singh)

14.1 Defining Modernization: Multiple Perspectives

KEY CONCEPT

- There is **no single definition of modernization** — it depends on which scholar's perspective is taken:
- **Max Weber** — modernization = **rationalization**: more goal-oriented rational social action and bureaucratization; traditional social action (emotion, love) ends, leaving a 'robot' with no emotions.
- **Karl Marx** — modernization = a **classless, moneyless society** (the modern society).
- **Rostow** — modernization = the journey from the **pre-take-off/traditional stage** to the **stage of mass consumption**.
- **Talcott Parsons** — modernization = **structural differentiation** (specialisation; in Durkheim's terms, division of labour leading to both specialisation and alienation — both are products of modernization).
- **Yogendra Singh** — the simple idea: modernization is a **process of transition from a traditional agrarian society to a modern industrial society** (like a child transforming into an adult).

KEY CONCEPT

Modernization is **not a static state** — it is a **continuous, dynamic process** (not solid/liquid/gas/plasma, but a solid→liquid or liquid→gas transition). Yogendra Singh, a follower of **Talcott Parsons**, frames it in terms of a **moving equilibrium**.

The classical scholars (Comte, Durkheim, Weber, Marx) reacted to the Industrial and French Revolutions by reflecting on the modernization of **Europe**. Gradually, after the Cold War, modernization theory shifted to the **non-West** (the Marshall Plan, NATO, the World Bank, soft loans, aid) — and this includes the modernization of **India**, which is Yogendra Singh's concern.

14.2 The Four Dimensions of Modernization

KEY CONCEPT

Yogendra Singh lists **four dimensions of modernization**: (1) **psychological**, (2) **political**, (3) **economic**, and (4) **social and cultural**.

- **Psychological** — individuals become more **ambitious** (aspiring to role models beyond caste/religion — engineers, IAS officers, presidents — irrespective of colour, gender or language) and more **innovative** (Amazon, Swiggy, Uber). Globalization gave huge exposure and connected everyone across borders, making such ambitions possible.
- **Political** — the **Westminster model** (parliament), **democracy**, **bureaucracy**, **secularism** (on which **Ashis Nandy** has also spoken critically), and **meritocracy** (rational-legal bureaucracy: recruitment on merit, written codes/rules). These are **not indigenous to India** — they are European in origin; even academic discourse is hegemonised by European culture ('politics of knowledge').
- **Economic** — the **free market economy** (laissez-faire: the state should not regulate enterprises but give them space to innovate), measured by the (now discontinued) World Bank **Ease of Doing Business** index; and **modern education** based on scientific temperament, rationality and logic (physics, chemistry, sociology — not Vedic/Sanskrit literature), largely in English medium, in a modern university system (credit system, exam-based merit, competitive exams, limited seats).
- **Social and cultural** — especially the family: transition from the **traditional extended joint family** to its **nuclearization**.

KEY CONCEPT

Education then vs now: earlier, education was the **exclusive monopoly of upper-caste Hindu men** (only the dvija could read the Vedas; the 'ekaj'/non-dvija — who are the majority, with Shudras + SC/ST constituting over 55% of the population — could not) — what **Frank Parkin** calls **exclusionary social closure**. Today education is based on a **universalist standard**: the Right to Education sponsors it for everyone, with 25% reservation for weaker sections.

14.3 The Central Question: Tradition vs Modernity

KEY CONCEPT

- Yogendra Singh's central question: **Has modernization radically altered the traditional social structure of Indian society?**
- The general belief is that **modernity and tradition are binary opposites that cannot coexist**. But Yogendra Singh argues that **the modernization process in India carried the baggage of tradition along with it — tradition and modernity mutually coexist** in the Indian social structure.

EXAMPLE

- Caste did not disappear with democracy; it took a modern avatar — the **caste association** (e.g. all-India Thakur associations, Pandit associations, temple trusts, pressure groups and political parties built around caste, tribal and religious identities). Local identities became **national-level associations** through modernization.
- This is **dynamic equilibrium** — change at one level, but the status quo maintained at another: 'change is there, but everything is still the same'.

14.4 Political Modernization: Modern Vessel, Traditional Liquid**KEY CONCEPT**

- Political modernization stands for **universal adult franchise, democracy and political parties**. But in reality:
- Representatives are **largely upper caste** — you hardly find low-caste people in dominant positions in national political parties.
- The bureaucracy is still upper-caste dominated — **Kancha Ilaiah** calls it the '**Indian Brahmanical service**'; even **Rajya Sabha** nominations are roughly **70% upper caste**.
- Though anyone can contest, a low-caste candidate **cannot win** without the muscle power and money power that upper castes hold.
- **Dynasty politics** persists alongside meritocracy: a leader's son contests in the name of his father's legacy — democracy is a **modern vessel carrying a traditional liquid**.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Elite circulation**: before independence, political elites were upper-caste, English-speaking, Western-educated. Post-independence (especially after the **Mandal Commission, 1979**, with coalition politics and the OBC mobilisation), **regional elites** — less English-educated, holding regional languages — arrived. Yet the elite structure remains dominated by the **traditional elites**: it looks heterogeneous but is ultimately homogeneous.
- In Yogendra Singh's words: **one could see modernist ideas in the practice of ideals like democracy and secularism, but also the consolidation of primordial/traditional identities through caste associations, tribal groups and regional politics**.
- Example: a regional identity (Punjabi, Bihari, etc.) is now articulated through **modern instruments** — social movements, political parties, pressure groups — demanding special concessions (as the **BIMARU states** did on feeling relative deprivation). The traditional identity does not die; it is expressed through modern means.

14.5 Cultural Modernization: Purity–Pollution and Communication

KEY CONCEPT

- The Hindu social structure based on caste upholds the notion of **purity and pollution** — regulating inter-dining, inter-marriage, conversation and even passing through the residence of the lower castes.
- The British introduced the **printing press, telegraph, postal service and railways**, which **enhanced communication** and **challenged the foundation of caste hierarchy** — in the same train coach or aeroplane, upper and lower castes sit together, unconsciously crossing traditional boundaries.

KEY CONCEPT

- But the **same communication technologies** also aid **caste associations**: easier travel makes it simple to participate in social movements and consolidate traditional identities (people converge from all over India overnight — e.g. around movements like the Bhim Army).
- Casteism persists even in urban centres — look at the **matrimonial columns** of newspapers, where caste is advertised daily.
- So modernization has made it easier to **both** break and **rebuild** caste ties — a moving equilibrium.

14.6 Economic Modernization: The Non-Homogeneous Working Class

KEY CONCEPT

- At the surface, the economy has modernised: the **jajmani system** (exchange of *services* based on caste — not barter, which is exchange of goods) is gone, replaced by a **free-market** relationship of **consumer and supplier** rather than patron and client.
- Economic modernization brought **urbanization**, migration (rural→urban) and an **industrial working class**.
- But this working class is **not homogeneous**:
- There is **FICCI**, but also **DICCI** (Dalit Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry) and **WICCI** (Women's Indian Chamber of Commerce and Industry) — modern institutions/pressure groups working to secure the interests of **sections** within the working class, not everyone.
- The **informal sector** largely runs on **kinship, familial and caste ties**.
- Modernization would imply the **waning of traditional identities**, but they persist and even organise representation for these sections.

14.7 Social Structure, Cultural Structure and the Sources of Change

Yogendra Singh organises his analysis through a **diagram/table** (to be reproduced exactly if the question is asked): he divides **social structure** into **macro** and **micro**, and **cultural structure** into **little tradition** and **great tradition**, with **two sources of change** — **heterogenetic** (from

outside) and orthogenetic (from within).

COMPARISON

- **Social structure:** **macro** (political, economic, social, cultural modernization — surface/structural change) and **micro** (role institutionalization, elite circulation, dynasty politics/succession of kings', compulsive migration, population shift — the level where continuity persists).
- **Cultural structure:** **little tradition** (affected by **Islamization**) and **great tradition** (receiving the **secondary Islamic impact**).
- **Sources of change:** **heterogenetic** = from outside (primary westernization, Islamization, free market, democracy, the *idea* of a political party); **orthogenetic** = from within (Sanskritization/traditionalization, migration rural→urban, elite circulation, the formation of Akali Dal/Samajwadi Party/Bahujan Samaj Party, DICCI/WICCI, Buddhism and Jainism as reforms *within* India, Panchayati Raj Institutions).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Role institutionalization** — fitting into new roles (e.g. the **working woman** is a new role; the traditional role of women was household care-taking). To what extent women are seen in the public sphere indicates modernization — as **Ambedkar and Nehru** said, the development of a nation is measured by how many women work and in what condition. If women's participation remains low in politics, education and economy, India cannot be said to be modernising.
- **Cultural resistance at the great-tradition level** — the elite Hindus (the 'manufacturers' of the Vedic/Sanskrit texts) resisted low castes leaving Hinduism (for Buddhism, Jainism or Islam) or becoming upper caste.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Islamization** (heterogenetic — a controversial claim that Muslims came from outside, which Yogendra Singh firmly holds): little traditions were affected (e.g. **Sufism** is a product of the dialectic between Hinduism and Islam — 'Ram Rahim', Sufi culture/music, Indo-Islamic architecture — all influences of Islam on Indian traditions); the great tradition received the **secondary Islamic impact**.
- **Buddhism** challenged the great tradition (questioning Brahmin authority and caste) and gave rise to its own **little tradition**: **Pali** became a common language (while Sanskrit was the elite language), developing out of the Kshatriya fold.

14.8 Conclusion: Macro Change, Micro Continuity

KEY CONCEPT

- **Conclusion:** according to Yogendra Singh, modernization brings changes in the **macro social structure**, but the **micro social structure is still intact**.
- Example: the family has gone from **joint to nuclear** (macro change), but it still has a **male head of household** (micro continuity) — despite government schemes that run on women-headed households.
- Example: **women's reservation in panchayats** exists to ensure women's representation, but the '**sarpanch-pati**' — the husband actually running the panchayat while the woman is pushed back to domestic duties — shows the same traditional idea continuing.
- We have **modernity in structural form but not in institutionalised role form at the micro level**.
- Yogendra Singh is **not criticising** this process — he is **studying** it.

QUICK REVISION

- Modernization = transition from agrarian to industrial society; a continuous dynamic process (moving equilibrium), not a static state.
- Multiple definitions: Weber (rationalization), Marx (classless), Rostow (mass consumption), Parsons (structural differentiation), Yogendra Singh (agrarian→industrial).
- Four dimensions: psychological (ambition/innovation), political (Westminster/democracy/bureaucracy/secularism/meritocracy), economic (free market, modern education), social-cultural (nuclearization).
- Central argument: modernity and tradition are NOT binary opposites — modernization carried the 'baggage of tradition'; both coexist.
- Political: democracy + dynasty; upper-caste dominance (Kancha Ilaiah's 'Indian Brahmanical service'); regional elites but traditional elite dominance.
- Cultural: purity-pollution challenged by print/telegraph/post/railways, but the same communication strengthens caste associations; matrimonial-ads casteism.
- Economic: jajmani → free market; non-homogeneous working class (FICCI/DICCI/WICCI); informal sector on kinship/caste ties.
- Framework: social structure (macro/micro) + cultural structure (little/great tradition) + heterogenetic/orthogenetic change.
- Conclusion: macro change, micro continuity (nuclear family with male head; sarpanch-pati).

Social Reform in Indian Society

15.1 Objectives and Social Composition of the Reformers

Most social reforms in India are traced to **1830 onwards**, and what was reformed largely concerned **caste practices, the status of women, and untouchability**. (Note: UPSC has not asked questions from 'protest and movement during the colonial period' — Section A — but has asked from 'social movements' in Section C, which is treated there.)

KEY CONCEPT

- The **three broad objectives of social reform**, common across all reformers:
 1. **Emancipation of women.**
 2. **Abolition of untouchability.**
 3. **Reform of the caste structure.**
- Whether it is the Ramakrishna Mission, Swami Vivekananda, Periyar, Jyotiba Phule, Savitribai Phule, Mahatma Gandhi, Ambedkar or Raja Ram Mohan Roy — all largely addressed these three issues.

KEY CONCEPT

- The **social composition** of the initial reformers had a clear pattern (roughly 95%): they were **Western-educated, Hindu, upper-caste, middle-class men**.
- In short: Western educated + Hindu + upper caste + middle class + men.
- They shared the three objectives, and were also united by Western education, upper-caste background, and male gender.

15.2 Religious Reform as Social Reform

KEY CONCEPT

- **Religious reform implies social reform** because **religion is a way of life** — it determines every aspect of social life.
- In Hinduism, **caste** defines occupation, marriage, status, loyalty and obligations, whom one can eat with, and even dress and appearance — i.e. caste defines **life chances**.
- Since **caste is the product of religion**, reforming religion would reform the whole social structure. Hence the early reformers spoke of **religious reform**, which effectively meant

social reform.

15.3 Emancipation of Women: The Status Before Reform

KEY CONCEPT

- The status of women was **inferior to men**, and this inferiority had **religious sanction** (justified in the name of the Vedas, the Quran, etc.). The key facts to note:
- **Hindu women could marry only once**, while **Hindu men could marry multiple times** and keep more than one wife — polygamy was practised among Hindu men, not only Muslims.
- **Prohibition on widow remarriage** applied to women but not to men.
- **Muslim women had to observe purdah** (not Muslim men).
- **Sati** — self-immolation on the husband's death (the widow was expected to jump into the fire).
- **No right to property** for women.
- **No right to divorce/terminate an undesirable marriage** (for both Hindu and Muslim women).
- **Social and economic dependence on men** — women could not go out to work, and their personality was reduced to obeying the husband, cooking, cleaning and caring for the elderly. In the language of **Ann Oakley**, she was **alienated from her creative self**.
- **Child marriage** — around age 8–10, largely among upper-caste women (because upper castes were most concerned about purity).

EXAMPLE

Upper-class vs peasant women: the **peasant (largely Shudra) woman** was a **working woman** — she could go out, earn, and had more **agency/mobility** than the upper-caste woman, who was wholly dependent on men. So peasant women had greater agency than upper-caste women.

15.4 Women's Reform and Its Constitutional Culmination

KEY CONCEPT

- Social reform attacked these orthodox customs, beginning with the **Brahmo Samaj**. **Primary westernization** infused modern practices of equality and humanitarianism across the masses.
- Key initiators: **William Bentinck** (abolition of sati) and **Raja Ram Mohan Roy** (abolition of sati and child marriage, and support for widow remarriage).
- Gradually the national movement saw large participation of women, culminating in the **All India Women's Conference (1927)**, founded by **Margaret Cousins** — the first all-India body of its kind (like the Indian National Congress, 1885, at the political level). Its objective was to **promote education and literacy among women at mass level**.
- Today the body has **adapted to new problems** — human trafficking, rape, domestic violence,

health and fertility issues — functioning as an NGO.

- Other milestones: **Sarojini Naidu** became the first woman president of the Indian National Congress.

GOVERNMENT & POLICY

- Reform ideals ultimately culminated in the **Constitution**: if religion first justified women's inferior status, the Constitution restored their power. Key provisions:
- **Articles 14 & 15** — equal status for women at par with men (gender equality).
- **Directive Principles of State Policy** — e.g. equal pay for equal work.
- **Hindu Succession Act, 1956** — women became **co-heirs** to property.
- **Hindu Marriage Act, 1955** — empowered women to dissolve the marriage/seek divorce on certain grounds, and made **monogamy compulsory** for Hindus.
- Yet some practices, like **dowry**, still continue.

15.5 The Sociological Reading: Private to Public Patriarchy

KEY CONCEPT

- Using **Sylvia Walby's** framework: the pre-reform status of women was **private patriarchy**; today, although women are legally empowered, patriarchy persists as **public patriarchy**.
- **Macro-structures have changed, but the micro reality is almost the same**: legally, norms of mobility and individualism were introduced, but socially, patriarchal norms and customs still prevail over legal rules.
- In other words, **universalism was constitutionally imposed from the top, but particularism still prevails at the bottom**.

EXAMPLE

- Example: the **Hindu Succession Act** made women co-heirs, but women in the majority of cases still do not have **land ownership** in agriculture. About **80% of agricultural labourers are women**, yet hardly **3–4% of them own land**.
- Without land ownership one is a **peasant**, not a **farmer** (a farmer owns land); only farmers can avail government schemes and services (better irrigation, soil health card, fertilisers), so landless women are further deprived of opportunities.

15.6 Abolition of Untouchability: The Status Before Reform

KEY CONCEPT

- Caste defines **life chances** (occupation, marriage, status, loyalty, food choices). Those **without caste** within Hinduism — the **avarna** (as against the **savarna** or 'caste Hindus'; the avarna

are the 'pancham'/fifth, the 'broken men', i.e. Dalits) — have their life chances most heavily regulated and are the most vulnerable.

- The problems faced by the untouchables before reform:
- In **South India**, an untouchable walking the same street had to **announce his presence** so that even his **shadow** did not fall on a Brahmin (purity–pollution was practised more stringently in the South than the North).
- In **Punjab**, the untouchable had to **shout aloud** to announce his arrival so everyone could hide — his mere presence was believed to pollute the environment.
- A separate **well** was reserved for untouchables; where no separate tank existed, they drank dirty water from ponds/irrigation canals.
- They were **prohibited from entering temples**, so they **manufactured their own gods** (whom Brahmins did not respect).
- Their children could **not study in the same school** as upper-caste children — separate schools were opened.
- They could **not join the police or army** or government services, and were **restricted to menial occupations** (scavenging, tanning hides and skins — the leather industry, seen as impure because it involves animal skin).

15.7 Reformers Against Untouchability (Phule, Ambedkar, Periyar)

KEY CONCEPT

- The abolition of untouchability was initiated by **Jyotiba Phule, Ambedkar and Gandhi**.
- **Jyotiba Phule** — founded the **Satya Shodak Samaj**; wrote the famous book 'Gulamgiri' (slavery) about Dalits, agricultural slaves and bonded labourers. The Samaj **attacked the Brahmin claim of superiority**: Phule argued the upper castes claim ownership of land while the low castes actually work it — an **inherent contradiction in the relations of production** — so the land belonged to the low castes. He urged the **Shudras and Ati-Shudras** (the Dalits) to unite against caste discrimination and propagated caste equality.
- **Ambedkar** — the **temple-entry movement**; founded the **All India Scheduled Castes Federation**; published the journal 'Mook Nayak'; and founded the **People's Education Society**.
- **Gandhi** — the **All India Harijan Sangh** (1932).

KEY CONCEPT

Periyar (E. V. Ramasamy) — equally important; later linked to the **Self-Respect Movement** and the **SNDP (Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana) movement**. He was an **outspoken critic of the Hindu scriptures** (like Ambedkar) — the **Bhagavad Gita, Ramayana and Manusmriti** — because he believed they justify the superiority of the Brahmins.

15.8 Westernization and the Breakdown of the Caste–Occupation Link

KEY CONCEPT

- Before westernization, **caste decided occupation** — an example of **cumulative inequality**. After westernization, **meritocracy, egalitarianism and equal opportunity** arrived: your ability/merit (e.g. UPSC marks) decides your occupation — **dispersed inequality**. This is **Andre Beteille's** idea of the **breakdown of cumulative inequality**.
- **Westernization** introduced modern industries, railways and meritocracy, promoting rapid **urbanization**, increased **social interaction** and **intermixing of castes**, and the **breakdown of the caste–occupation link**.
- On railways, people of different castes could no longer avoid sitting together or eating train/flight food (you never know who prepared it).
- With leather becoming a luxury (e.g. **Louis Vuitton**), even upper-caste merchants and Brahmins entered the leather/hide trade — **profit motive** displaced purity–pollution.
- **Land reforms** broke the link between caste and land ownership (land ceiling, fragmentation).
- **Modern Western education** (the university system) did not discriminate between upper and lower castes, and **equality before law** took away the judicial functions of the caste panchayat, opening administrative services to all castes.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Industrial society rewards instrumental action** (goal-oriented social action) — the dominant norm became **profit motive, not purity–pollution** — responsible for the breakdown of the **caste–vocation link**.
- The education system became **secular and meritocratic**, and **equality before law** opened the doors of administrative services to all castes.

Overall, social reform came with westernization — largely **heterogenetic changes**, though some were **orthogenetic**. The reformers (who first contacted westernization — primary westernization, absorbing rationality, secularism, humanism, equality) built a **civil society** that spread these ideas to the masses (secondary westernization).

15.9 Conclusion: From Particularism to Universalism

KEY CONCEPT

- Social reform marks the movement from **traditional society to modern society**:
- Earlier the norm was **particularism**; now it is **universalism**.
- Earlier **ascribed/ascriptive features** decided life chances; now **status is achieved**.
- Earlier there was **collective orientation** (collectivism — the individual, e.g. a Dalit, had to obey the caste structure and Brahmins); now there is **self-orientation** (every person is equal and can assert rights and hold the government accountable).

- In Parsons' terms, this is the shift from **pattern variable A to pattern variable B**, achieved through social reform.

KEY CONCEPT

Conclusion: social reforms introduced the ideas of the **Renaissance, Enlightenment and the French Revolution** into Indian society. Social reforms **propelled modernization**, but **certain traditions have not yet withered away** — and one can be hopeful that what the social reformers envisioned will be practised and established by **legal practitioners and state administrators**.

QUICK REVISION

- Social reform (1830s onwards) centred on caste practices, women's status, untouchability.
- Three objectives: emancipation of women; abolition of untouchability; reform of caste structure.
- Reformers' social composition: Western-educated, Hindu, upper-caste, middle-class men.
- Religious reform = social reform (religion/caste define life chances).
- Women's status: one marriage (vs male polygamy), no widow remarriage, purdah, sati, no property/divorce, child marriage, dependence — private patriarchy (Walby); reform → Brahmo Samaj, Bentinck, Ram Mohan Roy → All India Women's Conference 1927 (Margaret Cousins) → Articles 14/15, DPSP, Hindu Succession Act 1956, Hindu Marriage Act 1955; but dowry persists, public patriarchy, macro change/micro continuity.
- Untouchability: avarna/'broken men' most vulnerable; shadow-pollution (South), shout (Punjab), separate wells, no temple entry, separate schools, menial jobs (scavenging, tanning).
- Reformers: Phule (Satya Shodak Samaj, Gulamgiri, relations of production), Ambedkar (temple entry, SC Federation, Mook Nayak, People's Education Society), Gandhi (Harijan Sangh 1932), Periyar (Self-Respect, SNDP, critique of scriptures).
- Westernization: cumulative → dispersed inequality (Beteille); railways/meritocracy/land reforms/secular education broke caste–occupation link; profit motive > purity–pollution.
- Conclusion: particularism → universalism; ascribed → achieved; collectivism → self-orientation; Renaissance/Enlightenment/French Revolution ideas; modernization with persisting traditions.

Perspectives on Caste: G. S. Ghurye

16.1 The Four Scholars and the Beginnings of Caste Writing

KEY CONCEPT

- Section B covers **Perspectives on Caste**, built around **four key scholars**: G. S. Ghurye, M. N. Srinivas, Andre Beteille and Louis Dumont.
- The first writings on caste can be traced to the **1820s**. One of the first books on caste (with origin, evolution and the modern scenario) is attributed to **James Stuart Mill (1824)** — and **Ghurye copied this structure**: origin → evolution → present scenario → the future (will India become **caste-less**, as the makers of the Constitution envisioned, or **plural** — with more and more castes?) → and **caste outside India**.

EXAMPLE

- **Satish Deshpande's sociological reading of a joke** (from one of his memorial lectures): when OBC reservation was first implemented (1991–92), a joke went viral — of 10 astronauts sent to explore Mars/Moon, 6 were OBC, 2 SC, 1 ST, and 1 general (if space was left).
- The implication: for the **lower caste**, **caste overrides qualification**; for the **upper caste**, **qualification overrides caste**. Caste is **hyper-visible among the lower castes and invisible among the upper castes** — upper castes are spoken of as 'general', as if they are caste-less, although they have benefited most from caste.

16.2 The Four Sources of Ghurye's Ideas on Caste

KEY CONCEPT

- Ghurye's ideas on caste can be traced to **four sources/factors**:
- 1. **Indological sources** — the Vedic texts, Samhitas and Brahmanas, i.e. how caste was described in the ancient Sanskrit classical texts (Ghurye works like an archaeologist of history, uncovering when caste arose and how it was practised).
- 2. **The Indo-Aryan Racial Theory** (of Risley) — caste developed from race.
- 3. **The idea of the sub-caste** — a sub-caste is itself a caste (it is 'sub' only in relation to a caste above it, and it has sub-sub-castes below it; no caste is a single homogeneous unit — it has internal factions/segments).
- 4. **Caste outside India**.

- From these four sources come Ghurye's **six features of caste**.

16.3 The Indo-Aryan Racial Theory

KEY CONCEPT

- **Indo-Aryan Racial Theory** (given by **Risley**): caste developed from **race**, and **occupation stabilised it**.
- The **Aryans** (who came from outside, from the Persian side) were **fair**; the **non-Aryans** (the indigenous people, called **Dasas**) were **dark**. Fair and dark = **varna** (Sanskrit for 'colour').
- To preserve their unique identity and purity, the Aryans imposed **restrictions on intermarriage** and on **occupational purity**; the groups they encountered were excluded from these occupations.
- The Aryans already practised a three-class system (Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya — by other names) in Persia; in India they continued it, with a **fourth class outside** them. Each class had a specific occupation. Restricting intermarriage with the outsiders automatically produced a social group marked by **endogamy and hierarchy — the caste**.

CRITICAL POINT

- **Ghurye's own verdict** (a line to remember verbatim): the racial theory is '**valid only for Hindustan proper**' — i.e. only in **North India** (the Indo-Gangetic plain). In **South India**, **endogamy was not practised** and there was no restriction on intermarriage. So the theory is **partially valid, partially invalid**.
- The race-caste correlation **cannot be scientifically verified**: geographical factors are ignored — in Kashmir even Dalits are fair, and in Kanyakumari even Brahmins are dark.
- To verify it, Ghurye conducted **anthropometric analysis** (measurements of the **nasal index** — the kind of nose/brow measurements used in crime documentaries), an ideal-type model inspired by **Lombroso** (of 'Born Criminal' fame) and **Risley** — the first to do such measurements. (This detail is not exam-important.)

16.4 The Indological Account: Four Phases of Caste

These points are in Ghurye's book '**Caste and Race**' (1932): chapters 1–2 = Indo-Aryan racial theory; chapters 3–4 = the Indological account of caste, written as **four temporal phases of caste**.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Phase 1 — Vedic period (Early Vedic; 1500 BC – 920 BC)**: society was **egalitarian and tribal**; the order was the **varna vyavastha** (not caste/jati), where **anyone could change his varna**. The **Purusha Sukta of the Rig Veda** mentions only **three classes** (Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya/Vis) — no fourth, and no restriction; there was **no Brahminical supremacy** and no question of higher/lower or untouchable.

- **Phase 2 — Post-Vedic period (920 BC – 400 BC):** dominated by the sacred laws of the Aryas, the great epics and Gita literature. The **four varnas were firmly established** — the **fourth varna** emerged from the **intermixing of the three Aryan classes with the non-Aryans** (the outsiders). It was seen as the most impure; those born of intermixing between the third and the non-Aryan were the most polluted. Mixed castes are called '**Sankar Jati**' in Hindu literature (Kaliyuga is called the phase of Sankar Jati — when caste order breaks down). When it was realised that intermixing weakens caste, **endogamy came to be strictly followed**, and **Brahmins gained supremacy**.
- **Phase 3 — the period of the Dharma Shastras / Hindu emperors (200 BC onwards):** the **Dharma Shastras** (written sacred texts, like a law code governing everyday life) were **codified** — for the first time in writing: who may marry whom, who may eat/sit with whom. Rules on **social interaction**, restrictions on **inter-dining and inter-marriage**, and — most important — **different punishment for the same crime committed by different castes** (differential treatment). Summed up in the **Manu Smriti**. The Brahmin was projected as the lord of creation, to be given gifts (dana). Caste became **completely rigid**.
- **Phase 4 — the modern period (18th century onwards, when the British came):** caste was **neither flexible nor rigid, but both**.

KEY CONCEPT

- **How caste became flexible** in the modern period: the **social-religious reform movements** attacked caste, and **British legislation** — the **Caste Disabilities Removal Act 1850**, the **Widow Remarriage Act 1856**, and the **Special Marriage Act 1872** — weakened the caste system.
- **How caste became rigid: reservation** (caste-based reservation makes more castes demand reservation — people 'become more caste'); and the **census** (classifying people by caste reproduces caste consciousness rather than eroding it). Both strengthened caste.
- The overall net effect (weakening vs strengthening) is **not measurable** — both happened, for different reasons.

KEY CONCEPT

In conclusion, Ghurye explains the **evolution of caste** using three references: the **Indological account**, **modern historical texts**, and the **British census**. This is both an **evolutionary** and a **comparative** analysis (how caste was vs how caste is).

16.5 The Book 'Caste and Race': Fission/Fusion, Kin and Politics

KEY CONCEPT

- 'Caste and Race' (1932) was revised many times; chapters 6–11 were added later, giving the book a new edition structure (later editions titled e.g. 'Caste and Class', 'Caste and Occupation'). The later chapters:

- **Chapter 8 — Fission and Fusion:** **fission** = the breakdown of a caste into multiple **sub-castes**; **fusion** = those sub-castes coming together in a **coalition** (a caste association) during politics. Ghurye's point: **caste is not a homogeneous group** — within it are multiple divisions; even a 'homogeneous' caste becomes heterogeneous sub-castes (endogamy operates at the sub-caste level, not the caste level).
- **Chapter 9 — Caste, sub-caste and kin:** kin = **kindred** (maternal and paternal relatives — mama, mami, fufa, fufi, bua, bhanja, bhatiji, cousins). Caste is linked to kinship — e.g. the **biradari** (brotherhood/fraternity) in North India; in single-caste villages, caste reproduces generation after generation.
- **Chapter 10 — Caste and politics (general).**
- **Chapter 11 — Caste and politics in Tamil Nadu** — showing Ghurye was an **empiricist** (speaking on data, not speculation). This and the general chapter influenced M. N. Srinivas (dominant caste), Rajni Kothari, and Andre Beteille (who did field study in Tamil Nadu).
- **Chapter 12 — The future of caste in India: caste-less or plural?**

16.6 Caste and Politics: The Census as Creator of Caste

KEY CONCEPT

- In 'Caste and Politics' (chapter 10), Ghurye examines the relation between caste and politics against the then-contemporary situation. His argument: the **census is not a passive instrument** merely collecting data — it has **objectifying power: in the process of collecting data, it creates new groups** (it creates caste).
- His deeper claim: **Indians never practised caste as such — it was the British who divided them into caste groups through the census.**
- Example: **L. Middleton**, the **census officer of Punjab in 1921**, found that people **refused to give their caste** — they said 'we do not have caste' — yet he imposed a caste on them.
- Why the British conducted the caste census: they wanted **data to frame affirmative policies** and give **adequate representation** (percentage-wise) to communities demanding representation — i.e. they needed to know each caste's population.
- Ghurye's verdict: **the British were trying to cure the problem they themselves had created in the first place.** The census **manufactured caste and made it an all-India phenomenon** (Ghurye is, like an 'Indian Durkheim', concerned with integration).

CRITICAL POINT

- Ghurye was **against the caste census** for these reasons:
- 1. It **divides India** — it brings out the very caste identity that the Constitution tries to do away with.
- 2. It **creates caste** — every 10 years (the census cycle) the old caste discourse is revived in newspapers and on television.
- 3. It **unintentionally creates caste associations** — e.g. **Bahujan** = SC + ST + OBC clubbed

together into a caste association that became a political party (the **BSP**).

- 4. It pushes **tribals to claim caste identity** — the **Hinduization of tribes**: realising Hindus are privileged and tribals isolated, a tribal emulates Hindu customs and becomes a 'caste Hindu' through **Sanskritization** — which is a **gateway/entry into the caste structure** (a process by which the caste-less gain caste).
- 5. It makes **Sikhs worry about undercounting** — the caste census is largely Hindu-specific (Sikhism, like Buddhism under Guru Nanak, was against caste and Brahmanism, but conversions from Hinduism — mostly by the oppressed sections seeking refuge — brought caste into Sikhism); they feared not being counted as Indians at all.
- 6. It leads to the rise of the **anti-Brahmanical movement** (which began in South India with **Dravid consciousness**) — dividing the very India that Ghurye saw as united by a common culture diffused all over India.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Bernard Cohn** and others have made the same point about the census's power to create caste.
- On opposing the caste census *today*: the reasons differ depending on **who** is opposing (a university professor vs someone who does not want lower castes to prosper) — it is a matter of perspective, not a single structural reason.

16.7 Substantialization and 'Caste Patriotism'

KEY CONCEPT

- Forming associations on the basis of caste **substantializes caste** — it makes caste more and more crystallised. This leads to what Ghurye **coined** as '**caste patriotism**'.
- In the anti-Brahman movement, non-Brahmins still have caste (they are against Brahmins, but have their own caste); they form **coalitions around their own caste identities against the Brahmin identity** — this is **caste patriotism**, not patriotism at the Indian level (e.g. the **Jat agitation/protest** is caste patriotism — showing solidarity for a common caste cause even if reservation is not obtained).
- **Louis Dumont's theory of the 'substantialization of caste'** was actually used **first by Ghurye**.

KEY CONCEPT

In conclusion, Ghurye is highly concerned about **fissiparous tendencies** (tendencies that break India apart) — tendencies that threaten the Hindu culture that (he believes) had diffused all over India and united it. He blames the **British** (and, in passing, the **Muslims**) for these fissiparous tendencies.

16.8 The Six Features of Caste (the framework)

KEY CONCEPT

- Ghurye's **last major contribution on caste** is his statement of the **six features of caste**.
- Crucially, these are the features of **caste as it was present in the 1920s** — i.e. of **traditional Indian society** (before 1947, the 'British India' that brought modernization). Some may still be valid today, but they describe the 1920s.
- In other words, Ghurye has given a **comparative, evolutionary, historical and Indological account of caste**.
- (The detailed enumeration of the six features is taken up in the next class.)

QUICK REVISION

- Four scholars: Ghurye, Srinivas, Beteille, Dumont. First caste book: James Stuart Mill (1824) — origin→evolution→present→future (caste-less vs plural)→caste outside India.
- Ghurye's four sources: Indological texts; Indo-Aryan Racial Theory (Risley); sub-caste; caste outside India → six features.
- Racial theory: Aryan (fair) vs Dasa (dark); caste from race, occupation stabilised it; Ghurye: 'valid only for Hindustan proper' (North); cannot be verified (Kashmir Dalit fair, Kanyakumari Brahmin dark); anthropometric/nasal index (Lombroso/Risley).
- Four phases (Caste and Race 1932): Vedic (egalitarian, varna vyavastha, Purusha Sukta 3 classes, no Brahmin supremacy); Post-Vedic (4th varna from intermixing, Sankar Jati, endogamy, Brahmin supremacy); Dharma Shastras (codified, Manu Smriti, inter-dining/marriage bans, differential punishment, rigid); Modern (both flexible — reform movements + British laws 1850/1856/1872 — and rigid — reservation + census).
- Later chapters: Fission/Fusion (sub-castes); Caste, sub-caste, kin (biradari); Caste and politics (general + Tamil Nadu, empiricist) → influenced Srinivas/Kothari/Beteille; Future (caste-less or plural).
- Census: objectifying power — creates caste (L. Middleton, Punjab 1921); British curing a self-created problem; Ghurye against caste census (divides India, creates caste, caste associations/Bahujan/BSP, Hinduization of tribes via Sanskritization, Sikh undercounting fears, anti-Brahman movement).
- Substantialization → 'caste patriotism' (Ghurye coined; Dumont later); fissiparous tendencies blamed on British (and Muslims).
- Six features of caste: valid as of the 1920s (traditional society); comparative/evolutionary/historical/Indological account.

G. S. Ghurye: Features of Caste and PYQs

17.1 Caste as Integrative and Divisive

Ghurye held two seemingly opposite views of caste: the **traditional avatar of caste integrated** Indian society, while the **modern avatar of caste (created by the British through the caste census and quota politics) divides** it.

KEY CONCEPT

- Viewed through the **Indological perspective**, caste is part of Hindu culture and **integrates** us (like the joint family, caste structure, the triad, Vedic knowledge — a composite, syncretic culture diffused all over India).
- Viewed through the **westernized/rational/Enlightened** lens, caste **divides** us.
- Giving both accounts at once is itself the **evolution of caste** — and what worried Ghurye most was the **politicization of caste**.

KEY CONCEPT

- Ghurye was the **first scholar in India to discuss the politicization of caste** — but the *phrase* 'politicization of caste' is coined by **Rajni Kothari** (one of India's greatest political scientists).
- Caste census + quota politics + caste associations + politicization of caste are, for Ghurye, **unhealthy for Indian society** — and all of these came into existence only because of the British.

KEY CONCEPT

- Ghurye coined the term **caste patriotism**: when the census counts you as a member of a caste, you become **conscious of your caste membership**, caste associations grow stronger, and a 'caste patriotism' develops — what **M. N. Srinivas** later called the **vote bank** (derived from Ghurye's caste patriotism).
- **Caste patriotism integrates the caste but divides India** — mechanical solidarity becoming the biggest hurdle on the path to organic solidarity.

EXAMPLE

- Caste-based regiments in the Indian Army (e.g. the **Mahar Regiment**, for which **Ambedkar** fought) reflect the solidarity around caste ties of traditional society — and this caste-based

regimentation was done by the **British**.

- Caste was an Indo-Gangetic phenomenon diffused all over India *through the caste census* — the British treated caste as pan-Indian and imposed it even on people who had no caste.

17.2 The Six (Structural) Features of Caste

KEY CONCEPT

- In **Caste and Race (1932)**, chapters 1–2, Ghurye discusses the **features of caste as it was present in the 1920s** (traditional India, before fundamental rights). These are called the **structural features of caste**.
- The six features: (1) **segmentation of society**, (2) **hierarchy**, (3) **civil and religious disabilities and privileges**, (4) **lack of unrestricted choice of occupation**, (5) **restriction on food, drinks and social intercourse** (commensality), and (6) **endogamy**.

17.3 Feature 1 — Segmentation of Society

KEY CONCEPT

- **Segmentation of society** = stratification into segments (like the floors of a building). The tribal model speaks of **egalitarianism** (no high/low tribe), but caste has **high caste and low caste** — a segmentation.
- You are **born into** a caste (you do not choose it), so caste is **closed strata** based on **ascriptive features**; therefore there is **no mobility** in caste.
- Differences between castes are not only in **rank** — they are also reflected in **food, behaviour, dress code, culture and custom**: every caste has its own regulations and customs making it distinct.

EXAMPLE

- **Andre Beteille's field study (1960)** — a 10-month study of **Shripuram** village in **Tanjore (Thanjavur)** district, Tamil Nadu — exposed the **segments within Brahmins** (a 'society' can be a small village).
- He found four categories within Brahmins; two of them: the **Smarta Brahmins** (followers of **Shankaracharya**, worshipping Shiva and Vishnu) and the **Sri Vaishnava Brahmins** (followers of **Ramanuja**, worshipping Vishnu only).
- The Smarta do not marry the Sri Vaishnava — **endogamy within Brahmins** — and the two are untouchable to each other. This shows **untouchability existed at the upper level too**, not only at the bottom.

17.4 Feature 2 — Hierarchy

KEY CONCEPT

Hierarchy = a **ranked arrangement**. Your rank in the hierarchy decides your **life chances** — occupation, wealth, status.

17.5 Feature 3 — Civil and Religious Disabilities and Privileges

KEY CONCEPT

- **Civil and religious disabilities and privileges** — in the hierarchy formed by segmentation, the **upper castes** get privileges and the **lower castes / casteless (untouchables)** suffer disabilities.
- Disabilities imposed on the low caste/untouchable: they cannot drink from the common well, cannot enter the temple, cannot access education, cannot sit and dine with upper castes, and must maintain social distance.
- These **civil and religious disabilities developed from the concept of purity and pollution**: special powers and rights are bestowed on higher castes, while many disabilities are imposed on low castes and untouchables.

17.6 Feature 4 — Lack of Unrestricted Choice of Occupation

KEY CONCEPT

- **Lack of unrestricted choice of occupation** = restrictions on the choice of occupation. Occupation is fixed by **heredity**: your caste decides your occupation, and you cannot change it — because to change occupation means to change caste, and caste cannot be changed.
- Occupations were fixed by heredity; individuals were traditionally not allowed to change their traditional occupation.
- The upper castes (Brahmins) were free to opt for the study of religious books, which other caste groups could not do.

17.7 Feature 5 — Restriction on Food, Drinks and Social Intercourse (Commensality)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Restriction on food, drinks and social intercourse** — in one word, **commensality** — the prohibition on inter-dining and intercourse.
- Traditional Hindu society distinguishes **kaccha food** (raw/uncooked — e.g. fruits; any food made in **water**) from **pakka food** (cooked — any food made in **ghee**).
- An upper-caste person would **not accept pakka food from a low-caste person** (he might

accept kaccha/raw food, whose taste the other's touch cannot spoil) — and sometimes even water or kaccha food is not accepted.

- **What is accepted, by whom, and from whom, reflects hierarchy and caste consciousness.** These practices are still prevalent in villages.

17.8 Feature 6 — Endogamy and Marriage Restrictions

KEY CONCEPT

- **Endogamy** = marrying within one's caste. But caste is not homogeneous: **Maheshwari** and **Agarwal** are not castes but **sub-castes** of the **Baniya** caste — so 'caste endogamy' is really **sub-caste endogamy** (an Agarwal marrying a Maheshwari is sub-caste exogamy).
- The unit of caste is paradoxical: **Varna was discovered by Orientalists** (their reading of the Dharma Shastras, Gita and Puranas), **Jati was discovered through the census questionnaires by British administrators**, and **caste/sub-caste as a functioning system was manufactured by social anthropologists / structural-functional field workers.**

KEY CONCEPT

- **Uma Chakravarti**: the category **class is about production** (economic), while **caste is about reproduction** (social, not merely economic) — 'class produces, caste reproduces'. Caste is reproduced only through **endogamy**.
- **Arranged marriage** is really an arrangement **between castes** — invented as an apparatus to reproduce castes and maintain the caste structure.
- The **caste panchayat** (e.g. khap panchayat) was the instrument that ensured endogamous marriage.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Hypergamy** (from the woman's perspective, marrying a person of same or higher caste/status — **anuloma**) was allowed but **with restrictions**. **Hypogamy** (the husband is lower — **pratiloma**) was discouraged.
- According to Ghurye, marriage restrictions in society are of **three types: endogamy, exogamy, and hypergamy**.
- **Exogamy** operates at the village level and the gotra level (**sapinda** — a boy and girl with a common ancestor/'pind' cannot marry each other).

17.9 Ghurye on Caste Patriotism, Reservation and Politics

CRITICAL POINT

- **Ghurye opposed reservation** — reservation creates caste consciousness, divides society and strengthens caste.
- For Ghurye, the spirit of **caste patriotism can never develop patriotism cutting across caste lines**: it only reduces the nation, in our minds, to the level of caste (your caste becomes your nation). Reservation would **tear asunder national integration** — the very vision of the constitution-makers.
- Ghurye would therefore also **oppose the Poona Pact / separate electorate, EWS reservation, and the Fifth/Sixth Schedule** (he was an **assimilationist** — tribals are 'backward Hindus', so do not isolate them; their gods and our gods are the same, via diffusion and assimilation — which Srinivas would call parochialization and universalization).

COMPARISON

Ghurye and Ambedkar never met: Ghurye was a professor who limited himself to academic discourse, while Ambedkar was much more — a practising lawyer, activist, and leader. (In the 1920s Ambedkar was also active in academics, but their paths did not cross.)

17.10 Caste Outside India

KEY CONCEPT

- Caste is **not unique to India**. It is found in Sri Lanka (traditional Ceylon), Nepal, Bhutan, Pakistan and Afghanistan. **Max Weber** also discussed caste outside India.
- **Isabel Wilkerson** recently published a popular book on **caste in America** (after the Cisco case), where she **equated race with caste**.
- Caste is a **political, academic and Orientalist category** developed by the British in their attempt to understand Indian culture — classifying Indians (like we classify animals as endangered/extinct).
- Ghurye's point: **caste is a social group having these features** — so if these features are found outside India, those groups are also caste.

17.11 PYQ Content: Ambedkar, Caste and Democracy

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ambedkar on caste**: the two most important features of the caste system are the **division of labourers** and **graded inequality** (key words), followed by **endogamy**.
- **"Caste has been unhealthy for the growth of the sociology of India"**: Beteille said caste has been the **obsession of Indian anthropologists more than of the people of India** (over-obsession with any one thing is detrimental); **A. R. Desai** called caste the **"steel frame of**

Hinduism” (Hinduism equated with caste). Indian sociology was born of **Indology** — the study of Hindu culture, i.e. the study of caste.

KEY CONCEPT

“Has caste hindered democracy?” — discuss both dimensions. **Yes**: Ambedkar held **Hinduism and democracy are opposite** (democracy = equality, caste = inequality); **Ghurye** held democracy needs collective consciousness around national identity, while caste associations and caste patriotism hinder national integration. **No**: democracy itself gave castes the chance to consolidate (caste associations/pressure groups were born of democracy; elites circulate on caste lines).

KEY CONCEPT

Positional vs structural change: **Sanskritization is positional change** — adopting upper-caste customs (vegetarianism, the sacred thread, Vedic knowledge) moves you up within the caste structure but does **not erode the structure** (the status quo is maintained — a moving equilibrium). Structural change would erode the structure itself.

EXAMPLE

The abolition of sati: **William Bentinck** brought the legislation, supported by **Raja Ram Mohan Roy**. It was a **heterogenetic change** — the force of modernization/westernization promoted **humanitarianism** (a feature of Westernization), which eroded the traditional institutions against the fundamental rights of Dalits, women and weaker sections. Sati was practised in the **upper castes**; through the interactionist lens, a woman’s self-immolation was a **symbol of the king’s pride** — a **patriarchal bargain** (wives competing to maintain the structure of private patriarchy).

KEY CONCEPT

- **A. R. Desai’s Marxist perspective** (PYQ): Indian nationalism analysed through the **mode of production** — feudal before colonialism, **colonial/capitalist** under the British, and never socialist after independence; his books are “**Recent Trends of Indian Nationalism**” and “**Path of Development**”. Critique: it is an **ideal type mistaken for actual type** (Weber), **armchair philosophy** (not empirical), and **too myopic/economistic** (everything is ‘bourgeois’ — constitution, planning, cooperatives).
- **Ranjit Guha** (PYQ): the first person to introduce **subaltern studies** — the most unique, indigenous study, reading history from below (through the eyes of tribals and lower castes, not the British or upper castes).
- **Critique of the structural-functional approach** (PYQ): the general critique is the **Marxist perspective**, and the second is its **over-emphasis on integration and neglect of conflict**.

QUICK REVISION

- Ambedkar: division of labourers + graded inequality + endogamy.
- Caste unhealthy for sociology: Beteille (obsession) + A. R. Desai (steel frame of Hinduism);

sociology born of Indology.

- Caste & democracy: Ambedkar/Ghurye (hinders) vs democracy consolidating caste.
- Positional (Sanskritization) vs structural change.
- Sati: Bentinck, heterogenetic, humanitarianism, private patriarchy, patriarchal bargain.
- A. R. Desai (mode of production, ideal vs actual type, armchair, economistic); Ranjit Guha (subaltern); structural-functional critique (Marxist, neglect of conflict).

17.12 Conclusion and the PYQ Approach

KEY CONCEPT

- In conclusion, **Ghurye's account of caste laid the foundation upon which the superstructure of Indian sociology got erected** — because Indian sociology has more or less been the sociology of caste.
- There is a natural chain of critique: **Ghurye → M. N. Srinivas (a critique of Ghurye) → Louis Dumont (a critique of Srinivas) → Andre Beteille (a critique of Dumont).**

QUICK REVISION

- Ghurye: traditional caste integrates, modern (census/quota) caste divides; politicization of caste (phrase by Rajni Kothari).
- Caste census → caste consciousness → caste associations → caste patriotism (Ghurye) → vote bank (Srinivas); caste patriotism integrates caste, divides India.
- Six structural features (Caste and Race, ch. 1–2, 1920s): segmentation, hierarchy, civil/religious disabilities & privileges, lack of unrestricted choice of occupation, restriction on food/drink/intercourse (commensality, kaccha vs pakka), endogamy.
- Segmentation example: Beteille's Shripuram/Tanjore (1960) — Smarta vs Sri Vaishnava Brahmins (endogamy + untouchability at upper level).
- Endogamy: sub-caste endogamy (Maheshwari/Agarwal = Baniya sub-castes); Varna (Orientalists) vs Jati (census) vs caste (anthropologists); Uma Chakravarti (caste reproduces); arranged marriage; caste panchayat; anuloma/pratiloma; three restrictions (endogamy/exogamy/hypergamy); sapinda/gotra exogamy.
- Ghurye opposed reservation, Poona Pact, EWS, Fifth/Sixth Schedule (assimilationist).
- Caste outside India: Sri Lanka, Nepal, Bhutan, Pakistan, Afghanistan; Isabel Wilkerson's 'Caste'; Max Weber.
- Conclusion: Ghurye's account = foundation of Indian sociology; chain Ghurye→Srinivas→Dumont→Beteille.

M. N. Srinivas on Caste

18.1 Varna and Jati

18.1.1 From Book View to Field View

KEY CONCEPT

- M. N. Srinivas is the first person to take departure from the book view of Indian society (the book view given by William Jones, Wilkins and Ghurye) and introduce the field view of Indian society.
- In the **book view**, caste becomes **Varna**; in the **field view**, caste is **Jati**. So 'what is caste?' depends on who is speaking, in what context and on which time-scale — therefore caste cannot be defined easily, and that is why we speak of **perspectives on caste**.
- Srinivas was the **first to discuss the difference between Varna and Jati** (they had been confused before) — in his article '**Varna and Jati**'.

18.1.2 Varna vs Jati: The Reference and the Empirical Category

KEY CONCEPT

- **Varna** is mentioned in **Sanskrit texts** (e.g. the **Rig Veda's Purusha Sukta**), so it is a **reference category** — the reference through which we understand the Indian field. The **Orientalists discovered Varna** by translating texts into English.
- **Jati** is caste as it actually exists — a **collection of endogamous families inhabiting a region** (local: e.g. the **Vokkaliga of Rampura**; the **Thakurs** of UP/Bihar, not Tamil Nadu). Brahmin/Kshatriya are found all over India, but Vokkaliga is not.
- **Jati is an empirical category** — perceivable through the senses (it can be observed); **Varna is not empirical** — it is a book/reference category, an **ideal type** that does not exist in reality.

KEY CONCEPT

Although Varna **distorts** the picture of caste (showing only four, with Brahmins superior and untouchables inferior all over India — which is not reality), it has one **advantage**: it **enables ordinary men and women to understand and assess the general place of caste throughout India** — Varna is a **common language** (a Mishra and a Smarta can recognise each other as Brahmins), bringing stability and order to a chaotic world.

18.1.3 *Four Castes vs Innumerable Jatis*

KEY CONCEPT

- According to the **Varna scheme** there are **only four castes** (Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra) — and it **excludes untouchables** (they are outside the caste structure, the 'broken'/Dalit).
- But there are **thousands of Jatis** — **innumerable, small and local, with high regional variation**.
- Example: **Nama Shudra** is an untouchable jati of West Bengal — an untouchable is *not* a caste in the Varna model, but is *definitely* a jati.
- In **Shripuram** village (Tamil Nadu) the categories are Brahmins, non-Brahmins and **Adi Dravidas** (untouchables); within the Adi Dravidas are **Pallans** (Hindu Dalits) and **Parayans** (Christian Dalits) — so there is **hierarchy even within Dalits**, and the notion of purity/impurity exists even among those the Varna model calls impure.

18.1.4 *Endogamy, Occupation and the Challenge to Ghurye*

KEY CONCEPT

- In the **Varna model**, caste is **endogamous** and **engaged in a traditional occupation**. In the **Jati model**, jatis are **not always endogamous nor always following a traditional occupation**.
- Here Srinivas is **challenging Ghurye**: Ghurye's features 'endogamy' and 'lack of unrestricted choice of occupation' are actually the **Varna (book) view**, not the field view.
- In his **Rampura** field study, Srinivas found that **one jati = one occupation is invalid** — a single caste group could be involved in multiple occupations (you cannot pin a jati to one occupation).
- Srinivas is **not generalising** (unlike Ghurye) — he is describing Rampura specifically, the field view.

18.1.5 *Definite Hierarchy vs Nebulous Hierarchy*

KEY CONCEPT

- In the **Varna model** there is a **definite hierarchy and uniformity** — Brahmins at the top and untouchables at the bottom all over India — which means **no mobility**.
- In the **Jati model**, hierarchy is **local and 'nebulous'** (vague, blurred — a term Srinivas uses). **Dipankar Gupta** later used the term '**muddled hierarchy**'.
- The position of various jatis in the hierarchy is **not always clear**: e.g. the **Reddy** claim Kshatriya status (which can never be verified); every jati has its own '**Jati Puran**' — a text of mythologies constructed to justify its position (descent from a god, from the moon or sun).
- The **Lingayats** (Shaivites who invaded Coorg) claim status equivalent to Brahmins — unverifiable. The **Yadavs** are dominant in UP/Bihar but inferior in Maharashtra — so hierarchy is **not uniform, not pan-India**.

18.1.6 Why Hierarchy Cannot Be Objectively Assessed

KEY CONCEPT

- Srinivas held that **hierarchy cannot be objectively assessed**, for two reasons:
- 1. **The problem of criteria** — should rank be decided by **numbers, economic position (land ownership), political position, or ritual position**? There is no single deciding factor: some castes are high in numbers but low economically; some are ritually high but economically weak; a poor Brahmin may be ritually superior but economically inferior.
- 2. **Claims and counter-claims** — everyone can claim superiority and everyone can be counter-claimed: in Rampura, the **Smiths** asserted they would accept cooked (pakka) food only from Brahmins (claiming superiority), while the **untouchables** asserted they could not accept cooked food and water from Brahmins. So jatis cannot be represented in a simple ladder-like arrangement.

18.1.7 Hierarchy: Manufactured by Anthropologists

KEY CONCEPT

- Although Srinivas said there is no clear hierarchy at the local level, he **still placed Brahmins at the top and untouchables at the bottom in Rampura** — because hierarchy was **manufactured by anthropologists, not implicit in caste**.
- As a student of **social anthropology** he was a **structural functionalist** (a follower of **Evans-Pritchard and Radcliffe-Brown**), committed to showing how parts make up the system — so he constructed hierarchy to show how it maintains the caste system.

18.1.8 Ranking: Ritual vs Secular Factors

KEY CONCEPT

- In the **Varna model**, the criterion of ranking is **ritual** — the notion of **purity and pollution** — stressing **attributional features** (attributes/traits: food, skin colour, dress, language, mode of production).
- In the **Jati model**, rank is shaped by **political and economic resources** — the **secular factors** — the same criteria as for **dominance** (the **dominant caste**, originally called 'dominant jati').
- Examples from Rampura: the **Vokkaliga** (peasants) are Shudras in the Varna model (inferior), but in the field they are **dominant** — prosperous, wealthy, landowners, and numerous (the OBCs have the maximum population in India) — claiming superiority even over Brahmins.
- **Not all Brahmins are pure** — in the field view one may find impure/polluted Brahmins.
- **Mobility**: in the Varna model mobility comes only through **ritual considerations** (anyone can become Brahmin/vegetarian); in the Jati model mobility comes through **numbers, economic position and political position** — rituals are not the only route.

KEY CONCEPT

Final remark: there is a **disparity between ritual and secular position** — a caste can be **ritually high but ranked lower** in the local hierarchy, which is determined by **secular factors** (economic, political and educational status).

18.1.9 Dominant Caste and the Role of Context**KEY CONCEPT**

- Asked who the dominant caste of Rampura is, Srinivas answered: **'it is the context that defines your status.'**
- In a **secular context** (the village headman is a Vokkaliga, and Brahmins depend on the Vokkaliga headman), economic and political factors make the **Vokkaliga** dominant.
- In a **marriage/ritual context** (the Vokkaliga depend on Brahmins), the **Brahmins** are dominant.
- So there is **no universal idea of dominance**: the *concept* of dominant caste is about **secular rank** (political, economic, numerical factors), but actual dominance depends on context.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Caste is immutable** (fixed) in the **Varna model** (no mobility), but **mutable** in the **Jati model** — it is in the field that Srinivas observed **Sanskritization** (social mobility).
- **Census is a source of social mobility** (per Srinivas): ten years back you were Kshatriya, now you claim Brahmin status — these claims can never be objectively assessed.
- Castes construct **mythologies and texts** (Jati Purans) to claim ritual superiority, even after having secured secular power (numbers, wealth, political power).

QUICK REVISION

- Srinivas: first to depart from book view (William Jones/Wilkins/Ghurye) to field view; Varna = book, Jati = field; article 'Varna and Jati'.
- Varna = reference/ideal type (Sanskrit texts, Orientalists), not empirical; Jati = empirical (observable), 'collection of endogamous families inhabiting a region'.
- Varna = four castes (excludes untouchables); Jati = innumerable/local (Nama Shudra; Shripuram's Adi Dravidas, Pallans vs Parayans).
- Varna: endogamy + traditional occupation; Jati: not always endogamous, one jati $\neq$ one occupation (Rampura) — challenges Ghurye.
- Varna: definite hierarchy/uniformity/no mobility; Jati: local, 'nebulous' hierarchy (Dipankar Gupta's 'muddled'); Reddy/Jati Puran/Lingayat/Yadav examples.
- Hierarchy not objectively assessable: criteria problem + claims/counter-claims (Smiths vs untouchables of Rampura); hierarchy manufactured by anthropologists (structural functionalism).
- Ranking: ritual (purity/pollution, attributional) vs secular (political/economic); Vokkaliga

dominant; not all Brahmins pure; mobility via secular factors too.

- Dominant caste = secular rank, but 'context defines status' (secular vs ritual context); caste immutable (Varna) vs mutable (Jati, Sanskritization); census = mobility.

18.2 Features of Jati, Dominant Caste and Vote Bank

18.2.1 *Varna to Caste to Sub-Caste (Fission)*

KEY CONCEPT

- After distinguishing **Varna and Jati**, Srinivas discusses the features of caste — but he says **features of Jati**, not caste (he is a field-view scholar; the English for jati in the caste context is **sub-caste**).
- The structure he works with: **Varna** → **Caste** → **Sub-caste**. Within Brahmin there are multiple castes (**Sri Vaishnava, Smarta, Bhatkal**, etc.), and within each caste there are multiple sub-castes; within Shudra there are multiple castes, each divided into sub-castes.
- This is **fission** — and Srinivas is largely studying the fission process (as against fusion).

18.2.2 *Features of the Sub-Caste (Jati)*

KEY CONCEPT

- Srinivas's features of jati/sub-caste (largely from his field work, in contrast to Ghurye's book-view features):
- 1. **Hierarchy** — but *nebulous*.
- 2. **Purity and pollution** — but with no clear binary.
- 3. **Occupational association** — systematization of occupational differentiation.
- 4. **Restrictions on commensality, dress, speech and custom.**
- 5. **Caste panchayat and assemblies.**
- 6. **Sub-caste as a unit of endogamy.**
- 7. **Members share a common culture** (each sub-caste has its own distinct social customs and ritual life).

COMPARISON

- Ghurye discussed features of **caste** (via the **Varna/book view** — definite hierarchy); Srinivas discusses features of **jati/sub-caste** (via the **field view** — nebulous hierarchy).
- Srinivas witnessed a **completely different picture of jati in the field, in opposition to Ghurye's analysis based on ancient Sanskrit texts.**

18.2.3 *Hierarchy: Nebulous*

KEY CONCEPT

- In the book view, Brahmins are at the top and untouchables at the bottom (definite hierarchy). In the field, the **middle ranks are highly nebulous** (vague) — we cannot make an objective claim about who is where.
- There are **claims and counter-claims**: many untouchables do not even accept water or food from the hands of Brahmins.
- Yet, despite these contradictions, Srinivas **recorded Brahmins at the top and untouchables at the bottom even in the field** — because of his **commitment to structural functionalism**: a system must have a definite hierarchy to be called a system. This commitment made him **oblivious to the inconsistencies between book view and field view**.

18.2.4 *Purity and Pollution: No Clear Binary*

KEY CONCEPT

- Srinivas saw that Brahmins are considered the most pure and untouchables the most polluted — but in the field he also saw **polluted people claiming purity**.
- Example: the **Smiths** (untouchables) call themselves '**Vishwakarma Brahmins**'.
- There is **no clear-cut binary distinction between pure and impure** in the field. What marks someone as pure/impure is only **ritual considerations** — and even the low castes (or those outside the caste) can imbibe those rituals through **Sanskritization**.

18.2.5 *Occupational Association and Nesfield*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Jati is the systematization of occupational differentiation** — jatis are occupational groups, known by their occupations (**Sonar** = goldsmith, **Lohar** = ironsmith, **Kumhar** = potter, **Chamar** = leather worker).
- Srinivas drew on **Nesfield's occupational theory of caste** (not Risley's racial theory).
- But **one jati ≠ one occupation as a universal rule** — in the field a jati may have multiple occupations (someone from another jati working a non-traditional occupation).

18.2.6 *Restrictions, Caste Panchayat, Endogamy, Common Culture*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Restrictions on commensality, dress, speech and custom** — even in the field, the lower castes do not accept water/food from the upper castes (and claim Brahminical status).
- **Caste panchayat and assemblies** — their function is to ensure **compliance with caste norms** (no one digresses/disrupts the norms), so they maintain the system as it is and prevent intermixing.
- **Sub-caste is a unit of endogamy**, and **members share a common culture** (distinct social

customs and ritual life within the same caste).

18.2.7 *The Dominant Jati (Dominant Caste)*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Dominant caste** is a concept of the **jati (field) model** — Srinivas does not say Brahmins are dominant; he points to the **Vokkaliga** of Rampura.
- In the **ritual hierarchy** (Sanskrit texts) Brahmins are dominant, but in the field someone else is dominant — and **context defines status**.
- The **three main factors of dominance**: (1) **numerical preponderance**, (2) **economic ownership of land**, (3) **political position**.

EXAMPLE

In **Rampura**, the **Vokkaliga** are dominant: they are peasants (i.e. Shudra varna), but they have numerical preponderance, ownership of land, accumulated wealth, and the village **headman** is a Vokkaliga (political position).

18.2.8 *Westernization and the New Factors of Dominance*

KEY CONCEPT

- With **Westernization**, the factors of dominance recorded **more entries**:
- 1. **Representation in government jobs/bureaucracy** (IAS/IPS, even income-tax inspector).
- 2. **Urban income** (business).
- 3. **English-medium education**.
- 4. **Ritual rank** — still important: a Shudra who owns land, has numbers and political power will claim high status even at the ritual level (the 'final nail in the coffin').

EXAMPLE

- After **land reforms** (the land ceiling/land sealing acts and land fragmentation), the Vokkaliga lost their hold over land — so they began sending their children to **English-medium schools** to retain dominance.
- With **reservation**, ritually low people became bureaucrats and acquired land — their say in the village became dominant even without numerical preponderance.
- So **there has been a shift in the idea of dominance since independence** — earlier numerical preponderance, headman and peasant status sufficed; today Westernization and reservation have added new factors.

18.2.9 *Vote Bank and Horizontal/Vertical Solidarity*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Vote bank** is the **modern avatar (20th century) of caste**. Srinivas recorded it in his book '**Caste: Its 20th Century Avatar**' — caste as a political category in modern times, the **structural differentiation** (Parsons) of caste.
- The first person to talk about the **modern avatar of caste was Ghurye** (caste patriotism, caste association); Srinivas called caste associations **horizontal solidarity**.
- A vote bank is the **fusion of castes** (multiple castes fusing to form a party, in Weber's language). Example: the **Yadavs of UP** were once a vote bank, but now are spread across SP, Congress, BJP and BSP — so there is no neat caste vote bank today.

KEY CONCEPT

- Srinivas's two concepts:
- **Horizontal solidarity** — castes that **cannot be ranked hierarchically** (jatis cannot be ranked) form associations; this happens at the **local level** (nebulous hierarchy).
- **Vertical solidarity** — upper and lower castes integrated for **common interests** (e.g. the appointment of a Dalit President was an attempt by the ruling party to establish ties with the lower caste and shed its 'Brahminical/anti-lower-caste' image, forming a vote bank). At the **national level** the Varna model operates, producing vertical solidarity.
- These two terms are inspired by / linked to **Rudolph and Rudolph** (Lloyd and Susanne Rudolph, Padma Bhushan-awarded political scientists), who gave **vertical mobilization, horizontal mobilization and differential mobilization**.

EXAMPLE

Answer tip: in a question on **Durkheim's mechanical/organic solidarity**, adding Srinivas's **horizontal and vertical solidarity** at the end fetches good marks; in a question on **Marx's historical materialism**, adding that A. R. Desai saw 'bourgeois industrialization instead of socialism' (the Marxian mode-of-production theory failing in India) does the same.

18.2.10 *Conclusion*

KEY CONCEPT

- In conclusion, **Srinivas's perspective helped the sociology of caste become the sociology of jati — an empirical category**, unlike the highly abstract 'caste'.
- Clarification of terms: **Varna** is discovered by Orientalists (found in texts); **Jati** is found in reality; **caste** is a category made by colonialists/census commissioners. India had **only Varna and Jati** — 'caste' is either the Varna model or the Jati model.

QUICK REVISION

- Srinivas discusses features of **jati/sub-caste** (field view), not caste: Varna → Caste → Sub-

caste (fission).

- Features of jati: (nebulous) hierarchy; purity/pollution (no binary); occupational association (Nesfield, not Risley); restrictions on commensality/dress/speech/custom; caste panchayat; sub-caste as endogamous unit; common culture.
- Nebulous hierarchy — middle ranks vague; but he still placed Brahmins top/untouchables bottom (commitment to structural functionalism).
- Smiths = 'Vishwakarma Brahmins' (polluted claiming purity); purity/pollution = ritual, mutable via Sanskritization.
- Dominant caste = jati model; three factors (numerical preponderance, land ownership, political position) + Westernization's new factors (government jobs, urban income, English education, ritual rank); Rampura's Vokkaliga; land reforms → English-medium shift; reservation → new dominance.
- Vote bank = modern avatar (20th century) of caste; Ghurye's caste patriotism → Srinivas's horizontal solidarity; fusion of castes; structural differentiation.
- Horizontal solidarity (unranked, local) vs vertical solidarity (upper+lower for common interest, national/Varna); Rudolph & Rudolph's vertical/horizontal/differential mobilization.
- Conclusion: sociology of caste became sociology of jati (empirical).

Andre Beteille on Caste

19.1 The Segmentary System

19.1.1 *The Two Books and the Weberian Frame*

KEY CONCEPT

- Andre Beteille wrote two landmark books: '**Caste, Class and Power: Changing Patterns of Stratification in a Tanjore Village**' and '**Caste, Old and New**'.
- The title '**Caste, Class and Power**' echoes **Max Weber** (status, class, power) — Beteille replaces '**status**' with '**caste**' (caste represents one's status in the hierarchy).
- Beteille helped European scholars and Indian readers alike understand caste.

19.1.2 *Shripuram: The Three Clusters*

EXAMPLE

- Beteille did field work in **Shripuram** village, **Tanjore** district, Tamil Nadu — on the advice of **M. N. Srinivas**, who told him *not* to study West Bengal (Beteille is a Bengali Brahmin; his own biases would prevent objective data) but to go somewhere completely new.
- The village has **three clusters**: **Agraharam** (Brahmins), **Kudiyana streets** (non-Brahmins), and **Cheri** (Adi Dravidas / untouchables).
- Population order: **non-Brahmins** > **Brahmins** > **Adi Dravidas** (non-Brahmins are the majority).
- There is **complete segregation** based on **purity and pollution**: a Brahmin cannot pass through the untouchables' streets (he would need a ritual bath); the untouchables too regard a Brahmin's presence in Cheri as profane. This is **social distancing based on caste**.

19.1.3 *The Five Brahmin Categories (and their sub-divisions)*

KEY CONCEPT

- Beteille divided the Brahmins of Shripuram into **five categories**: (1) **Kannada Madhva**, (2) **Telugu Smartha**, (3) **Tamil Smartha**, (4) **Tamil Sri Vaishnava**, (5) **Temple Priests**.
- **Smartha** Brahmins are followers of **Shankaracharya (Adi Shankar)** — **Advaita (monism)** — and worship both Shiva and Vishnu. **Sri Vaishnava** Brahmins are followers of **Ramanuja** — **Vishishtadvaita (qualified monism)** — and worship Vishnu (Venkateshwara) only.

- These are **sectarian/doctrinal differences within the same caste** (Brahmins), not merely differences of whom they worship.
- **Temple Priests** are a different league of Brahmins (not every Brahmin is a temple priest).

KEY CONCEPT

- The categories are further subdivided: the **Telugu Smartha** into Kona Seema, Velnadu, Mulhanadu; the **Tamil Smartha** into Vadama, Brihacharanam, Ashtasahasram and Vattiman (and Vadama into Vadadesha and Chozhadesha, Brihacharanam into Kandramanikya, etc.); the **Tamil Sri Vaishnava** into Vadagalai and Thengalai; and the **Temple Priests** into Bhattachar and Kurukkal.
- The point: **Brahmins are not homogeneous** — there are segments within segments (fission within Brahmins).

19.1.4 *Non-Brahmins and Adi Dravidas*

KEY CONCEPT

- The **non-Brahmins** are the people of the **DMK / Self-Respect / anti-Brahmin movement** (led by Periyar, who was the guardian of the untouchables). They are divided into three kinds of castes:
- **Artisan castes** (potter, goldsmith), **Servicing castes** (barber, musicians), and **Cultivating castes** (peasants): **Vellalans**, **Padayachi**, **Gaundans** — the **Vellalans** are the majority and are traditional cultivators working on Brahmin land (the Brahmins are **landlords / mirasdars**).
- The **Adi Dravidas** (untouchables) are divided into **Pallans** (Hindu untouchables) and **Parayans** (Christian untouchables). 'Parai' is a musical instrument played at death processions — associated with the impure.

19.1.5 *Caste as a Segmentary System*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Caste is a segmentary system** — consisting of multiple segments (Brahmin, Smartha, Vadama, Vadadesha... are all 'jatis').
- **The principle of segmentation is constant, but the criteria for segmentation may vary.**
- Before Beteille, people confused caste and sub-caste; Beteille showed these are all **jatis activated in specific contexts** — one thing, defined by context.

19.1.6 *Elastic Ethnicity and Context*

KEY CONCEPT

- Beteille uses **Fredrik Barth's** idea of **elastic ethnicity / elastic boundaries**: which identity (jati) you activate depends on context.
- Example: 'Where are you from?' — New Rajendra Nagar, Central Delhi, Punjabi, or Indian?

All are identities (all are 'jatis'); which one you use depends on context (against Pakistan in cricket you are Indian; in the IPL you are Delhi).

- The same applies to the divisions of caste: in the **context of marriage**, the local sub-sub-caste identity becomes important; in **sectarian/doctrinal** contexts, the Smartha/Sri Vaishnava identity; in **political** contexts, the Brahmin identity.

19.1.7 The Four Levels of Segmentation

KEY CONCEPT

- Beteille's **four levels of segmentation** in Shripuram:
- **Level 1** (clusters: Brahmin/non-Brahmin/Adi Dravida) — activated in the **political context**.
- **Level 2** (sectarian: Smartha vs Sri Vaishnava) — activated in the **sectarian/doctrinal context**.
- **Levels 3 and 4** (sub-sub-castes: Vadadesha vs Chozhadesha, etc.) — activated in the **context of marriage**.
- In the marriage context a Brahmin is not just a Brahmin — he is Smartha or Sri Vaishnava, and within Smartha, Vadadesha cannot marry Chozhadesha. In the sectarian context he is Smartha vs Sri Vaishnava. In the political context, Smartha and Sri Vaishnava **unite as 'Brahmin'** (against non-Brahmin movements) — 'a man is Smartha only in relation to Sri Vaishnava'.

EXAMPLE

- In the **1962 election** in Shripuram, the candidate **Siyar Patta Bhimaran** was a Smartha Brahmin fighting the non-Brahmins; Brahmins (including Sri Vaishnavas) voted for him — his Smartha identity became secondary, and the **Brahmin identity became primary** in the political context.
- This illustrates Srinivas's principle (Beteille is Srinivas's student): **context defines status**.

19.1.8 Caste, Class and Power: Cumulative Inequality in Traditional India

KEY CONCEPT

- In **traditional Shripuram** (before colonial policies), there was a **vertical hierarchy**: Brahmins at the top (ritual hierarchy) and Adi Dravidas at the bottom — but there was also a **secular hierarchy based on wealth and power**.
- Traditional India: **Brahmins were landlords AND political elites**; non-Brahmins were **cultivators on Brahmin land AND politically subordinate**; Adi Dravidas were **landless labourers**.
- Therefore **caste was class** — from your caste came your class, your occupation, your wealth and your power.
- This is **cumulative inequality** (Beteille's term): caste, status, wealth and power are **tightly integrated** — the Brahmins were rank 1 in status, wealth and power (1-1-1); the non-Brahmins rank 2, the Adi Dravidas rank 3.

- You could not change your occupation because you could not change your caste.

KEY CONCEPT

With the **advent of Westernization/colonial policies**, the **forms of stratification began to change** in Tanjore village (the 'changing patterns' of the book's subtitle) — the detailed discussion follows.

CRITICAL POINT

A related note: in Indian sociology there is **no hard distinction between sociology and anthropology** — **Satish Deshpande, Patricia Uberoi and Nandini Sundar** call it a '**metropolitan division of labour**' (sociologists study urban Western societies; anthropologists study rural/tribal societies) — which is nothing but the **politics of knowledge**. Beteille used field work, which sociologists do too.

QUICK REVISION

- Two books: 'Caste, Class and Power' (Tanjore/Shripuram) and 'Caste, Old and New'; title echoes Max Weber (status→caste).
- Shripuram: Agraharam (Brahmins), Kudiya (non-Brahmins), Cheri (Adi Dravidas); non-Brahmins > Brahmins > Adi Dravidas; complete segregation (purity/pollution).
- Five Brahmin categories: Kannada Madhva, Telugu Smartha, Tamil Smartha, Tamil Sri Vaishnava, Temple Priests; Smartha (Shankaracharya, Advaita) vs Sri Vaishnava (Ramanuja, Vishishtadvaita).
- Non-Brahmins: artisan/servicing/cultivating castes (Vellalans majority); Adi Dravidas: Pallans (Hindu) vs Parayans (Christian).
- Caste = segmentary system; principle of segmentation constant, criteria vary; Brahmins not homogeneous (fission).
- Elastic ethnicity (Barth): which jati activates depends on context (marriage → sub-sub-caste; sectarian → Smartha/Sri Vaishnava; political → Brahmin).
- Four levels: L1 political (Brahmin), L2 sectarian (Smartha/Sri Vaishnava), L3-4 marriage (Vadadesha/Chozhadesha); 'context defines status'.
- Traditional India: caste = class (Brahmins = landlords + political elites); cumulative inequality (Beteille); westernization begins changing stratification.

19.2 Caste, Class and Power

19.2.1 Segments as Status Groups (Weber)

KEY CONCEPT

- Caste is a **segmentary system** whose segments (Brahmin, Smartha, Vadama, etc.) are **status groups** in themselves — in Weber's sense.

- A **status group** is a community marked by a **distinct lifestyle** and **endogamy**. **Max Weber** gave the **Brahmin** as his example of a status group in India.
- **Beteille = Max Weber + field work**: he accepts that Brahmin is a status group, but shows it is **not homogeneous** — each segment within it is itself a status group (a jati).
- So the Smartha will marry only a Smartha (endogamy), not a Sri Vaishnava — but the Smartha **can vote for** a Sri Vaishnava, because in the political context they are both Brahmins.

19.2.2 *Traditional Shripuram: The Rank Matrix (Cumulative Inequality)*

KEY CONCEPT

- In **traditional Shripuram**, there were two hierarchies: the **ritual hierarchy** (Brahmin > non-Brahmin > Adi Dravida) and the **secular hierarchy** (based on wealth and power).
- **Brahmins** were **landlords (mirasdars)** and **political elites** (the headman); **non-Brahmins** were **cultivators** on Brahmin land and **political subordinates**; **Adi Dravidas** were **landless labourers** (the lowest, like bonded labour).
- Appointment was based on **caste, not merit** — a **patrimonial** bureaucracy (Weber).
- This is Beteille's **rank matrix**: caste, class and power run together (1-1-1, 2-2-2, 3-3-3) — your power and wealth were **derived from your status** (Weber), i.e. **caste = class = power**, tightly integrated (cumulative inequality).
- (Contrast with Srinivas's Rampura, where the Vokkaliga peasants were dominant; in Shripuram the Brahmins are landlords and elites.)

19.2.3 *Economic Modernization: Land, Occupations, Education*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Economic modernization** includes private property, cash economy, industrialization, new means of production, real estate, and the **free market economy**.
- Its effects on Shripuram:
 1. **Land became a marketable commodity** — with a cash economy land can be bought and sold, so land was **freed from the clutches of the caste structure** (the Brahmins began loosening their hold over land ownership).
 2. **Rise of new occupations** — no longer only landlord/cultivator/labourer; now IAS/IPS officers, civil engineers, computer professionals.
 3. **Rise of English-medium education** — education as human capital (improving skilled, productive labour and hence GDP).

19.2.4 Political Modernization: Power Without Land

KEY CONCEPT

- **Political modernization** introduced a **democratic political structure** (universal adult franchise, political parties, Panchayati Raj, vote banks; the caste panchayat weakened).
- Its uniqueness: it gives you **power even without land ownership** — the basis of power is no longer only land.
- **Party politics** replaced village **caste politics** — and with parties came **networking outside the village** (before, a Vadama Brahmin had no contacts outside Shripuram; a BJP member does).
- This also gave rise to **elites** — 'lions and foxes' (manipulators) — produced by the democratic structure.
- Impact: (1) **land ownership became accessible to non-Brahmin cultivators**; (2) **political power moved to non-Brahmin elites** — democracy is majority rule, and the non-Brahmins have the numbers.
- Yet party politics now **runs caste politics** (parties made on caste lines) — tradition and modernity coexist (Yogendra Singh; Parsons' pattern variables A and B).

19.2.5 The Changing Rank Matrix: Autonomy of Class and Power

KEY CONCEPT

- In the traditional rank matrix, the **degree of correlation between caste, class and power was very strong** (one-to-one). After modernization, the **correlation is weak** — the **degree of variation is strong**.
- There is a **shift in the rank matrix**: no hard-line segregation, mobility, and fragmented boundaries.
- A **Brahmin need no longer be rank 1 in power and wealth** (though still 1 in status); a **non-Brahmin can be wealthier and more powerful than a Brahmin**; even **Adi Dravidas** can be powerful (via reservation and education).
- **Class and power gained autonomy from caste** — the village was undifferentiated before; now **structural differentiation** begins.

19.2.6 Caste Becoming Heterogeneous: A New Status Group

KEY CONCEPT

- Beteille's conclusion: **caste in modern India is becoming heterogeneous** — in terms of **income, occupation and education**.
- A **new status group is emerging based on achieved statuses** (income, education), replacing the old status group based on **ascribed features (birth)**.
- This is also a **status group** — its members have a **distinct lifestyle** (e.g. the **Indian Foreign Service** officers, with their distinct elitism, manners and social-club etiquette).

- A **new caste is developing** in the Indian village: one for which **ritual knowledge is no longer important** — it has been replaced by **English and etiquettes**.

EXAMPLE

Example: a Brahmin typist who daily sees an Adi Dravida IAS officer giving him orders feels humiliated — yet may even want his daughter to marry that officer. Change comes through such marriages: the upper-caste man marrying the lower-caste woman (or vice versa) shows caste becoming **heterogeneous**.

CRITICAL POINT

Modernization gives meritocracy, free market, English-medium education and egalitarianism — but it is also creating a new hierarchy. It is no longer caste-based; it is based on **who has adopted westernization, and to what extent**.

19.2.7 *Modernistic vs Modernizing*

KEY CONCEPT

- Beteille distinguishes two kinds of people (drawing on Srinivas's 'externally vs internally westernized'):
- **Modernistic** (externally westernized) — those who have **appropriated Western symbols/outlook** (dress, food, appearance) to look and feel Western.
- **Modernizing** (internally westernized) — those who **promote Western values/thinking** (not merely Western appearance).
- A democracy needs **internally westernized** people, but India has more and more **externally westernized** people — they look Western but 'speak Hindu' — and this is **a threat to democracy**.
- Beteille hints that **some Indian elites are in danger of becoming more modernistic than modernizing**.

19.2.8 *Conclusion: The Paradox of Modernization*

KEY CONCEPT

Beteille notes **the paradox of modernization in India**: it has **given birth to new castes** — castes **imported directly from the West** (e.g. the IFS officer), along with the **Western ideology of an open society**.

QUICK REVISION

- Caste = segmentary system; segments are status groups (Weber: Brahmin as status group); Beteille = Weber + field work; Smartha marries Smartha (endogamy) but votes for Sri Vaishnava (politics).
- Traditional Shripuram rank matrix: Brahmin = landlord (mirasdar) + political elite; non-

Brahmin = cultivator + subordinate; Adi Dravida = landless labourer; caste = class = power (cumulative inequality); patrimonial appointment.

- Economic modernization: land marketable (freed from caste), new occupations, English-medium education (human capital).
- Political modernization: democratic structure → power without land; party politics → networking; elites (lions/foxes); land to non-Brahmins, power to non-Brahmin elites (numbers).
- Rank matrix shifts: weak correlation, strong variation; class/power autonomous from caste; structural differentiation.
- Caste becomes heterogeneous (income/occupation/education); new status group on achieved statuses; ritual → English/etiquettes; new caste (IFS).
- Modernistic (externally westernized) vs modernizing (internally westernized) — threat to democracy.
- Paradox: modernization creates new (imported) castes + open society ideology.

Perspectives on the Modern Avatar of Caste

20.1 Backwardness and the Measurement Problem

The central idea discussed (from a newspaper article the students were asked to read sociologically): **anybody can claim backwardness — but how do you measure backwardness?** Communities now claim reservation by claiming backwardness.

KEY CONCEPT

- SC communities claim backwardness on the basis of **long social discrimination** with historical roots.
- ST communities claim backwardness on the basis of **geographical isolation** (they were not mainstreamed; reservation was an **entry into the Western world** / a gateway to meritocracy, which was geographically isolated from the tribals).
- OBC communities are '**other** backward' — other than SC/ST — and their backwardness is **social and educational**.
- How do you **measure** social and educational backwardness? The **Mandal Commission** did this with its indicators/criteria — but OBC status is **not** based on one uniform all-India scale: **every state has its own criteria for backwardness** (which makes OBC reservation the most contentious).
- EWS (economically weaker sections) is a category, not a caste — but it is **not open to those who already have reservation** (SC/ST/OBC are subtracted), so EWS means the economically weaker among the **upper castes/generals**.

KEY CONCEPT

There are many communities that were once backward and have become **forward** (through reservation); and many that were once forward and have become **backward** — backward relative to their own earlier position, or relative to those against whom they were once forward.

20.2 The Three Dimensions of Reservation Demands

KEY CONCEPT

- **Dimension 1** — reservation demand is made by dominant castes, but the dominant caste is **not a homogeneous category**: the Yadavs are not dominant all over India (or even all over UP), and not all Yadavs are dominant. So who demands reservation? The '**backwards who**

are from the forwards' — the backward forwards.

- **Dimension 2 — the presence of 'backward forwards'** (backwards among the forwards) reflects **heterogeneity and division within the backwards**.
- **Dimension 3 — when the backward forwards demand reservation, it consolidates caste identities and weakens social justice:** they have class consciousness *and* caste consciousness; they fight for economic upliftment but within the same caste — so the class struggle carries a flavour of caste.
- This yields a likely exam question: **'Reservation demands consolidate caste identity and weaken social justice. Comment.'**

KEY CONCEPT

The backward forwards feel **relative deprivation** against the forward forwards, and want to **emulate** them — earlier the lower castes emulated the upper castes; now there is **emulation within the caste** (the backward forwards emulating the forward forwards), which is a striving for **social mobility**.

20.3 Classization of Caste (D. L. Sheth)

KEY CONCEPT

- The term '**classization of caste**' was given by the Indian sociologist **D. L. Sheth**.
- It is a **two-fold process**:
 1. The **release of individual members of all castes from the religiously sanctioned status hierarchy** (the status hierarchy is no longer the determining factor).
 2. Their **interests and identities attach to organisations and categories** relevant to the **urban industrial system and modern politics** — party membership is now more important than caste membership (as Beteille also said).
- In short: **a process by which caste loses its traditional functions and acquires a new economic interest and political identity — structural differentiation.**

KEY CONCEPT

- Beteille's related point: **before modernization, caste was class; after modernization, there are classes within the caste** — one caste can include a landlord, an officer and a cultivator (Brahmins, non-Brahmins and Adi Dravidas are all open to everything).
- Caste is **evolving** — like a snake shedding its old skin — and this is the **new avatar of caste**.

20.4 AJGAR: The Dominant Castes

KEY CONCEPT

- M. N. Srinivas called the dominant caste an 'ajgar' (python) — the acronym **AJGAR** = **A**hir, **J**at, **G**ujjar, **R**ajput (the dominant castes; Ahir = Yadav).
- These are the castes engaged in real-life reservation politics — the 'backward forwards' demanding reservation.

QUICK REVISION

- Measurement of backwardness: SC (social discrimination), ST (geographical isolation; reservation = gateway to meritocracy), OBC (social + educational), EWS (economically weaker, but upper castes only).
- Mandal Commission set OBC criteria, but every state has its own criteria of backwardness.
- Three dimensions: (1) reservation demand by dominant castes (but dominant caste $\neq$ homogeneous); (2) backward forwards $\rightarrow$ heterogeneity within backwards; (3) reservation consolidates caste identity, weakens social justice.
- Backward forwards feel relative deprivation, emulate forward forwards (emulation within caste = social mobility).
- Classization of caste (D. L. Sheth): release from status hierarchy + attachment to modern organisations/politics; caste loses traditional functions, gains economic/political identity (structural differentiation).
- Beteille: before modernization caste = class; after, classes within caste.
- AJGAR (Srinivas's 'ajgar'/python) = Ahir, Jat, Gujjar, Rajput (dominant castes).

Louis Dumont on Caste: Purity, Impurity and Hierarchy

21.1 Dumont as Indologist and Structuralist

KEY CONCEPT

- **Louis Dumont** is a French **Indologist / Orientalist** — he relied on **ancient Sanskrit texts** to understand caste (he even learnt Sanskrit).
- **Indology is about WHAT you read** (ancient Sanskrit texts), not HOW you read them. Dumont's distinctive contribution is the method he used: he read the Indological texts through **structuralism** (the theoretical perspective of **Levi-Strauss**).
- **Structuralism** reads the world through **binary opposites** (good/bad, rich/poor, hot/cold, life/death): you cannot make sense of one category without its opposite. These oppositional categories are **cognitive categories** — they structure how we make sense of everyday life.
- Dumont therefore looked for the **binary opposites within the ancient Sanskrit texts** on caste.

21.2 Bouglé's Three Features and the Underlying Principle

KEY CONCEPT

- Before Dumont, the French scholar **Celestine Bouglé** (Dumont's intellectual predecessor, himself influenced by Levi-Strauss) had identified **three features of caste**:
- 1. **Hierarchy** — ritual hierarchy (status-based; the top is ritually pure, the bottom ritually impure).
- 2. **Hereditary occupation and specialization** — trade secrets passed through caste (caste itself acted like a 'patent').
- 3. **Repulsion (separation)** — castes maintain distance from each other, through **endogamy** and **commensality** (restrictions on whom to take food/water from), e.g. the Agraharam/Kudiyana/Cheri separation.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Dumont's key insight**: beneath these three features (the superstructures) lies one **underlying base** — the **binary opposition of purity and impurity**.

- Hierarchy has the pure at top and impure at bottom; occupation is divided into **pure occupations** (priestly ritual) and **impure occupations** (manual scavenging, menial tasks); repulsion separates the pure castes from the impure ones.
- So the **underlying principle governing the features of caste is the binary opposition of purity and impurity**.

KEY CONCEPT

This is the sociologist's task — **debunking / revealing what is hidden** (Peter Berger's idea of sociology as debunking; Robert Merton's 'latent' functions): every sociologist reveals something hidden, and Dumont revealed the base beneath the superstructure.

21.3 Purity and Impurity as the Ideology of Caste

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont believes **caste is the central feature of Hindu society**, established on the principle of purity and impurity.
- But **purity and impurity go beyond caste** — they govern everything in Hindu life: no haircut on Tuesday, Navratri fasts (no chicken), **silk is pure while cotton is impure**, death brings 12 days of impurity, childbirth brings impurity, menstruation is ritually impure (the **Sabarimala** case), etc.
- Even in non-vegetarian food there is purity/impurity: for a Bengali, **fish is pure** (offered to the goddess) but chicken is impure.
- The consciousness of the Hindu is shaped by purity/impurity — it is about **inequality** (pure/impure), not equality.

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont's propositions (to write down):
- **The ideology of the caste system is based on the binary opposition of purity and impurity.**
- **Caste is a set of economic, political and social relationships sustained by religious values.**
- **Social supremacy in Indian society is closely associated with ritual status, articulated as the oppositional unity of pure and impure.**
- **The rules of pure and impure are central to the establishment and functioning of the caste system.**

21.4 The Texts: P. V. Kane and Harita

KEY CONCEPT

- To decipher the purity/impurity principle, Dumont referred to two key texts: **P. V. Kane's 'History of Dharmashastra'** and **Harita**.
- **Harita** spoke of **three kinds of purity**: (1) **Kula** (clan/family — descent from an ancestor), (2) **Sharira** (the body), and (3) **objects of everyday use**.
- **P. V. Kane** held that the purity of a caste is **maintained through endogamy**.

21.5 Status over Power: The Supremacy of the Religious

KEY CONCEPT

- In India, **ritual status is more important than secular power**: the king employs priests; priests do not employ kings.
- Dumont's line: **'In India, status is more important than power'** — it does not matter whether you are an IAS officer or the Prime Minister; what matters to the Hindu is **who is ritually pure (status-wise)**.
- The notion of purity/impurity comes from the **supremacy given to religious values in Indian society**; ritual supremacy is accorded more importance than secular power.
- (**T. N. Madan** and **Ashis Nandy** similarly say religion is 'in our blood' — so how can one talk of secularism?)

KEY CONCEPT

If everyone — even kings and low castes — follows the purity/impurity rituals made by Brahmins, then everyone has been **Sanskritized**, and the way one thinks is **Brahminical**; hence superiority goes to the Brahmins.

21.6 India vs the West: Homo Hierarchicus vs Homo Aequalis

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont compares Indian and Western society in his classic book **'Homo Hierarchicus'** (the West being 'European/American'), again using **binary opposites**:
- **Hierarchy vs Equality** — Indian society is **hierarchical** (based on purity/impurity); Western society is **egalitarian** (no purity/impurity).
- **Holism vs Individualism** — in India **man does not exist** (only caste/society exists; caste rules regulate you); in the West the **individual exists** (free, governed only by free speech).
- In India, the individual exists only as the **Sanyasi (renouncer)** — who is **casteless** ('don't ask a sadhu his jati').
- Dumont calls Hindu society **'Homo Hierarchicus'** and the West **'Homo Aequalis'**.

21.7 Homo Major and Homo Minor: Holism vs Individualism

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont coined two further terms: '**Homo Major**' (India) and '**Homo Minor**' (the West).
- **Homo Major** — in India, **society prevails over the individual** (man is a **collective being**; e.g. an unhappy couple does not divorce because 'what will society say?'). Indians are characterised more by **holism, religion and hierarchy** — religious principles are more important than the political/economic domain.
- **Homo Minor** — in the West, **the individual prevails over society**. The values governing Western people are **equality/egalitarianism, free market economy, a highly rational political system, democracy, individualism and secularism** (complete separation of state and religion — you are a **citizen first, Christian second**; in India you are Hindu first).
- The **exception** proves each rule: in India, individualism appears only through the **renouncer (Sanyasi)**; in the West, society-over-individual appears only in **totalitarianism / hyper-nationalism** (e.g. Hitler's German consciousness).

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont is describing the **traditional Hindu society** (the Indological version, via texts including the Dharma Shastras) and the **post-French-Revolution Western society** — he is not saying one is good and the other bad, only that their **governing values differ**.
- Dumont greatly admired **Ambedkar** — who also held that **democracy and Hinduism are opposite to each other**.

21.8 Temporary vs Permanent Impurity

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont distinguished **two types of impurity**:
- **Temporary impurity** — the victim is the **upper caste** (no haircut on certain days, death and birth impurities). It can be **purified through rituals** — for the upper caste, pollution is **like anomie** (a temporary phase, fixed by purification).
- **Permanent impurity** — the victim is the **lower caste**: their occupations (menial tasks) are permanently polluted, and their impurity **cannot be purified by any ritual**.
- Hence untouchability is permanent for the lower castes, while the upper castes can always 'purify' themselves.

21.9 Dumont's Field Work: The Pramalai Kallar

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont is **both Indological and empirical** (integrating both, unlike Ghurye who was largely Indological): he also did **field work**.
- His field-study book is on the '**Pramalai Kallar**' sub-caste (Madurai, Tamil Nadu) — '**A South Indian Sub-Caste: Social Organization and Religion of the Pramalai Kallar**'.
- In **Homo Hierarchicus** he used the **Varna model**; in the field study he used the **Jati model**.
- Even in the field he found the **binary opposition of purity/impurity** being followed — residential separation, ritual separation, endogamy and food restrictions among the Pramalai Kallar — proving that Hindu religious values govern the cognition of all Hindus, North or South.

21.10 The Binary Oppositions of the Caste Structure

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont pushed binary opposition to its extreme in describing the caste structure, as a chain of oppositions:
- Savarna vs Avarna** (Brahmin/Kshatriya/Vaishya/Shudra vs the untouchables).
- Caste vs non-caste** (the four varnas vs the untouchables / Ati-Shudra / Adi Dravida).
- Dvija vs Ekaj** (twice-born B,K,V vs the once-born Shudra).
- Priestly vs non-priestly** (Brahmin vs K,V,S).
- Warrior vs non-warrior** (Kshatriya vs B,V,S).
- Dominant vs non-dominant** (Brahmin vs K,V,S — even the dominant castes, after gaining secular power, still claim Kshatriya status).
- Brahmin vs non-Brahmin** (B vs K,V,S — the same opposition Beteille found).

KEY CONCEPT

Conclusion: Dumont believed Indian society is based on **cognitive structures** which have their origin in **religious consciousness, rooted in history** (the Indological texts). His approach is therefore called the **cognitive-historical approach**.

21.11 Substantialization of Caste

KEY CONCEPT

- On **social change in caste** (the modern avatar of caste — as Ghurye, Srinivas and Beteille also discussed), Dumont argues:
- Earlier castes were **interdependent** (specialization and division of labour); today they are **no longer interdependent** — every caste has become a **self-sufficient, impenetrable block**,

identical to and in competition with one another (caste associations, vote banks, e.g. the All-India Thakur Association).

- He calls this process the '**substantialization of caste**' — the same phenomenon Ghurye called '**caste patriotism**' and Srinivas called the '**vote bank**'.
- In traditional India there was **integration between castes** (so he becomes a Durkheimian); in modern India there is **conflict between castes** (so he becomes a Marxist).

QUICK REVISION

- Dumont = Indologist (Sanskrit texts) + structuralist (Levi-Strauss); reads Indological texts through binary opposites.
- Bouglé's three features (hierarchy, hereditary occupation, repulsion) → Dumont's underlying base = binary opposition of purity/impurity.
- Purity/impurity governs all Hindu life (haircut, Navratri, silk vs cotton, death/birth, menstruation/Sabarimala); caste = central feature of Hindu society.
- Texts: P. V. Kane (History of Dharmashastra; purity via endogamy) and Harita (kula/sharira/everyday objects).
- Ritual status > secular power ('kings employ priests'); 'status is more important than power'; religious supremacy.
- India vs West: hierarchy vs equality; holism vs individualism; Homo Hierarchicus vs Homo Aequalis; Homo Major (society over individual) vs Homo Minor (individual over society); renouncer = only Indian individual; totalitarianism = only Western holism.
- Temporary impurity (upper caste, purifiable, like anomie) vs permanent impurity (lower caste, never purified).
- Field work: Pramalai Kallar (Madurai) — Jati model; purity/impurity found even in the field.
- Binary oppositions: Savarna/Avarna; caste/non-caste; Dvija/Ekaj; priestly/non-priestly; warrior/non-warrior; dominant/non-dominant; Brahmin/non-Brahmin.
- Conclusion: cognitive structures from religious consciousness rooted in history = cognitive-historical approach.
- Substantialization of caste: interdependence → self-sufficient competing blocks (like Ghurye's caste patriotism, Srinivas's vote bank).

Indian Sociologists on Caste: Summary and Critique

22.1 Summarizing the Four Scholars

KEY CONCEPT

- **G. S. Ghurye** — follows the **Orientalist** line: his six features of caste were the discovery of the Orientalists (who first translated the Sanskrit texts); his views were a **reaction** to the Orientalist idea of caste as responsible for 'underdevelopment'. He held caste **integrates** us (part of our culture). His account is **Indological, Evolutionary** (evolutionism from Darwin/Spencer) **and Comparative**.
- **M. N. Srinivas** — marks a **clear departure from Orientalism**: the first to start the **field view** officially/professionally/academically (earlier field workers like S. C. Roy existed, but not 'officially'). He used the **structural-functional approach** (whose origin is evolutionism, via Herbert Spencer), studying the **Coorgs** to show how joint family, marriage, rituals and caste **integrate** society. He developed **two concepts from field work**: **Sanskritization** (book/Varna view) **and dominant caste** (field/Jati view).
- **Louis Dumont** — an **Indologist** who believes **Brahmins are superior**: his line '**power is inferior to status**'. His two hierarchies are **pure/impure** and **status over power** (unlike Srinivas's ritual/secular). Against Weber (class, status, power independent) and Marx (power from money), Dumont says the top of the hierarchy has status, class and power together.
- **Andre Beteille** — 'slaps everyone': by showing **Brahmins are not homogeneous** (Smartha/Sri Vaishnava, further sub-divided), he exposed the **inadequacy of a sociology of caste running on Brahmanical lines** — how can Brahmins be superior if they are themselves divided?

CRITICAL POINT

- **The common thread**: Ghurye, Srinivas and Dumont all end up **claiming Brahminical superiority** — Ghurye (hierarchy with Brahmins at top; Vedic Aryan culture diffused south via Sage Agastya; Kartik replaced by Ganesh in the North), Srinivas (Sanskritization implies everyone wants to become Brahmin), Dumont (status belongs to Brahmins). Beteille is the critique of all three.
- **Summary keywords**: Ghurye = Indological/Evolutionary/Comparative; Srinivas = empirical/fieldwork/structural-functional; Dumont = Indology + Structuralism (binaries:

pure/impure, status/power); Beteille = the critic.

22.2 Critique of Srinivas: Sanskritization

CRITICAL POINT

- **1. Sanskritization legitimises Brahminical supremacy even in the field view** — it portrays Brahmins as the symbol/icon of civilisation, as if one cannot live without imbibing Brahminical culture. (Analogy: **Jevons' paradox** — promoting fuel-efficient cars ends up burning more coal.)
- **2. It ignores other religious traditions** — Islam, Christianity and non-Hindu traditions. **Punjab got Islamized, not Sanskritized** (Gurudwara architecture is Indo-Islamic; Kabir's couplets are borrowed from the Quran; the ghazal mixes Sufi and Punjabi folk). It thus equates Indian culture with Hindu culture. **Yogendra Singh** talked of Islamization; the concept of 'multiple traditions' was given by **S. C. Dube** (whom Yogendra Singh read). Sanskritization presents India as a **monolithic Hindu India**.
- **3. The reference groups have changed** — no longer upper-caste Hindu groups, but **secular, westernized groups** (an engineer at Facebook/Silicon Valley). So Sanskritization is **not empirically valid today**. Instead we see **Dalit Assertion** (Bhim Sena, Dalit Panther) — asserting their own identity, not claiming Brahminical status. Beteille: in the light of **affirmative action and constitutional safeguards**, Dalits demand status **on humanitarianism, not at par with Brahmins**.
- **4. Sanskritization fails to capture inverted reality** — **Brahmins emulating Dalits: 'Shudraization'** (a term by **Shyamlal**, a Rajasthan professor; upper castes wanting to become low caste for reservation benefits), which **D. N. Majumdar** calls '**desanskritization**'.

22.3 Critique of Srinivas: Dominant Caste

CRITICAL POINT

- Two **strands of critique** on the role of numerical preponderance:
- **Strand 1 — numbers do not decide dominance: D. N. Majumdar** — scheduled castes preponderate in many villages, yet the upper castes exercise power and authority (as headmen). **Adrian (A. C.) Mayer** coined '**village patriotism**' — affiliation to the village is so strong that the numerical preponderance of the low castes is **subsumed to the development of the village**, even if led by upper castes (village solidarity overrides caste inequality; patriotism legitimises hierarchy).
- **Strand 2 — numbers do decide dominance: Beteille** — before economic modernization the land-owning class (Brahmin) was powerful; with **land reforms** the big land-owning class **ceased to be** the source of dominance, and **numerical support became the decisive factor** (democracy is about numbers). Till 1946 a Brahmin ran the village panchayat; after **universal adult suffrage**, numbers mattered more than ritual status — hence the **non-**

Brahmin movement (and the rise of the **Kallar** sub-caste in Madurai politics; DMK/ADMK cabinets have 4–5 Kallar ministers).

- In conclusion, **the criteria of dominance vary from village to village.**

CRITICAL POINT

Even the dominant castes now seek reservation — Marathas, Jats, Reddys, Patils, Patidars (feeling relative deprivation). **'They have to go down so that they can go up.'** This makes **desanskritization the new field view and Sanskritization the old (book) view** — in the field we now see the dominant caste emulating the low caste (to get the backward tag). **Satish Deshpande** calls them **'backward forward'** (context makes them backward or forward).

22.4 T. K. Oommen's Multiple Power Structures

KEY CONCEPT

- **T. K. Oommen** (JNU Professor Emeritus): the concept of dominant caste **does not capture the alternate situations of dominance** — e.g. a **numerically weak caste owning most of the land and wealth**, or a **numerically strong caste that is economically and ritually depressed**.
- He therefore talks of **multiple power structures**: in a village there are **'power reservoirs'** (the pool of powerful people) and **'power exercisers'** (only the few owners of the reservoir actually exercise power).

22.5 Secularization of Caste and Caste Outside India

KEY CONCEPT

- **Secularization of caste** (a concept of **D. L. Sheth**, alongside his 'classification of caste'): the **ritual function of caste is getting over**, and caste adopts a new **secular function of power** — its modern avatar, the **vote bank**.
- **Caste outside India / in every religion**: caste exists in every religion — Christianity (Dalit Christians), Sikhism (Dalit Sikhs), and Islam (the **Arzal** = the lower/untouchable groups, vs the **Ashraf** = the upper groups).
- **The function of caste in modern times is political** (the vote bank) — earlier it had only a ritual function.

QUICK REVISION

- Ghurye = Orientalist/Indological/Evolutionary/Comparative (caste integrates); Srinivas = first official field view, structural-functional (Coorgs), Sanskritization (Varna) + dominant caste (Jati); Dumont = Indologist + structuralist, 'power inferior to status'; Beteille = critic (Brahmins not homogeneous).

- Common to Ghurye/Srinivas/Dumont: Brahminical superiority; Beteille exposes it.
- Critique of Sanskritization: legitimises Brahminical supremacy; ignores other traditions (Punjab got Islamized; Yogendra Singh; S. C. Dube's 'multiple traditions'); reference groups changed (secular/westernized; Dalit Assertion); inverted reality (Shudraization/Shyamlal; desanskritization/D. N. Majumdar).
- Critique of dominant caste: numbers don't decide (D. N. Majumdar; Adrian Mayer's 'village patriotism') vs numbers do decide (Beteille, land reforms, universal suffrage, non-Brahmin movement, Kallar); criteria vary village to village.
- Dominant castes seek reservation (Maratha/Jat/Reddy/Patil/Patidar) → desanskritization = new field view; Satish Deshpande's 'backward forward'.
- T. K. Oommen: alternate situations of dominance; multiple power structures (power reservoir vs power exercisers).
- Secularization of caste (D. L. Sheth) = ritual function over, secular function (vote bank); caste in every religion (Arzal/Ashraf; Dalit Christians/Sikhs).

Caste, Democracy and Caste Associations

23.1 Caste and Democracy

23.1.1 Answering 'Sanskritization vs Westernization'

EXAMPLE

- A model answer to 'Differentiate between Sanskritization and Westernization' (10 marks):
- **Introduce** — M. N. Srinivas introduced both concepts to explain social change. **Sanskritization** = imitation of the cultural lifestyle of the upper castes by low castes/tribals; **Westernization** = a process of institutional, ideological and technological change during 150 years of British rule.
- **Contrast** — Sanskritization promotes a **sacred outlook** (copying Brahminical lifestyle) and **mobility within caste**; Westernization promotes a **secular outlook** (egalitarianism, meritocracy) and **mobility outside caste**. Sanskritization was availed by the **low castes**; Westernization by the **upper castes** (primary westernization).
- **Dynamic relation** — Westernization can be a prerequisite to Sanskritization; they are also opposed.
- **Critique** — Yogendra Singh: Sanskritization is orthogenetic change, Westernization is heterogenetic.
- The lesson: **address the demand** — a 4th/5th-attempt student who dumps the whole Coorg case study and the three dimensions of Westernization (institutional/ideological/technological) fails the 'difference' question, while a first-attempt student who sticks to the contrast scores. Competition is about **addressing the demand**, not knowing more.

23.1.2 Further Critiques: Dube, Oommen, and Dumont

CRITICAL POINT

- **S. C. Dube** (field study in **Shamirpet, Telangana**) — against the dominant-caste concept: 'where is the dominant caste — village, district, region, state or national?' Srinivas did not clarify; one village's dominant caste is not the next village's. Moreover, it is **not the caste but individuals/families** that are dominant (e.g. Mulayam Singh Yadav's family in UP/Bihar).
- **T. K. Oommen** (recap) — **multiple power structures**: 'power reservoir' (a community that is a pool of power — e.g. the **Meena** among STs; farmers as a reservoir) and 'power exercisers' (the few who actually exercise that power — e.g. the **Tikaits** in the farmers' protest).

CRITICAL POINT

- **Critique of Louis Dumont:**
- 1. His understanding of caste is based on a **static, book view** — he did not see the **evolution of caste** (unlike Ghurye); caste is no longer rigid.
- 2. The **purity/impurity** category projects the **Brahminical view** of Hindu society, ignoring the **subjectivities** of purity (Dalits also claim themselves pure).
- 3. He **ignored the protest movements** in Indian history that questioned the ideology of caste division, projecting Hindu religious values as a universal category (as if there is no conflict against those values).
- 4. **McKim Marriott** — *Homo Hierarchicus* is a '**speculative sketch of a pair of models shaped by the textual ideology of social science**' — Dumont's models (homo hierarchicus/aequalis/major/minor) are ideal types projected as pure/absolute types.
- 5. **Nicholas Dirks** (*Castes of Mind*) — challenged Dumont's 'power is inferior to status' as absurd: **purohits were only advisors to kings** (kings employed them); there is no **diametrically opposite relation** between status and power. (Analogy: is the Prime Minister inferior to the President? It depends on the scale — head of government vs head of state.) Purohits served kings — because **power matters**. Brahmin rulers were rare in ancient India (only the Satavahanas claimed Brahminical status).
- 6. **Veena Das** — in villages the relation between castes is **not always hierarchical**: there is also **coordination and cooperation** — a relation of **reciprocity** (e.g. the jajmani relation is patron–client, not purely hierarchical).

23.1.3 Caste and Democracy: The Classical Discourse**KEY CONCEPT**

- **Ambedkar** believed **Hinduism and democracy are opposite** — democracy is about equality, while Hinduism is established on the inequality of caste.
- Initially it was believed that **caste and democracy are two opposite social categories** — democracy as an open system that would weaken or abolish caste.
- But caste became a reality in India **only with the British** — the **caste census** became an instrument that **created caste** (classifying people into high and low, giving the hierarchy an official stamp).

KEY CONCEPT

- The **classical sociologists** (Ghurye, Srinivas, Dumont, Beteille) initiated the **discourse on caste and democracy** by examining the **dynamic relation (static and fluid)** between them.
- This analysis helped the **modern political sociologists** (the Rudolphs) to frame a **hypothesis**: '**with more democratization, you get more caste associations**' — i.e. more horizontal solidarities.

23.1.4 Ghurye: Caste Patriotism

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ghurye** was the first to discuss the **politicization of caste** (the phrase was coined by **Rajni Kothari**).
- Traditionally **caste had integrated India**; with the British and the **caste census**, caste assumed a **new (political) avatar**.
- In **1932** the non-Brahmins mobilized against the Brahmins in South India (the census revealed Brahmin dominance in wealth, education and representation). On the surface this seemed to weaken the hierarchy, but it actually **generated a new collective sentiment — caste solidarity** — which Ghurye termed **caste patriotism**.

23.1.5 Srinivas: From Vertical to Horizontal Solidarity

KEY CONCEPT

- **Srinivas elaborated Ghurye's thesis**: 'far from disappearing with modernization, caste was now experiencing horizontal consolidation'.
- **Before independence** there was **vertical solidarity** — the interdependence of upper and lower castes (the jajmani relation; in Coorg and Rampura, Brahmins depended on the lower castes and vice versa).
- **After independence**, vertical solidarity weakened and was replaced by **horizontal solidarity**: castes formed their **own associations** (Jat Sabha, All-India Thakur Sabha, Brahman Sabha, Reddy association).
- How did this happen? The **Constitution gave everyone the right to form associations** (a fundamental right); **democracy runs on competition**, so these consolidated caste associations compete with each other — democracy turned out to be, in effect, **competition between caste associations** rather than between free individuals.
- This is a **change in the structure, not a change of the structure** — caste remains; only the form of solidarity has changed, from vertical (across castes) to horizontal (within the caste).

23.1.6 Dumont and Beteille: Substantialization and the New Caste

KEY CONCEPT

Dumont analysed the same process and gave it a new name: '**caste did not disappear with economic and political change, but its logic definitely got altered**' — earlier caste was a **structure**, now it has become a **substance** (impenetrable universal blocks). This is the '**substantialization of caste**' (as more modernization, more substantialization).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Beteille's** one-line answer on caste and democracy: **before democracy Shripuram had a highly undifferentiated caste structure (caste was class); after modernization, the old caste was replaced by a NEW caste** — the title of his book '**Caste, Old and New**'.

- The **new caste** = **status groups** — English-speaking professionals for whom **ritual knowledge is no longer important**; what matters is party etiquette, the way you speak English and dress. This **achieved-status group has emerged as the new caste**.
- With democracy and modernization, the undifferentiated Shripuram **started differentiating: class and power, once embedded in caste, gained relative autonomy and became disembedded** — Shripuram was waiting for a class structure, but got the new caste instead.
- **Beteille's broader contribution**: he was the **first to introduce Weberian sociology into India** (before him, Indian sociology had Orientalism — Ghurye; Marxism — A. R. Desai; and structural functionalism — Srinivas, but no Max Weber).

QUICK REVISION

- Answer strategy: address the demand (Sanskritization = sacred/mobility within caste/low castes; Westernization = secular/mobility outside/upper castes; dynamic relation; Yogendra Singh's critique).
- S. C. Dube: 'where is the dominant caste?' + dominant individuals/families; T. K. Oommen: multiple power structures (reservoir vs exercisers; Meena, Tikait).
- Critique of Dumont: static book view; purity/impurity = Brahminical view (ignores Dalit subjectivity); ignores protest movements; Marriott (speculative models); Nicholas Dirks (power not inferior to status; purohits served kings); Veena Das (reciprocity, not hierarchy, in villages).
- Caste & democracy: Ambedkar (Hinduism vs democracy opposite); caste census created caste; Ghurye (politicization, caste patriotism, 1932 non-Brahmin mobilization).
- Srinivas: vertical solidarity (pre-independence) → horizontal solidarity (caste associations post-independence); democracy = competition between associations; change in structure, not of structure.
- Dumont: substantialization (structure → substance); Beteille: old caste → new caste (English-speaking professionals/status groups); class/power disembedded from caste.

23.2 Caste Associations and the Evolution of Caste Politics

23.2.1 What is a Caste Association?

KEY CONCEPT

- 'Tradition gave us caste, modernity gave us democracy, and Indian modernity gave us caste association.'
- A **caste association is a formal organization of similar jatis having similar interests** (e.g. the Reddy association, Vanniyar association, Vadama association, Maratha sabha, Brahman sabha, Thakur sabha, Jat sabha/mahasabha). It acts as a **pressure group**, especially at election time.
- It is a **bureaucracy** — a formal, registered body (registered with the Government of India, receiving funds) with **hierarchy and division of labour** (a Jat leader, his associates, volunteers,

IT/WhatsApp workers). It is also a '**party**' in Weber's sense (people with common interests), though not a political party.

23.2.2 Functions of Caste Associations

KEY CONCEPT

- The functions of a caste association:
- 1. **Welfare of its jati and its members** — social, economic, political and educational: helping poor members, rebuilding a member's house after a fire, running hostels and coaching, and **ensuring representation in politics** (an association loses power if its members are not represented in the legislature/panchayat/administration). It works like a **fraternity** — e.g. coming together to defend a member facing charges.
- 2. **Justice to the community** (closely tied to welfare).
- 3. **Improving the social status of the community** — the census as an instrument of social mobility.

EXAMPLE

The Vanniyar (Palli) case: the Palli of northern Tamil Nadu, originally agricultural labourers, did not want to be classified as Shudra. Through their association they claimed **Kshatriya** status, asserting descent from the **Pallava dynasty / Agni Kula**; a court case ruled in their favour, and the census recorded them as Kshatriya. So the **census both creates caste and helps its mobility** — an **unanticipated consequence** (Merton).

23.2.3 Origin and Phase 1: Urban Welfare Associations

KEY CONCEPT

- Caste associations emerged with **British colonialism**: modern technology (travel, meetings, pamphlets, print) made it possible to form all-India associations. **Westernization consolidated caste identity** — and democracy promoted it (the right to form associations). At the national level they appeared from the **1890s** onwards (locally from the 1870s).
- **Phase 1 (late 19th century, 1890s–1930s) — URBAN caste associations:** they ran **cooperative societies** (housing, hospitals, educational institutions, hostels), and worked to **improve their caste's status** (claiming Kshatriya status, demanding temple entry, getting their names and histories recorded in the census — the **Jati Purans**). They performed **both ritual and secular functions**, but this was largely restricted to urban pockets.
- (Caste mobility is not only Hindu: among Muslims the lower **Arzals** emulating the upper **Ashrafs** is called **Ashrafization**.)

23.2.4 Phase 2: Poona Pact and Pressure Groups (1930s–70s)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Phase 2 (1930s–1970s):** the **Poona Pact (1932)** clearly separated Indians into **Savarna and Avarna** — earlier the separation was ritual, now it became **legal** too, which **strengthened Dalit identity**.
- Ambedkar offered to lead the Dalits; Gandhi's leadership was rejected by many; and when Dalits became **westernized**, a hierarchy emerged within them — **Dalit elites** (e.g. Mayawati) who are a distinct faction within the Dalits.
- With the **growth of representational politics**, castes began to act as **pressure groups** — the Dalit movement, the Depressed Class Association, the Dalit Panthers.
- In **1967** Congress faced its first defeat (in eight states); **factions/lobbies** of backward castes emerged within Congress, and the **locally dominant castes, empowered by land reforms, entered national and regional politics**. In Rajni Kothari's words, 'caste gets politicized' — and 'Congress as a system' began to be disrupted.

23.2.5 Phase 3: Dalit Politics and BAMCEF (1970s)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Phase 3 (1970s):** rise of **regional parties and decline of Congress**. The agrarian (dominant) castes formed their own parties or powerful factions within Congress.
- From **1977–78**, new caste associations came from the **low castes (Dalits)**: **BAMCEF** (Backward and Minority Communities Employees Federation), founded by **Kanshi Ram**, paved the way for the **Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP)** — which, in the wake of the **Mandal Commission report**, became a catalyst for the emergence of the **OBCs** as a significant political force.
- Dalit consciousness was now **on democratic lines**, organised around instruments provided by democracy (the political party). Politics came to be led by **cross-caste platforms** using the language of **assertion and resistance** for greater inclusion of oppressed groups.
- The **demand of caste associations changed** — from **collective welfare to political activism** (a social change from pre- to post-independence).

23.2.6 Phase 4: Mandalization of Politics (1980s–90s)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Phase 4 (1980s–90s)** — '**Mandalization of politics**': a **rebellion against upper-caste dominance at the national level**, expressed through the weakening of national parties (like Congress — the 'Brahmin-Bania party') and the rise of regional parties.
- When **OBC reservation was implemented (1991)**, the **anti-reservation agitation** had an **unanticipated consequence**: it united the **SC, ST and OBC** (the 'class unity' of the backward classes) — but it also **revived the question of caste and politics and normalized caste as the mode of politics**.
- A scholar noted that **caste groups, instead of crumbling, adapted themselves to the**

demands of parliamentary politics — producing a '**democracy of caste**': competition between **caste groups**, not between individuals. ('We don't cast our vote; we vote our caste.')

- The shift was from the **politics of ideology to the politics of representation**.

23.2.7 *Rudolph & Rudolph and Rajni Kothari*

KEY CONCEPT

- **Rudolph and Rudolph** (Lloyd and Susanne Rudolph, 1967): the **novelty of the caste association** was the **combination of the ascriptive dimension of caste with voluntary association** — caste is ascriptive (membership by birth), but membership of the caste association is **achieved/voluntary** (annual fee, elections, democratic participation). This is the **coexistence of tradition and modernity**. Caste also serves as an **associational platform** (providing networks for organizations).
- **Rajni Kothari** (post-1990s): it seems at the surface that our politics is 'caste-ridden', but the reality is the reverse — what we are experiencing is the '**democratization of caste**': caste has assumed a **non-ritual, purely political function**, and has been **democratized**. Caste and democracy are not opposite — they form a new mix.

CRITICAL POINT

In conclusion, the evolution of caste associations shows a tendency of **group loyalties over merit and competence**, and **caste patriotism over public interest** — both of which **run counter to liberal and democratic values**.

QUICK REVISION

- Caste association = formal organization of similar jatis with similar interests (pressure group; a Weberian 'party'; a bureaucracy).
- Functions: welfare (social/economic/political/educational) + justice + improving social status (census = mobility; Vanniyar/Palli → Kshatriya via court + census; unanticipated consequence).
- Origin: colonial modern technology; westernization consolidated caste; national-level from 1890s.
- Phase 1 (1890s–1930s): urban associations, cooperative societies (housing/hospital/education/hostels), status-raising (Kshatriya claims, temple entry, census), ritual + secular.
- Phase 2 (1930s–70s): Poona Pact (legal Savarna/Avarna split); Dalit elites; castes as pressure groups; 1967 Congress defeat; dominant castes (land reforms) enter national politics; 'caste gets politicized' (Kothari).
- Phase 3 (1970s): regional parties; BAMCEF (Kanshi Ram) → BSP; Mandal → OBC force; Dalit consciousness on democratic lines; cross-caste platforms (assertion/resistance); welfare → political activism.
- Phase 4 (1980s–90s): Mandalization of politics (rebellion vs upper-caste dominance; Congress

decline); anti-reservation agitation united SC/ST/OBC but normalized caste as mode of politics; democracy of caste.

- Rudolph & Rudolph: ascriptive caste + voluntary association; Kothari: democratization of caste (not caste-ridden politics).
- Conclusion: group loyalties > merit; caste patriotism > public interest; runs counter to democracy.

Caste and Gender

24.1 Rudolph & Rudolph: Three Forms of Mobilization

KEY CONCEPT

- Lloyd and Susanne Rudolph hold that the relation between caste and politics in India can be explained through **three forms of mobilization**:
- 1. **Vertical mobilization** — traditional **upper-caste elites mobilise the (largely low-caste) masses** (e.g. the national movement: Gandhi, Patel, the Indian National Congress). Vertical mobilization means **the status quo is maintained** — nothing really changes.
- 2. **Horizontal mobilization** — **similar caste groups are mobilised by individuals of the same caste** (what M. N. Srinivas called **horizontal solidarity**) — e.g. the **Mahad Satyagraha**, Ambedkar's **temple-entry movement**, the **Dalit Panther** movement, the **Kang/Kaung Satyagraha**.
- 3. **Differential mobilization** — the masses are mobilised by a **political party** (not a caste association), cutting across castes — e.g. the **Bahujan Samajwadi Party** (it has Brahmin, OBC, Shudra and ST candidates, even though the name is 'Bahujan'). The BSP's roots go back to **BAMCEF** and **DS4 (Dalit Shoshit Samaj Sangharsh Samiti)** — caste associations that grew into a political party.

KEY CONCEPT

- Caste associations (e.g. the All-India Yadav Welfare Association) are **horizontal** mobilization — same-caste people organising same-caste groups.
- **More and more differential mobilization = more democratization** (people affiliate to **ideology/development**, not caste); more vertical mobilization = nothing changes.
- The Rudolphs' conclusion: **prima facie it seems caste associations and their growth counter the modernizing process unleashed by colonialism; however, in reality, caste associations turned out to be the agents of modernity in India. Earlier we had casteization of politics; now we have politicization of caste.**

24.2 Anil Bhatt: Four Ways Caste Relates to Politics

KEY CONCEPT

- **Anil Bhatt** (drawing on extensive surveys, e.g. by **CSDS** — the 'psephologists'/political analysts like **Yogendra Yadav** and **Prashant Kishor**) analysed the relation between caste and politics in **four ways**:
- 1. **Political interest** — **high-status castes have higher levels of political interest** (they have always been at the top and want to maintain that hegemony in secular status too).
- 2. **Political awareness** — high castes also have higher awareness.
- 3. **Political identification (partisanship)** — **no relationship was found between caste status and partisanship**: persons of low caste are almost as likely to support a party of the high-caste status group (you support a party on its agenda/development, not on your caste).
- 4. **Political influence** — **high-status castes are not necessarily the influential castes**: middle and low castes dominate in many villages (the **dominant caste** — Patidars in Gujarat, Yadavs in UP, Reddys/Kammas in Andhra).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Before independence**, interest, awareness, identification and influence **intersected with each other**; **after independence they no longer do** — so the undifferentiated India became more differentiated. One caste may have high interest but low influence, and vice versa.
- This means **caste is getting democratized** (not the reverse).

24.3 Hierarchy vs Difference: Which Scholars Said What

KEY CONCEPT

- On the question 'which is more significant — the principle of hierarchy or the principle of difference in inter-caste relations?' the scholars divide:
- **Principle of hierarchy** — the Indological fraternity: **Ghurye** (a **definite, fixed, rigid hierarchy** — no change) and **Dumont** (a **rigid hierarchy** of purity/pollution — nothing nebulous; the pure stay pure, the impure stay impure).
- **Principle of difference** — **Srinivas** (a **nebulous hierarchy** — more difference than hierarchy: each caste is different, with claims and counter-claims to superiority) and **Beteille** (no fixed hierarchy — Brahmins are not homogeneous but segmented into status groups, so hierarchy depends on context).
- The line to recall: 'in the social world, there are certain social forms which are only different, but differences tend to get hierarchized.' The discussion concludes with **Dipankar Gupta**.

24.4 Caste Requires Endogamy: Surpanakha and the Smritis

EXAMPLE

- The **Surpanakha** example: when Surpanakha (a character in the Ramayana) proposed to Rama, he refused, saying 'I am Kshatriya and you are Brahmin — we cannot marry.'
- Sociological analysis: **caste requires endogamy for its own growth** — caste is a **social fact**, external to the individual and coercive even over Rama. Rama is the **spokesperson of the caste structure**: it is the caste which regulates the individual.

KEY CONCEPT

- What restricts our choices is a **written text** — the **Dharma Shastra** (just as **Sharia** regulates the everyday life of Muslims). The **Vedas** (Rig, Sama, Yajur, Atharva) are forms of **knowledge**, not regulators of daily life.
- **Shruti** = 'heard' (revealed); **Smriti** = 'remembered' (human-composed). The **Yajnavalkya Smriti** says one should marry a woman **whose virginity is intact, not previously wed by another, dear to one's heart, of the same varna, not a sapinda, younger than oneself, not diseased, and not from the same pravara or gotra**.
- The **upper-caste male view** is reproduced through the Yajnavalkya Smriti and legitimised by the Dharma Shastra: you are simply an **agent through which caste reproduces itself**.

24.5 Uma Chakravarti: Marriage, Sexuality and the Caste System

KEY CONCEPT

- The relation between caste and gender is historical and dynamic.
- **Uma Chakravarti**: the structure of marriage and sexuality is the foundation of the caste system. Marriage can be **endogamous, hypergamous or hypogamous** (all judged from the woman's perspective) — and the woman's choice is restricted: in India we have endogamy or, at most, **restricted hypergamy**; **hypogamy is prohibited** (marry within your caste or a higher caste, never a lower one).
- **Endogamy/hypergamy + control over female sexuality reproduce**: (1) caste inequality, (2) the ideology of purity and pollution, and (3) gender subordination.

24.6 Brahmanical Patriarchy

KEY CONCEPT

- **Brahmanical Patriarchy** (a term coined by **Uma Chakravarti**) = **Brahmanism + Patriarchy**: Brahmanism legitimises the superiority of the upper-caste Brahmin over the lower Shudra/Dalit; patriarchy legitimises the superiority of men over women. Combined, it means **upper-caste men ruling over upper-caste women as well as lower-caste women** — maintaining both the oppressive caste system and patriarchy.

- The **bricks** of this structure: **caste hierarchy** (restricting women's choice; wealth and resources concentrated with the upper castes), **female purity / stree dharma** (the idea that a woman should strive to be desirable — which ensures women's participation in their own subordination, since her sexuality is owned by the caste), and **ritual caste purity** (an elevated spiritual state rewarded for following social norms that oppress women and lower castes).
- The **cement** holding these bricks together: the **Dharma Shastras, Manusmriti and the Yajnavalkya Smriti**.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Arranged marriage is exclusive to India** (found nowhere else) — it exists to maintain caste inequality, by subduing the woman's choice. At the end of the day, **women become the gateway to caste**.
- **Ambedkar** was always more concerned with **women's education than men's** (upper-caste Brahmins already possess the cultural capital to get educated). **Nehru** similarly believed women and men are the **two wheels of the vehicle called India**.

QUICK REVISION

- Rudolph & Rudolph: vertical (upper-caste elites mobilise masses; status quo), horizontal (same-caste mobilises same-caste; Srinivas's horizontal solidarity), differential (political party mobilises across castes) mobilization.
- Differential = democratization (ideology/development); vertical = no change; conclusion: caste associations = agents of modernity; casteization of politics → politicization of caste.
- Anil Bhatt (four ways): interest & awareness (high castes higher); identification (no relation to partisanship); influence (middle/low dominant castes). Pre-independence they intersected; now they don't → caste democratized.
- Caste requires endogamy (Surpanakha/Rama; Dharma Shashtra; Yajnavalkya Smriti: virgin, same varna, not sapinda/pravara/gotra); caste = social fact; individual is agent of caste reproduction.
- Uma Chakravarti: marriage + sexuality = foundation of caste; endogamy/hypergamy + control of female sexuality reproduce caste inequality + purity/pollution + gender subordination.
- Brahmanical Patriarchy = Brahmanism + patriarchy (upper-caste men over women); bricks = caste hierarchy, female purity/stree dharma, ritual caste purity; cement = Dharma Shashtra/Manusmriti.
- Arranged marriage exclusive to India; women = gateway to caste; Ambedkar & Nehru on women's education.

Untouchability: Forms and Perspectives

25.1 The Many Forms of Untouchability

The syllabus says '**forms**' of untouchability because there is **no one form**. The common-sense idea is that in the caste system some people are untouchable — but that is only common sense.

KEY CONCEPT

- The idea that 'some groups are untouchable' was objectified through the **Dharma Shastras** as interpreted by the Orientalists: they found a division between **Savarna** (those who have varna) and **Avarna** (those who have no varna — hence untouchable).
- Looked at through **spiritual rebirth**: the **Dvija** (twice-born — Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya) can be spiritually reborn, while the **Ekaj** (once-born — Shudra and Avarna) cannot — those **excluded from spirituality** were seen as untouchable (not allowed to read/interpret the Vedas or become saints).
- Untouchability can be located **within Hinduism, across religions, within the Varna system (Shudra), across the Varna system (Avarna), across castes, within a caste, among upper-caste men and women, in the nation, and in gender** — it is a **phenomenon**, not just a caste.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Gandhi**: what the untouchables are to the upper-caste Hindu men, the same is **India to Britain** — untouchability also cuts across to the category of **nation** (untouchable nation).
- **Sabarimala** judgement: the social exclusion of women (based on menstruation) from the temple is **also a form of untouchability**.
- Religious conversion did not end it: when low castes converted to Islam, Christianity or Buddhism, **their caste followed them** — hence **Muslim Dalits, Dalit Christians, Dalit Buddhists**.

EXAMPLE

Satish Deshpande's reading of the astronaut joke (10 candidates — 5 OBC, 2 SC, 2 ST, 1 general astronaut): for the lower caste, **caste overrides qualification**; for the upper caste, **qualification overrides caste**. The victim was **Sameer Wankhede**, an IRS officer labelled a 'Muslim Dalit' — the label itself shows we live in a Hindu upper-caste society.

25.2 Purity and Impurity as the Ideology (Dumont and A. M. Shah)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Louis Dumont:** purity/impurity is the ideology of Hindu civilization — not just of caste. It is the base of everything in Hindu life.
- Everyday examples: removing slippers and washing feet before entering the sanctum; covering the head in a Gurdwara; the **sanctity of the kitchen** (the cooking mother lets no one in); restrictions on **food and water exchange** (food served by an untouchable becomes untouchable); endogamy in marriage; **childbirth** (the mother and child are secluded); **death** (sutak — not visiting the bereaved home for about 12–13 days); not eating chicken during Navratri.
- A **Jain** who observes sutak has, in Srinivas's terms, become **Sanskritized**.
- **A. M. Shah** (Delhi School of Economics, following Dumont): '**Hindu civilization is sometimes called the civilization of purity and pollution,**' and the Hindu psyche is believed to be **pathologically obsessed** with them.

EXAMPLE

- A. M. Shah's illustration (a Gujarati novel, **Neelkanth**, c. 1900): a Brahmin named **Bhadram** travelling from Ahmedabad to Bombay by train considered his co-passengers polluting and took a **purificatory bath at every station**.
- The word **asprishya** (the Sanskrit equivalent of 'untouchable') was used **even for the highest purity**: in the **Pushti Marg** (a Vaishnava sect founded by **Vallabhacharya**), a worshipper in a state of intense purity — e.g. **Meera Bai** worshipping Krishna — was in an 'asprishya state', which others could not touch or disturb. So untouchability applies to the **most impure and the most pure alike**.

25.3 Temporary vs Permanent Pollution

KEY CONCEPT

- Dumont's **two types of impurity**:
- **Permanent pollution** — the **low castes**, involved in **menial occupations** (manual scavenging, skinning animals), seen as permanently impure.
- **Temporary pollution** — the **upper castes**: death (sutak), childbirth, menstruation — impurity that can be **purified through rituals**.
- Even **upper-caste women** are the victims of temporary impurity — the biggest being the **menstrual cycle** (during which marriage is not even discussed) and **childbirth** (mother and child are secluded).

25.4 Untouchability Within Brahmins and Among Non-Brahmins

KEY CONCEPT

- **Brahmins are not a homogeneous group** — so there are **untouchable Brahmins**. Among Brahmins: the **temple priest** is the purest; the **ordinary** Brahmin is in the middle; the Brahmin specialising in **mortuary (death) rituals** is the lowest — a death-ritual priest is not called for marriages.
- **Beteille**: Brahmins are divided into segments, each a **status group** with its own lifestyle — so the Smartha do not marry the Sri Vaishnava (they treat each other as untouchable), and purity is reproduced generation after generation within each segment.
- **Non-Brahmins** of highly Sanskritic sects (e.g. the **Bhagats** and **Bhuvas** — low-caste/tribal sects) observe purity rules so meticulously that they consider ordinary Brahmins **less pure**, even polluting.
- Among the **Devadasis** there is also a hierarchy: the **Deo Dasi** (temple) is purest, the **domestic Dasi** is most impure. (The scholar **Subhadra Mitra Channa** speaks of Hindu women's two statuses — **Devi and Dasi**.)

25.5 The Career of the Concept: From Avarna to Scheduled Caste

KEY CONCEPT

- The word **untouchable** is a modern (English) category; the traditional Sanskrit category was **Avarna** — the precursor of the modern 'untouchables'.
- The concept has had its own **career** (Simon Charsley's essay): **Avarna** → **Asprishya Shudra** → **Depressed Classes** → **Excluded Classes** → **Harijan** → **Scheduled Caste** → **Dalit**.
- **Herbert Risley**, the 1901 census commissioner, was the first to classify the Shudra varna into five categories, including **Asprishya Shudra** ('untouchable Shudra') — but no coherent, consistent list ever emerged.
- **Jyotiba Phule** first spoke of the **Dalit** category; **Ambedkar** used 'Depressed Classes'; **Gandhi** gave 'Harijan'; the Government of India gave **Scheduled Caste**.
- In preparing these lists, officials always agreed on the **scavengers** (the lowest) but disagreed on the others — because there was **no clear criterion**. As a concept, 'untouchable' **suppressed the diversity** of these groups.

KEY CONCEPT

Michel Foucault: knowledge constitutes power — the people who manufactured this knowledge (of who is 'untouchable') acquired power over our minds; the 'fixed, inviolable line' between touchable and untouchable is a construction, not objective reality.

25.6 Untouchables Were Never Homogeneous

KEY CONCEPT

- The ancient texts do **not** mention the numerous jatis of untouchables — only **field studies** reveal that untouchables are themselves divided into endogamous castes arranged in hierarchy (some 'pure', some 'impure'), just like the rest of society.
- The **Smiths of Rampura** claimed **Vishwakarma Brahmin** status.
- **Garos** (Gujarat) — an untouchable **priest** caste that claims Brahmin status, wears the sacred thread, and adopts Brahminical surnames (Joshi, Vyas) — pure Sanskritization. They form part of a **hierarchy of priestly groups**: the high Brahmin sub-castes served as priests for high non-Brahmin castes, while a few low Brahmin sub-castes served lower-middle castes — status matters more than power (a Brahmin priest would not serve even a wealthy Dalit).

EXAMPLE

Untouchable saints: the book 'Untouchable Saints' (by **Eleanor Zelliot** and **Rohini Mokashi-Punekar**, 2005) shows that since about the 10th century there were untouchable saint-poets — **Tiruppan** (given the high **Alvar** status) and **Nandanar** (given **Nayanar** status) in Tamil Nadu, **Chokha Mela** in Maharashtra, and **Ravidas** in North India — whose poetry was accepted by high castes into temple and domestic worship. The **Bhakti movement** was a challenge to mainstream Brahminical philosophy, led by the low castes.

25.7 Impact of Modernity: The Transfer of Purity

KEY CONCEPT

- Ideas like **humanitarianism, meritocracy, liberty, fraternity, fundamental rights, urbanization, industrialization, secularization and democracy** diluted purity/impurity — but **only among the westernized upper-caste Hindu men**.
- Meanwhile the **lower castes were getting Sanskritized** — absorbing the very purity/pollution ideas that the upper castes were giving up. So **purity/impurity did not die; it was transferred from the upper castes to the lower castes** (the status quo was maintained).
- **A. M. Shah's summary**: in **pre-modern India**, concern for purity/pollution **decreased as one went down the hierarchy**; in **modern India** there is a **two-way change** — decreasing among the upper castes (due to westernization) and increasing among the lower castes (due to Sanskritization).

QUICK REVISION

- Forms of untouchability: within/across Hinduism, within/across Varna, across castes, within caste, upper-caste men & women, nation, gender — a phenomenon, not just caste.
- Savarna vs Avarna; Dvija (twice-born) vs Ekaj (once-born, excluded from spirituality).
- Dumont: purity/impurity = ideology of Hindu civilization; A. M. Shah: 'civilization of purity'

and pollution’.

- Temporary (upper caste: death/birth/menstruation) vs permanent (low caste: menial occupations) pollution.
- Within Brahmins: temple priest > ordinary > mortuary-ritual Brahmin (Beteille’s segments); non-Brahmin Sanskritic sects (Bhagats, Bhuvats); Devadasi (Deo Dasi vs domestic Dasi).
- Career of the concept: Avarna → Asprishya Shudra (Risley 1901) → Depressed Classes (Ambedkar) → Harijan (Gandhi) → Scheduled Caste; no clear criterion (only scavengers agreed); suppressed diversity; Foucault (knowledge = power).
- Untouchables never homogeneous (field studies): Smiths of Rampura (Vishwakarma Brahmin), Garo of Gujarat (Brahmin claim); untouchable saints (Tiruppan/Alvar, Nandanar/Nayanar, Chokha Mela, Ravidas; Zelliott & Mokashi-Punekar).
- Impact of modernity: purity/impurity transferred from (westernized) upper castes to (Sanskritized) lower castes — two-way change.

Untouchability and Caste: Past, Present and Future

26.1 Diwali, Civil Religion and the Little/Great Tradition

EXAMPLE

- **Why do we celebrate Diwali?** Different religions celebrate it for different reasons: the Hindu Brahmanical view (the return of Rama with Sita and Lakshmana); the **Jain** (Mahavira attained moksha); the **Sikh** (Guru Har Gobind Singh released from Jahangir's Gwalior Fort — **Bandi Chhod Divas**); and the Bengali (Kali/Durga puja, not Rama).
- At the end of the day, everyone has a different private religion, but Diwali becomes a **public religion for everyone** — a **civic religion** (Robert Bellah's idea): good over evil, light over darkness, knowledge over ignorance.
- The **diyas are totems** — symbols whose interpretation depends on one's **social location** (mechanical solidarity). The many different reasons are the **little tradition**, while the unified 'Diwali' we think of is the **great tradition**.

26.2 Michael Moffatt: The Replicability Principle

EXAMPLE

- **Michael Moffatt** conducted an **ethnographic study** (about **14 months**) of two untouchable castes — the **Paraiyars** and the **Pallars** — in the village of **Andavur**, **Chingleput** district, Tamil Nadu (about 50 miles from Madras).
- Social composition: the **untouchables are 32%** of the village; the **dominant caste is the Reddiar** (a peasant caste, over 50%). The village is divided into **Ur** (the elite area) and **Cheri** (the inferior area) — settlement patterns (pur, ur, nadu, puram).

KEY CONCEPT

- The **book view** of untouchability is a '**disjunctive model**' — treating touchables and untouchables as two separate, polar, binary categories (a structuralist perspective). Moffatt says it is time to change this.
- His key finding: **untouchables are both excluded and included** — on **exclusion** they **replicate**; on **inclusion** they **subordinate**. This is the **replicability (replicatory) principle**.

- Because they are excluded, for their own survival they **replicate the same hierarchy and structure** of the mainstream caste society within themselves.

26.3 Replication Within Untouchables

KEY CONCEPT

- Moffatt found **three strategies of replication**:
- **1. Replication of the caste hierarchy** — within the untouchables there is a hierarchy just like the mainstream:
- **Valluvar Pandarams** — the '**Brahmins of the Harijans**', the **purest among the impure** (they conduct life-cycle rituals, marriage, death and even astrology).
- **Paraiyars** — **numerically preponderant** among the untouchables (about 80%) — a **replica of the dominant Reddiar**.
- **Vannan** — washermen, specifically washing the clothes of girls at first menstruation, and arranging funeral pyres, and cutting hair.
- **Chakkiliyar** — leather workers (working with dead cattle).
- **Kurivikaran** — bird-catchers who **eat crows**, placed lowest among the untouchables (the most impure).
- **2. Caste divided into sub-castes, each sub-caste endogamous** — the Paraiyars themselves are divided into sub-castes, and endogamy is maintained within each.
- **3. Replication of Hindu religion** — excluded from the Ur's religious functions, the untouchables form **their own gods**: the Ur's local deity is **Seliyaman**, while the Cheri's is its replica **Mariamman**.
- This is the same strategy A. M. Shah saw in the **Garos** of Gujarat — adding Brahminical surnames (Joshi, Vyas) and conducting Brahmin rituals.

KEY CONCEPT

Subordination (on inclusion): when allowed to take part in an upper-caste ritual, they **accept their low status**. The Uber/Ola analogy (Michael Burawoy's '**work games**'): a platform worker works for two companies at once as a **defence mechanism** — work turns into a game that liberates from exploitation.

26.4 Subordination and the Critique of the Disjunctive Model

KEY CONCEPT

- Moffatt's theory is a **critique of the disjunctive models of untouchability** (which stressed the contrast between untouchables and the higher castes).
- When purity/impurity is found **even amongst the impure**, it shows **ideological homogeneity** — Dumont's purity/impurity is the ideology of the whole Hindu civilization, found in every

sphere.

- **Dumont:** the ideology of Hindu civilization is **highly non-competitive** — the impure accept their position (the 'tire never competes with the engine'). Untouchables accept their inequality so completely that they **replicate purity/impurity within themselves**. Hindu inequality is a **special form of inequality not found anywhere else**.

26.5 Caste: Past, Present and Future

KEY CONCEPT

- **'Is caste dead / weakened / strengthened?'** — caste is **not a quantitative, measurable variable**; it cannot be said to have 'strengthened' or 'weakened' (that is TV-journalist talk). The change is **qualitative — a change in form**.
- **Ghurye:** in traditional society caste was highly flexible; as India evolved it became rigid; with the British it became **both flexible and rigid**.
- **Srinivas:** earlier **vertical solidarity**, now **horizontal solidarity**; hierarchy earlier based on **ritual observance**, now on **non-ritual (political, economic, numerical) criteria**; the **new avatar of caste = the OBCs** (the 20th-century avatar, based on social/economic backwardness, not purity/impurity).
- **Rajni Kothari:** earlier **casteization of politics**, now **politicization of caste**.
- **D. L. Sheth:** **structural differentiation** within caste — it had ritual functions, now it also has non-ritual political functions — the **secularization of caste**.
- **Beteille:** earlier the **old caste**; now the **new caste replaces the old caste** (class did not replace caste).

26.6 Caste Outside India

KEY CONCEPT

- **What caste is to Indians, race is to outsiders.** The racial classificatory system has **Caucasoids as superior** and **Negroids as inferior** — just as the (Risley's) racial theory of caste ranked the fair at the top and the dark at the bottom.
- **Oliver Cox:** **caste is just like race** — race is '**coloured caste**' (endogamy within race, as within caste; each race has its own lifestyle).
- **Ghurye:** the **class structure of Britain is the exact replica of the caste structure of India** — we have casteism, they have classism.
- Sociologists look not at the **manifest body** but the **latent soul** — caste operates in different forms/avatars outside India too.

26.7 From Caste Public to Bio-Public

KEY CONCEPT

- In the **contemporary (post-pandemic)** context, untouchability has evolved: before the pandemic there was **vertical untouchability** (the impure below the pure, even within untouchables). After the pandemic there is **horizontal untouchability** — social distancing is now maintained between the **COVID-positive and the non-positive**, irrespective of caste.
- This is the move from a '**caste public**' to a '**bio-public**' (concern has shifted from **ritual hygiene to medical hygiene**) — a concept given by the sociologist **Badri Narayan**.
- Social distancing existed before and exists now — only the **form has changed** (again, not strengthen/weaken, but a change in form).

QUICK REVISION

- Moffatt (Paraiyars & Pallars, Andavur, Chingleput): untouchables both excluded and included — on exclusion they replicate, on inclusion they subordinate (replicability principle).
- Replication: (1) hierarchy within untouchables (Valluvar Pandarams = 'Brahmins of Harijans'; Paraiyars = dominant-replica; Vannan, Chakkiliyar, Kurivikaran at the bottom); (2) sub-castes, each endogamous; (3) own gods (Seliyaman → Mariamman); same as Garo (A. M. Shah).
- Subordination = accepting low status on inclusion (Burawoy's 'work games').
- Critique of disjunctive models; ideological homogeneity; Dumont's 'non-competitive' ideology.
- Caste past/present/future = qualitative change, not quantitative: Ghurye (flexible→rigid→both), Srinivas (vertical→horizontal; ritual→secular; OBC = new avatar), Kothari (casteization→politicization), D. L. Sheth (secularization), Beteille (new caste replaces old).
- Caste outside India: race (Caucasoid/Negroid); Oliver Cox (caste = race; 'coloured caste'); Ghurye (British class = Indian caste).
- Post-pandemic: vertical → horizontal untouchability; caste public → bio-public (Badri Narayan); ritual hygiene → medical hygiene.

The Idea of the Indian Village

27.1 The Village as an Ideological Category

KEY CONCEPT

- The **idea of India** was that of an **agrarian, rural country** — but this was a **Western (colonial) idea**. To a common-sense man, a village is a geographical space; to a sociologist, **the village is an ideological category through which the British conceptualised India** — the **microcosm of the macrocosm**.
- The British understood India through **ancient Sanskrit texts**, which described an agrarian, pastoral, religious, 'backward, uncivilized' India — hence 'India is village and village is India'.
- We know India (even the Bhagavad Gita) only through the British translations — **colonial knowledge produced the knowledge of India**.

27.2 Colonial Discourse: Metcalfe, Marx and the Indologists

KEY CONCEPT

- **Charles Metcalfe's** idea of India (the colonial/orientalist discourse — to justify rule by first 'knowing' the ruled):
 1. **India consists of villages.**
 2. Villages are **little republics** (autonomous, politically sovereign units, with their own head).
 3. Villages are **self-sufficient** (economically autonomous — everything produced, consumed and distributed within; no import/export).
 4. Villages are **static** and **resilient to change** (equilibrium maintained; 'dynasty after dynasty tumbled, revolution succeeded revolution, but village India does not reflect any change').
 5. **Communal ownership of land.**
 6. **Functional integration of various occupational groups.**

KEY CONCEPT

- **Marx** (the **Asiatic mode of production**) described India the same way — self-sufficient little republics, no private ownership, communal land, integrated occupational groups. (A. R. Desai, as a Marxist, reproduced this view.)
- An **Indologist** described the Indian village as: a **traditional community, self-sufficient,**

patriarchal in governance, and **surrounded by hostile villages** (hence autonomous, under a despotic government outside).

- The first historian of Indian civilisation, **James Mill**, divided Indian history into **ancient (Hindu)**, **medieval (Muslim)** and **modern (British)** — constructing the common-sense we still inherit (even **Bipan Chandra** reproduces this colonial version of history, which is why the subaltern and tribal movements go missing).

27.3 Nationalist Discourse: Gandhi, Nehru, Ambedkar

KEY CONCEPT

- **Gandhi** — 'the real India lies in the villages (Bharat)': the village represents the **essential core of Indian civilisation** and is the **site of authenticity** ('India begins and ends in the village'). Develop India by **developing the village** — he was against **westernized development** (which replaces tradition), not development per se. **Real Swaraj (self-rule) = revival of village communities** — hence **Panchayati Raj** (a Gandhian principle, in the DPSPs). Gandhi was **against the idea of the state**.
- **Nehru** — the village is **traditional and backward India**, a **den of superstition, tradition and underdevelopment** — which cannot gel with a modern industrial society. Instead of reviving the village, he suggested **modern industrial development** (heavy machinery, technology, dams) and modernising **agriculture through modern technology**. India should be a **strong nation state** (villages should not be autonomous like princely states).
- **Ambedkar** — the **Dalitist idea of the village**: the village is a **den of oppression, violence, exclusion and corruption** — a **Hindu Republic which is the negation of the Republic**, a colonialism of the Hindus designed to oppress the Dalits. The village is the '**working plant of the Hindu caste order**'; the real India is not yet free.

CRITICAL POINT

Even field studies reproduced the upper-caste view: **Beteille**, to befriend the villagers of Shripuram, used his **Brahmin identity** (not his professor/researcher identity); the Brahmin headman (a landlord) helped him, on the condition that he would **never visit Cheri** (the untouchable cluster). So whatever Beteille recorded was the **upper-caste view of Shripuram** — just as we read the upper-caste view of modern Indian history.

27.4 The State View: The Village as Underdeveloped

KEY CONCEPT

- The **Indian state (Nehru's vision)** looked at the village as **underdeveloped** — through the **Western idea of modernization** (Rostow's five stages: traditional → pre-take-off → take-off → drive to maturity → age of mass consumption).
- It established the **Planning Commission** (economists and social anthropologists, many from

the London School of Economics, who hired unpaid student interns to gather village data).

- Programs: **IRDP (Integrated Rural Development Programme)**, **CDP (Community Development Programme)**, **land reforms**, **the Green Revolution**.
- **Economists** studied only the economic aspects (production, distribution, supply chain); **anthropologists** studied only the socio-cultural aspects (everyday life, rituals, dress, food, festivals). **M. N. Srinivas** (in 'India's Villages') observed that this **mutual exclusion of aspects distorted our comprehension of the rural social structure**.

CRITICAL POINT

- **One modernity was imposed on multiple traditions:** multiple villages, but one plan for all. This **obliterated the diversity and specificity** of villages and reduced them to a **monolithic village** dependent on state policy.
- **Jan Breman:** the village was **nationalized, modernized and anthropologized**.
- **Thakur:** the village became a **litmus test** for the presence, absence or degree of development; focusing only on underdevelopment encourages a **unified, monolithic village India** dependent on the state — a reproduction of colonialism (sociologists became 'insider-outsiders' treating the insider as outsider).

27.5 Village Studies: Structural-Functional and Marxist

KEY CONCEPT

- **Village studies** in India were initiated by the **Planning Commission** in the **1950s–60s**.
- **Structural-functional branch:** **William Wiser** (Karimpur), **M. N. Srinivas** (Rampura), **S. C. Dube** (Shamirpet).
- **Marxist branch (from the 1970s):** **A. R. Desai** (planning, cooperatives and land reforms actually favoured **bourgeois industrialization** — socialism was only paid lip service, the instruments were 'socialist' but controlled by capital) and **Ramkrishna Mukherjee** (who established the base for a Marxist study of the village).

27.6 William Wiser and the Jajmani System

KEY CONCEPT

- **William Wiser** (Karimpur) was the **first to study the jajmani relationship** in the field.
- **Jajmani** is a relationship between an upper and a lower caste — e.g. the **nai (barber)** cuts the pandit's hair for free, and the Brahmin in exchange gives grains — **service for goods, no cash** (it is **not barter**).
- Wiser's conclusion: **nobody is master and nobody is servant** — the one who provides becomes the servant of the one provided to, but the latter also provides something in return. The relation is one of **interdependence (harmony)** — a structural-functional view.

27.7 S. C. Dube and the Dominant Individual

KEY CONCEPT

- **S. C. Dube** (Shamirpet, Telangana) critiqued Srinivas's 'dominant caste': it is **not the caste but the dominant individuals/families** that are dominant — the whole village depends on them.
- He identified **six features of a dominant individual**: (1) **individual traits/charisma**, (2) **seniority (age)**, (3) **wealth**, (4) **numbers**, (5) **education**, (6) **a government job**.
- Such charismatic, senior, wealthy, educated figures (e.g. a leader like Sonia Gandhi in Rae Bareilly, or Mulayam Singh Yadav) neutralise conflict — **harmony is maintained** — so there is little scope for conflict in the village.

QUICK REVISION

- Village = ideological category (microcosm of macrocosm) through which British conceptualised India.
- Colonial discourse: Metcalfe (villages = little republics, self-sufficient, static, communal land, functional integration); Marx (Asiatic mode of production); Indologist (traditional, self-sufficient, patriarchal, surrounded by hostile villages); James Mill (ancient/medieval/modern).
- Nationalist discourse: Gandhi (real India in villages; Swaraj = revival; Panchayati Raj), Nehru (village backward; modern industry), Ambedkar (village = den of oppression; Hindu Republic = negation of Republic; working plant of caste order).
- Beteille's Brahmin identity / Cheri exclusion = upper-caste view reproduced.
- State view: village underdeveloped (modernization theory); Planning Commission; IRDP/CDP/land reform/Green Revolution; economists vs anthropologists (Srinivas's 'India's Villages'); one modernity on multiple traditions; monolithic village; Jan Breman; Thakur (litmus test).
- Village studies (1950s-60s): structural-functional (Wiser/Karimpur/jajmani, Srinivas/Rampur, Dube/Shamirpet) and Marxist (A. R. Desai, Ramkrishna Mukherjee).
- Jajmani = service-for-goods, no cash, interdependence/harmony (not master-servant).
- Dube's dominant individual: charisma, age, wealth, numbers, education, government job; conflict neutralized.

Village Studies

28.1 Is Caste a Closed Class or an Open Caste?

KEY CONCEPT

- On 'is caste changing/weakening/disintegrating?' — the old belief was that **caste is closed and class is open**; but **caste is a closed class and class is an open caste**.
- **Pitirim Sorokin: no society is absolutely closed or absolutely open — it is a matter of degree.** Caste does not disappear: **mobility increases, but caste persists** (today the upper caste can be found in lower occupations and the lower caste in higher occupations — but occupation changes while the caste remains, and it reappears at marriage).

28.2 Questioning the Self-Sufficiency Doctrine

KEY CONCEPT

- In the **1950s**, ethnographers began to **question the self-sufficiency doctrine** of the Orientalists (Metcalf, Marx, the Indologists).
- **M. N. Srinivas and A. M. Shah** wrote an EPW article, 'Myth of Self-Sufficiency', questioning it through a **Gujarat case study** (trading; migration between Gujarat, Maharashtra and MP).
- **Beteille's Shripuram study** showed the same: it had **Kannada-speaking, Telugu-speaking and Tamil-speaking Brahmins** — clear evidence that villagers always had **connections with outsiders** (Harappan seals found in Mesopotamia; Chola/Pallava trade with the Roman Empire; land grants sold for migration).
- **S. C. Dube:** the Indian village has always been **dependent on towns** for salt, bangles and things of daily use; towns depended on villages for manpower, food-grains and raw materials — so **rural and urban India were interdependent and interrelated**.
- **Jyotiba Phule:** the **drain of wealth** (Dadabhai Naoroji's theory, given with respect to two nations) operates **within India too** — the same exploitation of rural India by urban India.

28.3 S. C. Dube: A Typology of Villages

KEY CONCEPT

- S. C. Dube conducted three field studies: the **Kamars** (Chhattisgarh, then MP), **Shamirpet** (Telangana, 1955) and **Ranikhera** (UP). He focused on **Shamirpet**.
- Shamirpet was chosen because it is a **multi-caste and multi-religious village** — Hindus, Muslims, Christians, Dalit Christians, Dalit Muslims; Telugu, Hindi and Urdu speakers (508 households; 1,437 Hindu upper castes; 680 SC/ST; 340 Muslims; 2,008 Telugu speakers; 340 Urdu speakers). It is 'India in miniature'.
- Dube observed **jajmani across religious groups**, not just caste groups: **Hindus and Muslims are interdependent** for goods and services (e.g. the food of Old Delhi is a symbol of Hindu-Muslim integration) — this maintained **integration and consensus** in the village.

KEY CONCEPT

- Dube's point: **there is no single 'Indian village'** (a Punjabi village differs from a Himachali, Kashmiri, Keralite or Telangana village). The colonials and social anthropologists developed a **monolithic image** of the Indian village without doing field work.
- So instead of theorising the Indian village, Dube developed a **typology** — **six criteria** to differentiate villages: (1) **area of land and size of population**, (2) **ethnic and caste composition**, (3) **pattern of land ownership**, (4) **structure of authority and power hierarchy** (who is the headman and on what basis), (5) **proximity to towns** (closer = more contact/assimilation/urbanisation), (6) **local traditions** (deities, festivals, their functions).

KEY CONCEPT

- From these six criteria, **three broad features** of the Indian village emerge: (1) it is a **territorial, social, political and economic unit**; (2) there is **inter-ethnic (inter-caste) dependency**; (3) **multiple villages are integrated with each other** (not self-sufficient).
- This is a **structural-functional** model — Dube saw dependency and integration, but **not conflict**.

28.4 S. C. Dube: How the Village Community is Organized

KEY CONCEPT

- The village community is organised in **two ways**:
- **1. In terms of kin and caste** — the individual's first obligation is to the **family**, then the **group of near kin**, then the **lineage** (vansh — the descent symbol, e.g. the Yadavs tracing descent to Yadu Maharaj), then **relatives** (affinal — by marriage), then the **sub-caste/caste**, then the **varna**. (In Beteille's Shripuram: family → kin → lineage → relatives → Smartha/Sri Vaishnava sub-caste → Brahmin — activated in different contexts.)
- **2. In terms of territorial affiliation** — the individual's affiliation is to the **family**, then the

village, then the **intra-caste organization**, then the **region**, then the **nation**.

- Overall, Dube tried to **develop models** of the Indian village, not a monolithic image.

28.5 Beteille's Weberian Model of Social Change

KEY CONCEPT

- **Beteille** (a Weberian) did not develop a generalisation: he developed a **model of social change** from his Shripuram study — from **symmetrical** (caste = class = power) to **asymmetrical** (class and power disembedded from caste).
- This model is an **ideal type**, to be used for **comparative analysis** — to see the **divergences and convergences** between the model and the reality of other villages (every village is unique; the social world is not so patterned that we can generalise from one village to all India).

28.6 Marxist Village Studies: Thorner and Gough

KEY CONCEPT

- **From the 1970s** (after the Green Revolution, 1967–77), village studies witnessed the **advent of Marxist studies** — which **rejected the unity/integration principle** of structural functionalism and brought the **class and economic angle** to the caste angle.
- **Daniel Thorner** (UP study): earlier we had Brahmin, Kshatriya, Vaishya, Shudra; **now we have Malik (owner), Kisan (cultivator) and Mazdoor (labourer)** — the upper caste became Malik, the middle caste Kisan, the low caste Mazdoor — **caste defined class; there was no change**.
- **Kathleen Gough** (Kumbapettai, Tamil Nadu): **modernization of the agrarian structure did not help the poor castes — it consolidated class divisions** (the village moved from caste-division to a strict class hierarchy).

CRITICAL POINT

- The Marxist scholars studied 20 villages in Punjab: **land reforms and the Green Revolution** (the two big post-independence programmes) at the surface seem **development-oriented** — but the upper caste, with its social and cultural capital, bought the heavy machinery and high-yielding seeds, becoming 'super-upper-class', while the Dalit peasants fell further. The **rich farmers captured the seed, credit and irrigation cooperatives**.
- The **failure of these policies** is what produced the **Maoist/Naxalite movement** — Naxalism exists because land reform was not successful.

28.7 Moffatt's Replication and the Contribution of Village Studies

KEY CONCEPT

- **Moffatt** (recap) provided a study that is neither about integration nor conflict: the excluded untouchables, instead of conflicting, **replicate** the same caste structure that excluded them — the principles of **replication and subordination**.
- **Conclusion:** village studies not only analysed development, social organisation and the strategies of the excluded, but **contributed concepts to Indian sociology** — **dominant caste, Sanskritization, dominant individual, replicability, consensus** — which we still use (e.g. to explain reservation demands by the dominant caste).

QUICK REVISION

- 1950s: self-sufficiency doctrine questioned (Srinivas & A. M. Shah, 'Myth of Self-Sufficiency'; Beteille's multi-language Brahmins; S. C. Dube's village-town interdependence; Phule's internal drain of wealth).
- S. C. Dube (Shamirpet, 1955): multi-caste/multi-religious village; jajmani across religions; six criteria for a village typology; three broad features (unit; inter-ethnic dependency; villages integrated).
- Village community organised by kin/caste (family → kin → lineage → relatives → sub-caste → varna) and by territory (individual → family → village → caste org → region → nation).
- Beteille: Weberian model (symmetrical → asymmetrical) as an ideal type for comparison.
- Marxist studies (1970s): Thorner (Malik/Kisan/Mazdoor — no change), Kathleen Gough (Kumbapettai — class consolidation); land reform + Green Revolution favoured rich farmers → Naxalism.
- Moffatt: replication/subordination (not integration, not conflict); village studies gave concepts (dominant caste, Sanskritization, dominant individual, replicability, consensus).

28.8 Current Affairs to Sociology: The MTP Act and the Female Body

EXAMPLE

- The **Medical Termination of Pregnancy (MTP) Act** — a legislation to reduce illegal abortion and consequent maternal mortality/morbidity — is a worked example of extracting sociology from a current-affairs topic.
- The changes: the **gestational limit was raised from 20 to 24 weeks** (one doctor's approval up to 20 weeks, two up to 24); and **'pregnant wife'** was changed to **'pregnant woman'** (so unmarried women too can now terminate).
- **Sociological reading:** (1) the gestational limit means the **state decides when a woman may keep or remove a child** — the female body becomes a site of control — the **medicalization of the female body**, supervised by (male) doctors. **Adrienne Rich** ('Of Woman Born') argues that this control of reproduction perpetuates patriarchy, with **male doctors replacing female**

midwives (ANMs, ASHA workers).

- (2) 'Pregnant **woman**' (not 'wife') **reinforces the gender binary / compulsory heterosexuality** — excluding trans, intersex and non-binary people from safe abortion.
- (3) After 24 weeks, a **medical board's approval** amounts to **bureaucratic surveillance** over women's bodies — what **Michel Foucault** called **biopower** (control over the body).
- (4) Treating '**fetal abnormality**' as a separate category reeks of **ableism** — which legitimises the disabled as unproductive; but (as **Erving Goffman** says) 'normal' and 'abnormal' is only a matter of **perspective**.

QUICK REVISION

- MTP Act: gestational limit 20 → 24 weeks; 'pregnant wife' → 'pregnant woman'.
- Medicalization of the female body (state/doctors control the body); Adrienne Rich ('Of Woman Born' — male doctors replacing female midwives).
- Compulsory heterosexuality / gender binary; Foucault's biopower (medical board surveillance); ableism (Goffman's normal/abnormal = perspective).

The Middle Class

29.1 Sanskritization: Modernizing or Traditionalizing?

KEY CONCEPT

- **Sanskritization is both a modernizing and a traditionalizing force.**
- It is a **modernizing force for the upper caste** — who exchanged their accumulated cultural, economic and symbolic capital for new capital (modern western education, trade and commerce); the primary beneficiaries were the **Brahmins and Banias**.
- It is a **traditionalizing force for the lower caste** — who emulated the cultural lifestyle of the upper castes.
- Contemporary dimension: reservation (an affirmative-action/westernizing force) uplifted the lower castes, which threatened the upper-caste position — so the upper castes too began **demanding reservation** to retain their position (studied by **Harold Gould**).

29.2 Ramkrishna Mukherjee and the Rise of Class

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ramkrishna Mukherjee** analysed 250 years of British rule through a **Marxist perspective** (like A. R. Desai), in two books: '**The Rise and Fall of the East India Company**' (as a historian) and '**The Dynamics of a Rural Society**' (as a sociologist — a study of **Birbhum**, Bengal).
- Before British rule the village was **egalitarian and undifferentiated** (a largely homogeneous body of peasants, with no class differentiation). With the British, **land became private property** — and a **three-tier class structure emerged: landlords, peasants and landless agricultural labourers**.
- This is **historical materialism**: class formation follows the change in the means of production. It provided the **base for later Marxist village studies** (Thorner's Malik/Kisan/Mazdoor; Gough's five classes).
- **One class → three classes (differentiation) → five classes (more differentiation) = the formation of the middle class.**

29.3 Theories of Class

KEY CONCEPT

- **Marx:** a class = people with a **similar relation to the means of production**.
- **Weber:** a class = people with a **similar market situation**, hence equal life chances.
- **Erik Olin Wright:** **contradictory class locations** — one can be a member of two or three classes at once (a worker and a shareholder).
- **Frank Parkin:** class is defined not by production/market but by the **strategy employed to exclude others and monopolise resources** (social closure).
- **Anthony Giddens:** the **middle class is the educated class** (the entrepreneur = upper class; the worker = lower class).
- **Shulamith Firestone:** **sex class** — men and women are the historic classes.
- **Pakulski & Waters:** the '**death of class**' — today **status (taste)** matters more than class.

29.4 Marx vs Weber on the Middle Class

KEY CONCEPT

- **Marx — polarization, not proliferation:** the middle class (the **petty bourgeoisie**) will **sink into the ranks of the proletariat** — **proletarianization** (a term coined by **Raymond Aron**).
- The laws of capitalism: the **law of general accumulation** (capitalists cut wages and install machines — 'dead labour' replaces 'living labour' — so workers lose purchasing power); then **overproduction + underconsumption** → **recession**, in which small businesses collapse and their owners **join the proletariat**. Hence there is no real scope for the middle class.
- **Weber — proliferation, not polarization:** he identified **four classes** (propertied upper class, propertyless white-collar workers, petty bourgeoisie, manual labourers); the **middle class (white-collar + petty bourgeois) will GROW** — as the economy, consumption and **rationalization** (efficiency, calculability, predictability, control) expand.

29.5 Frank Parkin: Social Closure

KEY CONCEPT

- **Frank Parkin's** strategies of social closure:
- **Exclusionary social closure** — the upper class excludes others and monopolises resources.
- **Usurpatory social closure** — the lower class 'usurps' resources (e.g. the Dalit movement — temple entry, the Mahad Satyagraha — seizing the ritual resource from the upper castes).
- **Dual closure** — a group that has usurped resources then acts like the elites and excludes its own: **Dalit men exclude Dalit women** (the Dalit movement is really a Dalit-men's movement). This is why **Dalit feminism** arose (Sharmila Rege, Jyotiba Phule, Savitribai Phule, Gail Omvedt) — usurping from **upper-caste women and lower-caste men** (because

the Indian women's movement was equated with upper-caste women's concerns).

29.6 The Indian Middle Class: B. B. Misra and Pavan Varma

KEY CONCEPT

- **B. B. Misra** — the **first scholar on the Indian middle class**: the origin of the contemporary middle class (doctors, engineers, bureaucrats, lawyers) can be traced to **colonialism and subsequent industrialization**. (Before the British, India had artisans, traders and merchants, but colonialism made this middle class **voluminous and visible**.)
- **Pavan Varma** — the middle class should **not be limited to consumption**; it is **equally about VALUES** (like **Goldthorpe's** 'affluent workers' — who called themselves middle class for their new income, though they lacked the values: earning but reinvesting rather than merely consuming — the **Protestant work ethic**; Benjamin Franklin's 'money begets money').
- **Amartya Sen** (in 'The Argumentative Indian') characterises the middle class as **argumentative** (never conceding a point) and self-appointed **custodian of Indian culture** — but one must first be educated to argue.

29.7 Old vs New Middle Class

KEY CONCEPT

- The **old middle class** is pre-1990s; the **new middle class** is post-LPG reforms (1990s onwards).
- **What is 'new' about the new middle class**:
 1. It is the **post-90s consumption class** — the main **driver of economic growth**.
 2. It is **more socially inclusive** — not only upper castes (the old middle class — doctors, lawyers, professors — were largely Brahmins and Banias), though the low castes remain **underrepresented**.
 3. Its orientation is to the **private sector, IT and entrepreneurship** (start-up culture, 'unicorns') — unlike the old middle class's orientation to government jobs; it looks to **Western education** (Oxford, Harvard, Silicon Valley) and treats **English as a passport to success**.
 4. It prefers **simple laws and hassle-free processes** (Digital India), dislikes subsidies, wants economic growth, and acts as a **watchful taxpayer** (RTI).
- **Social composition** (2011): about **50% of India** was in this 'new middle class', and **67% of that 50% were upper-caste Hindu men** — the upper castes are overrepresented, the lower castes underrepresented.
- The middle class is the **biggest vote bank** in India (influencers), and is concerned about environment, gender rights, water conservation, subsidies, and the tax-expenditure relation.

QUICK REVISION

- Sanskritization = modernizing (upper caste) + traditionalizing (lower caste); reservation → upper caste also demand reservation (Harold Gould).
- Ramkrishna Mukherjee: egalitarian village → private property → three-tier class (landlord/peasant/landless labourer); base for Thorner & Gough; 1 class → 3 → 5 = middle class.
- Class theories: Marx (production), Weber (market), Wright (contradictory locations), Parkin (social closure), Giddens (educated = middle), Firestone (sex class), Pakulski-Waters (death of class).
- Marx: polarization/proletarianization (middle class sinks); Weber: proliferation (middle class grows).
- Parkin: exclusionary, usurpationary, dual closure (Dalit men exclude Dalit women → Dalit feminism).
- Indian middle class: B. B. Misra (colonial origin), Pavan Varma (values, not just consumption; Goldthorpe).
- Old (pre-90s) vs new (post-LPG): consumption driver, socially inclusive, private-sector/IT/entrepreneurial orientation, English = success, hassle-free/digital; 2011: 50% new middle class, 67% UCHM; biggest vote bank.

The Middle Class: Structure, Ethos and the New Woman

30.1 Cultural vs Structural Change in Caste

KEY CONCEPT

- For 'changes in caste since independence', distinguish **structural** from **cultural** change:
- **Structural change** — caste assumed a **new (political) avatar** (a new limb was added): **structural differentiation** — from caste associations to multiple associations (CII, the National Women's Commission — not caste-based). **Politicization of caste = structural change**.
- **Cultural change** — the old limbs are weakening: **secularization of caste = cultural change**. **Endogamy/hypergamy** is weakening (from restricted hypergamy to open intercaste marriage) and the **caste panchayat's** regulatory role is declining.

30.2 Obituary to Caste and the Peculiar Tenacity of Caste

KEY CONCEPT

- **M. N. Srinivas's 'Obituary to Caste'** (an article, later the book '**Caste: Its Twentieth Century Avatar**', c. 1990): he invited scholars to write on the changing role of caste. His follower **Jayaram** wrote of the **decline of caste as a system and its transformation into interest groups** — decline due to **economic change** (occupation no longer linked to caste), transformation into interest groups due to **political change**.
- Srinivas's line: '**caste as a system which has endured for over 2,000 years is dead or dying, although individual castes are thriving**' — caste is now only **identity**, not a system. ('Caste is only identity now' — the line by **Dipankar Gupta**, inspired by Srinivas.)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Srinivas & Beteille's article 'The Peculiar Tenacity of Caste'**: caste is in **decline in three areas** (religion/ritual, marriage, occupation) but **rising in one (politics)**.
- **Religion/ritual**: earlier there was physical distancing by caste (in South India, the **Nairs** could approach within 16 feet of the **Namboodiri** Brahmins, other castes 64 or 128 feet); now there is a **secular trend of decline in the ritual basis of caste** — but untouchability continues in a **new form: atrocity** (Rohith Vemula, mob/cow lynching).

- **Marriage:** earlier endogamy + restricted hypergamy; now **intercaste marriage irrespective of anuloma/pratiloma**. Beteille: the **Radhi** and **Barendra** (both Bengali Brahmin jatis) earlier could not intermarry; today that is merely a marriage within the Brahmin community. Intercaste marriage happens **within adjacent sub-castes** (Brahmin–Baidya, Baidya–Kayastha). There is '**role distance**' (Goffman) — 'I don't believe in caste, but by the way, what is your caste?'
- **Occupation:** at the **general level** the caste–occupation link is weakening (mobility, merit, reservation); at the **specific level** it persists — the **Teli** (oil-presser) sub-castes still use different traditional techniques (one bullock vs two bullocks).

30.3 European vs Indian Middle Class (Ahmad & Rehfeld)

KEY CONCEPT

- A comparison between the **European middle class (EMC)** and the **Indian middle class (IMC)**:
- **Origin:** the EMC is **orthogenetic** (born within Europe, out of European conditions); the IMC is **heterogenetic** (born of colonialism).
- **Function:** the EMC developed to **question authority** (the 'third estate' — intellectuals, lawyers, doctors — overthrew the first and second estates, the French Revolution); the IMC **initially supported British rule, then gradually questioned it** (moderates → extremists → revolutionaries → Gandhi), and became the **leader of the nationalist movement**.

30.4 Yogendra Singh: Urban vs Rural Middle Class

KEY CONCEPT

- **Yogendra Singh:** the Indian middle class is **not homogeneous** — it is divided into the **urban middle class (UMC)** and the **rural middle class (RMC)**.
- **Similarity:** both share the same **ideological ethos** — **conservative and utilitarian**.
- **Difference — antagonism:** the RMC shares an **antagonistic relation** with the UMC (entrepreneurs and professional groups). Reasons: **stagnation in agricultural development, unfavourable price policy, land fragmentation, and non-availability of non-farm occupations** — so even the rich RMC faced **downward mobility** and felt alienated from the UMC (e.g. the farmer protests — the RMC resenting the urban middle class).

30.5 Dipankar Gupta and Beteille: Mistaken Modernity and Middle Classes

CRITICAL POINT

Dipankar Gupta (in 'Mistaken Modernity'): the Indian middle class is **only externally modern** — it equates modernity with the **consumption of durable goods**. 'The bigger car they have, the more laws they are going to violate' (Ferrari/Lamborghini owners who do not follow traffic

rules). **Sitaram Yechury** calls this '**modern noxity**' (toxic modernity), not modernity.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Beteille**: India has **middle classes**, not a **middle class** — the **upper middle class** (which follows a **consumerist culture** — replacing goods with each new launch) and the **lower middle class** (only consumers, buying **cheaper imitations** of designer labels, e.g. at Palika Bazaar). The UMC looks up to the **Western elites**; the LMC looks up to the **UMC**.
- **Material progress is taking place, but consumerism is yet to evolve** — and the middle class must also have a **modern ethos** (which it lacks). Therefore the middle class is **neither traditional nor modern** — it is **transitional** (consumption without ethos; a confused ethos; dependent on the market, not the state).
- The middle class is **highly differentiated** and cannot be called homogeneous.

30.6 Women in the Middle Class and the New Woman

KEY CONCEPT

- **Women in the middle class**: in the **upper middle class**, the daughter is educated **at par with the son** but **discouraged from higher education** (and passed off in marriage — education can become a hindrance to finding a match). In the **lower middle class**, education is seen as a **passport to marriage** (the husband needs an educated wife). Tolerance for **inter-caste/inter-religious marriage is high in the UMC and low in the LMC** (norms override individuals).
- **The new (middle-class) woman** — empowered and ambitious: she will not sit silent, reports harassment, tolerates no gender inequality, and takes **instrumental roles** (CRPF Cobra commandant, Air Force pilot, army); she prefers IPS to IAS. She is the living symbol of the ongoing feminist wave.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Conclusion**: the middle class has witnessed tremendous changes — from the **Nehruvian civil-service-oriented salariate** to the **entrepreneur, IT and private-sector oriented** middle class; 'the middle class is no more just a class, it is a **set of classes**'.
- Other middle classes: the **Dalit middle class** (Dalit consciousness and assertion — studied by **Gurram Srinivas** of JNU) and the **Muslim middle class** (which supports reformist legislation like the abolition of triple talaq).

QUICK REVISION

- Structural change (politicization, new political avatar) vs cultural change (secularization, endogamy/caste panchayat weakening).
- Srinivas's 'Obituary to Caste' (caste as a system is dead/dying; individual castes thrive; caste

= only identity); Jayaram (decline → interest groups).

- 'Peculiar Tenacity of Caste' (Srinivas & Beteille): decline in religion/ritual (physical distancing → atrocity), marriage (restricted hypergamy → open intercaste within adjacent sub-castes; Radhi/Barendra; role distance), occupation (general decline, specific persistence — Teli); rise only in politics.
- Ahmad & Rehfeld: EMC (orthogenetic, questions authority) vs IMC (heterogenetic, colonialism, led nationalism).
- Yogendra Singh: urban vs rural middle class (same ethos; antagonism — price policy, land fragmentation, no non-farm jobs, downward mobility).
- Gurcharan Das: NEP 1991 → entrepreneurial surge; Dipankar Gupta ('Mistaken Modernity' — externally modern, 'bigger car, more law-breaking'; Yechury's 'modern noxity'); Beteille (middle classes; transitional; consumerism without ethos).
- Women: UMC (par education, no higher education) vs LMC (education = passport to marriage); the new woman (ambitious, instrumental roles).
- Dalit middle class (Gurram Srinivas), Muslim middle class (reformist); 'a set of classes'.

The Women's Movement

31.1 The Four Waves of Feminism

KEY CONCEPT

- **Feminism** is an ideology traceable to the **French Revolution**, initiated by **Mary Wollstonecraft** (author of 'A Vindication of the Rights of Women').
- It developed in **four waves**: the **first wave** (1848–1920, socialist feminism), the **second wave** (1960–80s, radical feminism), the **third wave** (1990s, intersectional and queer feminism), and the **fourth wave** (2012 onwards, social-media feminism).
- The journey is from a **homogeneous** movement (for middle-class white women) to an increasingly **heterogeneous** one (for all women and men).

31.2 The First Wave: Socialist Feminism (1848–1920)

KEY CONCEPT

- The **first wave** (also called **socialist feminism**, spread over the UK, US and Canada) demanded **political justice** — women's representation and **franchise** (the right to vote and be voted).
- Key names: **Mary Wollstonecraft**, **John Stuart Mill**, **Jane Addams** and **Sojourner Truth**.
- The first country to give women the franchise was **New Zealand** (a British colony), followed by the US campaign led by **Elizabeth Cady Stanton**, whose '**Declaration of Sentiments**' listed 16 ways women are oppressed (no property rights, unequal divorce rights, exclusion from the economy, domestic isolation).
- Political justice in the US was ensured by the **19th Amendment (1920)**.

31.3 The Second Wave: Radical Feminism (1960–80s)

KEY CONCEPT

- The **second wave** (also called **radical feminism**) saw a **split between liberal and radical feminism**: the **liberals** sought **equality of opportunity at the workplace and home**; the **radicals** sought the same but by **deconstructing patriarchal society** ('women of the world unite — you have nothing to lose but men'), and they also spoke for **lesbians**.
- Scholars: **Shulamith Firestone** ('the history of all society has been the history of sex-class

struggle'), **Simone de Beauvoir** ('one is not born a woman, one becomes one'), **Betty Friedan**, **Kate Millett**.

- The demand was now **political + economic + social justice**: economic = minimising the gender wage gap, equal pay for equal work, safe working conditions; social = education, **reproductive rights**, sexuality, abortion (a woman's right over her body).
- The slogan '**the personal is political**' — a woman's personal life (sex, relationships, access to abortion, domestic unpaid labour) reflects **sexist power structures**, not mere personal choice.
- Achievements: the **Equal Pay Act (1963)**, **Equal Remuneration Act (1976)** and **Maternity Benefit Act (1961)** in India; **Title IX** (US education/sports rights); **Roe v. Wade** (legalising abortion) and the right to birth control.

31.4 The Third Wave: Intersectionality (1990s)

KEY CONCEPT

- By the end of the 1980s it was realised that the earlier waves fought for **white, middle-class women** — so the **third wave** was dominated by **intersectional feminism** (founded by **Kimberlé Crenshaw**) and **queer feminism** (lesbian, gay, transgender, intersex).
- **Intersectionality**: a Dalit lesbian woman is the victim of **three forces at once** — Brahmanism (as a Dalit), patriarchy (as a woman) and homophobia (as a lesbian) — making her a special victim ('the most excluded of the excluded').
- The issues fought: **trafficking of women**, **sexual harassment at the workplace**, **domestic violence**, **body surgery**, **surrogacy**, **pornification of the media** (the **male gaze** — the camera centres the woman's body as an object), and **derogatory terms** (slut, bitch — which reproduce women's subordinate place).
- The **idea of beauty is socially constructed** (Renaissance 'chubby' beauty vs today's 'zero size'), constructed through Bollywood.

31.5 The Fourth Wave: #MeToo and Social Media (2012 onwards)

KEY CONCEPT

- The **fourth wave** (2012 onwards) **empowered women through the internet**, using **print and social media** to collaborate and mobilise women.
- Movements: **#MeToo** (begun in America by black women), **Time's Up**, **One Billion Rising**, the **Slut Walk**, and the **Gay Pride** movement — symbols of solidarity against the shared sexist power structure.
- It speaks about **both boys and girls**: not just maternity benefit but **paternity benefit/leave** — men should also be engaged parents and free to express emotions.
- Distinctions: **transgender** (the soul/gender — 'I feel like a woman') vs **transsexual** (bodily change) — the movement is now **LGBTQIA+ inclusive**.

31.6 Indian Feminism: The First Phase

KEY CONCEPT

- Indian feminism has its base in **colonial times** and was initiated **not by women but by men** (and the British):
- **William Bentinck** — the **Abolition of Sati (1829)**; the **Widow Remarriage Act (1856)** — Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar; the **Female Infanticide Prevention Act (1870)**; women's education — Vidyasagar, Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Dayanand Saraswati; the **Age of Consent Act (1891)** (raised the age of consent from 10 to 12).
- The first women initiators: **Savitribai Phule** (1848 — the first school for girls), **Tarabai Shinde** ('Stri Purush Tulna', 1882 — India's first feminist text, 'a comparison between men and women'), and **Pandita Ramabai** (who openly criticised patriarchy and Hinduism, and converted to Christianity as an act of rebellion).
- The **first phase spans 1850–1915**.

31.7 Indian Feminism: Gandhi and the Nationalist Phase

KEY CONCEPT

- In the **second phase (1915–1960)**, women's concerns were **overtaken by the nationalist movement** — women's rights were sidelined as the struggle against colonial rule intensified.
- **Gandhi revived women's presence in the public sphere** by initiating them into the **non-violent civil disobedience movement**, using **feminine methods** (fasting, self-abnegation, renunciation, sacrifice, tolerance, caring) — women participated in the **Dandi March** and civil disobedience.
- Women's organisations emerged: the **Women's India Association (1917)**, the **National Council of Women in India (1925)**, the **All India Women's Conference (1927)**, and the **National Federation of Indian Women** — widening women's political participation, franchise and leadership, and taking up social evils (sati, purdah, widow remarriage).
- By the end of the Quit India Movement, nationalist ambitions had again **subjugated women's concerns to national interests**.

31.8 Indian Feminism: Protest Politics (1970s) and Eco-Feminism

KEY CONCEPT

- From the **1970s**, there was a shift from **welfare politics to protest politics** (radical feminism taking over liberal feminism): feminists challenged **unequal wages, domestic unpaid labour, and women's use as a 'reserve army of labour'** — the aim was to abolish the free service of women (women as 'keep capital').
- The **mid-1970s** saw the rise of **autonomous women's organisations (left-wing, with no political-party affiliation)**: **SEWA** (Self-Employed Women's Association, Gujarat), the

Working Women's Forum (Tamil Nadu), and the **Shramik Mahila Sangathan** (Maharashtra). They **shunned the welfare approach and adopted protest politics** — mobilising women against dowry, domestic violence, workplace discrimination and sexual exploitation.

- This led to the **anti-dowry movement** (the **Dowry Prohibition Amendment Act, 1984**, amending the Dowry Prohibition Act of 1961) and the **anti-sati movement** (after the **Roop Kanwar** case).

KEY CONCEPT

- The **Chipko movement** (a deforestation/ecological movement) saw women in the Himalayan region saving trees from contractors. This is **eco-feminism** (led by **Vandana Shiva**): an **attack on nature is an attack on women** — the same **patriarchy** exploits both. Women depend on forests for fuel, fodder, fruits and herbs, so 'development' (big dams, megawatts) comes at the cost of women's livelihood — just as **A. G. Frank** said the development of the core comes at the cost of the underdevelopment of the periphery.
- Note: dowry cannot simply be 'banned' because it is redefined as 'gift' (the idea of the gift — **Marcel Mauss**, Durkheim's nephew).

QUICK REVISION

- Four waves: first (1848–1920, socialist, political justice, NZ first franchise, Stanton, 19th Amendment); second (1960–80s, radical, liberal vs radical split, 'personal is political', Firestone/de Beauvoir/Friedan/Millett, Equal Pay/Roe v. Wade); third (1990s, intersectionality/Kimberlé Crenshaw + queer feminism, trafficking/harassment/male gaze); fourth (2012, #MeToo, social media, paternity, LGBTQIA+).
- Indian feminism: initiated by men/British (Bentinck 1829, Widow Remarriage 1856, Age of Consent 1891); women initiators (Savitribai Phule, Tarabai Shinde's 'Stri Purush Tulna', Pandita Ramabai).
- Nationalist phase: Gandhi's feminine methods; AIWC 1927 etc.; women's concerns subjugated to nationalism.
- 1970s protest politics: autonomous women's organisations (SEWA, Working Women's Forum, Shramik Mahila Sangathan); anti-dowry (1984), anti-sati (Roop Kanwar); Chipko & eco-feminism (Vandana Shiva).
- Dowry can't be banned (gift — Marcel Mauss).

Indian Feminism and Environmentalism

32.1 Indian Feminism: The Four Phases

KEY CONCEPT

- The Indian women's movement is divided into phases: **social reform during the freedom movement** (1850–1950s), **1947–1975**, **1976–1985**, and the continuing phase.
- **First phase** — initiated by men and the British: the **Abolition of Sati** (William Bentinck, 1829), the **Widow Remarriage Act** (I. C. Vidyasagar, 1856), the **Female Infanticide Prevention Act**, women's education (Vidyasagar, Raja Ram Mohan Roy, Dayanand Saraswati), and the **Age of Consent Act** (1891, Lord Lansdowne — raising the age from 10 to 12). Women-led: **Savitribai Phule** (first girls' school, 1848), **Tarabai Shinde** (Stri Purush Tulna), **Pandita Ramabai**.
- **Second phase (1915–1960)** — the nationalist movement overtook women's concerns; **Gandhi** initiated women into the movement using feminine methods (sacrifice, fasting, tolerance). Women's organisations: the **All India Women's Conference** (an NGO founded by **Margaret Cousins**, affiliated with the Indian National Congress), the **National Federation of Indian Women** (the women's wing of the CPI), the **Women's India Association** (1917) and the **National Council of Women in India** (1925).
- **Post-1947** — nation-building took precedence; the Constitution gave franchise and civic rights (**Article 14**, DPSPs — equal pay for equal work, maternal/child care). The **state adopted a patronizing role** (women as a 'weaker section'), so **Indian women did not have to struggle for basic rights as Western women did** (who fought against a patriarchal state).

KEY CONCEPT

- From the **1970s**: **welfare politics** → **protest politics**. Feminists challenged **unequal wages**, **relegation to unskilled work**, and **women's use as a 'reserve army of labour'** — the aim was to **abolish the free service of women** (women as cheap capital). Feminist class-consciousness spread across tribal, Dalit, Muslim and lower-class women. **1975** was the International Decade for Women.
- **Left-party-based women's organisations** (SEWA in Gujarat, the Working Women's Forum in Tamil Nadu, the Shramik Mahila Sangathan in Maharashtra) worked for the **economic upheaval** of women — fighting **public patriarchy**. **Autonomous women's organisations** (no party/trade-union affiliation) worked for **political and social upheaval** — politicising violence against women, and fighting **private patriarchy** (dowry, domestic violence). They

shunned the welfare approach and adopted protest politics.

- Results: the **anti-dowry movement** (Dowry Prohibition Amendment Act, 1984 — only limiting, not banning, dowry), the **anti-sati movement** (after the **Roop Kanwar** case — the Commission of Sati Prevention Bill), and the **Chipko movement**.

32.2 The Two Goals: Corporate and Liberal Feminism

KEY CONCEPT

- The Indian women's movement worked for **two goals** (Jana Everett's classification):
- **1. Liberation/upliftment of women** — reforming social practices so women can play a constructive role — called **corporate feminism**.
- **2. Equal rights for men and women** — extending to women the civil rights men enjoy (political, economic, familial) — called **liberal feminism** (which works through law, asking the state for equal representation — not overthrowing patriarchy).
- Other classifications: **Kalpana Shah** (moderate/women's-rights, radical and socialist feminism); **Sangari & Vaid** (modernising patriarchal modes of regulating women vs democratising gender relations).

32.3 The Issues: Brahmanism and the Dalit-Woman Question

CRITICAL POINT

- **The big issue of the women's movement:** the concerns of low-caste women are **completely absent**. Both the left-party and autonomous organisations (inspired by Western feminism) **did not address Brahmanism and Brahmanical patriarchy** — the specifically Indian issues of controlling female sexuality.
- **All women do not suffer the same kind or level of discrimination:** upper-caste women face dowry deaths and family control over mobility/sexuality; **Dalit women face the collective, public threat of rape, sexual assault and physical violence**. Most rape in India is against low-caste women, and the **conviction rate for rape of Dalit women is under 2%** (against ~25% overall) — because of the caste nexus between the police, the perpetrator and the political class (highlighted by Kancha Ilaiah). (Nirbhaya and the Hyderabad victim were upper-caste; the Hathras Dalit victim's body was burnt by the administration.)
- The problem: **'all Dalits are assumed to be males, and all women are assumed to be a uniform category'** — leading to the **universalization of the upper-caste woman's experience (and the Dalit male's experience)**.
- **Christine Delphy:** the home too is a **mode of production** — the upper-caste housewife employs a maid (a Dalit woman) as her 'clerk', and exercises her power over her.

32.4 Dalit Feminism and the Autonomous Dalit Women's Organisations

KEY CONCEPT

- In the 1990s, **Autonomous Dalit Women's Organisations** emerged (the **National Federation of Dalit Women**, the **All India Dalit Women's Forum**, the **Dalit Mahila Samiti**) — underlining the **Brahmanism/casteism of the mainstream feminist movement and the patriarchy of Dalit politics**. The split in Indian feminism thus came in the form of **upper-caste vs Dalit women's organisations** (like the West's liberal/radical split).
- **Dalit women suffer triple oppression**: (1) oppressed by the upper castes (casteism), (2) by the Hindu patriarchal system (control of sexuality), and (3) by **Dalit men** (patriarchy within). They are pushed into bonded labour, the devadasi system, sex trafficking, witch-hunting and prostitution.
- **Sharmila Rege**: Dalit feminism challenges the '**masculinization of Dalithood**' (the Dalit movement as a Dalit-men's movement) and the '**savarnization of womanhood**' (the women's movement as an upper-caste women's movement). The **Dalit feminist standpoint is emancipatory** — it interrogates the Brahminical middle-class biases of earlier feminists.
- **SRED** (Society for Rural Education and Development, a Tamil Nadu NGO, founded 1979): recognising that **land ownership** is central to fighting caste-based discrimination (Bina Agarwal), it formed women's collectives that identified and occupied wastelands — giving Dalit women land ownership, dignity and status.

EXAMPLE

Contemporary issues: **son meta-preference** (noted by the Economic Survey — more among the dependent upper-caste woman), **sex-selective abortion** (sex-determination tests are legally banned but continue), the **declining sex ratio**, and **sex trafficking** (largely a lower-caste issue — see the International Justice Mission).

32.5 Gail Omvedt: What Counts as a Women's Movement

KEY CONCEPT

- **Gail Omvedt** (an American sociologist who settled in India in 1983 and took Indian citizenship) distinguished four kinds of movement — only the last is a true women's movement:
- 1. **Movements where women participate** — general movements (anti-price-rise, nationalist) in which women are present but the family structure is not the focus — participation, not action.
- 2. **Movements of women** — movements on general issues (slum improvement, price rise) where women are the only participants — but this **may confirm the gender division of labour** (men fight for wage rise, women against price rise) and is not a women's movement.
- 3. **Women's reform movements** — education, abolition of sati (pre-independence) — which did **not challenge the fundamental structure of oppression** in family and society (so dowry could simply be redefined as 'gift').

- 4. **Women's liberation movements** — the real women's movement, channeled by the ideology of **fighting the sexual division of labour and patriarchy** (e.g. the demand for 'wage for housework' in Tamil Nadu politics).
- The **Chipko movement** is only a 'movement of women' (a fight for livelihood), not a women's movement — the women did not question the sexual division of labour that made them collect forest produce.

32.6 Ecological Feminism: Val Plumwood and Vandana Shiva

KEY CONCEPT

- **Val Plumwood** — the Western rationalist worldview runs on **dualism** (human/nature, reason/emotion, mind/body, masculinity/femininity): **masculinity is identified with mind, logic and reason; women with emotion, body and nature**. This dualistic framework sanctions the domination of both women and nature. Hence 'ecology is feminine and development is patriarchal' — the same force exploits women and nature.
- **Vandana Shiva** (the Indian eco-feminist): 'the modern idea of development is based on Western patriarchy' — science, rationality and development are a **Western patriarchal project**, responsible for the **subjugation of women and the destruction of nature**.
- In ancient times, **nature was seen as a living being** and identified with the **nurturing mother — prakriti as a feminine principle** (nature provides food and is fertile, just as the mother does). People were **accountable to nature** (the Ramayana and Mahabharata show nature being revered and permission being sought). Land was **communal** — the earth was a goddess; the idea of **private property over nature is a Western patriarchal idea**.
- With modern science, **prakriti is viewed as dead, separate from man, inferior — and exploited for machines and finished goods**. The human–nature relation shifted from **symmetrical/horizontal to vertical** (man controls nature). The reaction to this subjugation: the **Chipko movement**, **Narmada Bachao**, the **Silent Valley (Kerala)** and **Kudankulam (Tamil Nadu)** protests.
- This is the answer to the PYQ: 'Western patriarchy which surrenders feminine principles is the new development project in India — comment.'

32.7 The Evolution of Western Environmentalism

KEY CONCEPT

- Environmental consciousness developed **late in the West** (India had it in its ethics). Its stages:
- 1. **The conservation era (mid-1800s)** — inspired by **Henry David Thoreau**: preserve the environment; environmental laws to regulate industry and protect wilderness; groups like the **Sierra Club** and the **Earth Liberation Front**; national parks by legislation (**Yellowstone, 1872**; the Grand Canyon).
- 2. **The modern environmental movement (1950 onwards)** — a response to ecological

disasters: **Rachel Carson's 'Silent Spring'** criticised DDT (the US EPA later banned it) and brought environmental issues to the public, ushering in '**green democracy**'. (In India, a parallel movement arose against the pesticide **Endosulfan**.)

- **3. Mainstream environmentalism (1970 onwards)** — the **Sierra Club and Greenpeace** became institutionalised pressure groups, providing scientific and economic expertise and acquiring land for preservation (forums like Rio+20, the IPCC).
- **4. Grassroots environmentalism (1980s)** — bottom-up: local volunteers and tribal groups, drawing on **feminism, Marxism (ecological Marxism) and spirituality**, and cutting across ethnic, racial, gender and class lines.
- America even has a **Green Party** (the only party whose agenda is environmentalism — in a two-party system explained by **Duverger's law**).

QUICK REVISION

- Indian feminism: social reform (men/British) → nationalist phase (Gandhi's feminine methods; AIWC/NFIW) → 1970s protest politics (left-party orgs = public patriarchy/economics; autonomous orgs = private patriarchy/dowry/domestic violence; anti-dowry 1984, anti-sati/Roop Kanwar, Chipko).
- Two goals: corporate feminism (liberation/upliftment) + liberal feminism (equal rights) — Jana Everett; also Kalpana Shah; Sangari & Vaid.
- Issues: Brahmanism & Brahmanical patriarchy ignored; Dalit women's concerns absent (rape conviction <2% vs ~25%); 'all Dalits = male, all women = uniform'; Christine Delphy (home as mode of production).
- 1990s: autonomous Dalit women's organisations; Sharmila Rege ('masculinization of Dalithood, savarnization of womanhood'); triple oppression; SRED (land ownership); Dalit feminist standpoint emancipatory.
- Gail Omvedt: movements where women participate / of women / women's reform / women's liberation (only the last is a true women's movement; Chipko is 'of women').
- Eco-feminism: Val Plumwood (dualism — masculinity=mind/reason, women=nature/emotion; 'ecology is feminine, development is patriarchal'); Vandana Shiva (development = Western patriarchal project; prakriti as nurturing mother → dead/exploited; Chipko/Narmada/Silent Valley/Kudankulam).
- Western environmentalism: conservation (Thoreau, Yellowstone, Sierra Club) → modern (Rachel Carson's Silent Spring, DDT) → mainstream (Greenpeace institutionalised) → grassroots (feminism/Marxism/spirituality); Green Party.

The Environment Movement

33.1 Environmental Racism and Eco-Justice

KEY CONCEPT

- **Eco-justice** emerged in response to environmental inequities — the **differential treatment of communities** regarding ecological concerns. Some communities bear a **disproportionate burden** of environmental problems.
- **Environmental racism** (a concept of **Robert Bullard**): environmental policy/practice negatively affects groups based on class, race or ethnicity.
- The **NIMBY syndrome** ('Not In My Backyard'): developed countries dump their waste elsewhere — e.g. solid waste in America is disposed in **black/African-American settlements**, and Delhi's waste is dumped in unregulated settlements/slums. **Life chances are determined by geographical location, class and race.**

EXAMPLE

Eco-terrorism (e.g. the **Earth Liberation Front**) is radical grassroots environmentalism that uses **violent and illegal methods** against businesses/organisations (mining etc.) believed to threaten the environment — protecting the environment through non-legitimate means.

33.2 Indian vs Western Environmentalism

Aspect	Western environmentalism	Indian environmentalism
Ideology	Anthropocentric — human needs prioritised over nature (e.g. America withdrawing from Kyoto)	Ecocentric — ecological needs prioritised
Religious basis	Consistent with Judeo-Christian belief in man's domination over earth; human exceptionalism	Reverence for nature integral to Hindu philosophy (Vayu dev, Agni dev, Ganga maa; Advaita Vedanta — Adi Shankara's purusha–prakriti monism)
Origin	Born of scientists (IPCC, UNDP, Rio)	Born as a response to the dominant notion of development/modernity — blossoming in the 1970s with Chipko and tribal resistance (e.g. the Dongria Kondh against bauxite mining)
Class interest	Represents the upper and middle class ('iPhone is eco-friendly', air purifiers)	The environmentalism of the poor
Motivation	Leisure — keeping beautiful places unpolluted	Survival — livelihood depends on the environment
Conservation ideology	Protectionist conservationism	Utilitarian conservationism (people depend on forest produce)
Measure	GNP (gross national product)	Gross nature product

KEY CONCEPT

Convergence — Ulrich Beck's 'Risk Society': modern threats (COVID, global warming, bad air) affect **everyone**, not just a few sections — '**wealth is hierarchic, but smog is democratic**' — so the concern is no longer that of the poor alone (though the rich and poor manage the risk differently).

QUICK REVISION

- Western = anthropocentric, Judeo-Christian (man's domination), born of scientists (IPCC), upper/middle-class, leisure, protectionist, GNP.

- Indian = ecocentric, Hindu reverence for nature (Advaita), response to development/modernity, environmentalism of the poor, survival, utilitarian, gross nature product.
- Convergence (Beck): 'wealth is hierarchic, smog is democratic' — modern risks affect everyone.

33.3 The Evolution of Modern Indian Environmentalism

KEY CONCEPT

- The evolution of modern Indian environmentalism:
- **1970s** — the '**environmentalism of the poor**' (Ram Chandra Guha traces its origin to **Chipko**, followed by protest against commercial logging in the Himalayan foothills, involving both Gandhian and left-wing activists).
- **1980s** — institutionalisation: the **Ministry of Environment and Forests (MoEF&CC)** was set up (upgraded from a department), followed by state-level departments.
- **1990s** — every university made an **environment course mandatory**; the fields of ecological, economic and environmental history emerged.
- **1995** — **anti-environmental backlash**: the Greens, who had made the state accountable (asking where land for new projects would come from), were regarded as the **only obstacle to India's march to greatness**.

KEY CONCEPT

- **India's environmental-management policy followed the 'frontier economics model'** — treating the environment as an **infinite supply of physical resources** for human society (nature–society relation dominated by humans). What is needed instead is an '**eco-development model**' in which development is **synergetic with ecosystem processes** — moving from the '**polluter pays**' principle to the '**pollution prevention pays**' concept.
- The emergence of these movements paved the way for a new development paradigm — **sustainable development** (the **new ecological paradigm**).

33.4 Guha and Gadgil: Eight Environmentalists and Three Individuals

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ram Chandra Guha and Madhav Gadgil** (in '**Ecology and Equity**') described **eight types of environmentalists** in India:
- 1. **Crusading Gandhians** — cite Hindu scriptures; advocate self-realization, ecological prudence, frugality and a return to the pre-capitalist village; against mines, power projects and railways; use non-violent methods (Chipko, Narmada Bachao).
- 2. **Ecological Marxists** — see unequal access to resources as the cause of degradation; favour local-level decision-making (people's science movements); may use Gandhian tactics (the

Silent Valley movement in Kerala — which got a hydroelectric project abandoned).

- 3. **Appropriate technologists** — seek a synthesis of agriculture and industry; advocate small-scale, intermediate, eco-friendly technology (the appropriate-technology wing of Chipko, organising soil/water conservation and afforestation).
- 4. **Wilderness enthusiasts** — e.g. BBC's Planet Earth (David Attenborough); Sunderlal Bahuguna; Greta Thunberg.
- 5. **Guardians of the sacred** — protecting sacred groves (North-East and tribal groups).
- 6. **Community managers** — village forest committees managing 'safety forests' (sacred groves) and 'supply forests' (regulated harvest).
- 7. **Technocrat planners** — who carry out the **Environmental Impact Assessment (EIA)**.
- 8. **Judicial activists** — the National Green Tribunal, and public interest litigation (PIL).

KEY CONCEPT

Gadgil and Guha also observed that Indian development policies create **three types of individuals**: the **omnivores** (the elite beneficiaries of development projects), the **ecosystem people** (those dependent on the natural environment — tribals), and the **ecological refugees** (displaced by mining/development). Independent India has become a **field of conflict between these groups**, triggered by the abuse of natural resources to benefit the omnivore elite.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Anil Agarwal** described **four rays of hope** for India's environment: the **NGO movement**, the **judiciary**, **people's initiatives** (e.g. Ralegan Siddhi — Anna Hazare's village) and the **media**. He called for a '**third war of independence**' — to be fought by post-independence Indians **with themselves** to protect their environment. **Dr. M. P. Parameswaran** spoke of building a '**fourth world**' — combining Marxism, Gandhism, environmentalism, eco-feminism and human rights.
- **Akhilleshwar Pathak** argues that the Indian state largely promoted modernization and capitalism — so the poor, in order to survive, had to collaborate with their oppressors.

33.5 The Chipko Movement

KEY CONCEPT

- **Chipko** (1970s) was an organised resistance to the destruction of forests: ash trees were allotted to private companies (for cement), against which the **Dasholi Gram Swarajya Mandal** (a local cooperative) mobilised. Women **lay down in front of the trucks** (non-violent, Gandhian), and **Chandi Prasad Bhatt** suggested **embracing (hugging) the trees** to prevent them being cut.
- Its **six demands**: (1) recognition of the **traditional rights** of forest people over forest produce; (2) making arid forests green through **people's participation**; (3) forming **village committees** to manage forests; (4) developing **forest-based home industries** (raw material, money and

technique); (5) giving priority to **local varieties** in afforestation; and (6) asking men to **give up alcohol**.

33.6 Theories: Neo-Marxist Environmental Sociology

KEY CONCEPT

- The **neo-Marxist theory** holds that development comes at the cost of natural resources — so capitalism is not sustainable; development and nature are opposed.
- **Treadmill of production**: the modern economic system requires **constant growth** (the iPhone 11, 12, 13...), causing increased resource exploitation; in the 20th century, **consumerism** (the middle/leisure class displaying status through goods) keeps the treadmill running.
- **Ecological Marxism** (John Bellamy Foster): 'labour is the father of material wealth, **earth is its mother**' — the force that subjugates the proletariat is the same force that destroys the earth. Marx condemned capitalism not only for exploiting men and women but for the **metabolic rift** (his term) — the imbalance between human needs and nature's carrying capacity.
- Capitalism **privatises the commons** (forest, air, water; even the 'spectrum'/air is auctioned), and rests on an **inherent contradiction**: more machines to cut labour costs means more exploitation of nature — 'workers of the world, you have nothing to lose but the environment'.
- **World-systems theory**: the world is divided into core and periphery; the rich nations are the main consumers but the **environmental damage falls heaviest on the poor nations** (the concept of **historical responsibility** in the Kyoto Protocol).

33.7 Ecological Modernization and Its Critique

KEY CONCEPT

- The **neoliberal theory — ecological modernization theory** — holds that **modernization is compatible with ecological sustainability** (there is no conflict): the way out of the ecological crisis is **further industrialisation** (green growth/green capitalism — catalytic converters, BS6 emission standards, e-vehicles, solar tracking, vertical gardens).
- It supports **green consumerism and decarbonization**, and informs policy (green contracts, carbon tax, green GDP, the Kyoto Protocol). Its **Environmental Kuznets Curve** says development first degrades, then protects, the environment (an inverted-U: after the turning point, environment improves).
- **Critiques**: **Jevons paradox** (fuel-efficiency gains increase, not decrease, fuel use — cheaper driving means more people drive); the **Netherlands fallacy** (wrongly assuming a rich nation's environmental impact is contained within its national borders).

33.8 Ulrich Beck's Risk Society

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ulrich Beck ('Risk Society')**: traditional societies faced **external risks** (drought, earthquake, famine — unrelated to human action, affecting few sections); modern societies face **manufactured risks** — the outcomes of our **own intervention into nature** (nuclear holocaust, biological weapons, laboratory errors like COVID).
- **Martin Rees ('Our Final Century')** argued we must focus on the **unintended consequences of scientific advancement**. As environmental risks rise, the old class conflicts over the 'wealth cake' lose significance — because the cake itself is poisoned.
- We are thus moving into a **world risk society**, in which **risk consciousness and risk avoidance** become central — because pollution does not respect national boundaries (hence the idea of the global commons).
- In the pandemic, the virus was 'the most democratic virus' — a manufactured risk affecting everyone.

QUICK REVISION

- Environmental racism (Bullard); NIMBY; eco-terrorism (Earth Liberation Front).
- Indian (ecocentric, survival, poor, utilitarian, gross-nature-product) vs Western (anthropocentric, leisure, upper-middle class, protectionist, GNP) environmentalism; convergence via Beck ('smog is democratic').
- Guha & Gadgil: 8 environmentalists (Crusading Gandhians, Ecological Marxists, Appropriate technologists, Wilderness enthusiasts, Guardians of the sacred, Community managers, Technocrat planners, Judicial activists); 3 individuals (omnivores, ecosystem people, ecological refugees).
- Chipko: Dasholi Gram Swarajya Mandal, Chandi Prasad Bhatt (tree-hugging); six demands.
- Neo-Marxist theory: treadmill of production; ecological Marxism (Foster; 'earth is its mother'; metabolic rift); privatisation of commons; world-systems (core-periphery, historical responsibility).
- Ecological modernization: green capitalism, Environmental Kuznets Curve; critiques — Jevons paradox, Netherlands fallacy.
- Beck's Risk Society: external vs manufactured risks; Martin Rees; world risk society.
- PYQs: Chipko as eco-feminism; Western patriarchy (Vandana Shiva); 'has green-cover reduction caused global warming' (Neo-Marxist yes / eco-modernization no); 'anthropogenic influence on climate' (2020); 'humanity at the mercy of nature/technology' (2020) — conclude with the new ecological paradigm (polluter pays → pollution prevention; material-centric → human-centric/Amartya Sen's capability approach).

PYQs: Colonial Knowledge and the Faction-Ridden Village

34.1 PYQ 2020: Colonial Administrators and the Construction of Traditionalism

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTION

- PYQ (2020, 20 marks): “Colonial administrators helped to construct the very traditionalism which marked the Indian society as backward. Comment.”
- **Introduction:** ‘the above statement reflects the reaction to the **Indophobic sentiments** which had downgraded India as backward.’

KEY CONCEPT

- **Bernard Cohn:** ‘history finds data and social anthropology creates data’ — and his student **Nicholas Dirks** (*‘Castes of Mind’*): ‘colonialism not only creates knowledge but is produced by it’.
- **Bernard Cohn’s key view:** the British conquered not only the territory of India but also its **epistemological space** — i.e. *how we know India* (the ancient/medieval/modern frame) is itself a colonial creation. This ‘cultural analysis’ was labelled **ethno-sociology** (McKim Marriott’s term) — creating knowledge about the people you will rule, to justify ruling them.
- **Cohn:** the British devised **investigative modalities** — **historiography, observation and travel, survey/enumeration (census), museology and surveillance** — to collect and generate knowledge of the dominated world; the **accumulation of this knowledge, along with the exercise of power, were parts of the same project of colonialism.**

KEY CONCEPT

- The instruments, one by one:
- **Census — Ghurye’s classical statement:** ‘through the census, the British tried to create solutions for the problems created by them only.’ Caste as a **pan-India phenomenon is a British creation**, and through the census they wanted to give quota/representation to different caste groups — solving a problem of their own making. (The example is **L. Middleton**, Punjab census commissioner, 1921.) The census produced **caste patriotism, caste associations and caste divisions.**

- **Historiography** — history is not only about finding data but **creating data**: colonial historiography shows village India as static, backward, self-sufficient and a 'little republic'.
- **Observation and travel** — British travellers and missionaries (e.g. **Francis Buchanan**, the Jesuits) went into kingdoms, observed and studied their civilisations, and thereby 'created knowledge' about India as a whole.
- **Museum** — a museum lets an outsider 'know' the inside, presenting India in a chronological/evolutionary way, just as the British wanted to know India from its (constructed) past.
- **Gazetteers** (and museums) are equally instruments of this knowledge-creation — to be remembered alongside census, historiography and observation/travel.
- **Contemporary 'colonial hangover'** — the colonialists are gone, but the **caste census still runs**, and it still shows Indian society as backward. Even though the caste census has advantages (delineating policy, channelling resources to unrepresented sections), its **latent dysfunction is that it recreates caste consciousness** in a free, sovereign, equality-speaking India — which is why **Ambedkar's** warning that **Hinduism and democracy cannot survive together** is now more relevant than ever.

QUICK REVISION

- PYQ 2020 (20 marks): 'colonial administrators helped construct the very traditionalism that marked India as backward.'
- Intro: reaction to Indophobic sentiments; Bernard Cohn ('history finds data, social anthropology creates data') + Nicholas Dirks ('colonialism creates knowledge and is produced by it').
- Cohn: British conquered the 'epistemological space'; investigative modalities (historiography, observation/travel, survey/enumeration, museology, surveillance); ethno-sociology (Marriott).
- Instruments: census (Ghurye's 'solution for problems created by them'; L. Middleton 1921; caste as pan-India creation; caste patriotism), historiography (creating data), observation/travel (Buchanan, Jesuits), museum (evolutionary view).
- Contemporary: colonial hangover — caste census still runs; latent dysfunction = recreates caste consciousness; Ambedkar (Hinduism vs democracy).

34.2 PYQ: Is Indian Rural Society a Faction-Ridden Society?

PREVIOUS YEAR QUESTION

- PYQ: "Indian rural society is a faction-ridden society. Discuss." A 'faction' = a division.
- The scholars' field studies all reveal **multiple divisions within rural society**: **Srinivas** (Rampura — Vokkaligas, Lingayats, and the 'untouchable' smiths), **S. C. Dube** (Shamirpet — Hindu jatis, Muslim jatis, untouchables), **Beteille** (Shripuram — Brahmins, non-Brahmins, Adi Dravidas), and **Moffatt** (Andavur — who adds one more dimension: the '**Brahmins of**

the untouchables’).

KEY CONCEPT

Conclusion: seen through the **colonial/Indological lens**, India consists of homogeneous elements (the village, the Brahmins); but seen through the **field-worker’s lens**, India consists of **multiple Brahmins in multiple villages** — finding multiple Brahmins within a single village vindicates the claim that Indian rural society is **faction-ridden** (there is not one Brahmin but many factions within the Brahmins).

QUICK REVISION

- Faction = division; rural society has multiple divisions.
- Srinivas (Rampura), Dube (Shamirpet), Beteille (Shripuram), Moffatt (Andavur ‘Brahmins of the untouchables’).
- Colonial/Indological lens = homogeneous India; field lens = multiple Brahmins in multiple villages → faction-ridden.

Backward Class Movements

35.1 The Meaning of Backward Class and Common Features

KEY CONCEPT

- A **backward class movement** is a movement of the **non-Brahmins against the Brahmins** (the 'forward' section). The four movements in the syllabus are the **Satya Shodak Samaj** (Western India/Maharashtra) and the **Self-Respect Movement, SNDP Movement and Justice Party** (South India) — largely pre-independence.
- **Features common to all backward-class movements:**
- 1. **Initiated by non-Brahmins against Brahmins** — 'non-Brahmin' is a bigger category (Shudras, untouchables, Muslims — all non-Brahmin), so it was a **movement of the exploited majority against the exploiter minority**.
- 2. **Aim: to restructure society by equitable distribution of the resources usurped by the Brahmins** — the five resources being **water, land, education, temple entry and government jobs** (temple entry was a resource because the temple was a site of spirituality, and restricting it maintained Brahmin monopoly).
- 3. **Counter-hegemony against cultural hegemony:** the Brahmins owned and controlled the cultural, economic and political system (not just the means of production), so the movement was a counter-hegemony against that cultural hegemony.
- 4. In Frank Parkin's terms, it was a **usurpatory social closure** against the Brahmins' **exclusionary social closure** (their strategies — scriptures, monopolising education — to justify their claim over resources).
- 5. **Polarisation:** the non-Brahmins consolidated (forgetting their internal caste differences to unite as 'non-Brahmin'), and the Brahmins consolidated in response — producing a clear-cut polarisation.

35.2 Satya Shodak Samaj (Jyotiba Phule)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Jyotiba Phule** (of the **Mali/gardener** caste, a Shudra) — humiliated at a Brahmin friend's wedding, he discovered his caste and resolved to **abolish the caste system** (a radical alteration, like Ambedkar's 'Annihilation of Caste').
- He criticised the social-religious reformers (Raja Ram Mohan Roy, **M. G. Ranade**, Dayanand

Saraswati, Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar, Vivekananda) as **Brahmins operating within a Brahminical framework** — they cut the shoots (sati, widow remarriage, girl education) but never the **roots (Brahminism)**.

- His verdicts: '**Brahmo Samaj is Brahmin Samaj**'; '**Arya Samaj is Aryan Samaj**' (Aryan = Brahmin); '**the Indian National Congress is an Upper-Caste Brahmin Congress.**'
- He organised **Satya Shodak marriages** (marriage without Brahmins — no priest, no ritual, a sacred relation between two people only), sought to **remove Brahmins from birth, death and marriage**, and opened **schools/education for the lower castes**.
- **Reinterpretation of the past**: the Aryan-invasion story is a myth — the **Shudras were the original inhabitants and the original kings** (Bali and Sugriva were Shudra kings); the Aryans came from outside and enslaved them. He wrote **three books**: **Gulam Giri** (1873, 'slavery' — equating the Shudra's condition with the Negro slaves of Africa), **Deen Bandhu** (the thoughts behind the oppressive Aryan Vedic tradition) and **Shetkariyanch Asud** (how the peasants could improve their lives).
- **After Phule's death, Shahu Maharaj** took over the Samaj and **used it for political gain** — fighting for **Kshatriya status** (a place *within* the Varna order, not its abolition) and special political representation — so the radical reform agenda was sidelined and the movement declined.

QUICK REVISION

- Backward class = non-Brahmin (vs Brahmins as forward); movement of exploited majority vs exploiter minority.
- Common features: non-Brahmin origin; redistribute resources (water, land, education, temple entry, government jobs); counter-hegemony vs cultural hegemony; usurpationary vs exclusionary closure; polarisation.
- Satya Shodak Samaj (Phule, Mali/Shudra): abolish caste; reformers cut shoots not roots; Brahmo/Arya Samaj = Brahmin/Aryan Samaj; Congress = Brahmin Congress; Satya Shodak marriage; education; reinterpretation (Shudras = original kings; Bali, Sugriva); three books (Gulam Giri 1873, Deen Bandhu, Shetkariyanch Asud); Shahu Maharaj used it politically → decline.

35.3 The Tamil Renaissance and the Non-Brahmin Movement

KEY CONCEPT

- The **Tamil Renaissance**: classical Tamil texts — **Pattu Pattu, Silappadikaram, Manimekalai and the Sangam literature** — contributed to **Dravidian consciousness**, just as the Vedas, Puranas, Samhitas and Smritis contributed to Brahmanical consciousness.
- Tamil scholars believed that the **Dravidians were the original inhabitants** of the land, and that the Aryans **imposed Sanskrit culture and the caste system** on them. The rediscovery and reinterpretation of these texts led to the rise of the **non-Brahmin movement from 1915 onwards**, and to anti-Brahmin resentment against the Brahmin monopoly over resources.

35.4 The Justice Party

KEY CONCEPT

- The non-Brahmin movement gave rise to the **Justice Party** (the **South India Liberation Front**), formed by **T. M. Nair, Thyagaraja Chetty and Mudaliar**.
- Its demand (in the **Non-Brahmin Manifesto**): **political representation in the councils, and representation in education and government jobs** — i.e. replacing Brahmins in these positions, rather than fighting Brahminism as a structure.
- **Why it collapsed**: its demands (education, jobs, representation) were **elitist/brahminical demands**, not the demands of the real oppressed (the untouchables and peasants — whose demands were food, water, freedom from discrimination). Its **social composition was professional middle class, zamindars and urban business groups** — so it represented feudal and commercial interests only, and **confined itself to the quest for government jobs and offices instead of cultural reform or revival of non-Brahmin culture**.

QUICK REVISION

- Tamil Renaissance: Pattu Pattu, Silappadikaram, Manimekalai, Sangam literature → Dravidian consciousness (vs Brahmanical consciousness from Vedas/Smritis).
- Dravidians = original inhabitants; Aryans imposed Sanskrit/caste.
- Justice Party (South India Liberation Front; Nair, Thyagaraja Chetty, Mudaliar): political representation + education + jobs; elitist demands; professional middle class/zamindars; no cultural reform → collapsed.

35.5 E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker and the Self-Respect Movement

KEY CONCEPT

- **E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker ('Periyar')**: initially a **Gandhian** (non-violent; supported the **Vaikom Satyagraha** temple-entry struggle and the Harijan cause). He joined the **Congress** (which, from 1920, had become inclusive of peasants), but experienced **caste discrimination at the Erode Congress meeting** (the lunch was arranged by caste) — so he quit and called the Congress the '**Brahminical/Upper-Caste Congress**'.
- Having left both the Justice Party and the Congress, he launched the **Self-Respect Movement**. He moved from Gandhi's Varnashram belief to an **Ambedkarite** position — his objectives were to **dissolve the Congress and burn the Shastras** (Vedas, Samhitas, Puranas).
- **Influenced by Marxism** (adding it to his Dravidian ideology) he attacked the **political, cultural and economic system**; influenced by Phule he accepted the **Aryan-invasion theory** and organised **self-respect (inter-caste) marriages**, doing away with the services of priests in birth, death and marriage.
- **Limitations**: (1) its social base was **confined to the upper non-Brahmin castes**; (2) in 1944 Periyar **merged the Justice Party with the Self-Respect League** to form the

Dravida Kazhagam (Dravidar Kazhagam) — turning a social-reform movement into a **purely political** one (which later became the DMK) — thereby **weakening the ideological struggle against Brahmins and Brahminical culture**.

QUICK REVISION

- Periyar (E. V. Ramaswamy Naicker): Gandhian → Ambedkarite after Erode Congress caste discrimination; called Congress 'Brahminical Congress'.
- Self-Respect Movement: dissolve Congress + burn Shastras; + Marxism (attack political/cultural/economic system); + Phule (Aryan invasion; self-respect inter-caste marriages).
- Limitations: upper non-Brahmin base; 1944 merger → Dravida Kazhagam → political (DMK) → weakened anti-Brahmin ideological struggle.

The Dalit Movement

36.1 Nationalism and the Backward/Dalit Question

KEY CONCEPT

- 'India is a nation without nationalism' — nationalism is **psychological unity cutting across identities** (tribal, Dalit, woman, Brahmin), and that unity is still 'in the making'.
- The Congress fought the British, but **Ambedkar, Phule and Periyar fought the Congress itself** — their enemy was not the British but the Brahminical structure that monopolised resources (just as the communist's enemy is the landlord/industrialist, the women's enemy is patriarchy). So there is no single 'we'.
- Nationalism is **dynamic, not static**: it appears in **disaster nationalism** (the Kerala floods — everyone donates) and **sports nationalism** (India–Pakistan matches) — **fission and fusion**: people fuse in some contexts and separate in others.

36.2 SNDP Movement (Shri Narayana Guru)

KEY CONCEPT

- The **SNDP movement** (Shri Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam), led by **Shri Narayana Guru** in Kerala, is the last backward-class movement.
- Narayana Guru belonged to the **Ezhava (Izhavas)** community — traditionally **toddy tappers**, a low caste (alcoholism and non-vegetarianism being associated with the low castes). They were discriminated, outcasted and segregated — denied temple entry, education and a common water source.
- The Ezhavas were like the **Nadars of Tamil Nadu** and the **Idigas of Karnataka** (toddy-tapping communities).
- Narayana Guru urged them to **abandon alcoholism, non-vegetarianism and obscene songs**, and to uplift themselves spiritually. The movement's objectives were **education for the Ezhavas, recruitment to government services, access to roads and temples, and spiritual uplift**.
- It brought **transformative structural changes** — upward social mobility and a shift in the traditional distribution of power.
- **Critique**: instead of fighting the upper castes, Narayana Guru reformed the low castes themselves — a **Sanskritizing** (reformatory) strategy, not a real struggle.

36.3 Common Patterns and Critiques (Ghanshyam Shah and M. S. A. Rao)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ghanshyam Shah** — the underlying pattern of all backward-class movements is **striving for social mobility *within* the system rather than fundamentally transforming it** (historically, **Sanskritization** was resorted to for mobility). They began as challenges to traditional Hindu values and Brahmanism, but **broke down when members developed political aspirations** (Shahu Maharaj's Kshatriya claim, the Justice Party's jobs, the Self-Respect League's Dravida Kazhagam).
- **Phule's counter-narrative**: there is no 'Ram Rajya' (Gandhi) — the only Rajya is **Bali Rajya** (Bali was the real king; he was killed by **Vaman, an avatar of Vishnu = a Brahmin**, so Brahmins have always been the outsiders who killed the original kings).
- **Ambedkar's counter-narrative** (in '**Beef and Broken Men**'): the original Dalits were **Buddhists** who challenged the Brahmins and were outcasted — the modern Dalits are those outcasted Buddhists.
- These **genealogies/stories are constructed to challenge the established discourse and establish a new discourse** that can bring social mobility to the community (just as Yadavs trace descent to Yadu Maharaj).
- **M. S. A. Rao** — 'who is backward?': **backwardness is a social-political construct, and 'backward' is not homogeneous**. The Constitution speaks of the socially and educationally backward, but after OBC reservation **backward class got confused with backward caste** (each state has its own criteria). **Satish Deshpande**: within the backward there are the '**backward forward**' (socially forward, economically backward — Maratha, Jat, Patidar) and the '**backward backward**'.
- **M. S. A. Rao's four types of backward movement**: (1) led by **upper non-Brahmin castes** (Maratha, Jat — reservation demand); (2) led by the **low castes** (Phule, Narayana Guru, the Self-Respect movement); (3) led by **untouchables against the upper and other backward castes** (the Ambedkarite movements); (4) **tribal movements** (separate).

QUICK REVISION

- **SNDP** (Shri Narayana Guru, Kerala): Ezhavas (toddy tappers, like Nadars/Idigas); stop drinking/non-veg; education + govt jobs + temple/road access + spiritual uplift; transformative change; Sanskritizing/reformative critique.
- **Ghanshyam Shah**: mobility within (not transformation of) the system; movements broke down with political aspirations.
- **Counter-narratives**: Phule (Bali Rajya; Vaman/Brahmin killed the king) + Ambedkar (Beef and Broken Men; Dalits = outcasted Buddhists) → new discourse for mobility.
- **MSA Rao**: backwardness = social-political construct; backward-forward vs backward-backward (Deshpande); 4 types (upper non-Brahmin; low caste; untouchables; tribal).

36.4 Pre-Ambedkarite Dalit Movements

KEY CONCEPT

- Before Ambedkar, **Dalits had no consciousness** — they simply accepted their subordinate role; protest was only at the **local/regional level** (no all-India movement, no connectivity).
- Important pre-Ambedkarite movements:
 - **1. The Satnami movement** of the Chamars of Chhattisgarh (1820), led by **Guru Ghasidas** (regional only).
 - **2. The Adi Dharma movement** in Punjab (1920s), led by **Babu Mangu Ram Mugowalia** — 'to Punjab what Jyotiba Phule was to Maharashtra' (Punjab has the largest SC population).
 - **3. The socio-political mobilisation of the Jatavs of Agra** — untouchable **shoemakers/leather-workers** who prospered under British industrialisation and urbanisation, used their wealth to **claim Kshatriya status** (Sanskritization) for political representation. **Owen Lynch** ('Politics of Untouchability'): the Jatavs have **two reference groups** — they bank on their own community for **votes (numbers)**, but the candidates **emulate the elites** (elite emulation) for political seats.

QUICK REVISION

- Pre-Ambedkarite: no Dalit consciousness; regional protest only.
- Satnami (Chamars, Chhattisgarh, 1820, Guru Ghasidas); Adi Dharma (Punjab, 1920s, Babu Mangu Ram Mugowalia); Jatavs of Agra (shoemakers → Kshatriya claim; Owen Lynch — two reference groups, elite emulation).

36.5 The Ambedkarite Phase (Poona Pact, Yola Conference, Navayana)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ambedkar**: 'I was born Hindu, but I will never die Hindu' — having faced the consequences of untouchability; **Gandhi** replied that religion is not a house one changes at will.
- The two landmark events of this phase: the **Poona Pact (1930)** and the **Yola Conference (1956)**.
- **Poona Pact (1930)** — Ambedkar demanded a **separate electorate** for Dalits; Gandhi opposed it. The division between Hindus and Dalits, until then only a sentiment, now became **official**. Gandhi believed the untouchables could be integrated through social reform; Ambedkar believed **Hinduism itself had to be reformed**.
- **Yola Conference (1956)** — Ambedkar declared that there was **no escape for the untouchables except conversion to Buddhism**, and converted that very day (a symbol to create confidence; 'you were originally Buddhists — come back home').
- He also **reformed Buddhism**: Buddhism had become **Brahminical** (Mahayana's deification of the Buddha vs the original Hinayana), so he added a **fourth wheel** — **Navayana** (the new Buddhism).

- Ambedkar's slogan: '**Educate, Agitate, Organize.**' Overall, he created **Dalit consciousness** by integrating Dalits into the new Buddhism.
- **Why Buddhism (and not Islam/Sikhism/Jainism)?** Because Buddha was the **first to challenge Brahminism**. Ambedkar also **rejected the communists** — they failed to differentiate the working class from the Dalits (in India the working class is largely the Dalits, whose problem is **discrimination**, not just payment); he therefore formed the **Independent Labour Party** (for both workers and Dalits), not a communist party.

QUICK REVISION

- Ambedkar: 'born Hindu, will never die Hindu'; Gandhi: religion is not a house.
- Poona Pact (1930): separate electorate (Ambedkar) vs integration (Gandhi); official Hindu/Dalit split.
- Yola Conference (1956): conversion to Buddhism; Navayana (fourth wheel; against Brahminical/Mahayana deification).
- Educate, Agitate, Organize; Ambedkarism (coined by Gail Omvedt = Phule + Marx + Ambedkar); rejected communists (discrimination vs payment); Independent Labour Party.

36.6 Post-Ambedkarite Movements (Dalit Panther, RPI, BSP)

KEY CONCEPT

- The three post-Ambedkarite movements: the **Dalit Panther movement** (Maharashtra, college students, 1972 — named after the Black Panther movement of the US), the **Republican Party of India** (1956), and the **Bahujan Samaj Party** (1984 — rooted in DS4/BAMCEF).
- All three aimed to **transform the system in favour of the Dalits**, running on Ambedkar's spirit of '**Educate, Agitate, Organize**'.
- The **BSP** allied with the **Bahujans** (OBCs and tribals) to fight their common enemy — the Brahmins.
- The Dalit movement's four resources to claim: **education (reservation)**, **temple entry (Mahad Satyagraha)**, **political representation (RPI, BSP)**, and **government jobs (the Independent Labour Party)**.

QUICK REVISION

- Post-Ambedkarite: Dalit Panther (1972, college students, from Black Panther), Republican Party of India (1956), BSP (1984, from DS4/BAMCEF).
- All run on 'Educate, Agitate, Organize'; BSP allies Bahujans (OBC + tribal) vs Brahmins.
- Four resources: education, temple entry, political representation, government jobs.

36.7 Dalit Assertion and the Contemporary Perspective

KEY CONCEPT

- **Dalit assertion** = 'a claim of a community that is **dominant by its own right**, and does not depend on **Sanskritic rituals** for its upliftment.'
- **Ghanshyam Shah's two types of Dalit movement**: (1) **Reformative** — reforming the caste system (includes the **Bhakti movement, the Neo-Vedantic movement, and Sanskritization**); (2) **Alternative** — creating an alternative socio-cultural structure (via **conversion** — religious — or via **education, wealth and power** — secular). Both types use political means.
- **Contemporary perspective**: in **Una (Gujarat)** a group of Dalits was assaulted by self-proclaimed **cow vigilants (gaurakshaks)** for skinning a dead cow — recalling Ambedkar's story that the Brahmins were **originally beef-eaters** who turned vegetarian only when the Buddhists challenged them. Una became an **epicentre of anti-Brahminical assertion** (seen as a threat to the ruling party).
- The **Rohith Vemula** incident and the **Hathras** case highlight that **untouchability has gone, but atrocity remains** — and today atrocity against Dalits **provokes nationalist sentiments** (a **differential/nationalist mobilization**, unlike the pre-independence vertical/horizontal mobilizations).
- Today the Dalit movement is **not limited to Dalit concerns** — it speaks for **Muslims, farmers and women** (e.g. the Bhim Sena at the farmers' protest) — reflecting the rise of **Bahujan nationalism**. The traditional **Brahmin–Dalit dichotomy has weakened with political democracy** (a Dalit President; a BSP with Brahmin members and funders).

QUICK REVISION

- Dalit assertion = dominant by its own right, no Sanskritic rituals.
- Ghanshyam Shah: reformative (Bhakti, Neo-Vedantic, Sanskritization) vs alternative (conversion — religious; education/wealth/power — secular).
- Contemporary: Una (gaurakshaks, skinning dead cow; Brahmins originally beef-eaters); Rohith Vemula, Hathras → 'untouchability gone, atrocity remains'; atrocity now provokes nationalist sentiments (differential/nationalist mobilization).
- Dalit movement now speaks for Muslims/farmers/women (Bhim Sena) → Bahujan nationalism; Brahmin–Dalit dichotomy weakened (Dalit President; Brahmin members in BSP).

Education and Social Change

37.1 Gandhi on Education (Basic Education / Nai Talim)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Gandhi was against Western education** — education based on book-learning, memorising and reproducing facts for marks.
- Why? Western education **prepares people only for low clerical positions in the government**, and it **creates inequality**: the English-educated start looking down on the cobbler and carpenter (occupations that were respected before the British came). So Western education **destroys indigenous knowledge and talent** (carpentry, Ayurveda) and makes people feel superior.
- His solution — **Basic Education / Nai Talim (new training)**: introduce **productive handicrafts** (carpentry, pottery, spinning) at the school level for everyone, thereby **restoring dignity and honour to people in such occupations**. (Spinning the charkha, for instance, teaches the history of cotton while doing practical work — bookish knowledge is useless.)
- **Basic education is the agent of social transformation** — train everyone in handicraft so that, when they grow up, they treat manual workers as equals.

37.2 Tagore on Education

KEY CONCEPT

- **Tagore was also against Western education**: the true spirit of education lies in **self-actualization, intellectual development and critical thinking** (critical analysis, evaluative skills, logical reasoning).
- He proposed the **mother tongue as the medium of instruction** (English should not be compulsory — it is just a language; critical thinking does not need English).
- He favoured teaching **history and geography through field work** — visiting museums, forts (with their light-and-sound shows) — rather than learning from books (e.g. 'page 200 to page 300 will be tested tomorrow').

37.3 Durkheim and the Functions of Education

KEY CONCEPT

- **Durkheim** (a functionalist) looked at the *functions* of education (not what education *should* be):
- 1. **Value consensus**: teaching history and ethics creates a feeling of 'us' among students from different regions (a Southerner, a Kashmiri, a Northeaster) — cultivating **fraternity, nationalism, cooperation, teamwork and morality** — integrating the different parts of society under one value consensus.
- 2. **Meritocracy**: the more educated you are, the more you are westernised, and the more you look at the world through a humanitarian, egalitarian — hence meritocratic — outlook.
- The **school is the agent of socialization** that transmits these functions, and their result is **social solidarity** (specialization → interdependence → solidarity).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Talcott Parsons** (also functionalist): the **school is a bridge between the family and society**. The **family** socialises on **particularistic, ascriptive** lines (pattern variable A), while the **school and society** instil **universalistic, achievement-oriented, meritocratic** values (pattern variable B).
- Education **creates a pool of talented individuals / a productive workforce**, helping in **role allocation and the division of labour** — with the talented filtered out through **examination and certification**.

QUICK REVISION

- Gandhi: against Western education (book-learning, clerical jobs, inequality, kills indigenous talent); Basic Education/Nai Talim (productive handicrafts at school; dignity to manual occupations; agent of social transformation).
- Tagore: self-actualization + critical thinking; mother tongue as medium; field-work/museums, not books.
- Durkheim: value consensus (history/ethics → fraternity/nationalism/morality) + meritocracy; school = agent of socialization → solidarity.
- Parsons: school as bridge (family = particularistic/ascriptive; school/society = universalistic/achievement); role allocation, division of labour, examination/certification.

37.4 The Marxist Critique: Bowles & Gintis and Althusser

CRITICAL POINT

- **Bowles and Gintis — the myth of meritocracy**: meritocracy does not exist. Equal opportunity is a myth because **achievement is greatly influenced by class, caste and gender position rather than individual ability**. The functionalist myth says IQ → education → class; the

reality is **class** → **education** → **IQ** (your social location determines your education, which determines your 'IQ').

- The **NFHS (National Family Health Survey) 2020** confirms this: **access to education is lower among Dalits, Muslims and tribals** — so it is not just individual talent.
- **Louis Althusser — education as an Ideological State Apparatus (ISA)**: education **legitimizes and reproduces inequalities**, producing an **obedient workforce by rewarding conformity over intelligence**. The myth of meritocracy hides these inequalities (you became an IAS officer, I became a clerk — 'on merit', though merit does not exist).
- Althusser's deeper point (echoing Amartya Sen): **poverty is not just lack of wealth but lack of capability** — a bright transgender student or a Kashmiri student faces external constraints (discrimination, no internet, closed schools) that are not about individual ability.
- The **New Education Policy (NEP) 2020** addresses this with **vocational occupations** and **Special Education Zones** for weaker sections and geographically excluded regions (Kashmir, the North-East).

QUICK REVISION

- Bowles & Gintis: myth of meritocracy; class → education → IQ (not IQ → education → class); NFHS 2020 (education lower among Dalits/Muslims/tribals).
- Althusser: education = ISA; legitimizes/reproduces inequality; rewards conformity over intelligence; myth of meritocracy hides inequality; poverty = lack of capability (Sen).
- NEP 2020: vocational occupations + Special Education Zones (Kashmir, North-East).

Research Methods

38.1 Epistemological Foundations: A Priori and A Posteriori

KEY CONCEPT

- **Epistemology** = the study of knowledge — how you know what you know.
- **A priori knowledge** — knowledge *before* facts, based on **intuition** (e.g. 'you cannot visit that haveli after 6 pm' → it must be haunted). It rests on **verifiability** (you keep verifying your own intuition rather than testing it).
- **A posteriori knowledge** — knowledge *after* facts, based on **experiment/observation**, resting on the principle of **falsifiability**.

38.2 Quantitative and Qualitative Methods

KEY CONCEPT

- **Quantitative methods** are used by **positivists** (who believe the social world can be theorised, with data, laws and causal relations); **qualitative methods** are used by **non-positivists**.
- **Quantitative research methods**: **official statistics** (Durkheim's police-station suicide data), **survey**, **structured interview** and **questionnaire**.
- **Qualitative research methods**: **ethnography** (with **participant observation**), the **comparative method**, **case study**, **life history** and **oral history** (a history transmitted orally through families, never recorded).
- The method you choose depends on your **research question**: for the religion of the (uncontacted) **Sentinelese**, a survey/questionnaire/structured interview/oral history is not feasible (life at risk, no language); **ethnography or case study** (reading books/documentaries on them) is.
- **Malinowski** ('Argonauts of the Western Pacific', the Trobriand Islanders) popularised participant observation; **Durkheim**, by contrast, **never did fieldwork** — he collected data on the **Arunta** tribe from the ethnographers **Spencer and Gillen** (secondary data). **Margaret Mead** (Papua New Guinea) observed three tribes and found males feminine and females masculine in some — showing 'males behave in masculine manner universally' is wrong.
- For 'did the joint family break down due to industrialisation?' the **comparative method** (case study before vs after) is apt; for 'consumer behaviour of Delhi University students' the **survey** is apt.

- **Quantitative methods are more reliable; qualitative methods are more valid.**
- Even **religiosity and happiness can be quantified** — the **Pew survey** measures how religious people are, just as there is a happiness index — collecting both quantitative and qualitative data.

38.3 Triangulation and Primary/Secondary Data

KEY CONCEPT

- **No contemporary research relies on one method** — multiple methods are used (a mix of quantitative and qualitative), and this process is called **triangulation**.
- **Primary data** — data collected by you, first-hand (e.g. visiting a village and recording its population). **Secondary data** — data collected by someone else which you interpret (e.g. crime/poverty data from newspapers); the same data is primary to the collector and secondary to the consumer.
- **Techniques of data collection** include **participant observation** and **interviews** (the same methods are also techniques, since through them you collect data).

38.4 Variables and Hypothesis

KEY CONCEPT

- A **variable** is any category **subject to change** (e.g. temperature, poverty, unemployment). The **independent variable** is the **cause**; the **dependent variable** is the **effect** ('poverty leads to unemployment' — poverty = independent, unemployment = dependent).
- **Durkheim** used **multivariate analysis** (Protestants/Catholics, men/women, aged/young) to show that the degree of integration/regulation determines suicide; **Marx** made the mode of production the dependent variable of the means and relations of production; **Weber** made capitalism the dependent variable of the Protestant ethic (but held a **multi-causal** world — the Protestant ethic is only the most unique of several causes).
- A **hypothesis** is a statement/assumption reflecting the **relation between variables**. **Simple hypothesis** = two variables ($A \rightarrow B$); **complex** = many variables; **null hypothesis** = when no relation is found (so it is rejected and an **alternative hypothesis** is developed).
- **Sources of a hypothesis**: literature review (Weber reviewing Benjamin Franklin), life history/biography, **dream experience** (Freud's 'Interpretation of Dreams'; Kekulé's benzene ring), theories (Marxism, feminism), documentaries/films/songs (Pink Floyd's 'We Don't Need No Education'), or simply a conversation.
- **Importance of the hypothesis**: it directs the research, may lead to further hypotheses, and helps develop and test generalizations.

QUICK REVISION

- A priori (intuition, verifiability, before fact) vs a posteriori (experiment, falsifiability, after fact).
- Quantitative (positivist): official statistics, survey, structured interview, questionnaire. Qualitative (non-positivist): ethnography/participant observation, comparative, case study, life history, oral history.
- Method depends on research question (Sentinelese → ethnography; joint family → comparative; DU students → survey).
- Triangulation = using multiple methods; primary vs secondary data.
- Variable = category subject to change; independent (cause) vs dependent (effect); Durkheim multivariate, Marx (mode of production), Weber (multi-causal).
- Hypothesis: simple/complex/null/alternative; sources (literature review, life history, dream, theory, songs, conversation); importance (directs, leads, tests).

38.5 Reliability and Validity**KEY CONCEPT**

- **Reliability** = the extent to which a result is **consistent when repeated**; **Validity** = the extent to which a method **measures what it intends to measure**.
- **Positivists are concerned with reliability** (consistent findings); **non-positivists with validity** (in-depth, valid information). So **quantitative methods (structured interview, questionnaire) have high reliability**, while **qualitative methods yield more valid data**.
- **Atkinson and J. D. Douglas** (ethnomethodologists) questioned the **validity** of Durkheim's suicide data — what is 'suicide' to Durkheim might actually be **murder** (a validity issue, not reliability).
- **The Aarushi Talwar case**: structured interviews — two CBI teams asked the parents the same (scripted) questions; consistent answers = a **reliable** finding (only four people were in the house).
- **Types of reliability** (names only): **test-retest** (one set at two points of time — like rating Domino's on different platforms); **parallel forms** (one set, two points of time, two methods — questionnaire vs the Likert scale); **inter-rater** (one set, one method, two assessors — the two CBI teams, whose opposite findings were *not* reliable, which is why the Supreme Court closed the case for lack of proof).

QUICK REVISION

- Reliability = consistent on repeat; Validity = measures what intended.
- Positivists → reliability (quantitative: structured interview/questionnaire); non-positivists → validity (qualitative, in-depth).
- Atkinson & J. D. Douglas: Durkheim's 'suicide' may be murder → validity question.

- Aarushi case → structured interview, reliable finding; types of reliability: test-retest, parallel forms (Likert scale), inter-rater (two CBI teams).

38.6 The Comparative Method

KEY CONCEPT

- **Durkheim:** 'the comparative method is not just a method — it is **sociology itself** (no generalisation is possible without comparison).
- Comparison can be done at **three levels**: (1) **two different societies at one point of time** (India 2020 vs China 2020); (2) **one society at two different points of time** (India 1947 vs today); (3) **different social groups within one society** at one point of time (Protestants vs Catholics).
- Examples of the three levels: **Durkheim** (compared social groups — Protestants/Catholics, married/unmarried, aged/young → degree of integration explains suicide; and compared pre-industrial vs industrial society → 'suicide increases with industrialisation'); **Weber** (compared the Protestant ethic with Hindu, Confucian and Judaic ethics → 'religious ideas are responsible for economic growth', *turning Marx upside down*); **Marx** (compared ancient, feudal and capitalist modes of production → 'the history of all society is the history of class struggle', by inductive reasoning); **Talcott Parsons** (compared pattern variable A — traditional — with B — modern; evolutionary universals); **Robert Merton** (compared social groups within 1940s America — innovators, ritualists, rebels, retreatists → the strain theory); **Theda Skocpol** (compared the Chinese, American and French revolutions → for a revolution, two forces are needed: one decapitating the system from within, one attacking from outside); **Oliver Cox** (compared race with caste → 'race is coloured caste').
- The comparative method **helps develop generalizations and even laws of human behaviour, and models of social change** (e.g. Marx's historical materialism).
- **Alan Macfarlane:** instead of always comparing two (which breeds **relativism and essentialism** — 'Scotland is better than Shimla' because the comparer is from Scotland; 'French secularism is the real secularism'), develop a **triadic model** (three or more) to avoid assuming one is superior. (Ashis Nandy: India had secularism before France — Akbar's **Sulh-i-kul** and **Ibadat Khana**.)

QUICK REVISION

- Durkheim: 'comparative method is sociology itself'.
- Three levels: two societies at one time; one society at two times; groups within one society.
- Durkheim (integration/suicide), Weber (religion → economy; turned Marx upside down), Marx (class struggle; inductive), Parsons (pattern variables), Merton (strain), Skocpol (revolutions), Cox (race = coloured caste).
- Macfarlane: triadic model to avoid relativism/essentialism (Ashis Nandy — Akbar's **Sulh-i-kul**, **Ibadat Khana**).

38.7 Sampling

KEY CONCEPT

- **Sampling** = the method of selecting a population. A **sample** should be **representative** and easy to collect.
- **Random (probabilistic) sampling** — everyone has an equal chance of selection: **simple random sampling** (slips in a basket); **stratified random sampling** (divide into strata — gender, caste, religion — and pick from each); **systematic random sampling** (a random starting point + a fixed sampling interval, e.g. every 10th candidate); **clustered random sampling**.
- **Non-random (non-probabilistic) sampling** — a part of the population is favoured: **convenience sampling** (whosoever is available, e.g. only Delhi candidates); **voluntary response sampling** (people volunteer themselves); **purposive sampling** (the researcher uses judgement to select); **snowball sampling** (contacts through contacts, e.g. reaching transgenders through one friend); **quota sampling**.
- **Example:** a study of Uber drivers' monthly income — fieldwork (primary data) at one petrol pump, collecting ~60 drivers over 5 days, gave a **representative** (though not fully so — mostly male, mostly Delhi) sample.

QUICK REVISION

- Sampling = selecting a population; sample should be representative and easy to collect.
- Random: simple, stratified (strata), systematic (interval), clustered.
- Non-random: convenience, voluntary response, purposive, snowball, quota.
- Uber-driver petrol-pump example.

Industrialisation in India

39.1 Industrialisation and De-industrialisation

KEY CONCEPT

- **Industrialisation** = producing on a large/mass scale, with an organised production process and labour drawn from different domains (not just household/kinship). It is studied by economics (GDP, employment), history (how it happened) and sociology (through social categories — caste, gender, discrimination, exploitation).
- **De-industrialisation** (propounded by **William Digby and R. C. Dutt**) is based on three propositions: (1) the **decline of handicraft industry** continued well into the 20th century; (2) it was **not compensated** by a sufficient rise in modern industries; (3) in consequence, **Indian society became more and more agricultural** (the displaced handicraft workers became agricultural labourers).
- At **1800** India had about **15–20% of its workforce in manufacturing** — a very large manufacturing population.
- The idea of de-industrialisation has two roots: the **nationalist tradition** (R. C. Dutt, **Dadabhai Naoroji**, and later Nehru) and the **Marxist theory of imperialism** (the colonial powers first captured the economy, then the political and social domains). It is a precursor of **dependency theory** (A. G. Frank).

39.2 The De-industrialisation Debate: Thorner vs Krishnamurthy

KEY CONCEPT

- **Daniel Thorner** (a Marxist) — there was **no de-industrialisation**. Using census data (1881–1931), he found the **male industrial working force roughly constant (or increasing)**, so the census data do not support either absolute or relative de-industrialisation. If a shift from industry to agriculture happened, it was **between 1815 and 1880** — due to the rise of **plantation agriculture** (especially in the North-East) and forced commercial crops (indigo), which drew in people who were *not* in manufacturing.
- **J. Krishnamurthy** — critiqued Thorner: industrialisation means the **rise in the share of manufacturing output per capita** (historically linked to a rise in the share of manufacturing in the workforce, but that is **neither a necessary nor a sufficient condition**). A **decline in manufacturing output per capita = de-industrialisation**, and a declining workforce is compatible with rising output under **capital-intensive techniques**. So a constant workforce

does *not* disprove de-industrialisation.

QUICK REVISION

- Industrialisation = mass-scale, organised production, labour from diverse domains.
- De-industrialisation (Digby & R. C. Dutt): decline of handicrafts (uncompensated) → society more agricultural; 1800 = 15–20% in manufacturing; roots = nationalism + Marxist imperialism.
- Thorner: no de-industrialisation (census 1881–1931, workforce constant); shift 1815–80 (plantations, indigo).
- Krishnamurthy: industrialisation = output per capita (not workforce); capital-intensive techniques; output decline = de-industrialisation.

39.3 Tirthankar Roy's Synthesis: Traditional vs Modern Industry

KEY CONCEPT

- **Tirthankar Roy** summarised the debate — he also holds there was **no de-industrialisation, but industrialisation**; the real difference is between **traditional and modern industry**.
- **Traditional (pre-British) industries**: **spinning and weaving, leather goods, metal works, carpets and rugs** — they used **no machinery**, were **not organised in large-scale factories**, used **family/household labour**, and were **not regulated by law**.
- **Modern industry** (a product of the **Industrial Revolution**): uses machinery, large-scale factories, is regulated by law, and recruits from the open market.
- The **de-industrialisation theory** (net effect of British policy was negative) rests on four propositions: (1) traditional industry declined; (2) it declined because **hand tools lost to machinery** (obsolete technology); (3) this market battle was **forced by Britain's commitment to free trade** (no subsidy/protection for handicrafts); (4) Britain did create some modern industries (textile mills) but they **did not compensate** for the destruction (Manchester competed with, and undercut, the handicrafts whose goods were actually of *better* quality but produced more slowly and costlier).

39.4 Why and How Factories Came to India

KEY CONCEPT

- Factories were established in India **after the 1850s**, mainly to **export manufactured goods to Britain** — first the **textile mills of Bombay** and the **jute mills of Kolkata**, then Madras. (Plantation agriculture — tea in Assam — began even earlier, in **1839**, for British consumption.)
- **Why labour was so cheap**: (1) the **destruction of handicrafts** threw skilled workers into the market; (2) **peasants forced into cash crops** (indigo) got very low wages (in textiles and

plantations the wage was about **one-third**); (3) **labour was not regulated by law**, and **child labour was rampant**.

- The British also developed **hill stations** — the seat of power is always at the top (Raisina Hill), and controlling the hill stations gave legitimacy over the hill people — built by local labour at a very high death rate.

KEY CONCEPT

- **World War I** — Britain needed goods it could no longer produce at home, so it **liberalised the rules** and allowed Indians to establish factories (the **steel plant at Jamshedpur**, ordnance factories). **D. R. Gadgil** says industrialisation really began during World War I.
- **D. R. Gadgil's point**: World War I led to the **expansion of the working class**, and — because Indians could now be **promoted from worker to supervisor** (the 'white-collar' jobs, so called because supervisors wore white shirts, earlier reserved for the British) — it created **multiple classes**, and even **attracted the upper castes** into industry.
- The **Indian Railways** (1860s) also pushed industrialisation — first linking the textile and jute mills, then (in the early 20th century) expanding and aiding indigenous factories.

39.5 The Colonial Working Class: Morris D. Morris and Caste in the Mills

KEY CONCEPT

- **Morris D. Morris** studied the working class of the Bombay textile mills (colonial period). The **Factory Acts of 1881 and 1891** (against child labour, on working hours) were passed under pressure from **Manchester** (which could not compete with Indian mills), but were **ineffective** — the offices were controlled by British officials, there was corruption, and **child labour remained rampant**.
- Morris's findings: workers of **different castes formed clusters according to their status group** (same caste = same status, living together), but **recruitment was not based on caste**. However, **Dalits were systematically excluded from the spinning section** of the textile mills — because spinning required using a spit (saliva), and the **spinning section had the higher wages** — so caste norms kept Dalits out of the most lucrative section.

QUICK REVISION

- Tirthankar Roy: traditional (no machinery, household labour, unregulated) vs modern (machinery, large factory, regulated, open-market) industry.
- De-industrialisation's 4 propositions: decline, obsolete tech (hand tools lost), free trade, modern industries didn't compensate.
- Factories after 1850s (Bombay textiles, Kolkata jute, Madras); plantation (Assam tea 1839); cheap labour (destruction of handicrafts, forced cash crops, no regulation, child labour).
- Hill stations = power at the top (Raisina Hill).
- WWI: Gadgil — liberalisation → factories (Jamshedpur); worker → supervisor (white collar)

→ multiple classes; upper castes entered; Railways (1860s).

- Morris D. Morris: Factory Acts 1881/1891 ineffective; caste clusters; Dalits excluded from the spinning section (spit, higher wages).

Industrialisation in India: Caste, Plantation, Mining and the Informal Sector

40.1 Caste in the Mills: Morris and Chandavarkar

KEY CONCEPT

- **Morris D. Morris** (Bombay textile mills): recruitment was **not** based on caste, but **Dalits** were excluded from the spinning section — by **both Hindus and Muslims** — because spinning involved putting a thread in the needle using one's **spit (saliva)**, and there was the idea of pollution. The spinning section was the **highest-paid**, so it was monopolised for one's own caste and kin. Dalit migration to industry was **late** (they initially stayed in the villages, then came for cleaning/manual work).
- **Rajnarayan Chandavarkar** (industries 1900–1940) complemented Morris by studying **settlement patterns**: workers of different castes lived in **clusters** in common buildings (the one-room **chawls**, in semi-urbanised areas), with **very little interaction** between castes outside the workplace. Alongside the large factories, **small businesses (petty bourgeois)** mushroomed — paying low wages and outside state regulation.
- The workers **compartmentalised** their lives: at the workplace there is **organic solidarity** (specialised division of labour, cooperation across castes), but outside there is **no mechanical solidarity** (they return to caste, with little interaction). This is **Milton Singer's** critique of Weber's Protestant ethic — the **Chettiars** of South India (among Asia's first bankers, with the **hundi** system) compartmentalise personal and professional life, so the spirit of capitalism is **not unique to Protestants**.

QUICK REVISION

- Morris: no caste-based recruitment, but Dalits excluded from spinning (spit/pollution; highest wage); late Dalit migration.
- Chandavarkar: caste clusters in chawls; petty-bourgeois small businesses; compartmentalisation.
- Organic solidarity at workplace, not mechanical outside; Milton Singer (Chettiars, hundi) vs Weber's Protestant ethic.

40.2 Plantation Labour: Indentured and Bonded

KEY CONCEPT

- **Sarit Bhowmik** (a leading name in the sociology of work) studied the **tea plantations of Assam and West Bengal (Darjeeling)**. Assam is the oldest tea plantation. Workers were recruited largely from the **tribal population of Central India**.
- **Indentured labour** (instituted **after the abolition of slavery**): a bonded-labour contract of **five years or more** (the labourers were called **Girmitiyas**, from 'girit' = the agreement/permit). They were recruited for **sugar, cotton and tea plantations and rail construction** in the British colonies (West Indies, Africa, South-East Asia), derogatorily called '**coolies**'. Mostly illiterate, they **could not understand the contract** (they put thumb imprints). In **1856–57 the death rate en route was 10–13%**; conditions were harsh (3 a.m. starts, physical torture, children working from age 5, desertion punished by extending the contract).
- **Radhika Singha**: the labourers accepted these contracts to **escape poverty and famines** that were frequent under colonial rule.
- In **West Bengal** there was no indentured labour, but **bondage through indebtedness** — money-lenders (in collusion with the plantation owners) lent to the workers, who could then never leave. Wages were **about half** those of textile workers, with working hours about **1.5 times** longer.
- About **20–25% of plantation workers were women** and **5–10% children**.

40.3 Mining: Janaki Nair and the Kolar Gold Fields

KEY CONCEPT

- **Janaki Nair** studied the **Kolar Gold Fields** (the only gold mines in India) in colonial times. Most workers were **Dalits**, who had moved from neighbouring areas **as an escape from caste oppression** (they hoped caste would not operate in mining). But they found **bondage through debt** — money-lenders, in collusion with the mine owners, lent to the workers and trapped them.
- The workers **pressured the trade unions** to raise the issue of **untouchability** (along with wages, working hours and training) — and they succeeded.
- **Overall pattern**: different industries had different caste compositions — **textile** = caste groups of the varna system (with Dalits excluded); **plantations** = tribals; **mining** = Dalits.
- **Trade unions** consist only of workers (not executives or diploma-holders) — a Marxist idea, since the interests of workers and managers are contradictory.

QUICK REVISION

- Plantation (Sarit Bhowmik): Assam/West Bengal tea; tribal workers; indentured labour (Girmitiyas, 5+ years, after abolition of slavery, 10–13% death rate); Radhika Singha (escape poverty/famine); West Bengal bonded via debt; half wages, 1.5× hours; 20–25% women.

- Mining (Janaki Nair, Kolar): Dalit workers as escape from caste; debt bondage; trade unions raised untouchability.
- Caste pattern: textile = varna castes, plantation = tribals, mining = Dalits.

40.4 Post-Colonial vs Post-Independence

KEY CONCEPT

Post-independence simply means after 1947. **Post-colonial** is a **political term** (used by the **subaltern school**): though India won independence from British rule, **many pockets — Dalits, women, the disabled, tribals — are still colonised**, still exploited and oppressed, and often without even the sense of nationalism. So these scholars prefer 'post-colonial' to 'independent India'.

QUICK REVISION

Post-independence = after 1947; post-colonial = political term (subaltern school) — many groups still colonised.

40.5 Labour Commitment: Moore, Feldman, Lambert and Sheth

KEY CONCEPT

- **Wilbert Moore and Arnold Feldman** argued that India **could not industrialise** because its social structure impedes **labour commitment**: a **closed system of stratification (caste)**, emphasis on **primordial loyalties** (caste, region, religion, language), the high role of **religious values**, and a **strong attachment to land** (kept as a status symbol and economic back-up).
- **Richard D. Lambert** (five factories in Pune) found the **opposite**: workers in small factories looked for big-factory jobs, and once in a big factory showed **lifetime commitment** — they were **over-committed**, viewing the job the way they viewed their **traditional caste occupation** (the specialist serves the patron — the jajmani system).
- **N. R. Sheth** (a factory, early 1960s) found that **traditional culture can promote commitment**: recruitment was based on **particularistic norms of obligation to caste and kin**, and workers accepted their obligation to supervisors **as religious duty** — so there is **no contradiction between traditional values and industrialism**.

QUICK REVISION

- Moore & Feldman: India can't industrialise (closed stratification, primordial loyalties, religion, attachment to land).
- Lambert (Pune): Indian workers over-committed (lifetime, job = caste occupation/jajmani).
- Sheth: traditional culture promotes commitment (particularistic recruitment; obligation as religious duty).

40.6 The Informal Economy: Keith Hart, Breman and Sanyal

KEY CONCEPT

- **Keith Hart** coined the concept of the **informal economy** — the state of economic activities of the **working poor**, with an **absence of social security provisions**, based on **rural–urban migration**.
- **Jan Breman's** characteristics of the informal sector: **capital comes from kinship groups**; **labour comes from kinship + caste groups** (and the village/neighbourhood — the owner personally knows the workers, who work out of **personal obligation**); **skills are learned on the workplace** (no prior training); and there is **deviance in production** — pirated goods (Gaffar Market, Tank Road, Karol Bagh — the largest piracy markets, assembling pirated electronics in Delhi's slums).
- **Ravi Sundaram** ('Pirate Modernity', CSDS): around the Asian Games, when TVs became popular, people went to China and returned with equipment to **make pirated televisions in Delhi's slums** — a 'pirate modernity'.
- **Kalyan Sanyal**: the informal sector is the **space where people innovate new forms of production, distribution and redistribution** to accommodate the **surplus labour force** at levels of economic subsistence.
- **Over 90% of India's labour force works in the informal sector.**

40.7 Post-LPG Informalisation and Class Structure

KEY CONCEPT

- After **LPG liberalisation**, economists expected **formalisation**, but the opposite happened — **informalisation** of the labour force. **Kalyan Sanyal and Rajesh Bhattacharya** give two causes: (1) the **dismantling of trade and capital barriers** — MNCs came with better technology, so Indian companies **outsourced to the informal sector** (cheaper) and small/medium enterprises shut down (about **1 lakh textile workers** were removed after liberalisation, of whom **80,000 joined the informal economy**); (2) **cheaper imports** (the toy industry was finished by Chinese imports). Critics thus say globalisation did not benefit the mass of the population.
- **Class structure of the informal sector**: (1) **owners** — a **petty bourgeois** class (mini-workshops, self-employed artisans); (2) **sub-proletariat** — the **largest** segment, casual + unskilled workers bound by kinship ties and personal obligation; (3) the **declassed** — those who have severed ties with family and village, live like vagabonds, work irregularly, and take up deviant activities (selling pirated goods), lacking fixed accommodation and the stamina for full-time work (due to drugs).
- **Class structure of the formal economy**: (1) the **capitalist class** (control over the means of production); (2) the **professional class** (from the 1960s, trained in technical institutes — white-collar, high wage, high status, social security, not from a working-class background, mostly upper caste — first entering PSUs and engineering); (3) the **proletariat** (from the

rural middle class, in trade unions, owning land in the village, indifferent or opposed to agricultural labourers); (4) **manual workers** (from the rural lower class, low in the caste hierarchy).

QUICK REVISION

- Informal economy (Keith Hart): working poor, no social security, rural–urban migration.
- Jan Breman: capital/labour from kinship; personal obligation; on-the-job skill; deviance (piracy — Gaffar Market; Ravi Sundaram’s ‘Pirate Modernity’).
- Kalyan Sanyal: informal = innovation to absorb surplus labour; 90%+ of labour force.
- Post-LPG informalisation (Sanyal & Bhattacharya): MNC competition → outsourcing; cheaper imports (toys); 1 lakh textile workers, 80,000 to informal.
- Informal class structure: petty-bourgeois owners; sub-proletariat (largest); declassed.
- Formal class structure: capitalist; professional (1960s, upper caste); proletariat (rural middle class, trade unions); manual workers (rural lower class).

Urbanisation in India

41.1 Space, Place and the Inequality of Space

KEY CONCEPT

- **Place** = the physical characteristics of a location (Delhi as the capital, with Mughal architecture) — the concern of geographers and historians. **Space** = a location's **culture, politics and economy** — the concern of sociologists.
- There is an **inequality of space**: different places have different power. Delhi is more powerful because it is the seat of central politics and holds the powerful institutions — a disruption in Delhi affects all of India, while a disruption in Bihar, the North-East or Kerala does not. (Irom Sharmila's protest in the North-East went unheard for years, but the farmers' protest in Delhi made the Prime Minister repeal the three laws.)
- **Urbanisation is the most important manifestation of modernity**: urban centres are the centres of power, economy, politics and administration, and the **urban way of life is the aspiration** of young Indians (created through mass media and films) — which is why agriculture/rural life is seen as unskilled and non-profitable. (This aspiration is propagated through **Gramsci's civil society** — where the state's **hegemony** is created.)
- Urban centres carry the dominant value of **individualism** — which is why **violence (communal etc.) typically starts in urban centres** and then spreads to rural ones (where community life makes violence a last resort).

41.2 City and Country: Folk, Popular and High Culture

KEY CONCEPT

- Before industrialisation, the **city** was the **marker of civilization** (the Indus Valley's advanced drainage and technology), while the **country** propagated **folk cultures** (homogeneous local cultures).
- Three kinds of culture:
- **Folk (low) culture** — the oral, democratic culture of common people, learned through socialisation, with no fixed rules (village women singing at rituals). It spreads through the movement of women (marriage) and men (migration), producing **fusions**.
- **High culture** — rule-based, written, transmitted through the **guru-shishya parampara** (Hindustani classical music, classical dance, Bharat Muni's writings; art films; Margaret

Atwood, Salman Rushdie).

- **Popular culture** — a middle path for **mass consumption**: it borrows from both folk and high culture, with no rules but wide reach (Bollywood, Chetan Bhagat, Punjabi songs simplified with Hindi/Urdu words). Urban centres are the centres of **popular culture**.

41.3 Redfield and Singer's Typology of Cities

KEY CONCEPT

- **Robert Redfield and Milton Singer** studied Indian cities through **cultural processes** (not just economic/geographical), and classified cities into four types — two pre-industrial, two post-industrial:
- **Pre-industrial cities**: (1) **administrative-cultural cities** — cities of the literati and indigenous bureaucracy (Varanasi, Allahabad, Kyoto, Lahore, Lhasa); (2) **cities of native commerce** — weekly fairs and cattle markets providing goods to villages (Pushkar).
- **Post-industrial cities**: (3) the **metropolis** — cities of the worldwide managerial and entrepreneur class (London, New York; in India Bombay, Madras, Calcutta); (4) **cities of modern administration** — built by rulers to gain legitimacy (New Delhi built near Mughal Delhi to erase Mughal symbolism; Washington DC).
- **Metropolis vs cosmopolitan**: a metropolis has diverse cultures **living in clusters without necessarily interacting** (Bihari rickshaw-pullers, Oriya plumbers in Malviya Nagar); a **cosmopolitan** city has diverse cultures **interacting and creating a new, homogeneous culture** (New York). Many sociologists say **India has no truly cosmopolitan city** — its cities remain divided by caste, class and religion.
- **The role of the city**: in the pre-industrial phase, to **transform little traditions into great traditions** (folk music into classical music) on the basis of a **moral order**; in the post-industrial phase, cities run on a **technical order** (Bangalore = software, Dharavi = manufacturing, Delhi = services), are **uprooted from their indigenous culture**, and have a **central business district (CBD)** — a marketplace of largely **impersonal relations** among diverse groups (e.g. Connaught Place, planned by Albert Mayer for Nehru's New Delhi).

QUICK REVISION

- Space (culture/politics/economy — sociology) vs place (physical — geography); inequality of space (Delhi > others; Sharmila vs farmers' protest).
- Urbanisation = manifestation of modernity; urban way of life = aspiration; individualism → violence starts in cities.
- Folk (oral, democratic), high (rule-based, guru-shishya), popular (mass consumption, Bollywood) culture.
- Redfield & Singer: 4 cities — administrative-cultural (Varanasi, Kyoto), native commerce (Pushkar), metropolis (Bombay), modern administration (New Delhi); metropolis vs cosmopolitan; moral vs technical order; CBD (Connaught Place, impersonal relations).

41.4 Primary and Secondary Urbanisation

KEY CONCEPT

- **Redfield and Singer's primary and secondary urbanisation:**
- **Primary urbanisation** — a pre-civilized **folk society** becomes a **peasant settlement** (after the invention of agriculture), develops a **sacred culture** (a new ritual life — e.g. Malinowski's point that sea-going rituals changed), then **intellectuals** who interpret that sacred culture, then an **administration** — producing the first (indigenous) urbanisation (Varanasi). No conflict, because everyone follows the same culture.
- **Secondary urbanisation** — when this society is **invaded by a powerful foreign power**, the local culture is dominated, and new rules are framed on the foreign culture. This produces **conflict as a permanent condition of cities**, and (through **syncretism**) a composite culture; it also creates **new identities** — the ideas of the **minority**, **the marginalized**, **tolerance**, **enclaves**, and a new **intelligentsia** preaching a **cosmopolitan** identity (initially a negative term).

41.5 Consequences and Features of Urbanisation

KEY CONCEPT

- The **consequences of urbanisation**: little traditions convert into great traditions; centres of administration and governance are established; **economic centres** are created (for indigenous products — weekly markets — and for foreign products); and cities become centres of **trade**.
- The **features of urbanisation**: a **non-agricultural economy**; **trading and services** (including pilgrimage); **transport and communication networks**; **individualism** (you must trade with strangers of other cultures); **increased population density**; a **division of labour** (skilled craftsmen) and the idea of **merit**.
- **Kingsley Davis**: urbanisation is an **index of the transformation from a rural/agricultural economy to a modern/industrial economy** — a rise in population and density, and above all a **non-farm economy**.
- **Slums**: initially workers lived with their owners (attached labour), but when industrial cities made the owner-worker relation **impersonal**, workers lived apart and the **slum culture** developed. (Sociologically, slums are the 'ocean of cultures' — centres of political socialisation and hope — to be discussed further.)

QUICK REVISION

- Primary urbanisation: folk society → peasant settlement → sacred culture → intellectuals → administration (Varanasi; no conflict).
- Secondary urbanisation: foreign invasion → domination, conflict, syncretism, minority/marginalized/tolerance, cosmopolitan intelligentsia.
- Consequences: little→great tradition; administration; economic centres; trade.

- Features: non-agricultural economy; services; transport; individualism; density; division of labour; merit.
- Kingsley Davis: urbanisation = index of rural-to-industrial transformation (non-farm economy).
- Slums: from attached labour to impersonal relations.

Urbanisation in India: Patterns, Slums and Violence

42.1 The Three Stages of Urbanisation and Over-Urbanisation

KEY CONCEPT

- **Kingsley Davis:** urbanisation is a change in **economic activities** (from agricultural to non-agricultural) plus a **demographic explosion** — and it moves in a **cycle** with three stages.
- The **three stages:** (1) the **initial stage** — a rural, agricultural economy with traditional social norms and a **dispersed settlement pattern** (peasant society); (2) the **acceleration stage** — non-agricultural economic domains develop and people (and the state) invest in **transport and communication networks**; (3) the **terminal stage** — **over 70%** of the population is urbanised and outside the agricultural sector.
- In an urban society, **status shifts from land** (the dominant caste's marker) to **modern criteria** — **well-being** and **profession** (white-collar vs blue-collar); land can even lower one's status.
- **Over-urbanisation:** urban misery and rural poverty **exist side by side** — some centres (Delhi/NCR/Gurgaon) are over-developed while others are neglected, producing an **imbalance**.

QUICK REVISION

- Kingsley Davis: urbanisation = change in economic activity + demographic explosion; three stages (initial/dispersed → acceleration/transport → terminal/70% non-agricultural).
- Status shifts from land to well-being/profession; over-urbanisation = urban misery + rural poverty side by side.

42.2 Amitabh Kundu and Pseudo-Urbanisation

KEY CONCEPT

- **Amitabh Kundu** (human geography) argues India shows **pseudo-urbanisation**: people come to cities **not because the cities attract them (pull) but because of rural distress (push)** — not industrialisation.
- The **patterns of Indian urbanisation:** (1) **lopsided urbanisation** — only a few **mega-cities** (mostly colonial cities or princely political capitals) develop; (2) urbanisation **without**

a **strong economic base or industrialisation** — population grows exponentially but the economic base **shrinks** (Delhi's industries were relocated for pollution); (3) urbanisation is mainly a product of **demographic explosion and poverty-induced rural-urban migration** (rural distress = poverty, caste discrimination, religion, ethnicity); (4) it produces **slums** (centres of poverty); (5) the migration is of **poor quality** (unskilled people learning on the job) and leads to **urban decay** (infrastructure not in sync with the numbers).

- **Urban agglomeration** = a continuous urban spread — a town plus its adjoining **urban outgrowths** (JNU, ports, railway colonies, cantonments). **Noida = New Okhla Industrial Development Area**.
- **Definition of urban:** a **statutory town** (municipality/corporation/cantonment) or a **census town** (population > 5,000, density > 400, and **75% of the male working population in non-agricultural activities** — Indian urbanisation is largely male-led).

42.3 Causes and Patterns of Urbanisation in India

KEY CONCEPT

- The **causes of urbanisation in India:** (1) **industrialisation** (Noida, Jamshedpur, Bokaro — steel plants); (2) **commercialisation** (centres of trade — 'smokeless capitalism' like Singapore/Hong Kong; parts of Mumbai); (3) **social benefits and services** (education, healthcare, recreation — Allahabad, Kanpur as education centres); (4) **employment opportunities** (Bangalore as the Silicon Valley of India after liberalisation); (5) **modernisation and changes in the way of living**; (6) **rural-urban transformation** (a rural area gaining amenities).
- **Western vs Indian urbanisation:** in the West, urbanisation is **fuelled by industrialisation** (surplus agricultural labour absorbed into industry); in India, it is **not** — it is fuelled by rural-urban migration and demographic explosion.

QUICK REVISION

- **Kundu:** pseudo-urbanisation (push not pull; distress not industry); lopsided (mega-cities); no economic base; slums; poor-quality migration; urban decay.
- **Urban agglomeration/outgrowth** (JNU, ports); **Noida = New Okhla Industrial Development Area**; statutory vs census town (5000/400/75% male non-agricultural).
- **Causes:** industrialisation, commercialisation, social services, employment (Bangalore), modernisation, rural-urban transformation; West = industry-led, India = migration-led.

42.4 Slums: The Census and the Sociological View

KEY CONCEPT

- **Census 2011** defines slums as residential areas whose dwellings are **unfit for habitation** — dilapidated, overcrowded, faulty in design, narrow streets, lacking ventilation/light/sanitation. The main differentiating factors are **sanitation, toilets and drinking water within the**

premises: drinking water within the premise (56.7% slum vs 71.2% non-slum); **no toilet within the premises (34% slum vs 18.6% non-slum)**; open drainage (36.9% slum vs 44.5% non-slum). On most other parameters (permanent houses, home ownership, electricity, mobile phones) slums and non-slums are similar.

- **Sociologists do not see slums as homogeneous.** Charles Stokes divides them into **slums of hope** and **slums of despair**:
- **Slums of hope** — those where people see a chance of **social mobility**, pooling resources through **kinship networks** (e.g. **Dharavi**, a manufacturing hub with expanding population and success stories). UNFPA found slums can be sites of mobility (e.g. Dharavi youth wrongly arrested by the police, who then studied law and became lawyers defending their area — the story behind the film *Shahid*).
- **Slums of despair** — **exclusionary spaces** with negligible chances of mobility, involved in deviant/illegal trades (drugs, prostitution) — e.g. Sanjay Camp in Delhi (originally partition camps, later 'unauthorised' slums).

QUICK REVISION

- Census 2011: slums = unfit for habitation; differentiating = toilet (34% vs 18.6%), drinking water (56.7% vs 71.2%).
- Sociologists: slums not homogeneous; Charles Stokes: slums of hope (Dharavi, mobility, kinship pooling) vs slums of despair (Sanjay Camp, deviance).

42.5 The Significance of Slums

KEY CONCEPT

- The **significance of slums in Indian urbanisation**:
- 1. **Source of cheap labour** — Indian urbanisation is cheap (unlike the West, where labour is costly — see the Devyani Khobragade case); slums keep wages low and are the 'engine' of urbanisation.
- 2. **They provide urban culture** — the 'ocean of urban culture': migrants bring folk culture (Chhath, Rath Yatra), create a **fusion culture**, and produce **counter-culture** (Mumbai's rap music; the film *ABCD*) — migration follows family → kinship → caste → village.
- 3. **Informal business/industry** — about **20,000 mini-factories in Dharavi**.
- 4. **Centre of social cohesion** — people help each other in disasters, and rebuild communities after violence (e.g. 1984 anti-Sikh violence — studied by Veena Das).
- 5. **Vote bank** — a large vote bank (e.g. Manoj Tiwari and the Bihari vote bank near the Yamuna).
- 6. **A distinct political culture** — attracted by **welfare narratives** (free electricity/water/education — these small savings aid mobility); Ajay Gudavarthy links Congress's decline to liberalisation ending the welfare state.
- 7. **Engines of social change** — through trade-union and labour movements in the city, and

by carrying urban attitudes (gender equality, education, anti-superstition) back to the village.

- **Census 2011:** states investing in social sectors have fewer slums — **Kerala has the lowest (1.5%).**

42.6 Slums and Sexual Violence: Asis Nandy and Ayona Datta

KEY CONCEPT

- **Mike Davis** ('Planet of Slums'): Western slums sit at the **periphery** (pushed out as the city expands), but Indian cities are '**living cities**' — slums are interspersed with residential areas, so all classes live and interact nearby (contrast **Chandigarh/Lutyens' Delhi**, the '**dead cities**' planned only for the upper class).
- **Asis Nandy:** sexual violence in slums is **anomic rape** — a product of **anomic urbanisation** (Durkheim's anomie): the transition to a non-agricultural economy happened without creating the new values; **kinship ties are dying, community is weakening, the pathological becomes normal, relations become superficial**, and there is a **stranger-misogyny** and an **erosion of the public from the city** (slum-dwellers are excluded from the city's aesthetic centres).
- **Ayona Datta** criticises the assumption that providing basic amenities will reduce crime: most sexual violence happens in the **private sphere** and goes unreported. The **lack of sanitation facilities turns women's private life into part of the public gaze** (communal toilets), and the **law/state is an enabler** of these crimes — the state does not create the facilities for privacy, even while the courts speak of the right to privacy.
- (Also to note: **slums as a site of intrusion/violence** — the Sanjay Gandhi–Jagmohan slum clearances and Emergency sterilisation — and the idea of **disposable children** from high infant mortality, are flagged for the next class.)

QUICK REVISION

- Mike Davis: Western peripheral slums vs Indian 'living cities' (slums interspersed); Chandigarh/Lutyens = 'dead cities'.
- Asis Nandy: anomic rape; anomic urbanisation; kinship dying; stranger-misogyny; erosion of public from city.
- Ayona Datta: private-sphere violence unreported; sanitation → public gaze; law/state as enabler.
- Slums: cheap labour, urban culture (fusion/counter-culture), 20,000 Dharavi factories, social cohesion (1984), vote bank, welfare-narrative politics, engines of change; Kerala lowest slums (1.5%).

Urbanisation in India: The State, Slums and COVID-19

43.1 The Anti-Modernist Critique: Nandy and Pathak

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ashis Nandy** is an **anti-modernist** — modernity is **exclusionary** (hospitals exclude those who cannot pay; big dams caused displacement). It was **adopted by the elite and enforced on the lower class**, but its **values were never given to the marginalized** (slum-dwellers). So, with their traditional institutions destroyed and no new values provided, they live in a condition of **anomie** — hence **anomic urbanisation** and **anomic rape/sexual violence**.
- **Avijit Pathak** — also critical of modernity's non-inclusiveness: **tradition gives 'pleasure to the soul'** (a sense of community and completeness), while **modernity gives 'satisfaction to the mind'** (scientific, rational, efficient). The **Ramlila** (performed by one's own community, with emotional connect) was destroyed by the **TV Ramayana** — which leaves people in awe of technology but without that sense of community.
- **Nayanika Mathur** — modernity is also **bureaucratic and slow**: under MGNREGA the paperwork is so heavy that the welfare program cannot be implemented; **modernity is emancipatory for the wealthy but very torturous/incarcerating for the lower class**.

43.2 Ayona Datta and the Private-Sphere Violence

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ayona Datta** argues that the **policy determinism** — that rape/sexual violence can be countered by providing sanitation, water and electricity — is **misguided**, because it ignores violence in the **private sphere**, which is **over 90% of sexual violence in slums** (and goes unreported — the perpetrator is family/neighbour, and it is a taboo).
- Because basic facilities are **outside the household**, women's private life becomes part of the **public gaze** (communal toilets), so the **boundary between private and public is blurred**, and men appropriate the same behaviour in the private sphere — without fear of the law. The **state and its laws are enablers** of this violence (the state has not created the facilities for privacy, even while talking of the right to privacy).
- Note: **domestic violence was not a crime until the 1970s** (policymakers treated the home as a private matter), and the Domestic Violence Act came later — reflecting how the law is

made largely for men.

43.3 The City as Exclusionary: Swachh Bharat and Beautification

CRITICAL POINT

- **The critique of Swachh Bharat (Swachhwarat):** cleaning requires **municipal workers**, who are **mainly Dalits** (a documentary survey found **over 97% of manual scavengers are Dalit**), while the **higher bureaucracy is 37% Brahmin** — so the **caste–occupation link persists**. Meanwhile, **industries flush their effluents freely** (when the NGT tries to stop them, the government makes new rules to allow them, citing jobs).
- **Beautification programs are designed for the upper class** (with a Western complex): slum-dwellers, who lack even tap water, cannot clean their houses, yet the burden of Swachh Bharat falls on them. So **state policies become a medium through which the state intrudes into the lives of slum-dwellers**.

QUICK REVISION

Swachh Bharat critique: 97% of manual scavengers Dalit, 37% of higher bureaucracy Brahmin; industries flush effluents freely; beautification for the upper class; state intrusion into slum lives.

43.4 Slums as a Site of State Violence: Tarlo and the Emergency

KEY CONCEPT

- **Emma Tarlo** (using Veena Das's concept of the '**margins of the state**' — slum-dwellers living at the boundary of the legal and illegal): during the **Emergency**, the state intervened in slums and rural areas.
- The anecdote: Sanjay Gandhi and Jagmohan, unable to see the Jama Masjid because of a slum, decided to clear it — under the **Jhuggi-relocation programme**. Relocation was made conditional on the **sterilisation of the (male) head of the family**: bring a sterilisation certificate and you get a house.
- People **negotiated** with the state using **innovative means** — calling their (old) parents/grandparents to get sterilised in their place. The scheme had a **communal overtone** (Sanjay Gandhi's view that the poor should not bear many children), and it was a reason **Indira Gandhi lost the post-Emergency election** (Khushwant Singh: people were actually happy with the Emergency, but sterilisation instilled fear).
- This is **Foucault's biopower** — the state trying to **control the body of the marginalized** — and it shows slums become a **site of violence** and of **negotiation with the state**.

QUICK REVISION

- Nandy: anti-modernist; modernity exclusionary; anomic urbanisation/rape; Pathak: tradition = soul/community, modernity = mind/efficiency (Ramlila vs TV Ramayana); Mathur:

bureaucratic modernity.

- Ayona Datta: 90%+ private-sphere violence; public gaze blurs private/public; state/law as enabler; domestic violence a crime only since the 1970s.
- Emma Tarlo: Emergency; 'margins of the state'; sterilisation-for-house (Sanjay Gandhi/Jagmohan); people negotiated (sterilising parents); biopower.

43.5 Veena Das and the 1984 Anti-Sikh Violence

KEY CONCEPT

- **Veena Das** (an Indologist who did her PhD under M. N. Srinivas, working on Jati Purans, and whose life changed after witnessing the 1984 riots) wrote **'The Signature of the State'**.
- After Indira Gandhi's assassination, the **state (Delhi police) and slum-dwellers** unleashed communal violence against Sikhs — the mobs chanting that 'the Sikhs have killed our mother'. Slum-dwellers were **transformed from a working class into a violent mob**, breaking their production and labour relations (attacking the very Sikhs who were their employers and neighbours).
- For **compensation**, the victims had to **prove their residence** in the (unauthorised) slums. Having no legal papers, they **negotiated with the state through illegal means**: showing **FIR copies** (state papers bearing their slum address), and **electricity/water bills obtained by bribing officials** — so **corruption became functional**. People at the margins of the state must show the **'signature of the state'** to prove their existence.

43.6 Disposable Children and the Margins of the State

KEY CONCEPT

- **Nancy Scheper-Hughes's** concept of **'disposable children'** (first studied in the slums of Brazil): because the state does not provide basic health facilities and the **infant mortality rate is very high**, poor mothers **produce more children** — as **security** (if one dies, others remain) and as **economics** (more hands for subsistence/child labour). **N. Bhandari** found the same in Indian slums.
- This is a form of **invisible state violence**: the state does not protect the children of the marginalized. (Related: right to privacy as a fundamental right — because the state's control over an individual's data is a form of violence; and **Gramsci's** point that public and private institutions are both instruments of state control — cf. **Althusser's** ideological and repressive state apparatuses.)

43.7 The Impact of COVID-19 on Slums

KEY CONCEPT

- **Impacts of COVID-19 on the slum population:**
- **Lockdown** — a sense of fear (no correct information); **job loss** (informal, daily-wage workers); **homelessness**; **lack of basic facilities** (shared toilets); the impossibility of **social distancing and quarantine** (five people in one room); no access to hospitals, testing, medicines or vaccines.
- **Reverse migration** — no transport, **deaths en route**, state harassment (sanitizer sprayed, lathi-charge), **no MGNREGA work** at the native place, **indebtedness** (buying bicycles), and an increase in **domestic violence**.
- **Re-institution of the caste system** — migrants who had escaped caste in the city returned to it in the village; **re-domestication of working women** under multiple patriarchies (joint family, caste, village) — and the **female labour-force participation rate declined**.
- **Religious polarisation** (the Markaz rumours) and a **rise in religiosity** (science could not provide medicines/Remdesivir); **welfare politics became prominent** (the Bihar election's job promises); the **brutal nature of the capitalist state** (profiteering, black marketing of essentials); and a rise in **poverty and deviance**.
- **Positive impacts:** a decline in **marriage expenses/dowry** (Oxfam report — the poor began spending less on rituals).
- **Dowry vs groom price:** **groom price** is what you pay/spend during the marriage; **dowry** is the gifts the girl's father must keep giving until her death.
- **Digital social exclusion:** online-only systems (e.g. the Delhi Darshan ticket) exclude the marginalized — and, intersectionally, women (lower education/access), transgenders, and Muslims (who, per the Sachar Committee, are even more backward than Dalits) — while Dalits (as sanitation workers) had to keep sanitising during the pandemic.

QUICK REVISION

- Veena Das: 'The Signature of the State'; 1984 anti-Sikh violence (state + slum mob); working class → violent mob; compensation via FIR copies + bribes (functional corruption).
- Disposable children (Scheper-Hughes; Brazil → India, N. Bhandari): high IMR → more children as security/economics; invisible state violence; Gramsci/Althusser (instruments of control).
- COVID-19: lockdown (job loss, homelessness, no quarantine), reverse migration (deaths, harassment, indebtedness), caste re-institution, women re-domesticated, religious polarisation, welfare politics, profiteering, poverty/deviance.
- Positives: decline in marriage expenses/dowry; groom price vs dowry; digital social exclusion (Sachar Committee; Dalit sanitation workers).

Green Revolution and Its Impacts

44.1 The Green Revolution and the Agrarian Revolution

KEY CONCEPT

- **Revolution** = a change in the **social structure** (not mere reform); the **industrial revolution** moved work from the **private sphere (household)** to the **public sphere** and created the proletariat and bourgeoisie. **Green Revolution** was a type of **agrarian revolution** because it, too, changed the social structure — new classes, tenants becoming labourers, women domesticated, the rise of OBC politics in the North and dominant-caste politics in the South, and even new religious movements (the **Dera gurus** — e.g. Ram Rahim, Ram Pal). Earlier agriculture was a **household economy** — '**oikonomia**' — from which we moved to the modern '**economy**'.
- **Green Revolution** = the increase in the **productivity of agriculture** in India, based on **High-Yielding Variety (HYV) seeds** (developed by **Norman Borlaug**), **irrigation, mechanisation and chemicals** (fertilisers, pesticides) — primarily of wheat and rice. It began in the period of **Lal Bahadur Shastri**, with **M. S. Swaminathan** as a key figure.
- It succeeded in **Punjab, Haryana and Western UP** (later called the '**Bermuda Triangle of Girls**' because female feticide/infanticide began there), plus parts of Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka and Andhra — about **one-third of India's arable area**.
- The colonial government had used technology from the 1930s, but only for export cash-crops (tea, coffee, rubber); its wheat/rice seed experiments failed.

QUICK REVISION

- Revolution
- social structure
- industrial revolution
- private sphere (household)
- public sphere
- Green Revolution
- agrarian revolution
- Dera gurus
- household economy — '**oikonomia**'

- 'economy'
- productivity of agriculture
- High-Yielding Variety (HYV) seeds
- Norman Borlaug
- irrigation, mechanisation and chemicals

44.2 Land Reform and Technological Intervention

KEY CONCEPT

- Green Revolution was the **second stage of the land-reform programme**. Stage 1 = **redistribution of land** (land-ceiling acts); stage 2 = **technological intervention**. Both remain incomplete.
- Land reform gave tenancy rights (not ownership), and its failure produced the **Naxalite movement** (Kanu Sanyal, Charu Majumdar). West Bengal and Kerala had the best land-reform laws, but in WB the reform was **successful only on paper** — the previous landlords beat the new owners until the Naxalite movement forced possession.
- The redistribution-vs-technology debate: Nehru feared technology's benefits would be captured by the upper class, but the USA (large plots) vs Japan (small plots, *higher* productivity) comparison showed **productivity does not depend on farm size**. Land was pursued first because it carries human dignity and subsistence (India's history of famines is why migrants never sell their village land).
- **Technological intervention** = **mechanisation** (high capital) + **genetically engineered seeds** + **fertilisers** (popular in the West after the 1930s; India had to wait for seeds suited to its climate, so Green Revolution came in the 1960s).
- Two institutions powered it: the **developmental bureaucracy** and the **cooperatives**.

QUICK REVISION

- Revolution = change in social structure (work private → public; new classes); Green Revolution = agrarian revolution.
- GR = HYV seeds (Borlaug) + irrigation + mechanisation + chemicals; Shastri/Swaminathan; Punjab/Haryana/WUP ('Bermuda Triangle of Girls') + South; ~1/3 arable area.
- Land reform: redistribution (Naxalite movement — Sanyal/Majumdar) → technological intervention; USA vs Japan (productivity not farm-size dependent).
- Two institutions: developmental bureaucracy + cooperatives.

44.3 The Developmental Bureaucracy: Joan Mencher

KEY CONCEPT

- **Joan Mencher** (fieldwork in **Chingleput**, Tamil Nadu) studied the role of the **developmental bureaucracy** in the Green Revolution. Every input (seeds from the National Seed Corporation, fertilisers, machine loans) was regulated by the state.
- She found the bureaucracy was **not neutral**: it defined **small and marginal farmers** (less than 5 acres of irrigated land) as 'uneconomic', and regarded only the **big farmers as 'progressive farmers'** (investing in a capital-intensive agriculture). But the **small and marginal farmers were equally innovative and enthusiastic** about the new technology — they simply were **not given the means** (cooperative loans, seeds, encouragement).

QUICK REVISION

- Joan Mencher
- Chingleput
- developmental bureaucracy
- not neutral
- small and marginal farmers
- big farmers as 'progressive farmers'
- small and marginal farmers were equally innovative and enthusiastic
- not given the means

44.4 Cooperatives and Seeds: Satyadeva

KEY CONCEPT

- **Satyadeva** studied the **Haryana Seeds Development Corporation** (part of the **National Seed Project**, started with the **World Bank**). To get seeds you had to buy a **share** (Rs. 100 per acre for 5 crops).
- Among his sample of **285 shareholder seed growers**: one-third grew seeds on ~5 acres, one-third on 5–10 acres, and one-third on 10–100 acres — so the policy **mainly benefited big farmers** (who had the money to pay, and who **controlled the cooperatives**, getting loans at ~6% against the bank's ~12%).
- Most of the 285 shareholders were **upper-caste/dominant-caste**, and none were SC. The **public-sector seed corporations were in effect created to benefit the private sector** — an expansion of the private sector in agriculture that, historically, always benefits the large farmers.

QUICK REVISION

- Mencher (Chingleput): bureaucracy biased — 'small/marginal' = uneconomic; big = 'pro-

gressive'; but small farmers equally innovative, just not given means.

- Satyadeva (Haryana): seed share Rs. 100/acre; 285 growers (1/3 each: 5 / 5–10 / 10–100 acres); benefits big farmers (co-op loans 6% vs bank 12%); upper/dominant caste; PSUs benefiting private sector.

44.5 Bhalla and Chadda: The Pro-Rich Bias Fallacy

KEY CONCEPT

- **Bhalla and Chadda** (agricultural economists) tested the hypothesis that Green Revolution technology, being **capital-intensive**, suits big farms better. Their Punjab study (3 regions, **180 villages** using the 30th round of the NSS methodology, **1,663 cultivating households**) **exposed the fallacy**.
- Findings: **material cost per acre is inversely related to farm size** (small/marginal farmers spent **48.63% of material cost on drought cattle**; rent also fell as farm size rose); **diesel/repair costs rose with farm size**. So the technology is **as efficient, if not more, on small farms**.
- The 140 marginal farms (8.4% of surveyed farms, avg. 1.6 acres) contrasted with large farms (avg. 32.8 acres — about 20 times larger); **farm business income per acre was Rs. 754.50 for the smallest farms vs Rs. 740.50 for the large** — small farmers are at least as productive, if not more. Such inequalities are then **perpetuated by the developmental bureaucracy's preference for large farms**.

QUICK REVISION

- Bhalla & Chadda (Punjab, 180 villages, 1663 households): material cost inversely related to farm size; small farms as productive (Rs. 754.50 vs Rs. 740.50 per acre); pro-rich bias = fallacy; inequality perpetuated by bureaucracy.

44.6 Wet vs Dry Areas: Bagchi and Athreya

KEY CONCEPT

- **Amiya Bagchi**: because the bureaucracy insisted Green Revolution suited **irrigated (wet) areas**, **inequality increased more in wet areas** (they became more prosperous, but with glaring inequality).
- **B. Athreya** (Trichy district, Tamil Nadu; 6 villages from 2 panchayats): in **wet areas** poor peasants' agricultural income/wages (Rs. 346) were **4.2 times higher** than in dry areas; agricultural labourers' cash wages were Rs. 1,030 (wet) vs Rs. 530 (dry) — and **total income was 1.5 times higher** in wet areas. So **the economic condition of wage labourers was always better in wet areas**.
- A striking finding: the **income of agricultural labourers was outstripping the peasants** (labourers Rs. 1,686 vs peasants Rs. 1,333) — because labourers were on cash wages, while

peasants (on crop-share) bore the rising input cost. So a **class structure formed**: landowner → tenant → peasant → labourer, with **peasants becoming poorer**.

- **Peasant vs tenant**: the tenant does not work in the field (peasants work under him); the peasant works/hires labourers. Pre-Green-Revolution movements were **peasant movements**; the new farmers' movements are movements of **big landlords/tenants**.
- **Mahalwari** (North India): village elders divided the common land, keeping the best (arable) land for themselves — for the first time creating a class of **marginal farmers**.

QUICK REVISION

- Bagchi: inequality rose more in wet (irrigated) areas.
- Athreya (Trichy): wet vs dry — 4.2× (peasants), 2× (labourer wages), 1.5× (total income); labourers (Rs.1,686) outstripped peasants (Rs.1,333); class structure landlord→tenant→peasant→labourer.
- Peasant (works) vs tenant (doesn't); pre-GR peasant movements → post-GR big-farmer movements; Mahalwari → marginal farmers.

44.7 Scarlett Epstein: A Longitudinal Study (Mandya)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Scarlett Epstein** did a **longitudinal study** (comparing the same area in 1955 and 1970) in **Mandya district, Karnataka**. After the Green Revolution's irrigation reached the villages, the **land holding of the Lingayats (the dominant caste) increased substantially, while that of the Adi Karnataka (scheduled caste) decreased**.
- In the **wet (irrigated) areas**, outsiders also began **buying land** (investing in the land market), and **most of the benefit of irrigation was appropriated by the big (Lingayat) farmers** — who controlled the cooperatives (loans at 6%, half the bank rate) and could **buy fertilisers/chemicals on credit** (paying after harvest), options the small and marginal farmers lacked. So the **inequality between the dominant caste (Lingayats) and the scheduled castes (Adi Karnataka) increased**.

QUICK REVISION

- Scarlett Epstein
- longitudinal study
- Mandya district, Karnataka
- wet (irrigated) areas
- buying land
- buy fertilisers/chemicals on credit

44.8 Mechanisation and the Labourers: Dhanagare

KEY CONCEPT

- **D. N. Dhanagare:** mechanisation improved the farmers' condition but was catastrophic for labourers — mostly migrant labourers from Bihar and UP (cyclical migration, staying for the season).
- The costs: in 12,000 villages of Punjab there were 2 lakh farm machines (1984); 5,000 farm-accident deaths in 1978; about 1,000 farm workers lost limbs in one year (1985) in Punjab/Haryana/Western UP; and by 1985 over 10,000 migrant labourers had died. Agricultural labourers were **not covered by the Workmen's Compensation Act** (they were not counted as 'workers'), so they got no compensation.
- **Pesticide poisoning:** by 1984 there were 7.5 lakh acute poisoning cases (International Development Research Centre, Ottawa), of which **one-third were from India** — and the victims were agricultural labourers, rarely the rich farmers.
- As labourers fled to industrial towns (for wages and compensation), the Green Revolution areas faced a labour shortage and created a **new form of bondage**: landowners gave labourers land and brought their families — the **whole family became servants of the landowner**.

QUICK REVISION

- Dhanagare: mechanisation helped farmers, catastrophic for migrant labourers (Bihar/UP, cyclical migration).
- 2 lakh machines in 12,000 Punjab villages (1984); 5,000 deaths (1978); 1,000 lost limbs (1985); 10,000 migrant deaths by 1985; no compensation (not under Workmen's Compensation Act).
- 7.5 lakh pesticide poisonings (1/3 from India; victims = labourers); new bondage: whole family = servants of the landowner.

44.9 Environment, Decline and New Politics

KEY CONCEPT

- **Environment:** Punjab and parts of Haryana are **cancer-prone** — arsenic and uranium in the groundwater; Bihar's groundwater too has arsenic (journal *Water*, from illegal sand-mining), but the poor cannot afford RO systems — so cancer centres have also appeared in Bihar.
- **Decline:** the productivity of Green Revolution areas has **declined since the 1990s** — and this has produced **new forms of politics** — the **Jat reservation** demand (Punjab/Haryana), the **Patidar** agitation (Gujarat), and similar movements in Andhra.
- Why reservation? The Green Revolution societies **never invested in modern institutions** (schools etc.) and remained conservative; they cannot compete in private jobs (which need communication skills), but **government jobs are a level playing field** — hence the reservation agitation.

QUICK REVISION

- Environment: arsenic/uranium groundwater (Punjab/Haryana cancer-prone; Bihar arsenic).
- Productivity declined since the 1990s → new politics (Jat reservation, Patidar agitation); no investment in modern institutions → private jobs inaccessible, government jobs = level playing field.

Green Revolution: Gender, Bondage and Agrarian Class

45.1 Impact on Women: Agarwal, Walia and Chaudhary

KEY CONCEPT

- Agriculture was a **household activity** (family labour + **attached labour** — a family attached to a landlord for life; like the **gold-mine workers** who were given an advance they could never repay and so stayed attached for life). Green Revolution changed this and created new forms of bondage.
- **Bina Agarwal**: technology has a **clear bias against women** — women are not given the skills to use the new machines (which are male domains). Agriculture once let women work outside the domestic sphere, but **mechanisation excluded them** from agrarian work. However, in **small and marginal farms** (which cannot afford machines) women's role **increased** — because they work at a lower wage.
- The impact on labour: big landlords stopped using **family labour** (except at peak periods); **permanent labourers** were retained (for peaks); **casual labourers** lost work and declined.
- **Saila Walla** (Haryana): women labourers are used only in peak periods and for new crops (e.g. picking cotton buds — a banal activity). Technological change **strengthened patriarchy** — the **khaps** became powerful, control over women's bodies increased, and **female feticide/infanticide** rose (they got money but not modernity).
- **Prem Chaudhary** (khaps, Haryana/Punjab): women had **no land ownership**, so no access to credit/inputs (no collateral), and were **neglected by government officials** (who could not believe women can be farmers) and by research/extension services. The answer is **land ownership rights** — land is a productive asset giving subsistence, freedom and empowerment.

QUICK REVISION

- Bina Agarwal: technology biased against women; mechanisation excluded women; but small/marginal farms → women's work increased (low wage).
- Saila Walla (Haryana): women used in peaks + cotton; patriarchy strengthened (khaps, feticide/infanticide).
- Prem Chaudhary: no land ownership → no credit/inputs; neglected by officials; solution = women's land ownership.

45.2 Feminisation, Domestication and Selective Modernity

KEY CONCEPT

- **Feminisation of agriculture:** as men migrated (from non-GR areas to GR areas, and from GR areas to cities), the onus of cultivation fell on women. But this is **not empowerment** — women were given the **least productive sector** of the economy, so it is itself patriarchal.
- **Domestication and objectification:** women and luxury cars both became objects of status in GR areas (see Punjabi songs). The **selective modernity** of GR areas — they had wealth (Weber's 'new rich'), bought luxury goods and travelled, but remained attached to land and tradition: they accepted TV/cinema but not women going to theatres. After 1991, land acquired at high prices bought Mercedes/BMWs/hotels — and later debt.
- **Violence against women increased** — with wealth and political power came a sense of **impunity** (the belief that one will not be convicted; e.g. the lynching video culture).
- **Prosperity → freedom demands:** the **Khalistan** movement became powerful after Green Revolution (prosperity, not poverty, fuels demands for freedom — as in Kashmir).
- **Vandana Shiva:** environment and women are linked — Green Revolution's **unsustainable agriculture** (monocropping, excessive fertiliser and water) will destroy the environment and further lower women's status; she even argued against using machinery.

QUICK REVISION

- Feminisation of agriculture = patriarchal (least productive sector).
- Selective modernity (consumerism; new rich; khaps; violence; impunity); Khalistan rose with prosperity.
- Vandana Shiva: unsustainable GR (monocropping/fertiliser/water) → environment + women harmed.

45.3 The Rise of New Political Forces and the New Farmers Movement

KEY CONCEPT

- The dominant castes (Jats, Jat Sikhs, etc.) — earlier the **vote bank** behind Congress (a **patron–client relationship**) — used their new wealth to become **leaders themselves**, and mobilised **on the basis of caste** (in the pursuit of fighting caste, they **substantialised** it — Beteille). This rise of the OBCs is called the '**Silent Revolution**' (Christopher Jaffrelot) — a smooth, democratic, non-violent transition of power (unlike the violent transition in South India).
- **New Farmers Movement** (from the **New Social Movement** of the 1960s): **apolitical** (not led by any political party), making **abstract demands** (not specific, negotiable ones), and raising **social-reform issues**. Its philosophical basis came from **Sharad Joshi** (Shetkari Sangathan, Maharashtra) — a retired civil servant who argued '**Bharat vs India**' — the **internal colonisation** of rural India by urban India (farmers pay market price for inputs

but must sell at MSP; they finance urbanisation by cheap food) — so he demanded a **free market in agriculture**. Other movements (Tikait in UP; Karnataka's Marxist movement) had Gandhian/Marxist orientations.

- **Critique: Gail Omvedt** — the movement is of the **enterprising/capitalist farmers**, with a **class bias** (it ignores agricultural labourers and women). **Neera Chandhoke** — it is **not apolitical** (Tikait supported the BJP, Sharad Joshi backed anti-Congress candidates). **Mridula Mukherjee** — there is **nothing new**: only the leaders changed from peasants to big farmers.

QUICK REVISION

- OBC rise = 'Silent Revolution' (Jaffrelot); patron-client/vote-bank → caste mobilisation (substantialisation — Beteille).
- New Farmers Movement: apolitical, abstract demands, social reform; Sharad Joshi (Shetkari Sangathan, 'Bharat vs India', internal colonisation, free market).
- Critique: Gail Omvedt (class bias), Neera Chandhoke (not apolitical), Mridula Mukherjee (nothing new).

45.4 The Jajmani System and Its Disintegration

KEY CONCEPT

- The **jajmani system** rests on four terms: **Jajman** (the one receiving service), **Purohit** (rituals), **Mahabrahmin** (death rituals, for 10 days), and **Poni** (manual work — barber, cleaning).
- It is **not a system of division of labour** (division of labour is economic and based on choice/freedom): it is based on **caste norms and religious significance**, and is what Ambedkar called **graded inequality** — privileges for some castes, pathos for others — in effect a **form of slavery for the Ponis**.
- **Surinder Jodhka** found the jajmani relation **disintegrating** in Green Revolution areas: the **caste-occupation link is dissociating** (wage labour, monetised economy), with **marketisation of caste occupations** (Dalits opening barber shops for migrant labourers), landlords dropping attached labour for modern ways, and Dalit families doing domestic work in landlord homes — all castes also **Sanskritising**.

QUICK REVISION

- Jajmani: Jajman, Purohit, Mahabrahmin, Poni; NOT division of labour; graded inequality (Ambedkar), slavery for Ponis.
- Jodhka: jajmani disintegrating — caste-occupation dissociation, marketisation, Sanskritisation.

45.5 Bonded Labour and New Forms of Bondage

KEY CONCEPT

- Indian agriculture ran on **bonded (intergenerational) labour**. **Swami Agnivesh** fought for its removal (filing PILs in the Supreme Court; emancipating bonded labourers in Haryana, Chhattisgarh, Bihar); the practice was made illegal by law and court decisions. (The idea of 'bondage' now extends beyond agriculture — e.g. an employer demanding a five-lakh bond is also illegal per the Supreme Court.)
- **Attached labour** was also a form of bondage. After Green Revolution, **new forms of bondage** emerged: landowners gave (interest-free) loans to attach labourers — 'work until you repay'; **Pranab Bardhan** found labourers' money incomes rose but **inflation cut their real purchasing power**; **Paul Brass** called the attached labourers '**bonded slaves**'.
- **Jodhka's critique**: unlike permanent slavery, this bondage is **temporary** — once the (interest-free) loan is repaid they are free; so it is better called a '**labour mortgage**' (the interest-free loan's purpose is to attach, not to profit).
- In textile industries (Tamil Nadu, Nepal, Bangladesh) the same pattern appeared — moneylenders (in collusion with mill owners) attached workers; when the WTO ruling removed the US quota, **Nepal's textile mills shut and the workers brought the Maoist revolution**.
- A new bondage in GR areas: as migrant labourers declined, landowners **gave land and brought whole families** — the family became servants of the landowner. **Beteille** also noted the rise of **formal contracts** between tenant and landowner.

QUICK REVISION

- Bonded labour (intergenerational; Swami Agnivesh's PILs); attached labour = bondage; new bondage via interest-free loans.
- Bardhan: money income up but inflation cut real wages; Brass: 'bonded slaves'; Jodhka: temporary 'labour mortgage'.
- Textile bondage (Tamil Nadu/Nepal/Bangladesh; WTO quota → Nepal's Maoist revolution); whole-family servitude; Beteille's formal contracts.

45.6 Agrarian Class Structure: Desai, Thorner and the Mode of Production Debate

KEY CONCEPT

- **A. R. Desai**: Indian agriculture has **four classes** — three cultivators (**landowners, tenants, agricultural labourers**) plus the **non-agriculturalist** (who services the agrarian class). These classes emerged with the **commercialisation of agriculture** under the British (permanent settlement; the Ryotwari system's exaggerated taxation → middlemen became big landlords → the Deccan riots; the Mahalwari system, where village elders kept the best land → a new class of **small/marginal farmers** and **big tenants** emerged).

- **Daniel Thorner** rejected this — one person can hold **multiple roles** (landowner can also be tenant; labourer can also be tenant) — hence his famous **Malik, Kisan, Mazdoor**.
- **Mode of production** (Marx) = the **means of production + relations of production** (and their **inherent contradictions**); human labour is both economic and social (the expression of human potential — the dialectic of objectification). Marx held that at one time there is **one dominant mode of production**; the **Indian mode-of-production debate** asks whether, after Green Revolution, agriculture became **capitalist, or remained feudal, or is semi-feudal/semi-capitalist**.

QUICK REVISION

- A. R. Desai: 4 classes (landowner, tenant, labourer, non-agriculturalist); from commercialisation; Ryotwari → middlemen/big landlords (Deccan riots); Mahalwari → small/marginal + big tenants.
- Thorner: multiple roles → Malik/Kisan/Mazdoor.
- Mode of production = means + relations of production; one dominant mode (Marx); Indian debate: capitalist vs feudal vs semi-feudal.

Mode of Production and Challenges of Social Transformation

46.1 Dialectics and the Mode of Production Debate

KEY CONCEPT

- **Dialectics** (Hegel and Marx) is the process in which **two contradictory ideas come into conflict and synthesise into a new idea**. Hegel's was **dialectical idealism**; Marx's was **dialectical materialism** (it is **being that determines consciousness**, not the reverse — his real assumption).
- The contradiction comes from the **labour process** (labour is the expression of human potential and also transforms humans); capitalism benefits one class and exploits another at the same time — so **two antagonistic ideas coexist**, and their churning produces a new idea (communism is the culmination where the dialectic ends). Alienated workers rebuild community at work through **Elton Mayo's 'informal organisations'**.
- **Paul Brass's 'dual modernity'**: whenever a new idea emerges, the indigenous/old idea **revives at the same time** (English education → vernacular revival; allopathic medicine → Ayurveda).
- **Mode of production = means of production + relations of production** (and their inherent contradictions); Marx held there is one dominant mode at a time. The Indian **mode-of-production debate** asks whether, after Green Revolution, agriculture is capitalist, feudal, or semi-feudal/pre-capitalist.
- **Weber vs Marx**: Weber is ideational (the *spirit* of capitalism develops), Marx material; **Kautsky** (and Tawney) argued it was **capitalism that produced Protestantism**, not the reverse (capitalism already existed in Holland/Scandinavia before Protestantism).
- **E. P. Thompson**: the agrarian–industrial shift made **time repressive** (in agriculture one worked at one's comfort; in industry the shift-hooter governs time).

QUICK REVISION

- Dialectics
- two contradictory ideas come into conflict and synthesise into a new idea
- dialectical idealism
- dialectical materialism

- being that determines consciousness
- labour process
- two antagonistic ideas coexist
- Elton Mayo's 'informal organisations'
- Paul Brass's 'dual modernity'
- revives at the same time
- Mode of production
- means of production + relations of production
- mode-of-production debate
- Weber vs Marx

46.2 The Subaltern School

KEY CONCEPT

- One of the **two great contributions of Indian social science** (the other being the mode-of-production debate) is the **subaltern school** — history/sociology **from the perspective of the marginalized**.
- It dismantles the mainstream idea that only the 'enlightened' have true consciousness. Example: tribals fighting the British with primitive weapons were called 'irrational' — but for them, whose subsistence was destroyed by forest and agricultural policies, fighting was the **most rational choice** (death was imminent anyway).
- **Dalit sociology vs subaltern sociology**: Dalit sociology can be written from an elite perspective (Mulk Raj Anand's *Untouchable*, Premchand — where a Dalit is emancipated only with upper-caste help); subaltern sociology writes from the **consciousness of the Dalits themselves**. Example: **Kancha Ilaiah** (English-medium education as an instrument of Dalit emancipation) vs the Dalit activist who argued that vernacular education keeps Dalits rooted in their community (English-educated Dalits abandon it) — two different perspectives on the same empirical reality.

QUICK REVISION

- two great contributions of Indian social science
- subaltern school
- from the perspective of the marginalized
- most rational choice
- Dalit sociology vs subaltern sociology
- consciousness of the Dalits themselves
- Kancha Ilaiah

46.3 Amit Bhaduri and Utsa Patnaik: Semi-Feudal vs Pre-Capitalist

KEY CONCEPT

- The debate (started by **Ashok Rudra**) tested Green Revolution agriculture against the **criteria of capitalism**: production for exchange (exchange value over use value), **wage labour**, monetisation, and **reinvestment of surplus**. They found no strong positive association — instead they found the **emergence of 'gentleman farmers'** (who no longer use their own labour, only supervise).
- **Amit Bhaduri** (West Bengal): the mode is **semi-feudal** — because of an **extensive non-legalised sharecropping system**, the **perpetual indebtedness of small tenants** (landlords are also lenders), **incomplete access to the rural market**, and **involuntary exchanges** (the landlord controls the market). Since the power of the feudal lords is not decreasing and they still control marketing, it is semi-feudal (not semi-capitalist).
- **Utsa Patnaik** (Punjab/Haryana): the mode is **pre-capitalistic** — because capitalism should be judged by **reinvestment of surplus and accumulation of capital**, not by the free/unfree status of labour (labour is not truly free even under capitalism — the reserve army of labour). Indian agriculture lacks reinvestment (surplus is spent on rituals, marriages and luxuries), has **personalised relationships of dependence** between landowner and labourer, and an **inordinate development of capital in the sphere of exchange** (money-lenders at high rates). It is a transition phase between feudalism and capitalism.

QUICK REVISION

- Dialectic = thesis/antithesis/synthesis (Hegel idealist, Marx materialist); dual modernity (Brass); mode of production = means + relations of production.
- Subaltern school = perspective of the marginalized (tribals' 'irrational' fight was rational); vs Dalit sociology (Kancha Ilaiah English-medium debate).
- Bhaduri (Bengal): semi-feudal (sharecropping, indebtedness, no market access, involuntary exchange).
- Patnaik (Punjab): pre-capitalistic (no reinvestment/accumulation; personalised dependence; exchange-sphere capital); gentleman farmers emerging.

46.4 Development, Social Change and Social Transformation

KEY CONCEPT

- **Social change** need not alter the structure; **social transformation** is the **replacement of problematic social structures** (caste system, class system, unemployment). The Indian state generally pursues social change (incremental), while society demands social transformation — so **development itself is often a challenge/obstruction to social transformation**.
- **Development is a qualitative concept** (changes in people's lifestyles — against caste/gender discrimination, conflict, violence), while **growth is quantitative** (GDP). Types: **economic development** (equitable growth), **human development** (literacy, employment and its *quality*),

social development (decline in caste/gender violence, discrimination, communal conflict). The idea of development depends on the nature of society (agrarian vs industrial).

- **Progress is a value-loaded term:** technological progress (the nuclear bomb) may be social digress; the post-modernists critiqued modernity's 'tomorrow will be better than today'.

QUICK REVISION

- Social transformation = replacing problematic structures (not just change).
- Development = qualitative (lifestyle changes); growth = quantitative; economic/human/social development.
- Progress = value-loaded (nuclear bomb = tech progress, social digress).

46.5 Dipankar Gupta: From People to Citizens

KEY CONCEPT

- **Dipankar Gupta's 'from people to citizens':** in a multicultural society, people must be **converted into citizens** to minimise conflict and give minorities a sense of belonging. Citizenship rests on the premise that **everyone is equal with equal rights over social resources**.
- So we should demand **universal health, universal education and universal livelihood** (not 'right to' — which serves only the unempowered poor, since the empowered already have access; universal systems improve because both empowered and unempowered use them).
- **Do not focus much on history:** history brings conflict and false pride (the rewriting of Aurangzeb, Tipu Sultan, the Ramayana); all history is a writer's (biased) interpretation, so we should learn from the *failures and successes* of the past, not individuals.
- **Focus less on nationalism and more on democracy:** nationalism shifts discussion to the past (a civilizational 'oneness'), while democracy speaks of the present (equal access, Article 17, caste/gender/communal violence). This makes for a non-ethnic nationalism.
- **Make policies for citizens, not for people:** 'people' is a pre-modern, homogeneous category (one religion, one set of values, inequality-friendly), whereas 'citizenship' is modern (different religion/caste/class but equal access and equal voice).
- **We need 'citizen elites', not charismatic leaders:** European transformation (the welfare state, the UK's NHS, R&D centres) was brought by elites at the top; India's successful business/literary/academic people should rally to convert people into citizens. (India's problems: charismatic leaders, class-mass division/crony capitalism, and giving human-social-cultural costs less weight than economic costs.)

QUICK REVISION

- Dipankar Gupta: people → citizens; universal health/education/livelihood (not 'right to'); history = conflict/false pride (learn from failures, not individuals); democracy over nationalism; policies for citizens not people; 'citizen elites' not charismatic leaders.

46.6 Development-Induced Displacement (Walter Fernandes)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Walter Fernandes** (the key scholar of development-induced displacement): development has displaced **three times** as many people as the Partition of India — yet this is **not part of national consciousness**.
- Estimates: Walter Fernandes — about **40 million** displaced; the **Indian Institute of Public Administration** (54 large dams) — **44,182 persons per dam**; **N. C. Saxena** (former Planning Commission) — over **50 million**; the **World Bank** — about **39 million** (3,000+ large dams). (Extremes: **Arundhati Roy** claims 60 million, **Surjit Bhalla** 2–3 million.)
- **Why the figures are understated:** project proponents **fudge displacement data** to get government and donor-agency approval (many dams were World Bank-funded).
- **Who is displaced:** largely the rural poor — **Scheduled Tribes (over 40% of the displaced, though only ~8% of the population)**, **Dalits (~20%)**, **landless labourers and small/marginal farmers** — 'Gandhi's last men' — which is why it never becomes national consciousness.
- **Smitu Kothari** documented **multiple displacement**: people displaced for the Rihand dam, then by a thermal plant, coal mines, railways, industries and a national highway — five times.
- **The spiral of impoverishment:** dehumanisation, disempowerment, psychological trauma, the **dismantling of the production system** (from forest-dependence to unskilled wage labour), the **desecration of cultural/religious places**, the **scattering of kinship groups**, and **loss of political power** — leading to the **production and reproduction of poverty**.
- **Arundhati Roy's point:** forest-dwellers who lived off nature (fuel, food, herbs, water) are pushed into a monetised economy at Rs. 10–20 wages — so displacement produces poverty. **Deculturation** leads to **individualism** and loss of cultural identity. (The World Bank requires both an **Environmental Impact Assessment** and a **Social Impact Assessment** before any project.)

QUICK REVISION

- Walter Fernandes: development displaced 3× the Partition; not in national consciousness.
- Estimates: Fernandes 40m; IIPA 44,182/dam; Saxena 50m; World Bank 39m; Arundhati Roy 60m vs Surjit Bhalla 2–3m.
- Displaced = ST (>40%), Dalits (~20%), rural poor ('Gandhi's last men'); data fudged for approval.
- Smitu Kothari: multiple displacement (5×); spiral of impoverishment (dehumanisation, production-system dismantling, deculturation); EIA + SIA.

Challenges of Social Transformation: Women, Caste and Ethnicity

47.1 Atrocities Against Women: Religion and Structure

KEY CONCEPT

- **Religion is one basis of atrocities against women** — in every religion there are structures enabling men (and society) to dominate women:
- **Hinduism** — women are given **Shudra status** (Manusmriti), cannot be high priests or light the cremation fire; **menstrual blood is seen as polluting** (the Sabarimala exclusion, despite the Supreme Court); the **Kul Badhu** (a woman is responsible for the whole family); the idealised images of **Sati and Savitri**; and the **husband as demi-god** (bhakti). Veena Das: woman is at once **Devi and Dasi**.
- **Islam** — **Patricia Uberoi**: Muslim marriage is a **contract** (with **maher**), but the maher is usually small and in over 80% of cases **not paid**; the **burqa** is a patriarchal construct (socialised as 'natural', tied to family dignity).
- **Catholicism** — divorce and abortion are seen as **sin**, so a married woman becomes a 'prisoner of the family'.
- The atrocities are of **three types**: **social** (female feticide/infanticide, dowry, child marriage, child labour), **domestic** (rape, sexual atrocities, domestic violence, mental/physical torture), and **violence** (manifest and latent).
- **Manifest violence** = realised (rape, physical torture, eve-teasing, stalking). **Latent violence** = unrealised/structural (the sexual division of labour; self-inflicted violence — women not eating, not taking care of themselves, the feminisation of poverty, nutrition going last to women).
- **Rape is an exhibition of power**, not biological need: **social power** (an upper-caste man raping a Dalit woman = caste + patriarchy), **economic power** (pink-collar jobs, the feminisation of agriculture), and **political power** (no representation; the women's reservation bill, Mulayam Singh's opposition, Nitish Kumar's women's reservation). **Renuka Singh**: men control women's bodies in **legitimate (marriage)** and **illegitimate (rape)** ways.
- **Nivedita Menon**: India legalised abortion early — but for **population control** (a neo-liberal idea), not feminism; the **PCPNDT Act** (sex-determination) came the same way.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Social structure** (Levi-Strauss's binary opposites) is part of our **unconscious** — so women are also patriarchal (socialised into it). **Gender is performative** (Judith Butler) and **socially constructed** (Simone de Beauvoir: 'one is not born, but rather becomes, a woman'). **Constructivism**: caste, gender, even 'child' are socially constructed.
- **Sandhya Srinivasan**: women cooking with traditional fuels for ~3 hours/day inhale smoke equal to **20 cigarettes** — an unintended (latent) violence.
- **Ajantha Subramanian** ('Cast of Merit'): IITs are socialised in a casteist/Brahminical way — ISRO succeeds but nobody built a technology for **manual scavengers** (the Bandicoot robot, made by IIT students, never got funding); Abdul Kalam (missiles) is celebrated, small innovations are not.
- **Utsa Patnaik**: women work **3,980 hours/year** vs men's 1,230 (a pair of bullocks: 1,084) — worse than cattle.
- **Bina Agarwal**: machines removed women from agriculture (men sit on machines), and men create **myths** (that machines kill, that women are weak, that engineering is not for women) to keep women away from technology — leading to **domestication** and **pink-collar jobs** (nurse, receptionist, teacher — the 'feminine' jobs in the least productive sector).

QUICK REVISION

- Religion as basis: Hindu (Shudra status, menstrual pollution/Sabarimala, Kul Badhu, Sati/Savitri, husband as demi-god), Islam (maher not paid, burqa), Catholic (divorce/abortion = sin).
- Three types: social, domestic, violence; latent (structural, self-inflicted) vs manifest (rape, torture).
- Rape = exhibition of power (social/economic/political); Renuka Singh (legitimate/illegitimate control); Nivedita Menon (abortion = population control; PCPNDT).
- Structure (binary opposites, unconscious); gender = performative/constructed; Srinivasan (20 cigarettes), Subramanian (Cast of Merit), Patnaik (3980 hrs), Agarwal (machines/myths/pink-collar).

47.2 Domestic Violence**KEY CONCEPT**

- Domestic violence was only **criminalised in 1983** (Section 498A IPC — cruelty by husband/in-laws, cognizable and non-bailable); the **Domestic Violence Act** followed (2002/2005). Before that, the state never saw it as violence — it was treated as a **private matter** (others should not intervene).
- **Neera Desai** (TISS report): as long as there is **tolerance for domestic violence in cultural, legal and political institutions**, laws alone cannot work — and laws made *within* the system only reinforce the (patriarchal) hierarchies.

- **Uma Chakravarti** ('The Frog in the Well'): after marriage the father's and mother's roles are opposite — the father says 'if there is a problem, phone', the mother says 'adjust'.
- **Reasons**: the grip of family and patriarchy; **dowry** (mental/physical torture); not bearing a (male) child; **earning more than the husband** (urban India). Women are seen not as autonomous but **in relation to male family members**.
- **Class difference**: upper/middle-class women (no childhood experience of violence) suffer **psychological trauma** and cannot fight back; lower-class women (who have lived among violence) **fight back and talk about it** — and have more freedom (they are not domesticated).

QUICK REVISION

- 1983 (S.498A) → domestic violence criminalised; DV Act later; treated as private matter.
- Neera Desai (TISS): tolerance in institutions; laws within the system reinforce hierarchy.
- Uma Chakravarti ('Frog in the Well'): father 'phone', mother 'adjust'; reasons: dowry, no child, earning more; women not autonomous; class difference in response.

47.3 Caste Conflict

KEY CONCEPT

- Caste conflict resurged after the **1970s**. It began with the British (equality before law → empowerment), initially as **upper-caste vs Dalit** conflict; after independence the **dominant (backward) castes** (land-owners — Jats, Yadavs, Kurmis in the North) took the space vacated by the upper castes and **enforced the traditional social order** (Tanjore, Tamil Nadu, 1990s — a Dalit basti burned, ~100 dead; Ranveer Sena vs MCC in Bihar over land).
- The **Dalit Panthers** (1970s, Marx + Ambedkar) produced **Dalit literature** (Dalits explaining their own consciousness) and the **SC/ST Act**.
- **Kanshi Ram**: 'Bahujan' (multiple heads); **Mayawati**: 'Sarvajan' (a Brahmin–Dalit coalition — the exploiter and exploited against another exploiter); **Bhim Army** (education → social mobility); **Bhima Koregaon** (asserting that Dalits *have* histories — exclusion from history is itself violence); **Jignesh Mevani**; **Gopal Guru** ('subaltern Hinduism' — Hindutva bringing Dalits into its fold). **Pauline Kolenda**: the sweepers' own myth (they were Brahmins, outcasted) — caste groups create mythologies to resist the karma logic.
- **Muzzaffar Assadi and S. Rajendra** — causes of caste conflict: **land issues** (Dalits who bought land couldn't farm it — no irrigation, tubewells; joined Naxal groups), **temple entry**, **forcing human excreta** (dry latrines; banned by a 1994 act), **nude worship** (Karnataka), **grazing-ground conflict**, **bonded labour and social boycott**, **untouchability in hotels**, **discrimination in bureaucracy/workplace**, and **false implication in cases** (the film *Aakrosh*).

QUICK REVISION

- Caste conflict resurgent after 1970s; British equality → upper-caste vs Dalit; dominant castes enforced order (Tanjore, Ranveer Sena/MCC).

- Dalit Panthers (Dalit literature + SC/ST Act); Kanshi Ram (Bahujan), Mayawati (Sarvajan), Bhim Army, Bhima Koregaon, Gopal Guru (subaltern Hinduism).
- Assadi & Rajendra: land, temple entry, human excreta/dry latrines (1994 act), nude worship, grazing, bonded labour, discrimination, false implication (Aakrosh).

47.4 Ethnic Conflict and Ethnicity

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ethnicity** can be defined **narrowly** (racial/linguistic groups — a colonial legacy of dividing coloniser from colonised) or **broadly (Horowitz)**: 'ethnicity designates a sense of collective belonging based on common descent, language, history, culture, race or religion, or some combination' — so Protestant–Catholic, Hindu–Muslim, black–white, Tamil–Sinhala and Shia–Sunni are **all ethnic conflicts** in the broad sense (religion-based conflict is called 'communal' in India).
- **Ethnic group vs nation**: an ethnic group **may do without a state**, but a **nation implies bringing ethnicity and statehood together**; **Ernst Gellner**: nationalism is 'the principle that the political and the national unit should be congruent'.
- **Causes of ethnic conflict** (four theories/perceptions): **primordial identity** (ethnic bonds are stronger than civic/national bonds — the idea of 'ancient hatred'), the role of **myths** (myths create charismatic personalities and legitimise actions — e.g. the mythology around Gandhi as 'Mahatma', or Modi's 'Bal Narendra' crocodile story; and Sanskritisation through fake genealogies — e.g. the Yadavs of Yadavpur appointing a Brahmin to write a genealogy).

QUICK REVISION

- Ethnicity: narrow (race/language) vs broad (Horowitz — collective belonging by descent/language/history/culture/race/religion).
- Ethnic group (no state) vs nation (ethnicity + statehood); Gellner (political = national unit).
- Causes: primordial identity/'ancient hatred'; myths (charisma + legitimation; Yadavpur fake genealogy).

Population Dynamics: Poverty, Communalism and Sex Ratio

48.1 Poverty: Old and New Forms

KEY CONCEPT

- **Poverty** has been defined as **absolute** (cannot meet subsistence needs) and **relative** (below a mean income) — but these are economic. Sociologically there are also **poverty of knowledge** and **poverty of modernity** (no access to modern institutions despite finances).
- **Social mobility vs social exclusion**: poverty can be escaped through mobility, but **social exclusion** means **no chance of mobility** — the excluded are not part of the system (homeless, beggars, Dalits, transgenders, AIDS patients, women) — excluded from labour market, rituals, and political representation.
- **New forms of poverty (post-globalisation)** are based on **social exclusion and self-exclusion**. **Self-exclusion**: the working class has money but **not the courage** to enter a mall (it is 'for the rich'); professional workers feel exploited and go for **early retirement** (investing in finance rather than work); alienation (the 'gypsy' movement after the Vietnam War) leads people to opt out of the labour market, political membership and society.
- **Relative deprivation** (Merton): after urbanisation and individuation, people lose the community's insurance and depend on **exploitative institutions** (banks, insurance, credit cards) — so they compare themselves with others and feel deprived, feeding social/self-exclusion (and **vaccine hesitancy** — the deprived felt the state served only the rich/connected; the state responded with '**nudge**' incentives, e.g. a bar offering free beer for a jab). Inequality has risen so much that Marx's theory of revolution seems more practical — resentment shows in religious revivalism, ethnic violence, and could turn into identity-based civil conflict rather than class revolution.

QUICK REVISION

- Poverty
- absolute
- relative
- poverty of knowledge
- poverty of modernity

- Social mobility vs social exclusion
- social exclusion
- no chance of mobility
- New forms of poverty (post-globalisation)
- social exclusion and self-exclusion
- Self-exclusion
- not the courage
- early retirement
- Relative deprivation

48.2 Communalism and Communal Violence

KEY CONCEPT

- **Communalism** = the **fundamental distinction between groups based on religion or primordial identity**. It is a modern phenomenon (pre-British violence was ethnic/sporadic); Abrahamic religions were once thought more prone to it, but now **all religions are developing a 'political theology'** (Hindutva making uniform rules like an Abrahamic religion; Buddhist violence against Muslims in Sri Lanka/Myanmar).
- **Communal violence has three dimensions (CSDS): communal riots, hate speech, and structural violence** (economic boycott — refusing a Muslim cab-driver/delivery-boy).
- **Reasons:** the **trauma of Partition**; colonial rule (entering a modern economy where groups blame each other for their backwardness); **relative deprivation** (the Godhra riot's economic basis — Muslims in real estate); the use of religion and caste in politics (regional/caste parties); **history-writing** (a political act — right-wing vs Marxist; popular history books like Bikram Sampath's Savarkar); and the **commodification of women**.
- **Critique:** Marxists call communal violence **anti-human and anti-development** (Randhir Singh) — people of the same (proletarian) class fight each other; **Ashis Nandy** (anti-modernist) says it is a **product of modernization** — people lost community but did not get individualism's values, so they transform frustration into caste/religious conflict.
- **Post-globalisation change:** from **collective punishment** (anonymous mass riots) to **individualised punishment** (mob lynching); the **culture of impunity** (posting lynching videos with the belief that one will not be convicted — because of political support and vote-banks); anxious youth (relative deprivation, unemployment) are foot-soldiers, no longer controlled by traditional structures. **J. P. S. Uberoi:** the existence of different communities does *not* cause violence — it comes when people **define their identity solely on religion/community**.

QUICK REVISION

- Poverty: absolute/relative; poverty of knowledge/modernity; social exclusion (no mobility) + self-exclusion (opting out); relative deprivation (Merton).

- Communalism = fundamental distinction by religion/primordial identity; modern phenomenon; 3 dimensions (riot, hate speech, structural violence).
- Reasons: Partition trauma, colonial rule, relative deprivation (Godhra), religion-politics, history-writing, commodification of women; Marxist critique (anti-human) + Nandy (modernization).
- Post-globalisation: collective → individualised punishment (lynching); culture of impunity; anxious youth; Uberoi (identity-definition causes violence).

48.3 Sex Ratio: Hypergamy, Feticide and the Dimaru Estates

KEY CONCEPT

- India's **sex ratio** (especially the child sex ratio) is very skewed. Family planning began in the **1960s** (Rajkumari Amrit Kaur preferred 'moral' means; **sterilisation** was socially accepted; the 28-day coloured kits failed because reproductive health was taboo and child marriage common); the **1991 census** first confirmed the skewed sex ratio.
- Sociologists found female feticide/infanticide before the census: **Louis Dumont** (hypergamy — women of the upper strata 'missing'); **D. F. Pocock** (Patidar hypergamy); **Lata Mani** (Sati — only ~250 cases and declining, but the *middle castes* were Sanskritising and adopting it, which is why reformers protested).
- **M. N. Srinivas's 'Dimaru (daughter-eliminating) estates'**: economically prosperous states with a very skewed sex ratio — Punjab, Haryana, Himachal, Gujarat, Maharashtra, Arunachal, Uttarakhand.
- **Monica Dasgupta**: as the mother's **education increases**, **female feticide/sex-selective abortion increases** (educated mothers control fertility, so choose fewer (male) children). Reasons — **economic** (the low value of female labour where family labour is not used; expectation of support in old age) and **cultural** (lineage carried only by the male child; the male child needed in religious rituals to avoid hell; the bride must be younger than the groom — so a skewed ratio stays invisible).
- **Barbara Miller's 'Bermuda Triangle of Girls'** (West-Central UP and adjoining districts): a **northern model** (low demand for female labour in agriculture) vs a **southern model** (high demand for female labour). **Amitabh Kundu & Mahesh Sahu**: the West-Central UP districts had excess access to **amniocentesis/sonography** facilities (near Delhi) used for sex selection and illegal abortion; also the idea of '**additional sons**' (physical force to dominate), access to sex-selective technology, and higher urban living costs → sex-selective abortion; family planning itself (limiting to two children) fed the preference for the male child.
- **Consequences**: relaxing of **gotra exogamy and village exogamy**; **import of brides** from Bihar, the North-East, Kerala (objectifying women); **reduced dowry demand**; changed inheritance (women getting more rights); more education for women; and **inter-caste marriage (by boys only)**. **North Indian marriage** = kanyadan (donation); **South Indian** = exchange of women (cross-cousin marriage, e.g. the maternal uncle) — sapinda/incestuous marriage is banned under the Hindu Marriage Act except as custom.

- **'Son meta-preference'**: the cultural preference for a son (to carry the lineage and perform rites) means couples keep having daughters until a son is born — the daughters are then neglected. Relatedly, **Beteille's 'double movement of caste'**: the dominant castes pursue **Sanskritisation in society** (claiming higher ritual status) while simultaneously **de-Sanskritising before the state** (claiming OBC status for welfare benefits) — both at the same time.

QUICK REVISION

- Family planning 1960s (sterilisation; 1991 census confirmed skewed sex ratio).
- Dumont (hypergamy), Pocock (Patidar), Lata Mani (Sati ~250, middle-caste Sanskritisation); Srinivas's Dimaru estates (Punjab/Haryana/Himachal/Gujarat/Maharashtra/Arunachal/Uttarakhand).
- Dasgupta: education → more sex-selective abortion; economic + cultural factors; Miller's Bermuda Triangle (northern vs southern model); Kundu & Sahu (amniocentesis, additional sons); family planning → male preference.
- Consequences: relaxed exogamy, bride import, reduced dowry, inheritance changes, women's education, inter-caste (boys only); kanyadan vs exchange of women.

48.4 Reproductive Health

KEY CONCEPT

- **Reproductive health** is measured through **ante-natal (ANC) care, institutional delivery, a skilled attendant**, and the absence of **reproductive morbidities**. India has improved in the last 20 years but remains low.
- **Institutional delivery**: over 90% in urban non-slum areas (paid from savings), lower in rural and lowest in slums (paid from wages — **40% of slum household income is spent on maternal health**). Quality differs between private and government hospitals, so the poor distrust hospitals; they also see ANC as preventive (not curative) and follow custom.
- **Contraceptive use**: only ~52% in slum/rural areas; lower among SC/ST (lowest pre-natal care) and Muslims (61% vs Sikhs 82%, Hindus 72.8%). **M. A. Hall & R. B. Stephenson** (western India): only sterilisation is socially acceptable — and **husbands make the decisions** about reproductive health.
- **Women's empowerment and reproductive health**: women in **nuclear families** use institutional delivery more (than joint families with in-laws); **education** improves reproductive health (lower fertility, more ANC/contraceptives); **domestic violence** (and marital rape) during pregnancy lowers pre-natal care and leads to unintended pregnancy.
- **Adolescent girls (10–19)**: child marriage, the discouraging of pre-marital sex, and the taboo on discussing reproductive health give them the worst reproductive health (with no rural–urban difference).

QUICK REVISION

- Reproductive health: ANC, institutional delivery, skilled attendant, morbidities; slums worst (40% income on maternal health); private vs government quality.
- Contraceptives ~52% (slums/rural); SC/ST lowest; Muslims lowest; Hall & Stephenson (only sterilisation acceptable; husbands decide).
- Nuclear family + education → better; domestic violence/marital rape → worse; adolescent girls (10–19) worst (child marriage, taboo).

ART, Ageing and the Family

49.1 Assisted Reproductive Technology (ART)

KEY CONCEPT

- **ART** (the 'genetic revolution' in the family) includes **IVF, intracytoplasmic sperm injection, cryopreservation of eggs/sperm, and artificial insemination**. It was created to cure infertility but expanded its scope.
- **Criticisms** (legal + social): (1) **Inequality** — ART is costly, so the rich can produce children with 'socially acceptable' qualities and genetic modification, while the poor cannot (like educational inequality once created caste); (2) **surrogates are from poor backgrounds**, have **no legal rights** (only a contract), and exchange their bodily privacy for unregulated money — India and Nepal are the **surrogacy hubs** (controlled by mafias; the government moved to ban commercial surrogacy).
- ART is also **fundamentally conservative**: it produces **biologically related children** (unlike adoption), so it reproduces the same biological/racial idea of family; the **sperm donor has no rights**, and courts inconsistently grant divorced fathers rights.
- But ART also **enables families** for gay, lesbian, single and **post-menopausal women**, thereby **assaulting the traditional image of heteronormativity**.
- Three ways ART disturbs the traditional family: it creates **social parenthood** (not biological — artificial insemination), it **destroys the family/market binary** (commercialisation of reproduction), and it **privatises parenthood** (contract in place of social bond).
- Biological vs social parenthood is legally unresolved: in the **N. D. Tiwari** case, DNA testing proved paternity and gave the child *some* property rights — but **not equal** (biological) rights, unlike a socially-adopted child who has full rights. **Single parents using ART are a legal 'grey area'** in India. The **Nepal 2015 earthquake** stranded surrogate mothers (many under contract with Israeli parents, for whom Israel sent special assistance) — exposing the unregulated, exploitative market.
- **Emancipation for upper-class women** (pregnancy without being pregnant) rests on the **exploitation of lower-class women**. **Ogburn's 'cultural lag'**: material development has outpaced cultural/legal development (India has no ART law — it uses archaic IPC/CrPC provisions; the West developed norms through debate — e.g. the 'three-parent baby') — a lag that produces **anomie** (the old values destroyed but new ones not yet established).

KEY CONCEPT

- **Solution — land rights:** land is the most basic productive asset (Kerala's successful land reform vs Bihar's failure — which is why Kerala's human development is far ahead); the **RTE** example shows how giving rights (education) empowered even rural women to protest. **David Harvey** (critic of neoliberalism): land is the last sphere the market could not fully control (family/honour/subsistence), which is why the farm laws were resisted. **Neoliberalism** = the retreat of the state from the market; it created a **Gramscian hegemony** (the 'common sense' that every young person must become an engineer).

QUICK REVISION

- ART = IVF, sperm injection, cryopreservation, artificial insemination.
- Criticisms: inequality (rich → genetic modification), surrogates (poor, no rights, hubs India/Nepal, mafias), conservative (biological children), but enables gay/single/post-menopausal families.
- Disturbs family: social parenthood, family/market binary broken, privatised parenthood; upper-class emancipation vs lower-class exploitation; Ogburn's cultural lag.
- Solution: land rights (Kerala vs Bihar; RTE); David Harvey (land = last uncontrolled sphere); neoliberalism (retreat of state; Gramsci's hegemony).

49.2 Ageing and Old-Age Problems

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ageing** (60+) — most of the aged live in rural India. Problems:
- **Modernisation** — isolation and alienation (dual-working families; children migrate to cities), reflected in the nature of care.
- **Social welfare under neoliberalism** — pension funds invested in the volatile market (**casino capitalism**; the 2007–08 crisis wiped out pensions); hospitals, schools, parks privatised (gated communities).
- **Widowhood** — women live longer than men and, having not worked and holding no assets, face no social security and family support; rural widows are even stereotyped as **witches**.
- **New diseases** (Alzheimer's, cancer) → **geriatric care** is emerging but weak (the aged are not 'part of the economy' or politics). **Old-age homes** give care and community but alienation returns when visitors leave.
- **Social exclusion** — the **digital divide** (biometric verification for pensions, online banking), financial exclusion, and exclusion from the labour market (the demographic dividend's cheap young labour makes the old's experience unwanted); their **roles** (socialising grandchildren) have been taken by schools and hospitals.
- **Zygmunt Bauman** ('liquid modernity'): the **place of death shifted from the household to the hospital**; **Ivan Illich's 'medicalization'**: medicine has taken over the roles of law and religion (including death, cremation, palliative care and even **euthanasia**). People also **resist**

— opting for alternate medicine and not chemotherapy, to preserve their relationships/identity.

- **Kinship has changed:** from blood/adoption to **fictive kinship** ('uncle', 'bhaiya') — a move from kinship to friendship.

QUICK REVISION

- Ageing (60+; rural): isolation (dual-working families), neoliberal welfare (casino capitalism, privatisation), widowhood (witches), new diseases → geriatric care, old-age homes, digital divide/biometric exclusion, roles taken by schools/hospitals.
- Bauman (death → hospital), Illich (medicalization → medicine took law/religion's roles); fictive kinship (kinship → friendship).

49.3 The Family: Murdock, Parsons and the Symmetrical Family

KEY CONCEPT

- **George Peter Murdock** (functionalist): the **family** is a social group of **common residence, economic cooperation and reproduction**, including adults of both sexes in a **socially approved sexual relationship** and their (biological or adopted) children — performing four functions (sexual, reproductive, economic, educational). E.g. the **Banaro tribe** of New Guinea (the husband does not have sex with the wife until a friend produces the children).
- **Talcott Parsons**: the family's role is **primary socialisation and the internalisation of cultural norms**.
- **Michael Young and Peter Willmott** ('The Symmetrical Family') — three stages: (1) **pre-industrial** (the household is the production unit, power skewed to men); (2) **early industrial** (production moves to the public sphere, male mortality high → women formed an '**informal trade union**' of kin/neighbours for insurance, so the conjugal bond weakened); (3) **the symmetrical family** (isolated nuclear household, **conjugal roles shared**, strong bond). Reasons for symmetry: **reduction of kinship role** (real wages, the welfare state), **geographical mobility**, **fewer children** (6 → 2), and the **home becoming attractive** (higher income, parties at home).
- **Family vs household**: policy has shifted from 'family' to 'household' (MGNREGA is per household) — 'family' is value-laden and conservative, while 'household' is inclusive of live-in relationships and emerging family forms.

KEY CONCEPT

- **Feminist critique**: **Ann Oakley** (London) found conjugal equality is a myth — women still do most housework even when working; the real problem is the **sexual division of labour**. **Sylvia Walby**: patriarchy has not disappeared but has taken **new forms**, moving from the private to the public sphere.
- **Marital breakdown**: **divorce, separation, and empty-shell marriages** (living together apart).

QUICK REVISION

- Murdock (4 functions; Banaro tribe), Parsons (primary socialisation), Young & Willmott (3 stages; symmetrical family).
- Family vs household (MGNREGA; live-in); feminist critique (Oakley — conjugal inequality, sexual division of labour; Walby — patriarchy new forms); marital breakdown (divorce, separation, empty-shell).

Kinship in India

50.1 The Feminist Critique of the Family

KEY CONCEPT

- Feminist studies of the family came late to sociology. They argued the family is **not egalitarian** but a system that binds women (through marriage), and they introduced **domestic violence, unpaid (household) labour, and the sexual division of labour** into the discipline. (Durkheim regarded the **sexual division of labour as the first form of division of labour** — but feminists point out that it is a discriminatory division.)
- **Margaret Benston**: women's **unpaid labour is beneficial to capitalism** — if housework were paid, wages would rise and workers could confront capital; even a minimum wage for women would be a massive redistribution. The (male) breadwinner's obligation to his family **delays conflict** (he cannot withdraw from wage labour).
- **Fran Ansley**: the family works as a '**safety valve**' — it absorbs the worker's alienation so industrialism is not threatened. **David Cooper** ('The Death of the Family'): family socialisation is repressive — it makes children **obedient and submissive** to authority (the labour force capitalism needs); so the family must be remodelled.
- Feminists also showed the family is a **political institution** — an inequality of power between men and women (husband dominating wife).

QUICK REVISION

- not egalitarian
- domestic violence, unpaid (household) labour, and the sexual division of labour
- sexual division of labour as the first form of division of labour
- Margaret Benston
- unpaid labour is beneficial to capitalism
- delays conflict
- Fran Ansley
- 'safety valve'
- David Cooper
- obedient and submissive
- political institution

50.2 Marital Breakdown

KEY CONCEPT

- **Marital breakdown** takes three forms: **divorce** (legal termination), **separation** (living apart without divorce), and **empty-shell marriages** (living together without a relationship).
- **Nicky Hart** ('When Marriage Ends') — three factors: the **value attached to marriage**, the **degree of conflict between spouses**, and the **opportunities to escape marriage**.
- On value: **Parsons and Ronald Fletcher** argue the value of marriage has **increased** (rising remarriage and higher expectations — people leave a marriage that fails their expectations). On conflict: **William Goode** (emotional over-strain on the isolated nuclear family, whose functions were taken by schools/hospitals), **Edmund Leach** (economic and social bonds weakened), **Graham Allan & Graham Crow** (independent incomes and the decline of family-owned businesses make divorce possible). On escape: **Colin Gibson** (secularisation made divorce acceptable), divorce legislation (the Special Marriage Act, Hindu Marriage Act), and the rise of **serial monogamy** (divorce → remarriage → divorce).
- The class dimension: divorce is acceptable in the urban/middle class but not the lower class; children are affected more by **parental conflict** than by divorce itself (which is socially acceptable in the West).

QUICK REVISION

- Feminist critique: unpaid labour (Benston), safety valve (Ansley), repressive socialisation (Cooper); family = political/power institution.
- Marital breakdown: divorce, separation, empty-shell; Nicky Hart's 3 factors; Parsons/Fletcher (value up), Goode (over-strain), Leach (weak bonds), Allan & Crow (independent income), Gibson (secularisation), serial monogamy.

50.3 Intimacy: From Spiritual Love to Plastic Sexuality

KEY CONCEPT

- **Anthony Giddens** on the changing idea of intimacy: (1) **spiritual love** — a pure, unattainable love that cannot become marriage (Krishna and Radha; Laila-Majnu); (2) **romantic love** — a product of the Enlightenment novel, love that *can* be achieved within social boundaries (same caste/status), committed for life, placed inside marriage; (3) **plastic sexuality** — based on **confluent love** (stay while it satisfies, otherwise leave), focused on physical beauty (Tinder/Bumble), expressed in **serial monogamy** and alternate forms of intimacy.
- Feminists partly favour plastic sexuality (it gives women choice), but note that only **independent women** (economically and socially) can practise it openly.

QUICK REVISION

- Anthony Giddens

- spiritual love
- romantic love
- plastic sexuality
- confluent love
- serial monogamy
- independent women

50.4 Iravati Karve: The Four Kinship Patterns

KEY CONCEPT

- **Iravati Karve** (an Indologist, student of G. S. Ghurye, of the Deccan College, and author of the first feminist reinterpretation of the Mahabharata) studied kinship through scriptures. Kinship is of three types — by **blood (consanguineal)**, by **marriage/adoption (affinal)**, and **fictive** (now powerful as families are isolated from kin — a move from kinship to friendship).
- Kinship patterns depend on **four factors** — **language, geography, caste and kinship terminology** — giving **four regional patterns**:
- **North Indian** (Punjabi, Sindhi, Haryanvi, Hindi, Bihari): **patrilineal**, **gotra exogamy**, **sapinda** (5 generations of the father, 3 of the mother), **territorial/village exogamy**, **caste endogamy**, and **kanyadan** (donation — the giver's status is low and he accepts nothing in return, sending gifts = dowry). Women as *daughter* have no importance; women as *wife* are important.
- **South Indian: cross-cousin marriage and uncle-niece marriage** (the uncle younger than the mother) are allowed, based on the **exchange of women**; gotra exogamy is both-sided. Exceptions: the **Todas** (polyandry — a woman married to all brothers, where the biological father is unimportant; social fatherhood matters) and the **Nairs of Kerala** (matrilineal).
- **Central Indian** (Gujarat, Rajasthan, Maharashtra, MP): mixed — higher castes follow the North, lower castes the South (Gujarat's Kathiawar tribes cross-cousin, while Patidars/Brahmins do not — D. F. Pocock's hypergamy); the **Rajputs** marry 'sor' (focusing on physical beauty rather than caste, hypergamous — the Kshatriya category is fluid, per K. M. Panikkar); the **Jats** follow four-gotra exogamy; the **Marathas** allow maternal cross-cousin marriage but not paternal.
- **Eastern Indian**: very mixed — the **Nagas** practise **marriage by capture** (the groom challenges the bride's father); the **Bonda** tribe prefer **divorced/older women** (women hold a privileged position).

QUICK REVISION

- Giddens: spiritual → romantic → plastic sexuality (confluent love).
- Karve: kinship by blood/adoption/fictive; 4 factors (language, geography, caste, terminology); 4 patterns (North = patrilineal/kanyadan/gotra-sapinda exogamy; South = cross-cousin/uncle-niece/exchange; Central = mixed/Rajput sor/Jat 4-gotra; Eastern = Nagas

marriage-by-capture, Bonda older/divorced women).

- Exceptions: Todas (polyandry), Nairs (matrilineal).

50.5 From Family to Household

KEY CONCEPT

- **K. M. Kapadia** defined the joint family (kin members, three or more generations, common property, one roof). **I. P. Desai** (Mahua, Gujarat) added the '**degree of jointness**' (economic + emotional) — so a **moderately joint family** accepts the patriarch's decisions even when living apart.
- **A. M. Shah** argued the category 'family' **excludes more people than it includes** (migrants, new family forms) — so we should study the **household**: a **residential and domestic unit of one or more persons living under the same roof and eating from a single kitchen**. He gives **four types** — **simple, complex, parental, and compound households** (built on the 'parental family' = parents + unmarried children).
- The **household** category (used by Patricia Uberoi, Pauline Kolenda and feminists) includes single-parent, gay, lesbian and live-in families — and policy (e.g. MGNREGA) now targets households, not families.

QUICK REVISION

- Kapadia (joint family), I. P. Desai (degree of jointness), A. M. Shah (household — 4 types; family excludes more than includes); household used by Uberoi/Kolenda and policy (MGNREGA).

Developmental Planning, Nationalism and Citizenship

51.1 Developmental Planning and Rural Development

KEY CONCEPT

- At independence India faced food scarcity (the Bengal famine; population grew 50% from 1890–1950 but cultivated land only 1.5%), low literacy, and discrimination. Nehru chose **planning** (not free capitalism) for **self-sufficiency** (fearing Lenin's 'economic imperialism') and to **double the standard of living** — creating a **social democracy** (political + economic democracy; the term from Rosa Luxemburg).
- The **Planning Commission (1950)** was an executive (not constitutional) body — to augment material, capital and human resources, formulate five-year plans, and execute them stage-wise. Plans proposed included the Gandhian plan (Gram Swaraj), the Bombay plan (capitalists), and M. N. Roy's People's Plan (collectivisation).
- The **mixed economy** separated public (heavy) and private (light) enterprise — which **A. R. Desai** called a **ploy of the Indian bourgeoisie** (the Bombay plan) to avoid competing with MNCs until they had enough capital.
- **Community Development Programme (CDP, 1952)** — aimed to increase agricultural production and transform village social/economic life; eight categories (agriculture, communications, education, health, training, social welfare, supplementary employment, housing). **Balwant Rai Mehta** (whose committee's report led to Panchayati Raj) redefined 'community' as *all* villagers working together — not a sectarian term.
- **Critics:** **A. R. Desai** (bureaucratic, top-down, no elected representatives, overlapping departments, no social-service mentality, benefits captured by landlords — class polarisation); **S. C. Dube** (70% of extension benefits to local elites); **David Mandelbaum** (a widening rich-poor gulf).
- **Rural development programmes** (from the 1960s–70s, slogan 'Garibi Hatao') — now **targeted** the backward: poverty-alleviation (IRDP), geography-based (drought/desert/hill), sectoral (health/education), and productivity programmes. **Robert Chambers** called this 'the programmatisation of India'. **Vivek Chibber** attributes planning's failure to excessive bureaucracy, the capitalist class's organised counter-efforts, the **import-substitution** model (creating monopolies), and the demobilisation of labour unions. (Contrast: **South Korea** succeeded with planning, being export-oriented.)

- **Post-1991 (neoliberalism):** state retreats from market (disinvestment), transparency/accountability, and a **rights-based approach** — MGNREGA, RTI, RTE (with legislative backing). The Planning Commission was replaced by **NITI Aayog**.

QUICK REVISION

- Nehruvian planning (self-sufficiency; social democracy); Planning Commission 1950; mixed economy (Desai's 'bourgeois ploy').
- CDP 1952 (production + transformation; Balwant Rai Mehta → Panchayati Raj); critics (Desai, Dube 70% to elites, Mandelbaum).
- Rural development (targeted; Garibi Hatao; IRDP; Chambers 'programmatisation'; Chibber — bureaucracy/import-substitution); post-1991 rights-based (MGNREGA/RTI/RTE; NITI Aayog).

51.2 Indian Nationalism: Derivative Discourse and the Civilizational View

KEY CONCEPT

- Two views of Indian nationalism: it is a **derivative discourse** of colonialism (**Partha Chatterjee** — Indians claimed superiority in the 'spiritual' private sphere while conceding the 'material' public sphere to the British, in three phases: social reform → political movement → self-rule), or it is **civilizational**.
- **Tagore:** nationalism is **anti-Indian** — it creates non-transcendable identities and releases ethno-religious violence; Indian identities were always porous (Kabir, Nanak, Bulleshah). He proposed the idea of '**homeland**' (one can belong to India without living in its territory).
- **Gandhi:** **spiritual freedom**, **Gram Swaraj** (decentralised power to the people — 'Raj Niti' → 'Lok Niti'), and **inter-nationalism** (anti-imperialist, anti-racist, Asian, non-violent).
- **Savarkar** ('Hindutva', 1923, inspired by Mazzini): **Hindutva** ≠ **Hinduism** — Hindutva is political/militarised; he masculinised the nation (from 'Matribhoomi' to **Pitrubhoomi** and **Punyabhoomi** — fatherland and holy land). Hindus, Jains and Buddhists have both fatherland and holy land in India; Muslims/Christians have only fatherland. His three ideas — **Rashtra (nation)**, **Jati (race)**, **Sanskriti (culture)** — make an **ethnic/sectarian** nationalism.
- **Ambedkar:** nationalism through the **annihilation of caste** and **constitutional morality** (not traditional morality). **Nehru:** secular, industrial, modern (Western) nationalism.

QUICK REVISION

- Derivative discourse (Chatterjee — 3 phases) vs civilizational view.
- Tagore (anti-nationalist; homeland; Kabir/Nanak/Bulleshah), Gandhi (spiritual freedom; Gram Swaraj; inter-nationalism), Savarkar (Hindutva ≠ Hinduism; Pitrubhoomi/Punyabhoomi; Rashtra/Jati/Sanskriti), Ambedkar (constitutional morality), Nehru (secular/industrial).

51.3 Citizenship and Its Four Discourses

KEY CONCEPT

- **Citizenship = the right to have rights** — including the right to make **competing demands** (the farmers' protest; Kunal Kamra vs Munawar Faruqui as examples of **limited citizenship** when citizenship becomes ethnic/descent-based).
- **Ornit Shani** identifies **four citizenship discourses** in India: (1) **liberal** (the individual holds rights — fundamental rights); (2) **republican** (rights in accordance with contribution to the **common good** — Nehru's idea); (3) **ethno-nationalist** (citizenship anchored on descent/religion — the most exclusive); (4) **non-statist** (Gandhian — civil disobedience as a right *and* sacred duty; limited state power; e.g. Vinoba Bhave's **Bhoodan/Gramdan**, and contemporary Gandhian social movements).

QUICK REVISION

- Citizenship = the right to have rights
- competing demands
- limited citizenship
- Ornit Shani
- four citizenship discourses
- liberal
- republican
- common good
- ethno-nationalist
- non-statist
- Bhoodan/Gramdan

51.4 Elite Formation and Civil Society

KEY CONCEPT

- **Elites** (unlike the economically dominant) control **economic, political and ideological** institutions; they are a closed, self-reproducing group. Indian elites: royal families, political dynasties, upper-caste leaders, film/sports stars, pro-state intellectuals, zamindars, corporate and religious leaders; **new elites** = YouTubers/influencers, start-up founders, media professionals.
- **Krishna Kumar** (educational elites): formed by **early selection** (private English-medium schools — remnants of the Raj) and **mass exams** (JEE, UPSC); education has become skill/status acquisition, not knowledge; elites reproduce themselves (two-thirds of civil servants till 1971 were related to civil servants).
- **A. R. Desai**: dominant castes (access to land + political power) used education for mobility

→ new elites. **Beteille**: reservation created a 'competition for backwardness' — political elites emerged within reserved groups. **Pradeep Chhibber**: local elites gave legitimation to the 1991 economic reforms (and feature in dynastic politics).

- **Civil society** (Neera Chandhoke): weak after 1947 (members joined the state), powerful in the 1970s–80s (anti-Emergency, trade-union/caste movements), then weakened after 1991 as **NGOs** (professional, funded, non-mobilising) replaced movements.

QUICK REVISION

- Citizenship = right to have rights (competing demands; limited citizenship — Kamra/Faruqui); Ornit Shani's 4 discourses (liberal, republican, ethno-nationalist, non-statist).
- Elites = control economic+political+ideological; Krishna Kumar (early selection + mass exam), Desai (dominant caste), Beteille (competition for backwardness), Chhibber (local elites); new elites (YouTubers, media).
- Civil society (Chandhoke): weak 1947 → powerful 70s–80s → weak post-1991 (NGOs).

Regionalism, Decentralisation and the Question of Minority

52.1 Democratic Decentralisation: Gram Swaraj and Panchayati Raj

KEY CONCEPT

- **Gandhi's Gram Swaraj** — he distrusted centralized politics ('Raj Niti', where people are mere voters) and proposed decentralising power to the village ('Lok Niti'/'Lok Shakti'). The **ideal village** would be self-sufficient (in food and cotton), with a cattle reserve, playgrounds, water works and sanitation; those with wealth would act as **trustees**. National elites would attack caste/gender barriers while grassroots leaders would demand their implementation.
- **Ambedkar's critique**: the Indian village is 'a sink of localism, a den of ignorance, narrow-mindedness and communalism' — Gram Swaraj would **reproduce caste** (the dominant caste would rule and exploit Dalits and women).
- The **normative model of decentralisation** needs both **institutions** (representation of interest groups, people's participation, political/financial autonomy, experts/planners, integration with state/centre) and a conducive **environment**. This was given constitutional status by the **73rd and 74th Amendments** — three tiers (village, block, district), with reservation for women, SCs and STs.
- The **three Fs — Funds, Functions, Functionaries** — determine success: **Kerala** devolved these (a third of funds directly to Panchayats) and performs best; Bihar did not. **Problems: surrogate leadership** ('Sarpanchpati' — the husband ruling in the wife's name), the state not devolving power, no experts, symbolic integration.
- **Positive studies: Anandi Mani et al.** — where women head Panchayats, reporting of crimes against women rises and women's issues (drinking water) are prioritised; **Raghabendra Chattopadhyay & Esther Duflo** — female Pradhans invest more in drinking water/sanitation, SC Pradhans in housing for SC areas.

QUICK REVISION

- Gandhi's Gram Swaraj (ideal village, trustees, Ramaraj) vs Ambedkar ('sink of localism' — reproduces caste).
- 73rd/74th Amendments (3 tiers; reservation); three Fs (Funds/Functions/Functionaries); Kerala best; problems = surrogate leadership (Sarpanchpati).
- Mani et al. (female Sarpanch → reporting up), Chattopadhyay & Duflo (female → wa-

ter/sanitation; SC → housing).

52.2 Regionalism

KEY CONCEPT

- A **region** is defined administratively or culturally; **regionalism is a cultural phenomenon** — it emerges from **over-pride in one's culture** or from **relative deprivation** (e.g. the demands for Uttarakhand and Jharkhand). **Rasiduddin Khan** gave ten criteria to identify a region: language/dialect, social composition, ethnic regions, demographic features, geographic contiguity, cultural patterns, economy, historical antecedents, political background, and psychological make-up.
- **Three forms:** **supra-state** (the South vs North on Hindi imposition), **inter-state** (water/border disputes; location of central projects/IITs), and **intra-state** (Gorkhaland).
- Regionalism creates **narrow identities** — the '**son of the soil**' movement (Shiv Sena in Maharashtra, the anti-migrant movement in Assam) claiming the first right over local resources; the **Khalistan** movement was the only genuinely secessionist one.
- **But regionalism is also positive:** it counters centralisation, preserves linguistic/cultural identities, raises regional issues nationally, and — as **Rajni Kothari** says — makes Indian democracy more vibrant (federalism is a **compromise between nationalism and regionalism**). When linguistic states were created, many feared the '**balkanisation**' of India — but the linguistically-created states (the South) performed **better** on socio-economic indicators, so India should follow a **plural integration model**, not a unitary one.

QUICK REVISION

- Region: administrative vs cultural; regionalism from over-pride or relative deprivation (Uttarakhand/Jharkhand); Rasiduddin Khan's 10 criteria.
- Three forms: supra (South vs North), inter (water/border), intra (Gorkhaland); son of the soil (Shiv Sena); Khalistan = secessionist.
- Positive: counters centralisation, preserves culture, Kothari (vibrant democracy), plural integration; linguistic states performed better.

52.3 The Question of Minority

KEY CONCEPT

- The concept of **minority** arises from **urbanisation** (secondary urbanisation — groups that do not follow the dominant culture) and from the **nation-state** (communities that do not constitute a nation). Legally, India recognises **religious and linguistic** minorities.
- **Muslims** are the central minority concern: the **Sachar Committee** found them **worse off than Dalits**. Reasons for their backwardness: the **abolition of zamindari** (many Muslims were dependants), the **destruction of handicraft/artisan industries**, not taking **modern**

education (preferring madarsas), the **migration of the educated to Pakistan**, and **discrimination in employment/housing**. They also face **communal violence and dehumanisation** (stereotypes about meat-eating, 'love jihad', the Ahmedabad non-veg rule).

- Minorities have internal problems too — **caste** (among Sikhs) and **sectarian** divisions (Shia–Sunni, Ahmadiyya). On Muslim women, the criminalisation of triple talaq is welcomed as deterrence/empowerment, but it raises the demand for a **Uniform Civil Code** — which should be based on modern principles of gender equality, not the Hindu code. **Hilal Ahmed** notes that India is unique in the visibility of its Muslim minority (mosques, dress) — which is now being turned into the basis of an exclusionary nationalism.
- **Naxalism** (sociologically) is a product of **differential development** — states/communities denied the benefits of modern development (exploited earlier by caste/class, now by state policies) imagine a different India; they are **anti-state** (attacking state symbols, not ordinary people). It began in Punjab (Gulzar's film *Machis*) but dissipated there after the Green Revolution. The **farmers' protest** also created a new '**township of protest**' (makeshift homes, facilities, more women and Dalit participation).

QUICK REVISION

- Minority from urbanisation + nation-state; religious/linguistic; Muslims (Sachar — worse than Dalits; zamindari abolition, handicraft destruction, madarsas, migration, discrimination, communal violence, dehumanisation).
- Uniform Civil Code (modern, not Hindu); Hilal Ahmed (visibility of Muslims); caste/sect within minorities.
- Naxalism = differential development, anti-state; farmers' protest = 'township of protest'.

Contemporary Issues 2021

53.1 The Sex Ratio at Birth: The Case Studies

KEY CONCEPT

- **NFHS Round 5** key findings: overall sex ratio improved (1,020 women per 1,000 men), but the **sex ratio at birth (SRB)** is **929** (up from 919 in NFHS-4) — still below the WHO's natural 952, so **anthropogenic/social intervention** is at work. The **Total Fertility Rate (TFR)** has fallen to **~2.0** — below replacement (2.1) — which threatens to turn India's **demographic dividend into a demographic burden** (an ageing population; fewer young workers). Feticide/infanticide is now spreading even to tribal areas and Kerala.
- **Reasons for the low SRB (sociological case studies):**
- **Ashish Bose** (1991 census): with *more* development, urbanisation and westernisation there is *more* feticide — developed states (Punjab, Haryana, Western UP, Delhi/Noida, Himachal, Chandigarh) have high feticide because of **good transport + easy access to sex-determination technology + upper/middle-class position** (able to afford 'mobile doctors' who come home); plus the **status of sons, globalisation/migration** (sons go abroad), and **westernisation** → **mindless consumerism** → **dowry**. He coined the **BIMARU districts** ('daughter-elimination male-aspiring rage for ultrasound' — black holes in India's demographic transition).
- **L. S. Vishwanath: Sanskritization** — low castes emulate the upper castes (including dowry), so infanticide spreads downwards (E. G. Jenkinson, magistrate of Saharanpur in the 1830s, observed low castes like the Tuglas and Kolis adopting it). **More reservation** → **more Hinduization** → **more Sanskritization** → **more dowry/feticide**.
- **Amartya Sen & Jean Dreze:** the Chamars of UP — sex ratio fell from 986 (1901) to 880 (1981), so SCs are now 'more like the higher castes'.
- **Satish Agnihotri: feticide** (prenatal, done 'scientifically' by professional doctors) is treated as '**holier**' than **infanticide** (barbaric) — so sex-determination technology **legitimises** daughter-elimination (doctors claim to be doing 'social service'), and the practice spreads to those who never did it before. Rural areas, unable to afford the technology, use infanticide.
- **Mira Shiva** (an **interactionist** perspective): women themselves opt for feticide — not because they are heartless but to **save their daughters** from a patriarchal society (eve-teasing, molestation, bride-burning, dowry death).

QUICK REVISION

- NFHS-5: SRB 929 (improvement but below WHO 952); TFR ~2.0 (demographic dividend → burden); feticide spreading to tribal areas/Kerala.
- Ashish Bose (development → more feticide; mobile doctors; BIMARU districts), Vishwanath (Sanskritization), Sen & Dreze (Chamars 986→880), Agnihotri (feticide 'holier' than infanticide), Mira Shiva (interactionist — women saving daughters).

53.2 Missing Women and the Gender Gap**KEY CONCEPT**

- **'Missing women'** (Amartya Sen) refers to the suspiciously low ratio of women to men **at birth** in parts of the developing world — caused by **social discrimination** (food, education, healthcare, sex-selective abortion), *not* biology. (Emily Oster's counter-claim — that Hepatitis B caused it biologically — is rejected.)
- **Siwan Anderson & Ray**: 'missing women' is really **missing adult women** — the main cause is **widowhood**: a widow in rural India is seen as a **witch**, has no access to property/resources, faces stigma (bad-luck omen), seclusion, change of diet/dress, discouragement from remarriage — so she is vulnerable to **rape and suicide**.
- The **Global Gender Gap Index 2021**: India's gap **widened to 62.5%** — because of women's inadequate representation in politics/technical/leadership roles, the declining female labour-force participation, poor healthcare, the female–male literacy gap, and income inequality. Its four dimensions: **economic participation, educational attainment, health & survival, political empowerment**.

QUICK REVISION

- Missing women (Sen) = low sex ratio at birth, social not biological (vs Emily Oster's Hepatitis B); Siwan Anderson & Ray — missing adult women (widowhood → witch, no property, suicide).
- Global Gender Gap 2021: 62.5%; four dimensions (economic, educational, health, political).

53.3 Dominant Castes and the Demand for Backward Status**KEY CONCEPT**

- Dominant castes (Maratha, Jat, Patel, Gujar, Kapu) now demand **backward status**. The **Maratha** reservation was declared **unconstitutional** by the Supreme Court (a state cannot decide backwardness — that is for the National Commission for Backward Classes); the **Rohini Commission** proposes **sub-categorising OBCs** (the creamy layer has captured the benefits).
- **Reasons for the demand**: (1) **agrarian distress** — dominant (peasant) castes want non-farm occupations, but the private sector has no jobs, so they want government-job quotas

— **Satish Deshpande** calls it 'an expression of **caste entitlement** rather than a claim to class disadvantage' (a means to urbanisation); (2) **classicisation of caste** (D. L. Sheth) — caste loses its traditional functions and acquires new economic interest/political identity (cf. Parsons's structural differentiation); (3) a **crippled urban economy**; (4) **relative deprivation** — resentment at reservation-driven SC/ST upward mobility (reservation is for them a means to **preserve social distance**, not fix injustice); (5) **status inconsistency** (Gerhard Lenski) — socially forward but economically backward, hence Deshpande's '**backward forwards**'; (6) **exclusion/inclusion error** — the creamy layer captures benefits; (7) **political support** — their numerical strength (vote banks).

QUICK REVISION

- Maratha reservation unconstitutional; Rohini Commission (OBC sub-categorisation).
- Reasons: agrarian distress (Deshpande — caste entitlement), classicisation (D. L. Sheth), crippled urban economy, relative deprivation, status inconsistency (Lenski — 'backward forwards'), exclusion/inclusion error, political support.

53.4 Gail Omvedt and the Backward Class Movement

KEY CONCEPT

- **Gail Omvedt** (who died this year) wrote '**Dalits and the Democratic Revolution**' and '**Cultural Revolt: Non-Brahmin Movement in Maharashtra**'.
- Her comparison of pre- and post-independence movements: the pre-independence movements (Satya Shodak Samaj, the Self-Respect Movement, SNDP, the Justice Party, the Adi Dharma movement) were **anti-caste = anti-systemic movements** — they sought to transform the basic structure of the caste system, and thereby **introduced democracy into India**. Their common features: **rejection of Hindu nationalism** (they proposed **Dalit-Bahujan nationalism**), **rejection of the Aryan racial theory** (Brahmins were not the original inhabitants — Dalits/Dravidians were), **rejection of Hinduism** (an 'imposed' religion — 'I was born Hindu, but I will not die Hindu'), **rejection of the Congress** (a 'Brahmin-bourgeois/Shetji-Bhatji party'), and being **economic radicals** (against moneylenders and capitalists).
- They were led by **sub-elites** (elites of the downward castes — Phule, Periyar, Ambedkar, Narayana Guru) who competed with the traditional (Brahmin) elites; they were **peasant-based mass movements of the Bahujan**; and they were a **cultural revolt** — a **counter-hegemony** (Gramsci) against the cultural hegemony of the upper castes.

QUICK REVISION

- Gail Omvedt: Dalits and Democratic Revolution; Cultural Revolt.
- Pre-independence movements = anti-caste/anti-systemic (introduced democracy); reject Hindu nationalism, Aryan theory, Hinduism, Congress; economic radicals.
- Sub-elites; peasant-based Bahujan movements; cultural revolt (Gramsci's counter-hegemony).

53.5 Surrogacy, MTP and ART

KEY CONCEPT

- Three laws dealing with **women's reproductive health**: the **Medical Termination of Pregnancy (MTP) Act**, the **Surrogacy (Regulation) Bill**, and the **ART (Assisted Reproductive Technology) Bill**.
- The **surrogacy bill** recognises only two beneficiaries: the '**intending couple**' (a married heterosexual couple, roughly 35–45, if infertile) and the '**intending woman**' (divorced or widowed — **not** a single/unmarried woman; she must marry to gain parenthood). The surrogate carries the couple's combined sperm and egg, so she cannot call herself the mother; **commercial surrogacy is banned**, leaving only **altruistic surrogacy**.
- Sociological critique: the bill is **exclusionary** — it **excludes lesbians, gays, bisexuals and transgender people from parenthood** (parenthood is a status), and it **excludes single mothers** — thereby **reproducing heteronormative standards** and **reproducing marriage as an institution** (marriage is treated as so sacred that one may have to sacrifice to gain parenthood). This is a form of **social exclusion**.

QUICK REVISION

- Three reproductive-health laws: MTP, Surrogacy, ART.
- Surrogacy: intending couple + intending woman (divorced/widowed — not single); commercial banned (only altruistic).
- Critique: excludes gay/lesbian/bisexual/transgender and single mothers → reproduces heteronormativity and marriage; social exclusion.

53.6 Democratic Backsliding, Wage for Housework and Further Issues

KEY CONCEPT

- **Democratic backsliding** = the legal/constitutional 'un-democratising' of democracy — e.g. the abolition of **Article 370** was legal and constitutional, but it is argued to be **undemocratic** because it did not take the confidence of all stakeholders into account. (Scholars: **Ashutosh Varshney**, and Levitsky & Ziblatt of 'How Democracies Die'.) **Democratic resilience** = the institutions that keep democracy from collapsing despite backsliding — **civil society, media, judiciary, the masses, and social media**.
- **Wage for housework**: does paying women for housework **liberate** them, or **reproduce the status quo** (the state legitimising housework as 'women's deal')? Link it to the **waves of feminism**.
- Further exam-relevant issues to read: **POCSO Act** (the 'skin-to-skin contact' judgment, later rectified by the Supreme Court), **LGBT marriage rights**, the **PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana** (third phase, ~40% women workforce), and **Startup India** (its first review article in EPW).

QUICK REVISION

- Democratic backsliding (legal but undemocratic — Art. 370) vs democratic resilience (civil society, media, judiciary, masses, social media); scholars Varshney, Levitsky & Ziblatt.
- Wage for housework (liberate vs reproduce status quo; waves of feminism).
- Also read: POCSO (skin-to-skin), LGBT marriage rights, PM Kaushal Vikas Yojana (40% women), Startup India (EPW review).

Tribes, Regionalism and Ethno-Nationalism

54.1 Regionalism Among Tribals

KEY CONCEPT

- **Regionalism** is a form of ethnicity — an over-attachment to one's region, usually seen as an antithesis of nationalism. Its **causes (especially among tribals)**:
- **Social** — identity crisis (the feeling that one's culture/language/way of life is under threat; e.g. **Gorkhaland**, when the West Bengal government imposed Bengali); **historical** — the British isolationist policy isolating the North-East (hence the most secessionist movements there); **political** — regional identity used for political ends; **ethnic borders** (e.g. Assam's plain vs hill tribes, with ST-status disputes); **economic** — deprivation and 'step-motherly' treatment (Telangana); **human diversity**; and **psychological** — **primordial loyalties** (Clifford Geertz) to one's ethnic group.
- **D. C. Burman** (or A. Burman): regionalism is **both functional and dysfunctional** — it maintains diversity but can harm national integrity (or turn secessionist). **Virginus Xaxa**: for tribals, regional consciousness is a **sense of identity** — the demand for autonomy is a way of **asserting tribal identity**; it is a **socio-cultural movement against homogenisation**, crystallising 'Adivasi consciousness' at the grassroots due to marginalisation and oppression. Examples: the **Gonds of Adilabad** (land alienation), the **Jharkhand Mukti Morcha** (the mouthpiece of tribal rights), and the secessionist **NSCN**.

QUICK REVISION

- Regionalism
- causes (especially among tribals)
- Social
- Gorkhaland
- historical
- political
- ethnic borders
- economic
- human diversity
- psychological

- primordial loyalties
- D. C. Burman
- both functional and dysfunctional
- Virginius Xaxa

54.2 Ethno-Nationalism

KEY CONCEPT

- **Ethno-nationalism = ethnicity + nation.** A **nation** (Benedict Anderson) is an **imagined political community that is sovereign and limited** — an ethnic group that becomes politically aware. **Ernest Gellner**: a nation is 'building a **political roof** over one's cultural head'.
- An **ethnic group can live without a state** (satisfied with affirmative action), but **when it claims that its self-realisation depends on mastering the political domain**, it takes steps towards nationhood — this is **ethno-nationalism** — which can express itself by demanding either a **state within the federal union** or a **sovereign state**.

QUICK REVISION

- Regionalism (tribal): social (identity crisis/Gorkhaland), historical (isolationist), political, ethnic borders (Assam), economic (Telangana), diversity, psychological (primordial loyalties).
- Burman: functional (diversity) + dysfunctional (secession); Xaxa: identity assertion, anti-homogenisation; Gond, JMM, NSCN.
- Ethno-nationalism: Anderson (imagined political community, sovereign, limited); Gellner (political roof over cultural head); ethnic group without state vs mastering politics → nationhood.

54.3 Religious Change Among Tribes (N. K. Bose's Hindu Mode of Absorption)

KEY CONCEPT

- **Religious change among tribes** came from cultural contact with the mainstream: about **89.4% of tribals identify as Hindu** and a small minority as Christian. **Christian missionaries** (funded by the British to pacify tribal revolts) converted the Khasis (~1813), the Nagas (~1850) and the Mizos (~1880) — offering schools and cooperatives; this was resisted by the **Birsa Munda/Tana Bhagat movements**.
- **N. K. Bose's 'Hindu mode of tribal absorption'**: through contact with plains Hindus, tribes emulate Hindu practices, project a caste identity, and get absorbed. Hindu 'great tradition' absorbed tribal elements — **Ganesh** from an elephant totem; **Kali** as a tribal goddess; myths linking tribes to the epics (Ram meeting the Bhil **Shabari**, Bhima marrying the tribal woman **Hidimba**); the **Bonda** women's 'Sita's curse' legend; and the **Khasas** claiming descent from

the **Pandavas** to justify polyandry. The **Hindu Right** later opened gurukuls/Saraswati Shishu Mandirs in tribal areas (Arunachal). **Christopher von Fürer-Haimendorf** (South Indian Gonds): between 1941 and the 1980s their religion became markedly Hinduised.

- Later **Sanskritization** examples: the **Bauris** of West Bengal (sacred thread, Vaishnavism), the **Bhumij** of MP (Kshatriya claims — studied by Surajit Sinha), the **Pardhan** (Fürer-Haimendorf).

QUICK REVISION

- 89.4% of tribals Hindu; Christian missionaries (Khasis 1813, Nagas 1850, Mizos 1880; Birsa Munda resistance); Hindu Right's gurukuls.
- N. K. Bose's Hindu mode of tribal absorption; tribal gods → great tradition (Ganesh, Kali); Bonda/Sita legend; Khasas (Pandava descent).
- Sanskritization: Bauris (sacred thread), Bhumij (Kshatriya), Pardhan (Fürer-Haimendorf).

54.4 PYQ Pointers on Tribes

KEY CONCEPT

- Recurring tribal PYQs and their answers: **unity and diversity** (~698 scheduled tribes; linguistic, geographic and economic diversity — from hunter-gatherers to white-collar); the **impact of geographical/economic mobility** (the breakdown of the social network → community disarticulation; land alienation → homelessness/joblessness; from an egalitarian, demonetised, barter society into a hierarchical, monetised, consumerist one — e.g. the **Mankidia** tribe displaced by the Similipal tiger reserve, now daily-wage labourers under MGNREGA); **tribe vs caste** (simple vs complex society, egalitarian vs hierarchical, mechanical vs organic solidarity — Tönnies's *Gemeinschaft/Gesellschaft*); **integration and autonomy** (Elwin's **isolationist** policy vs Ghurye's **assimilationist** vs the **integrationist** policy finally adopted — the Fifth and Sixth Schedules, tribal sub-plans); **ethno-nationalism and tribal discontent** (identity crisis, **jal-jangal-jameen**, economic and political factors); and the **definitional problem** (evolutionist → functionalist → the continuum view).

QUICK REVISION

- PYQs: unity/diversity (698 tribes); mobility (Mankidia/Similipal); tribe vs caste (Tönnies); integration/autonomy (Elwin vs Ghurye vs integrationist — Fifth/Sixth Schedule); tribal discontent (identity crisis, jal-jangal-jameen); definitional problem.

How to Approach the Exam (2022)

55.1 The Sociology Exam Structure

KEY CONCEPT

- **Paper structure:** each paper (Paper 1 and Paper 2) has **28 questions**, of which you **attempt 19** — so **38 questions in six hours**, with a real **choice**. Unlike GS (where all questions are compulsory), in sociology **your choice determines your marks**, so the ability to pick the right question is decisive.
- **Paper 1: Unit 4 (thinkers) and Unit 5 (stratification)** together carry about **170 marks out of 250** — so make notes on these two. **Paper 2: Section A** (perspectives) and **Section B** (institutions) are compulsory/static; **Section C** is contemporary/current-affairs — except **social movements, 'vision of social change', and rural/agrarian transformation programmes** (community development, Green Revolution), which are static.
- **Sources** for the GS overlap: **Ram Ahuja** for social issues/social justice; current affairs for the rest.

QUICK REVISION

- Paper structure
- 28 questions
- attempt 19
- 38 questions in six hours
- choice
- your choice determines your marks
- Paper 1
- Unit 4 (thinkers) and Unit 5 (stratification)
- 170 marks out of 250
- Paper 2
- Section A
- Section B
- Section C
- Sources

55.2 Answer-Writing and Essay Guidance

KEY CONCEPT

- **GS1 social issues and social justice** largely revolve around **secularism, communalism, globalisation, and the women's movement** — cover these dimensions (do **not** write thinkers here, unlike in sociology). Example: 'the women's movement in India did not address issues of lower-strata women' (2018) is answered through **intersectionality**.
- **Essay writing** is about **flow, not dimensions or facts** — the evaluator is a **general reader**, not a subject expert; you are judged on whether you convey your message clearly. (If the optional and ethics are ready, the essay is almost automatically ready — only the *art* of writing it needs practice.)
- **Writing tests is essential**: committing mistakes and correcting them is how the understanding gets fixed ('befriending the mistakes'); a person who has only watched videos/handouts but not written tests cannot be said to know the subject. Make your **own list of thinkers** during revision, rather than memorising one.

QUICK REVISION

- Paper 1 & 2: 28 questions, attempt 19 each (38 in 6 hrs); choice decides marks.
- Paper 1 Unit 4+5 (thinkers + stratification) = ~170 marks; Paper 2 Section A/B compulsory, Section C contemporary.
- GS1 social issues: secularism, communalism, globalisation, women's movement (no thinkers; e.g. intersectionality).
- Essay = flow, not dimensions; write tests (befriend mistakes); make your own thinkers list.